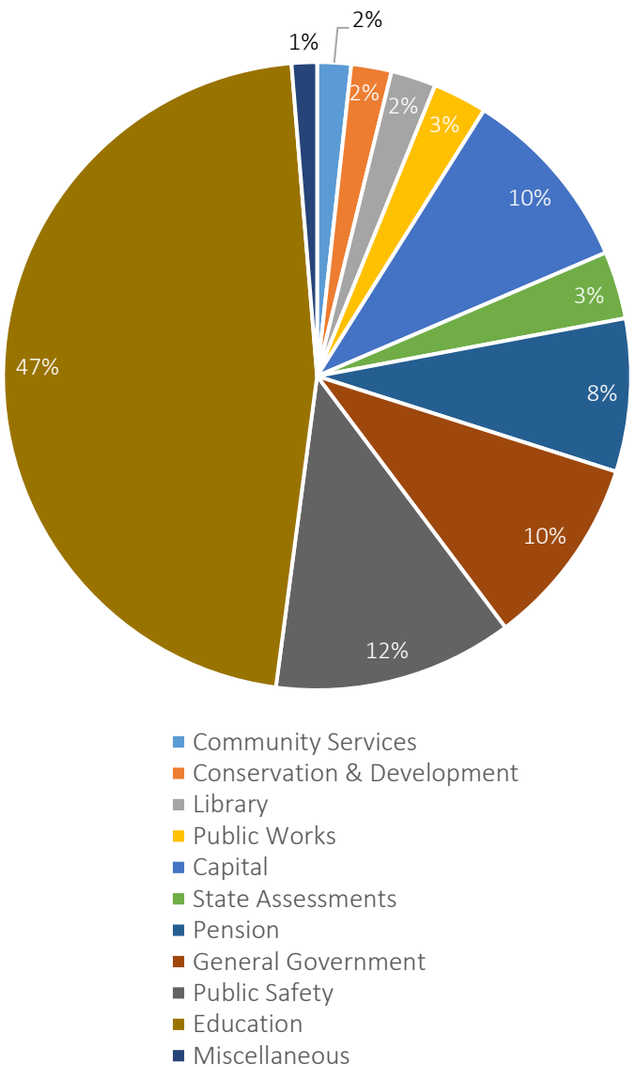
TOWN OF AMHERST

FISCAL YEAR 2027 PROPOSED BUDGET

JULY 1, 2026 - JUNE 30, 2027

Town of Amherst: Fiscal Year 2027 Budget Proposal

Total Spending Plan	$107,114,738



Highlights

Responsible Budget

Aligns with the Budget Guidelines adopted by the Town Council for Fiscal Year 2027. This budget invests in education, public safety and public works while increasing capital funding to enable completion of the four building projects (Elementary School, Fire Station, Library and Public Works Headquarters). It maintains a commitment to our retirees through funding of Other Post Employment Benefits and avoids the addition of new debt.

Funding for Schools

Increases base funding for the Regional Schools and Elementary Schools by 3.5% and 5.1% respectively. Earmarks $45,000 in the Town budget for support of the Morning Movement and Mentoring program.

Public Safety

Adds two firefighter/EMT positions by restoriing one frozen position and adding one new position. CRESS operating expense budget increased $6,000 (26%) to support communication, training, and supply costs.

Sustainability and Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Fully funds Sustainability and DEI initiatives. Amherst remains a leader in Climate Action and Racial Equity.

Public Works

Invests in Public Works to support higher wages and operating costs in response to inflationary pressures. Public Works funding is increasing by 7.9%, compared to a 4.5% increase in the overall municipal operating budget. In addition, the proposal includes two new Operator positions to strengthen Water and Sewer operations.

Navigating a Challenging Fiscal Environment

Incorporates strategies designed to help the Town navigate the challenging fiscal environment facing communities statewide. First, it includes a plan to fund the Fire Station without the use of debt, thereby reducing long-term pressure on the operating budget. Second, it reflects anticipated efficiencies from school consolidation, as identified at the time the Town approved the debt exclusion for construction of a new school.

Budget Calendar

- May 4, 2026 - Budget Presentation
- May 5, 2026: Finance Committee Begins Budget Review
- May 11, 2026: Finance Committee Public Hearing
- June 15, 2026: Town Council Vote

More Information

- Visit the Town's website for more information on all Town activities.
- For more information on the budget, click here.

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Executive Summary

"We are called to be architects of the future, not its victims."

- R. Buckminster Fuller

Town Manager's Budget Message

May 1, 2026

Dear Residents of Amherst and Members of the Town Council:

In accordance with Section 5.4 of the Amherst Home Rule Charter, it is my privilege to submit the FY27 Budget for the Town of Amherst.

This Budget includes all Town operations, including Municipal, Schools, Library, and Capital for the fiscal year spanning July 1, 2026 to June 30, 2027 (FY27). This submission includes the five-year Capital Improvement Program. The Operating Budget and Capital Improvement Program will allocate necessary funds needed to provide the services described for FY27. The budget amounts to $107,114,738, and represents an increase of $3,904,942, or 3.78% from the FY26 Budget. The Capital Improvement Program reflects an investment of $10,324,269 (including debt; excluding grants) for FY27, determined by allocating 10.5% of the tax levy to capital expenditures.

This year's budget reflects both our community's shared priorities and the financial realities we must navigate together. At the same time, this budget must be understood within the broader structural challenges facing Amherst and all communities in Massachusetts. Under Proposition 2 ½, property tax revenue, the Town's primary funding source, can increase no more than 2.5% annually, excluding new economic growth. However, the cost of providing municipal services, including education, public safety, public works, and libraries, continues to rise significantly faster than that rate due to inflation and other pressures. This creates a persistent structural gap between revenues and expenditures.

This year's budget reflects a careful balancing of these competing needs within the limits of available resources, without asking voters to increase their taxes through an override.

For FY27, the Town is able to fund an overall operating increase of 3.85%, consistent with Council guidance, along with supplementary support from the ambulance fund. One-time funds from FY26 are added into the Elementary Schools' base appropriation. It is important to be clear that this level of increase is not sustainable and is not the result of ongoing revenue growth. Rather it is due to a favorable one-time reduction in the public transportation assessment, lower than typical increase in retirement system costs and tighter revenue projections. These are fortunate but temporary options, not reliable funding sources.

As such, this budget continues to emphasize disciplined, sustainable financial planning while making targeted investments in priority areas, including education, public safety, public works, and capital projects. The Town of Amherst budget includes five components:

a. Municipal budget (which includes the Town's four enterprise funds);
b. Elementary School budget;
c. Library budget;
d. Amherst-Pelham Regional School District budget; and
e. Capital Improvement Program.

Other important budget documents include:

a. Community Preservation Act (CPA) budget; and,
b. Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) budget.

Section 5.4 of the Town Charter requires the Town Manager to "submit to the Town Council a proposed budget for the ensuing fiscal year, including municipal, school and library components as determined by the Town Manager, with an accompanying budget message and supporting documents."

As required by the Town Charter, these documents were submitted to the Town Council on this date and simultaneously filed with the Town Clerk and have been published on the Town Bulletin Board. All documents may be found here: https://www.amherstma.gov/3584/Upcoming-Budget.

Sincerely,

Paul Bockelman
Town Manager

Budget Highlights

- Adheres to Council Budget Guidelines
  - Provides a 3.85% increase to all operating budgets.
  - Adds one-time funding from FY26 back into the Elementary Schools' base appropriation for FY27.
  - Utilizes ambulance revenue to add two Firefighter/Emergency Medical Services staff by restoring one frozen position and adding one new position.

- Responsible Budget
  - Balances revenues and expenses with minimal use of reserves in enterprise funds.
  - Incorporates the Town Council's request to be less conservative with revenue projections while also ensuring that all estimates are achievable and supportable.
  - Honors the extensive work of the Library Director, School Superintendent, Principals, and Town staff in developing their budget proposals.
  - Honors the commitment made during the school building debt exclusion vote to realize operational efficiencies from replacing two aging school buildings by combining them into one new, efficient, state-of-the-art facility.

- Investment in Public Works
  - Invests significantly in the wages of Public Works employees through funding of a proposed collective bargaining agreement that is being negotiated.
  - Funds an additional operator in the water and sewer departments for an increase of two positions.
  - Begins to right-size operating budgets that have been negatively impacted by inflation with a focus on Public Works.

- Commitment to DEI and Sustainability
  - Funds DEI and Sustainability initiatives ensuring Amherst remains a leader in Climate Action and Racial Equity.

- Plans for Current and Future Capital Needs
  - Maintains fiscal discipline to meet upcoming facility and equipment needs by setting aside 10.5% of the tax levy for capital.
  - Adds no new debt to the books as we prepare to bond the replacement of the Public Works facility.
  - Re-confirms the plan to fund the replacement of a Fire Station using the capital stabilization fund, without adding debt.

- Funds Recreation Programs for Residents
  - Funds the aquatics program with revenue from expanded swimming programs for adults and students. These programs continue to be popular for all ages.
  - Fully funds the award-winning Morning Movement and Mentoring program that has benefitted our students. This program was previously funded from other sources, but this budget includes a dedicated appropriation.

FY27 Budget: Perseverance and Planning

The FY27 Budget Proposal reflects a comprehensive and deliberate commitment to planning as the foundation for advancing the Town's goals and ensuring long-term stability. This document is not simply a financial outline for the coming year, but a continuation of a broader, coordinated effort to align resources, policies, and decisions with a clearly defined vision for the future. By adhering to established plans while thoughtfully introducing new strategies, the Budget demonstrates that the Town can make measurable progress towards its goals.

The Town Council's six goal areas provide guidance for the Town's work: Administration & Leadership; Climate Action; Community Health, Safety, and Social Justice; Housing and Economic Vitality; Infrastructure Management, Maintenance, and Land Stewardship; and Town Council, Community and Strategic Relationships. These goals are not independent priorities, but elements of a cohesive strategy.

Administration & Leadership

A key element of this year's planning process is the approach to revenue forecasting. At the request of the Town Council, the FY27 budget incorporates a less conservative projection of revenues than in previous years. The initial operating budget projection of 3.50% was increased to 3.85% following the release of State Aid estimates. This adjustment reflects a calculated decision to take advantage of available resources and a more aggressive projection of revenue which will still maintain a responsible and sustainable outlook. The additional revenue capacity has been directed toward priority areas, including an increase of $269,704 to the Elementary Schools' base appropriation. In addition, the budget draws an additional $200,000 from the ambulance fund to add Fire/ Emergency Medical Services staffing.

While a less conservative approach introduces a higher degree of uncertainty, this risk has been carefully considered and communicated. Planning does not eliminate uncertainty, but it does provide a framework for managing it. Revenue estimates remain grounded in historical trends and realistic expectations. Interest revenue, for example, is currently elevated due to favorable rates and the accumulation of funds associated with ongoing capital projects, largely the Library and Elementary School. While projections for this revenue source have been increased, they have not been raised to a level that would create vulnerability in the event of a decline. This measured approach reflects a broader commitment to stability and sustainability.

In the area of education, the FY27 budget continues to implement a long-term plan aimed at improving efficiency and future financial sustainability. The Superintendent's Budget Proposal implements the efficiency savings from operating two buildings instead of three. The consolidation of elementary school operations represents a significant structural change, one that was planned and communicated prior to implementation. The anticipated savings, estimated at no less than $1 million at the time voters passed the debt exclusion, include reductions in utility costs associated with operating a net-zero facility, as well as efficiencies gained through consolidation of operations. While these changes require difficult adjustments, they are a necessary component of a broader strategy to align educational services with available resources.

The Amherst School Committee's request for a 5.9% increase exceeds the Town's financial capacity and the Town Council's guidelines. Meeting this request would require cuts to other services, reliance on one-time funds, or a Proposition 2 ½ override. These options are not sustainable or in line with the Town Council's guidelines. This proposal provides a 5.1% increase to the Elementary Schools' base appropriation and incorporates the Superintendent's proposed budget. It also allocates additional funding made available due to the Regional School District assessment coming in below guidance.

Climate Action

Climate Action remains a core principle of the Town's strategic planning. As one of the State's first Climate Leader Communities, the Town continues to implement the action steps outlined in its Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resilience Plan. The FY27 budget includes funding for sustainability initiatives, as well as support for projects that reduce the Town's environmental impact. The opening of a net-zero elementary school represents a significant step forward in this effort, as do the investments in energy efficiency initiatives in municipal buildings and electric and hybrid vehicles. These initiatives reflect a recognition that environmental sustainability is an integral part of long-term planning and community resilience.

Community Health, Safety and Social Justice

The Town's commitment to bending the arc of social justice is reflected in this budget. Continued support for the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion department ensures that these principles remain embedded in both internal operations and community engagement efforts. Through training programs, workshops, and public initiatives, the Town is working to foster a more inclusive and equitable community. This work is not separate from the broader planning process, but rather an essential component of it, ensuring that all residents have the opportunity to benefit from the Town's investments and initiatives.

Public safety planning continues to evolve in response to changing needs and priorities. The FY27 budget maintains current staffing levels for the Police Department and the Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service (CRESS) while initiating a multi-year plan to increase Fire/Emergency Medical Services staffing. By phasing in additional Fire Department staffing over a three-year period, the Town will make progress in improving service levels in a financially responsible manner. The first year of this plan calls for the addition of two positions – the restoration of one frozen firefighter/EMT position and the addition of one new position. The end result of the three-year plan means the Town will have expanded staffing to operate three ambulances and one fire truck at all times.

Housing and Economic Vitality

Economic development and housing initiatives are central to the Town's planning efforts to ensure the Town's long-term fiscal health. The FY27 budget includes funding for economic development and site planning initiatives throughout Town including the Wildwood School site, which is anticipated to be turned back to the Town in the fall of 2026. These efforts are particularly important in light of recent developments with the announced closure of Hampshire College, presenting both challenges and opportunities. With a significant portion of the Town's property classified as tax-exempt (approximately 30%), expanding the tax base and supporting economic growth are essential components of long-term fiscal sustainability. Planning for these outcomes requires both strategic investment and active engagement with the community to identify opportunities that are wise and align with the Town's values and goals.

Infrastructure Management, Maintenance, and Land Stewardship

Responsible capital planning remains one of the most visible and impactful components of the Town's long-term strategy. The FY27 budget continues to support a series of major building projects that have been in development for several years. The Amethyst Brook Elementary School is on track to open in August, representing a significant milestone in the Town's commitment to student-centered, energy-efficient educational facilities. The Jones Library renovation and expansion is also progressing on schedule, with an anticipated opening in the spring of 2027. Planning for a new Department of Public Works facility is moving forward, with the Public Works Building Committee actively engaged in the designer selection process and projected costs incorporated into the Capital Improvement Program. The Town continues to plan for the

replacement of the Central Fire Station, a project that remains a high priority due to the critical role of emergency services. With an estimated cost of $30 million, the Town has taken a disciplined approach to funding this project, accumulating $13 million in reserves to date and anticipating an additional $5 million from future sources. This incremental approach reflects a commitment to minimizing debt while ensuring that essential infrastructure needs are met.

Outside of the four major building projects, the Town has completed or is nearing completion of several impactful projects. The completion of the Centennial Water Treatment Facility and improvements to the Bangs Community Center further demonstrate the Town's focus on maintaining and enhancing its physical assets in a way that supports both current and future needs. The Centennial Water Treatment Facility provides access to a vital water supply while the improvements to the Bangs Community Center bring this important community facility up to current safety codes and creates additional dedicated space for the Senior Center. Other projects anticipated to be completed this calendar year include the new track and field at the Amherst Regional High School and a public downtown restroom at Kendrick Park. These represent two longstanding community needs that will be opened in the coming months.

Infrastructure planning extends beyond major capital projects to include ongoing maintenance and improvement efforts. The Town's five-year road improvement plan is a structured approach to address long-standing infrastructure challenges. Roads and sidewalks are important and the Town must elevate its annual investment to improve their condition. Significant capital sources of approximately $5 million per year, combined with enhanced maintenance capacity and updated treatment methods, will make significant progress in improving road conditions. The FY27 budget includes funding for the first year of this plan, as well as additional resources to expand operational capacity. This effort underscores the importance of consistency and discipline in addressing infrastructure needs, particularly when balancing immediate demands with long-term priorities.

Town Council, Community, and Strategic Relationships

The Town has a long history of collaboration and cohesion across its elected bodies. It has been a leader in bringing officials together to develop a unified plan, rather than competing against one another. Groups such as the Budget Coordinating Group and Joint Capital Planning Committee exemplify this approach and are not commonly found in every community. In recent years, however, this strength has been tested by increasingly tight budgets. Amherst, like many communities in western Massachusetts, is experiencing a structural imbalance: expenses are rising faster than revenues year after year. This growing pressure is straining the collaborative foundation that has long been a hallmark of the Town and has been essential to our financial stability.

To move forward, we must first define and quantify the challenge. Historically, Town revenues grow by 3 to 4 percent annually, while initial estimates project expenditures increasing by 5 percent or more each year. This difference results in a recurring shortfall of roughly $1 to $2 million each year just to maintain level services. The next step is to determine how to address this structural gap - through revenue growth, expenditure control, or a combination of both. Given the scale of the gap, a balanced approach is necessary. The Town will need to pursue responsible revenue growth opportunities while also identifying and implementing strategies to manage and contain cost increases.

If we can come together around a shared commitment to both responsible revenue growth and disciplined spending, Amherst can return to a path of fiscal sustainability. Doing so will reinforce the collaboration and consistency that have historically led to strong outcomes for the Town and its residents. Failure to move in this direction will lead to even more

contentious budget debates, fighting over dwindling resources, and requests for taxpayers to tax themselves more through operating budget overrides.

Operating Budgets

As part of the FY27 budget development process, municipal departments were asked to model 10% reductions in their operational budgets. It was clear that, at that level, reductions would require significant staffing cuts across both small and large departments, directly reducing the capacity in areas such as public safety, public health, inspections, planning, sustainability, and DEI. Departments also identified cuts to training and professional development, and while some explored operational changes such as a four-day work week, these options are not feasible for critical services. Overall, this exercise demonstrated that there is little flexibility to reduce spending without impacting services and the ability to meet the Town Council's goals. This underscored the importance of maintaining strong reserves to protect the Town from economic uncertainty and maintain continuity in a constrained revenue environment.

The Financial Indicators presentation on November 3, 2025 showed that operating budgets could increase responsibly at the rate of 3.5% prior to factoring in any State Aid increases. Subsequently, the Town Council's Budget Policy Guidelines adopted December 2, 2025 established this 3.5% increase across the four major budget components (Municipal, Library, Elementary Schools, and Regional School District) as one of its core guidelines. The guidelines also made several recommendations should revenue projections be updated and new resources become available.

After refining budget numbers and reviewing the Governor's budget, I presented a recommendation that each operating budget be increased by 3.85%. I allocated additional resources to the Elementary Schools to include the one-time funding from FY26 in their base appropriation. I also recommended that the Town increase its use of the Ambulance Fund to add two positions to the Fire Department by restoring one frozen Firefighter/EMT position and adding one new position.

The Town, Library, and Regional School District have all developed/adopted budgets that meet or are below the Town Council's guidance. The School Superintendent proposed a responsible budget plan for the Elementary Schools that was crafted with the input of district leadership including school principals that met the Council's guidelines. After deliberation, the Amherst School Committee, which oversees the Town's elementary schools, voted to request a $1.66 million increase in its budget, an increase of 5.9%.

This increase exceeded the Town Council's guidelines significantly. The 5.9% increase is beyond the capacity of the current budget and cannot be met without either (a) reducing other School, Town, and/or Library budgets; (b) utilizing additional one-time money; or (c) seeking an operating budget override of Proposition 2 ½. None of these options are palatable nor are any of the options in keeping with the Town Council's Budget Policy Guidelines.

In addition, the State's House of Representatives Budget recommendation calls for a reduction in State Aid to the Town when compared to the Governor's Budget Proposal. If these recommendations are adopted, it would place more stress on the Town's budget.

Amherst Schools are recognized as some of the finest in the state. This, in large part, is due to excellent teachers and the Town's continued strong financial commitment to the schools. Amherst has historically and continues to have one of the highest per student expenditures in the state. The projected decline in enrollments and efficiencies identified as part of the school building project must be taken into account to avoid financial instability.

While additional revenues are always needed, the paramount challenge lies in aligning the operations of the School Districts with the available revenue streams to sustain chosen programs.

Revenues

Property taxes and State Aid are projected to be stable with a moderate increase. Local Receipts are projected to increase by 9.4% as we have budgeted these less conservatively than in past years.

Property Taxes: Property tax revenues are projected to increase by 3.3%, not counting the debt override. New Growth is projected to be lower, in part, due to the fire at Olympia Drive that destroyed a new apartment building that was under construction which reduced projected new growth revenue.

Local Receipts: These are the most economic driven revenues in Town, meaning they can fluctuate significantly from one year to the next. This requires a more conservative budgeting approach taking into account prior year receipts and looking at current year activity. Per the Town Council's budget guidelines, we have made projections that are less conservative even though this is a concern in uncertain economic times. It is important to note that this is the second year of less conservative estimates as Local Receipts budgets were increased significantly in FY26 as well. Key changes include:

- $96,092 or 4.8% increase to motor vehicle excise.
- $88,600 or 11.1% increase for hotel/motel and meals excise tax.
- $398,342 or 38.8% increase to licenses and permits.
- $50,000 or 43.5% increase to miscellaneous (Hotel UMass occupancy fees).

State Aid: Despite some new funding, the Town's local share of State Aid remains stagnant. We project State Aid based on the Governor's FY27 budget proposal which includes a small increase of 2.5% in Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA), although it is important to note the House budget provides only a .7% increase. The overall increase for all State Aid categories is expected to be 2.7% due to minimal increases in UGGA and Chapter 70 and a possible significant increase in the charter assessment reimbursement.

Other Financing Sources: We project a 3.2% overall increase primarily due to rising Community Preservation Act debt obligations and the utilization of previously unspent capital funds to support new capital projects. Ambulance Funding to support staffing in the Fire Department is increasing by $200,000 however the total number is dropping 7.5% because this is a year when we are not purchasing a new ambulance (per our replacement schedule). Enterprise fund reimbursements are up 3.0% based on increases to the water and sewer enterprise fund FY27 operating budgets.

FY27: Expenditures

The proposed FY27 Town of Amherst Budget includes the following:

Budget	FY26 Recap	FY27 Proposed	Change ($)	Change (%)
Municipal*	$ 29,497,920	$ 30,833,590	$ 1,335,670	4.53%
Amherst Schools**	$ 28,049,236	$ 29,478,590	$ 1,429,354	5.10%
Amherst Schools - One time	269,704	-	$ (269,704)	-100.00%
Regional Schools	$ 19,744,008	$ 20,434,781	$ 690,773	3.50%
Libraries (tax support)	$ 2,394,154	$ 2,486,329	$ 92,175	3.85%
Subtotal	$ 79,955,022	$ 83,233,290	$ 3,278,268	4.10%
Capital	$ 9,663,408	$ 10,324,269	$ 660,861	6.84%
Retirement, OPEB, etc..	$ 8,377,403	$ 8,436,382	$ 58,979	0.70%
Assessments, Other	$ 5,213,963	$ 5,120,797	$ (93,166)	-1.79%
Grand Total	$ 103,209,796	$ 107,114,738	$ 3,904,942	3.78%

** Municipal budget includes $200,000 allocated from the ambulance fund.*

***Amherst Schools budget includes additional $339,075 comprised of $269,704 of one-time FY26 funding added into the base and $69,371 from the Regional School assessment coming in below guidance.*

FY27: Town Council Actions

As part of the FY27 budget process, I request that the Town Council:

- Approve the general fund budget including the elementary schools and library.
- Approve the regional school district budget.
- Approve the four enterprise fund budgets.
- Approve the capital improvement program.
- Approve proposed fee increases for water and sewer.

FY27: Next Steps

Upon receipt of the Town Manager's proposed budget, Section 5.5(a) of the Charter states that the Town Council shall immediately refer the budget to the Finance Committee.

The Finance Committee is required to hold a public hearing on the proposed budget. The public hearing is scheduled to be held on May 11, 2026. The Finance Committee is required to "thoroughly review the budget and make a presentation and recommendation to the full Town Council within 30 days of referral."

Over the course of the next four weeks, the Finance Committee will review the specific components of the budget and make a recommendation to the Town Council.

The Town Council shall adopt the budget, with or without amendments, by June 30, 2026.

Each of the component budgets included in this comprehensive Town budget has gone through a thorough review by staff and committees including the:

- Amherst School Committee;
- Board of Library Trustees;
- Amherst-Pelham Regional School Committee;
- Budget Coordinating Group;
- Joint Capital Planning Committee;
- Community Preservation Act Committee; and
- Community Development Block Grant Advisory Committee.

The referenced set of budget documents provides a complete financial plan for all Town funds and Town activities for FY27. I have also included supporting documents and historical budgets for your reference. The budget documents explain the proposed budgets for all Town agencies in fiscal terms, priorities, and programs. They outline proposed financial policies for FY27, describe important features of the budgets, indicate major variations from FY26, provide reasons for these changes, and provide a summary of the Town's debt position.

The public can learn more about this budget as follows:

- All documents can be found on the Town's website here: https://www.amherstma.gov/3584/UpcomingBudget.
- The Finance Committee will meet eight times in May to review the budget department-by-department. These meetings will be on Tuesdays and Thursdays on the following dates: May 5th, May 7th, May 12th, May 14th, May 19th, May 21st, May 26th and May 28th. All meetings are virtual and open to the public.
- The Finance Committee will hold a public hearing on the budget on May 11th at 6:30 p.m. This meeting is open to the public and public comments are welcome.

Conclusion

This FY27 budget reflects the Town's commitment to delivering excellent services while making the difficult but necessary choices required to maintain fiscal stability. We are prioritizing investments in Public Schools, Public Works, and Public Safety, recognizing that doing so requires real trade-offs and careful stewardship of limited resources.

The budget supports the Town Council's strategic priorities, preserves core services, and leans into opportunities for innovation; new approaches and big-picture thinking will be critical to overcoming our financial constraints.

We remain focused on long-term sustainability. This proposal is grounded in realistic and responsible planning that balances the immediate needs of the community with the long-term health of the Town. We need to renew our longstanding practice of working collaboratively across all departments and elected bodies to provide the best possible services for all Amherst residents.

Moving forward, Amherst must continue to focus on strategies that address the gap between revenue growth and rising costs to ensure long-term financial sustainability. Without a collaborative approach to the realities of the structural deficit, difficult trade-offs will remain an annual reality.

This budget is balanced, responsible, and forward-looking. It reflects a strong commitment to transparency, fiscal discipline, and the shared goal of maintaining a strong and vibrant community.

Acknowledgements

The development of the Town's budget plan is a team effort that starts at the very core of our operations – funding basic services delivered by dedicated employees. It is the needs and insights provided at the ground level – by the employees doing the jobs - that inform the decisions made in these budget planning documents.

The budget process starts in November with early financial projections and presentations to the four boards and the public.

The Schools, under the leadership of Superintendent Xiomara Herman and Finance Director Shannon Bernacchia, produced a comprehensive budget for both the elementary schools and regional school district. This effort included input and careful analysis and consultation from Principals and many others. Library Director Sharon Sharry shaped a budget of which the Town is just one part with the Jones Library Trust providing other resources. I am fortunate to work with such committed and great partners.

The Community Preservation Act Committee thoughtfully reviewed every request for funds and made recommendations to the Town Council.

The Joint Capital Planning Committee addressed the many capital needs we face as a community and provided valuable input that strengthened the Capital Improvement Program.

The municipal budget starts and ends with the Town's department heads. It's a talented group who are able to project the needs of their departments and manage their budgets with great proficiency.

My principal support staff in the production of this budget and, really, the person who sweat the details and is most responsible for pulling this impressive document together is Finance Director Sean Mangano. This document is the collective effort by this experienced and talented team. Assistant Town Manager David Ziomek, Clerk of the Town Council Athena O'Keeffe, and Communications Manager Samantha Giffen all contributed to the content and preparation of the document. And each department head or person responsible for a functional area provided the detailed summary of the work of their departments, identified departmental needs, and this year offered additional insights during the development of the budget.

A budget is a planning document. We know it will change. I am incredibly proud of the people who worked with me to create this document which addresses so many of the goals of the Town Council and the Town's residents despite minimal new resources.

Lastly, I want to thank every Town employee, Town Councilor, committee volunteer, resident, and our partners in the business community, and our world-class higher education institutions who contribute each day to make Amherst such a wonderful place to make a home.

What's New?

FY27: Municipal & Enterprise Fund Budget Requests

My recommended FY27 Town of Amherst Budget includes the following:

	FY27 Recommendation	Dollar Change from FY26	Percent Change from FY26
Municipal Budget	$30,833,590	$1,335,670	4.5%
Water Fund	$7,331,475	$328,975	4.7%
Sewer Fund	$7,308,014	$321,289	4.6%
Solid Waste Fund	$659,162	$19,043	3.0%
Transportation Fund	$707,044	-$31,940	(4.3%)

FY27: Municipal Budget Highlights

All contractual obligations, including all collective bargaining agreements – settled and projected, debt service, and assessments for the retirement system are included in this budget. The budget includes:

- Funding to provide for the increased cost of health insurance, a $297,432 increase;
- Funding for two additional firefighter/EMT positions over current staffing; one previously frozen position and the addition of one new position;
- Investment in Public Works wages and operating expenses reflected by a 7.9% increase in the Public Works budget, significantly higher than the overall 4.5% increase in the municipal budget; and
- Funding to enhance Recreation opportunities in Town including the Morning Movement and Mentoring program, Aquatics Program Director, and adjusting the recreation budgets to offset the impacts of inflation.

FY27: Enterprise Funds Highlights

- Water and sewer rates are proposed to increase to support the investments needed in these vital areas (4.65% for water; 5.04% for sewer). These increases reflect reduced water consumption from the closure of Hampshire College which puts upward pressure on rates.
- The Water Fund budget will increase $328,975 or 4.7% from the FY26 budget. This increase is driven by wage increases, additional staff, higher operating costs, and higher capital for infrastructure projects.
- The Sewer Fund budget will increase $321,289 or 4.6% from the FY26 budget. This increase is driven by wage increases, additional staff, higher operating costs, higher capital, and debt payments for infrastructure projects.
- The Solid Waste Fund budget will increase $19,043 or 3.0% from the FY26 budget. This request calls for $21,162 of Retained Earnings to supplement the operating budget. The Town is procuring a new cell tower contract which has the potential to increase revenues and eliminate the need for the use of Retained Earnings.
- The Transportation Fund budget will decrease $31,940 or 4.3% from the FY26 budget. This request calls for $61,048 of Retaining Earnings to supplement the operating budget due to poor revenue performance in FY26. Town officials will evaluate whether the poor revenue year in FY26 is an anomaly or permanent.

Town Council Goals & Budget Guidelines

TO: Paul Bockelman, Town Manager

CC: Dr. E. Xiomara Herman, Superintendent of Schools
Amherst School Committee
Regional School Committee
Sharon Sharry, Library Director
Library Trustees

FROM: Town Council

DATE: December 2, 2025

RE: FY27 Budget Guidelines

The Town Council provides these guidelines to assist in developing the FY27 budget for submission to the Council on May 1, 2026. This budget will require difficult decisions. Absent new, ongoing sources of revenue, the Town, Schools, and Library will be hard pressed to provide essential and desired public services, make needed capital investments, and make progress on our policy goals.

Our recommendations and broader guidelines are based on FY27 budget projections presented at the November 3, 2025 Financial Indicators meeting and revised during the November 12, 2025 Finance Committee meeting. These guidelines should be revised as new information becomes available and provided to elected officials in a timely manner.

We note that projecting next year's revenue is particularly risky due to uncertainty about state revenues, federal funding, and health insurance costs. The revenue estimates assume that State aid will be at about FY26 levels.

I. Summary of FY27 Budget Recommendations

Projections indicate an expected overall revenue increase of 2.6 % over FY26. This amounts to about a $2.7 million increase on a budget of $105.9 million. The Council makes the following major recommendations regarding the general budget policy, revenue and expense projections, capital budget, and use of fiscal year surpluses:

- General Budget Guidelines:
  - Do not consider a Proposition 2½ override to support the budget
  - Avoid taking on new initiatives unless a source of revenue is identified to maintain the initiative in future years
  - Devise a multi-year plan to improve staffing for Fire/EMS, and include in the budget the first year including unfreezing the position that was frozen in FY26
- Revenue Projections:
  - Adjust revenue projections as more information becomes available, with a focus on areas where forecasts have proven to be conservative or optimistic
- Expense Projections:
  - Provide the four major functional operating budget areas a 3.5% increase in FY27 –

equal percentage increases, with the elementary base not including the one-time FY26 funds
    - Maintain the contribution to Other Post-Employment Benefits at $600,000, the FY26 level
    - Increase Town budget expense lines to reflect current actual spending
    - If revised projections indicate higher revenues or lower expenses:
        - Increase the Municipal operating budget to help fund the increase in Fire/EMS staffing
        - Pending analysis from the Elementary School District, potentially increase the Amherst Elementary School Budget FY27 base nearer to its full FY26 amount prior to calculating the 3.5% year-over-year increase
        - Distribute proportionately to the four operating budgets, unless the remaining funds to be distributed would result in more than an additional 0.5% year-over-year increase to each major functional area, at which point, consult the Finance Committee regarding how best to distribute the funds before consulting with the Budget Coordinating Group
    - Appropriate from Free Cash to the Elementary School Special Education Stabilization Fund an amount that would replenish the existing Fund if it has been used during FY26[1]
- Capital Budget:
    - Allocate a minimum of 10%, and if possible 10.5%, of property tax revenue to the Capital Budget
    - Potentially allocate funds from the Capital Stabilization Fund to supplement capital funds to support the DPW or Fire Station projects, as anticipated in the November 2024 Financing Plan
    - Present a five-year Capital Improvement Program that is within the Financing Plan
    - Ensure that sufficient money is appropriated for road and sidewalk maintenance in FY27 that meets the plan being developed now that includes Chapter 90 state funds, Free cash transfers from year-end financial orders and the Capital Improvement program allocation
    - Prioritize projects that can lower operating costs or receive federal direct tax credits or other credits with any credits received allocated to the Capital Stabilization Fund
    - Be prepared to allocate funds as necessary through either the Capital Improvement Plan or Capital Stabilization Fund if the Regional School Committee seeks to fund repairs to the Middle School Auditorium roof
- Budget Surpluses included in certified free cash:
    - Maintain Free Cash at 5% and General Stabilization at 10% of our revenue budget
    - Transfer to Reparations Stabilization the amount received in Cannabis taxes

[1] The elementary school district currently has a Special Education Stabilization Fund, created in 2017 with a transfer of free cash. It currently has $242,000. This Fund is governed by state law. Use requires majority vote by the School Committee and the Council. Advisory on Special Education Stabilization Fund - Circuit Breaker - School Finance

- Allocate an amount to road and sidewalk maintenance that is needed to meet the Council's yearly goal for total road and sidewalk maintenance
- Allocate the remaining surplus revenues to Capital Stabilization Fund

Explanations for these recommendations as well as other recommendations are below.

II. FY27 General Budget Guidelines

The recommendations and broad guidelines will impose tight budgets across the four major budget functional areas (Town, Elementary Schools, Regional Schools, and Library).
Seventy percent (70%) of Amherst's revenues come from property taxes, which are capped at a 2.5% year-over-year increase, plus new growth. Local receipts are highly dependent upon the health of the economy and state aid has not kept up with inflation, requiring Amherst to cover more of its costs through local revenues.

Fiscal sustainability requires all revenue and expenditure plans be viewed in a multi-year context. Doing this requires all four functional areas to assess budgets to understand the difficult choices needed to reach a balanced Town budget. In addition, our schools must address already identified structural budgeting issues resulting from the decline in student enrollment and the recent use of one-time funds to supplement operating budgets.

The FY27 budget must balance and focus on providing essential services and maintaining and improving our infrastructure and capital assets. The services currently provided are important for many residents and businesses, even if not deemed essential. Across all departments we face increased labor costs, including a projected 15 to 20% increase in health insurance costs.

Addressing climate change will impose costs as we shift away from fossil fuels; to reduce these costs, we must also invest in renewable energy sources. We urge you to seek improvements in all departments to reduce expenses, enhance efficiency, and improve outcomes. We strongly advise that the Town avoid taking on new initiatives unless a source of revenue is identified to maintain the initiative in future years.

Amherst taxes are already high, the 15th highest of the 352 municipalities in Massachusetts[2]. Moreover, Amherst voters have committed to paying for a new elementary school with a tax increase for the debt service. The debt exclusion impact began in FY26 with a fuller impact in FY27 and beyond. Therefore, we advise against a budget that would require passage of a Proposition 2½ override.[3]

However, we recognize that FY27 will be a difficult year. We therefore ask that you present to the Council by February 15, an update on the operating budget forecasts for the Town, Elementary School, Regional School, and Library that includes the number of positions that would be required to go unfilled (by previous or new freeze or removal from the budget) to achieve the budget target increase and meet budget guidelines. By February 15, we also ask

[2] Tax Rates byhttps://dls-gw.dor.state.ma.us/reports/rdpage.aspx?rdreport=propertytaxinformation.taxratesbyclass.taxratesbyclass_main Class

[3] See Proposition 2½ and Tax Rate Process | Mass.gov

for you to provide an estimate of how much additional operating support would be necessary for each of the major functional areas to receive in order to fund these positions and budget guideline requests. This information will allow the Council to make a more informed decision on the path forward.

III. Revenue Projections - Recommendations and Comments

Overall revenue is projected to increase in FY27 by 2.6%, which includes projected revenue from property taxes, local receipts, state aid, the debt exclusion for the new elementary school, and other financing sources. We recognize that these projections will be updated in the coming months as additional information becomes available. The projected revenue increase needs to cover cost increases in wages, benefits, supplies, building and infrastructure repairs and maintenance, and more.

Property tax revenues are projected to increase by 3.4%, reflecting the allowable 2.5% increase plus new growth and debt exclusion revenue. This revenue has been fairly predictable. The FY27 new growth projection of $650,000 is below recent experiences. However, we agree that the projection needs to be conservative given the recent loss due to fire of a large residential building due to come on line in FY27. The Council urges you to revisit the projection once we learn more about future projects and permits.

You project a 11.8% increase in local receipts, largely based on increases in motor vehicle excise taxes, hotel/motel and meals excise taxes, and investment income. Local Receipts are sensitive to the economy. We urge you to adjust these projections as more information becomes available. Yet, we also acknowledge that a decrease in interest rates or an economic downturn will require a reduction in this revenue source. This would put additional pressure on revenues projected for FY27.

You projected flat state aid, but we recognize that these projections will be updated in January, when the Governor releases her budget. Growth in state aid continues to be less than needed to support cost increases for services and capital investment. Notably, Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA) and Chapter 70 education aid have failed to keep up with inflation.

The Council generally supports continuation of the policy that reserve funds should not be used to support recurring expenses. If there is a significant reduction of projected revenue for FY27, the Budget Coordinating Group should meet to provide advice. In an emergency or unique circumstance, we would consider the use of reserves as necessary to avoid disruption in essential services.

IV. Expense Projections (Non-Capital) – Recommendations and Comments

Past budget practice has allocated an equal percentage increase in operating budgets for four major budget functional areas. Exceptions have been rare, small, and for only one year.

Consistent with this practice, the November Financial Projections propose a 3.5% increase for each of the four major budget functional areas. Following the June 2025 Council vote and guidance, the projections also exclude the one-time bridge funding support for the elementary school budget from the FY26 base.

We concur with the 3.5% equal increases across the four major budget functional areas.

We also recommend budgeting Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB) at the FY26 allocation of $600,00 rather than increasing it as proposed at the Financial Indicators meeting and continuing this budget amount until the pension fund is fully funded.[4]

The Projections show a deficit budget. We accept that updated revenue projections are likely to offset this projected deficit, but you will need to plan carefully to deliver a balanced budget. If there are projected surpluses after revenue and expense projections are updated, we recommend the following:

- Increase the Municipal operating budget to help fund an increase in Fire/EMS staffing
- Pending analysis from the Elementary School District, potentially increase the Amherst Elementary School Budget FY27 base to nearer to the full FY26 amount prior to calculating the 3.5% year-over-year increase
- Distribute proportionately to the four operating budgets, unless the remaining funds to be distributed would result in more than an additional 0.5% year-over-year increase to each major functional area, at which point, consult the Finance Committee regarding how best to distribute the funds before consulting with the Budget Coordinating Group

The decision on the Elementary School budget depends on analysis of the cost savings from operating two rather than three schools. We have anticipated that completion of the new school will result in operating savings beginning in FY27 with the reduction of three to two elementary schools and utility savings due to a net zero school. The utility savings alone would come to $269,000 based on FY26 projected heat and electrical costs for Wildwood and Fort River, plus water costs for Wildwood. (Note that savings assume that Wildwood would be closed or transferred to the Town and thus not incur utility costs.) This level of savings is nearly equal to the one-time funding provided for the FY26.

However, we have yet to see the budget projections for the 6th grade move to the Middle school nor the budget for the new Fort River school and Crocker Farm. Thus, savings at this point are uncertain, which complicates making recommendations of operating budget allocations. The one-time funding was meant to be a bridge to FY27 when Wildwood and the current Fort River building would be closed.

A 3.5% increase in Amherst's Regional School assessment will not necessarily result in a 3.5% increase to the Region's overall budget. The Regional School assessment will be determined by the Regional Agreement. Each town's share of the total assessment is sensitive to each town's financial resources. We recognize that this may mean that Amherst's guidance results in shares for other towns that are not easily with their ability to fund or that other towns' guidance results in a share for Amherst that does not fit within our guidance. The Council will work with you to explain our financial challenges and ensure that Amherst's assessment is consistent with these Guidelines.

[4] The actuaries base a favorable discount rate in part on the assumption that the Town will increase funding of und OPEB once we reach full funding of Pensions.

We realize you will face challenges maintaining current services and achieving Policy Goals with these recommendations. You should consider our Policy Goals when developing the FY27 budget, with explicit recognition of instances where allocations or decisions reflect the Goals. We urge you to make tradeoffs explicit where Goals conflict with available resources.

In past years, you have submitted a Municipal budget that maintains level funding of expense budgets. We urge you to increase department expense lines to reflect current spending – especially for Fire/EMS and DPW.

Fire safety staffing continues to be below recommended levels for a town of our population, as was most recently detailed in a 2017 staffing study. We urge you to devise a multi-year plan to improve staffing for Fire/EMS, and include in the budget the first year of that plan. This could include unfreezing the position that was frozen in FY26. We also recommend you seek additional funding from the institutions of higher learning in Amherst (or urge them to provide an alternative for their students and employees

We also urge you to appropriate from Free Cash to the Elementary School Special Education Stabilization Fund an amount that would replenish the existing Fund if it has been used during FY26

The Council supports expense reduction strategies, such as regionalization, the responsible reassignment of costs outside of the General Fund and operational changes to achieve greater efficiency, and negotiation of fair, affordable, and sustainable labor contracts. We also encourage coordination between departments and/or the four major functional areas that would reduce expenses or create efficiencies in operations or personnel. This could include shared staff positions that require a high level of technical skills.

V. Capital Budget – Recommendations and Comments

The capital budget includes debt service obligations for prior capital projects, regional school debt assessments, and funding for new capital projects. Given the large backlog of public way repairs, major projects borrowing, and increases in construction and equipment costs that exceed the annual tax levy growth rate, we recommend funding capital at a minimum of 10% of the tax levy, and if possible 10.5% of the tax levy.

The Council is committed to the four major building projects (Elementary School, DPW, Fire/EMS, and Library). The initial funding strategy for these projects includes multi-year efforts to increase the Capital Stabilization Fund, decrease debt obligation and retain solid bond ratings.

Funding for the new elementary school is included in both revenue and expenditure budgets, due to taxpayer approval of a debt exclusion. If the school continues to be below budget, this will lower the future debt exclusion costs to taxpayers.

In November 2024 you presented multiple options for financing the expected costs of the DPW and Fire/EMS buildings. The Council has urged you to proceed with the DPW project given the deterioration of the building. The goal is for schematic design and cost estimates in 2026. If this occurs, we advise starting to draw on the Capital Stabilization Fund to offset and

lower borrowing costs and the draw on annual capital funds. We recommend a focused Finance Committee discussion options in early 2026 to determine options.

The proposed Financing Plans for major building projects will severely restrict the funds available for other pressing capital needs, including Amherst's share of regional school district's capital needs. We look to you to present a five-year Capital Improvement Program (CIP), advised by the Joint Capital Planning Committee (JCPC), that meets high priority needs, views capital investments with a climate lens, and manages these needs within the Financing Plan.

We further recommend allocating funds from the Capital Stabilization Fund to supplement capital funds to support DPW and Fire projects, roads, or School capital projects if needed. This should be included as part of a revised multiple year Financing options for discussion in early 2026.

We expect that you will make progress on Climate goals within our capital budget for buildings and vehicles. We may also have the opportunity to recoup some of this investment from the federal direct tax credits to municipal governments while these exist. We recommend you prioritize projects that can lower operating costs or receive federal direct tax credits, with any tax credits received allocated to the Capital Stabilization Fund for future fiscal year capital budgets. There are also credit incentives from Eversource for moving off of fossil fuels.

Capital investments are supported by means other than the capital budget, including the use of Community Preservation Act (CPA), CDBG, PARC grants, MassWorks, and more. The Capital Improvement Plan should take this into consideration, and municipal needs should receive priority for funding from CPA and CDBG funds. We recommend that you ensure that sufficient money is appropriated for road and sidewalk maintenance in FY27 that meets the plan you are currently developing and that the plan includes Chapter 90 state funds, Free cash transfers from year-end financial orders and the Capital Improvement plan allocation. We also urge active pursuit of State support for roads, sidewalks and intersections, including submission of the Complete Streets Stage 2 that would make Amherst eligible for state funding support.

We request that you be prepared to allocate funds as necessary through either the Capital Improvement Plan or Capital Stabilization Fund if the Regional School Committee seeks to fund repairs to the Middle School Auditorium roof within the same construction period as they are repairing the rest of the Middle School Roof under the borrowing authorization we recently granted.

VI. Budget Surpluses

It is prudent fiscal management to have an end of year surplus of up to 5% of the budget. If the Town meets this target, the year-end surplus will be approximately $5.01 million. The Council accepts that these are one-time funds that should not be used for ongoing operating expenses. The Council proposes the following guidelines for the allocation of end-of-year surpluses after Free Cash is certified.

We support year-end closeout transfers that prioritize maintaining Free Cash at 5% and General Stabilization at 10% of our revenues, as indicated by the Town's Financial Management Policies & Objectives.[5]

Policies & Objectives.[5]

In 2021 we established a Reparations Stabilization Fund and in 2022 we adopted a policy, based on the financial health of the Town, to annually transfer to the fund in an amount equal to the certified cannabis tax revenue for the previous year, not to exceed $205,000, until the Town's contribution equals $2 million. We recommend continuing this practice at the end of the FY26 fiscal year.

In 2022, the Council established the Capital Stabilization Fund to separate funds needed for major buildings from General Stabilization. Once "free cash" is certified for the Fiscal year ending June 30, 2025, after meeting the above transfers, we recommend allocating funds to road and sidewalk repair that is needed to meet the Council's yearly goal for total road and sidewalk maintenance, as set forth in the plan you are currently developing. The remaining surplus funds should be transferred to the Capital Stabilization Fund.

VII. Other ways to Support Services and the Budget

Robust contributions from tax-exempt organizations are essential for the health of the Town. Aligning requests with an institution's own goals may provide synergy and support for enhanced gifts to the Town. It is important to execute strategic agreements with Amherst College and Hampshire College and to negotiate a new Strategic Partnership Agreement with UMass as the current one expires June 30, 2027.

All agreements with our three institutions of higher education must include support of our first responders and the wear and tear on our roads that students, employees, and delivery vehicles cause.

We appreciate the University's support of education costs for children who live in University-owned housing and value the recent enhanced Strategic Partnership Agreement. It is critical that this support continues, is re-evaluated frequently, and that negotiations for a new agreement begin well in advance of the expiration date.

We must advocate on a state level to increase state aid. State PILOT payments must recognize that developed State-owned land is a greater cost to municipalities than conservation or forested land. We support continued advocacy for increases in UGGA, Chapter 70, Chapter 90, changes in the Charter school funding formula to reduce annual assessments, and other programs that support municipal budgets, local taxation options, and increased state aid.

Grants also supplement the budget. Aggressive pursuit of grants to offset costs and expand services can support new initiatives or allow the Town to reallocate funds to different expenditures.

IX. Conclusion

The Council appreciates the collaboration on the budget and financial management between you and the Town Council. We appreciate your efforts and that of Sean Mangano and Jennifer LaFountain, and many other members of the staff to inform Councilors about the

[5] https://www.amherstma.gov/DocumentCenter/View/19874

budget, the challenge to manage Town finances, and efforts to generate revenue to meet expenses and achieve the community's goals. The Council looks forward to continued collaboration as you develop and manage future budgets.

Town Council Performance Goals

Each year, the Town Council establishes goals for the Town Manager. These goals are instrumental in guiding the work of the Town Manager and Town departments. Below is a crosswalk that illustrates how this budget proposal supports the goals set by the Town Council.

Goal Areas and Action Items:	Budget:
I. Climate Action Objective: To continue to make progress on the Council's Climate Action Goals guided by the Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resilience Plan (CAARP) to prepare the Town to be resilient in the face of climate change. • Complete all work required to bring proposed amendments to General Bylaw 3.33, Refuse Collection and Recyclable and Compostable Materials, to the Council for a vote to approve or not approve. • Create and submit a Complete Streets Tier 2 Prioritization Plan to the Mass Department of Transportation. • Develop and enact the Clean Energy, Solar, and BESS bylaws by or before December 2026. • Begin the process of updating the Amherst Bicycle & Pedestrian Network Plan, including seeking necessary appropriations, with the goal of Council adoption in 2027.	• Maintained Sustainability Department funding and allocated $200,000 to support climate initiatives. • Funding to maintain ValleyBike program. • Funding to replace four vehicles with electric or hybrid options. • Current staff in Sustainability, Planning, and Public Works to address other objectives.
II. Community Health and Safety and Social Justice Objective: To ensure the health and safety of the residents of Amherst and continue making advances in racial equity and social justice. • Begin implementing the plan that was developed during 2025 for addressing critical space and program needs at the Senior Center. • In light of the LEAP Report, and consistent with the Town Council's November 14, 2022 vote, work with the DEI Department and other staff to organize a review of public safety protocols for responding to and handling public safety calls involving all residents, including minors, in order to recommend changes to those protocols, if appropriate. • Conduct an external assessment of the Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service (CRESS) Program, including hours of operation, and report back to the Council by June 30, 2026. • Provide the Council with an estimate of annual resources needed to bring fire/EMS staffing to levels that meet state/national standards. • Work with Dispatch and the Amherst Police Department to define and implement specific categories of non-violent calls that can be referred to CRESS.	• CRESS assessment is planned and supported by grant funds and existing staff support to work with the outside assessment team. • Restoration of one frozen firefighter/EMT position and addition of one new position. Completion of multi-year staffing plan. • Funding for the successful Morning Movement and Mentoring programs established in the Recreation Department's budget. • Current staff in CRESS, Dispatch, and APD to address other objectives.

III. Housing and Economic Vitality Objective: To ensure the present and future economic well -being of the Town and ensure access to safe, affordable and attainable housing for low- and moderate-income residents, as set forth in the Town Council's Comprehensive Housing Policy. • Propose revisions to the Zoning bylaws that would reduce the time and cost of developing, permitting, and building housing on parcels in Amherst with the objective of increasing missing middle housing development potential. • Propose revisions to zoning bylaws to increase and support economic development throughout the Town. • Send out an RFP seeking development partners who will work with the Town to establish a year-round shelter with supportive housing and services on Main Street at the former VFW site. • Begin work on adopting a new Master Plan within the time required by the Charter.	• Funds included for consultants to support the planning department on economic development and site planning activities. • Procurements underway for VFW developer and to study zoning and land uses in East Amherst. • Current staff in Planning to address other objectives.
IV. Administrative & Leadership Objective: Effectively and appropriately administer the operations and finances of Town pursuant to the Home Rule Charter, ensure the Town's strong financial and fiscal health, and effectively develop, supervise and manage the Town's workforce, fostering a proactive anti-racist culture throughout town departments. • Expand modes of communication to residents, including the possibility of email-based newsletters with the option for individuals to sign up for alerts of a specific type (e.g. by district or topic). • Work with the Council & TSO committee to develop ways to streamline and improve the recruiting, vetting, selection, and onboarding of community volunteers who serve on the Town's boards and committees. This process should include exploring ways the Town might shrink the number of boards and committees. • Continue implementing anti-racism, anti-discrimination, anti-oppression training for current and future employees (including Town Councilors).	• Current staff in Communications and Diversity, Equity and Inclusion to address objectives.
V. Infrastructure Management, Maintenance & Land Stewardship Objective: To maintain and manage the Town's capital and public assets. • Bring to the Council a plan for how to develop the South Amherst School site. • Begin assessment of the current condition of the Wastewater Treatment Plant and associated infrastructure (including pumping stations and sewer lines) and present an update that will address these issues.	• Comprehensive study of the needs of the wastewater treatment facility underway. • Resources allocated to DPW Building Committee which has begun meeting and is in the process of selecting a designer. • Multiyear plan to address roads presented to Council and first year has been funded.

• Appoint the DPW building committee and present a schematic design (including costs) to the Council by October 1st, 2026, as well as a timeline for completion of the project. • Create charge for and appoint Fire Station Building Committee, present a timeline for schematic designs (including costs) through completion of the project to the Council by October 1st, 2026 • Present a multi-year plan to the Council for how to address the significant backlog of road and sidewalk repairs including maintenance and updating of a prioritized list of road and sidewalk repairs that is available to the public. • Work with the TPC, DPW, schools, and Police Chief to develop an interim plan for managing traffic and public safety when the new elementary school opens (with a focus on South East Street and areas surrounding the new school).	• Resources assigned to develop an interim plan for managing traffic and public safety until the permanent traffic patterns are set for the Amethyst Elementary School. • Current staff to address other objectives.
VI. Town Council, Community, & Strategic Relationships <u>Objective:</u> To maintain, develop, and increase positive relationships and communications with the Town Council, residents, and local and state entities. • Continue Civic Academy and broaden outreach efforts in recruiting the next class in order to reach those not already engaged with local government. • Work with our legislators to explore the possibility of revising state legislation regarding Payments in Lieu of Taxes (PILOT) involving state-owned land, enhanced Chapter 70, and reformed Charter School funding formula to secure increased State support of our schools, and other legislation as appropriate. • Work with UMass Amherst, Amherst College, and Hampshire College to identify economic development and housing creation opportunities. • Work with UMass and the colleges to share the burden of emergency response– including exploration of a fee structure to reimburse the Town for expenses associated with students to cover expansion of the fire/EMS department. • Begin negotiations for renewal of UMASS strategic partnership, which expires in 2027, including prior conversation with the Town Council, Superintendent of Schools and other relevant staff to determine priorities.	• Resources allocated to continue Civic Academy. • Planning phase for next round of Strategic Partnership Agreement discussions underway. • Ongoing discussions with State legislators and others in the State to address inequities in State payments in lieu of taxes for state-owned land. • Working closely with Hampshire College around issues related to their closure.

Task/Meeting	Date
Financial Indicators Presentation	November 3, 2025
Budget Public Forum	November 17, 2025
Budget Policy Guidelines Approved	December 8, 2025
Governor's Budget Proposal Released	January 28, 2026
Budget Presentation to Town Council	May 4, 2026
Finance Committee Review Process	May 5, 2026 to May 28, 2026
Budget Public Hearing	May 11, 2026
Town Council Vote (tentative)	June 15, 2026

The chart above outlines key tasks and dates in the budget process. A tremendous amount of work goes on behind the scenes by staff to develop the budget document and prepare information for the meetings above. Please note that the Amherst Pelham Regional School District budget may follow a timeline different than the one above due to budget approvals required in other member towns. You can find more information on the entire budget calendar by visiting the website below: https://www.amherstma.gov/3584/Upcoming-Budget

The public can get involved in the budget process at any public meeting by giving public comment. The best way to get involved is to voice your ideas at the budget forum or the public hearing. An email to your elected official is another great way to share your thoughts on the budget.

Consolidated Spending Summary

CONSOLIDATED SPENDING SUMMARY - TOWN MANAGER'S PROPOSED BUDGET

	FY 2027 General Fund	FY 2027 Water Fund	FY 2027 Sewer Fund	FY 2027 Solid Waste Fund	FY 2027 Transportation Fund	FY 27 COMBINED FUNDS (memo only)	FY 26 COMBINED FUNDS (memo only)	Change FY 27 - 26	Percent Change
REVENUES									
Property Tax	73,954,029	-	-	-	-	73,954,029	71,456,083	2,497,946	3.5%
Local Receipts/User charges	8,609,495	7,331,475	7,308,014	638,000	645,996	24,532,980	23,239,153	1,293,827	5.6%
State Aid	19,348,536	-	-	-	-	19,348,536	18,843,690	504,846	2.7%
Other Financing Sources	5,202,678	-	-	21,162	61,048	5,284,888	5,039,198	245,690	4.9%
TOTAL REVENUES	**107,114,738**	**7,331,475**	**7,308,014**	**659,162**	**707,044**	**123,120,433**	**118,578,124**	**4,542,309**	**3.8%**
EXPENDITURES									
OPERATING BUDGET									
Town	30,833,590	3,910,153	4,326,965	598,025	604,343	40,273,076	38,411,037	1,862,039	4.8%
Elementary Schools	29,478,590	-	-	-	-	29,478,590	28,049,236	1,429,354	5.1%
Elementary Schools (1% add'l from Free Cash)						-	269,704	(269,704)	
A-P Regional School District (Assessment)	20,434,781	-	-	-	-	20,434,781	19,744,008	690,773	3.5%
Lones Library (Tax Support)	2,486,329	-	-	-	-	2,486,329	2,394,154	92,175	3.9%
Subtotal OPERATING BUDGET	**83,233,290**	**3,910,153**	**4,326,965**	**598,025**	**604,343**	**92,672,777**	**88,868,140**	**3,804,638**	**4.3%**
CAPITAL BUDGET									
Debt Service - Debt Exclusion	2,333,546		-	-	-	2,333,546	2,125,643	207,903	0.0%
Debt Service - Current	3,299,830	1,327,592	1,246,614	-	-	5,874,036	4,486,172	1,387,864	30.9%
Debt Service - Projected	100,000	-	-	-	-	100,000	123,255	(23,255)	-18.9%
Cash Capital (Tax Support)	4,200,893	-	-	-	-	4,200,893	4,799,865	(598,972)	-12.5%
Subtotal Tax Funded Capital	**9,934,269**	**1,327,592**	**1,246,614**	**-**	**-**	**12,508,475**	**11,534,935**	**973,540**	**8.4%**
Cash Capital (Non-Tax Support/Other)	390,000	1,040,000	745,000	-	-	2,175,000	2,408,000	(233,000)	-9.7%
Subtotal CAPITAL	**10,324,269**	**2,367,592**	**1,991,614**	**-**	**-**	**14,683,475**	**13,942,935**	**740,540**	**5.3%**
MISCELLANEOUS									
Assessment - Retirement System	7,836,382	367,098	371,804	61,137	75,799	8,712,220	8,653,241	58,979	0.7%
Assessment - Regional Loclup Facility	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
OPEB	600,000	79,000	150,000	-	26,902	855,902	855,902	-	0.0%
Reserve Fund	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
Subtotal MISCELLANEOUS	**8,436,382**	**446,098**	**521,804**	**61,137**	**102,701**	**9,568,122**	**9,509,143**	**58,979**	**0.6%**
Total APPROPRIATIONS	**101,993,941**	**6,723,843**	**6,840,384**	**659,162**	**707,044**	**116,924,374**	**112,320,218**	**4,604,157**	**4.1%**
UNAPPROPRIATED USES									
Reserve for Abatements & Exemptions	358,131	-	-	-	-	358,131	335,794	22,337	6.7%
State Assessments (Cherry Sheet)	3,725,067	-	-	-	-	3,725,067	3,826,446	(101,379)	-2.6%
Cherry Sheet Offsets	1,020,067	-	-	-	-	1,020,067	1,034,191	(14,124)	-1.4%
Other Amounts to be Raised	17,532	607,632	467,630	-	-	1,092,794	1,061,476	31,318	3.0%
Subtotal UNAPPROPRIATED USES	**5,120,797**	**607,632**	**467,630**	**-**	**-**	**6,196,059**	**6,257,907**	**(61,848)**	**-1.0%**
TOTAL BUDGET PLAN	**107,114,738**	**7,331,475**	**7,308,014**	**659,162**	**707,044**	**123,120,433**	**118,578,124**	**4,542,309**	**3.8%**
$ Change from Prior year	**3,904,942**	**328,975**	**321,289**	**19,043**	**(31,940)**				
% Change from Prior Year	**3.8%**	**4.7%**	**4.6%**	**3.0%**	**-4.3%**				

Organizational Section

"Without continual growth and progress, such words as improvement, achievement, and success have no meaning."

- Benjamin Franklin

Community Profile

The Town of Amherst is located in the bucolic Pioneer Valley of Western Massachusetts. It is a diverse, inclusive community offering a broad range of educational, recreational, and cultural opportunities.

Host to Amherst College, Hampshire College, and the flagship campus of the University of Massachusetts, the Town enjoys a tradition of open, professional, and high-quality government services, excellent education, extensive open space and agriculture resources, and respect for its history.

County	Hampshire
Government	Town Council, 13 Member Council w/ President and Vice President Town Manager
Location	Bordered by: Hadley to the west; Sunderland and Leverett to the north; Shutesbury, Pelham, and Belchertown to the east; and Granby and South Hadley to the south. 23 miles from Springfield, 18 miles from Greenfield, 50 miles from Pittsfield, 87 miles from Boston, and 157 miles from New York City
Land Area	27.7 square miles
Population	1950 - 10,856 1960 - 13,718 1970 - 26,331 1980 - 33,229 1990 - 35,228 2000 - 34,874 2010 - 37,819 2020 - 39,263
Density (persons per square mile)	1950 - 392 1960 - 495 1970 - 951 1980 - 1,199 1990 - 1,272 2000 - 1,259 2010 - 1,370 2020 - 1,417
Elevation at Town Hall	312 feet above sea level
Topographical characteristics	Valley plateau within a circle of hills
USGS Topo Plates	Belchertown, Mount Holyoke, Williamsburg, Shutesbury
Longitude / Latitude	42 22' 25" N, 72 31' 15" W

Budget Guide

The budget is divided into five sections:

1. Introductory Section: This section serves as a standalone summary of the entire budget. It includes a message from the Town Manager, an outline of significant changes to the budget, the goals of the Town Council and Town Manager, information about the budget process and important dates in that process, and a financial summary of the proposed budget and historical spending. This is the section to read if you only have a few minutes and want a quick understanding of the budget proposal.

2. Organizational Section: This section, which includes this guide, explains how to read the budget, general demographic information and history of the Town, the organization of municipal departments, and departmental staffing information. This part of the budget is designed to provide a deeper understanding of the Town and municipal government.

3. Financial Section: No budget is complete without lots of numbers and tables. You will find plenty of that in this section, which includes high level summaries of the various funds the Town operates, detailed breakdowns of departmental budgets and historical spending. This section is perfect for anyone who wants to see the big financial picture or dig into the detailed departmental spending plans. On the next page, there is a breakdown of the departmental spending plans to make it easier to navigate.

4. Informational Section: This section provides various pieces of information including financial comparisons to other communities, the Capital Improvement Program, debt management information, the financial policies of the Town, a glossary, and an acronym table. By the time you get to this section, you are ready to see how Amherst compares to similar communities and review the policies that guide decision making.

5. Appropriation Orders: This section includes all of the votes that the Town Council will consider for FY27. In any given year, these votes will include the operating budgets, the capital improvement program, the community preservation act recommendation, and authorization of any new debt obligations.

Financial Section Map:

The Financial Section is organized by fund type which includes the General Fund, Enterprise Funds, Grant Funds, and Revolving Funds. Each fund is explained in more detail below. In addition to being organized by fund type, each section begins with high level summary information and then drills down into greater detail.

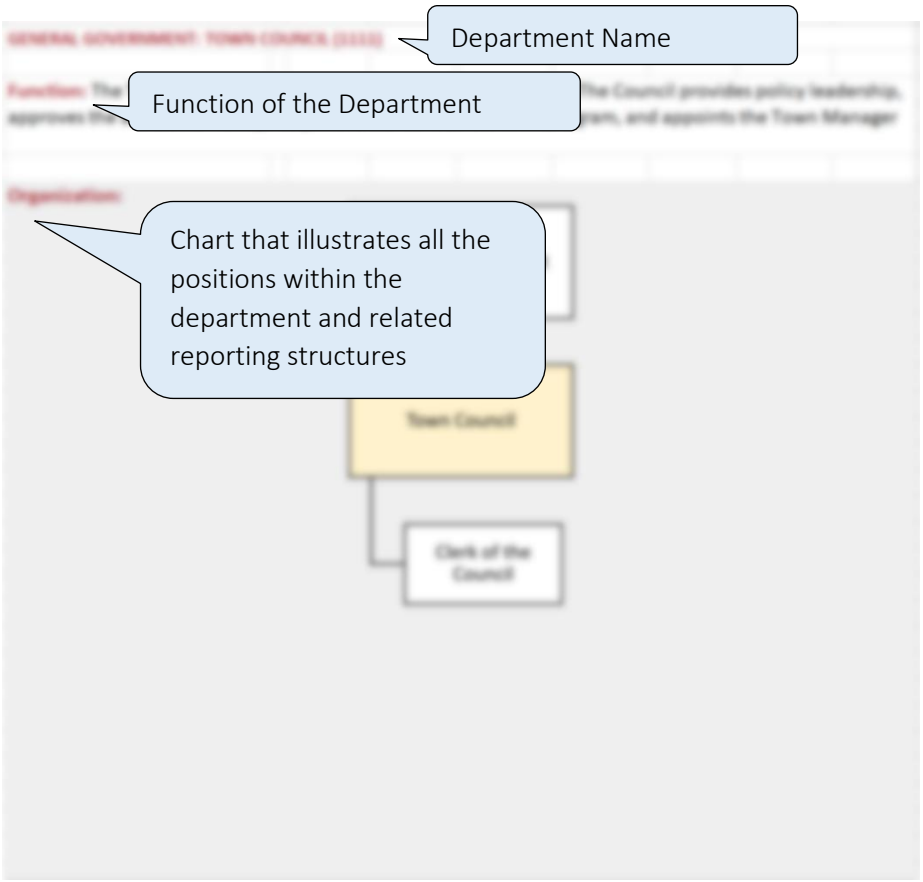
1. General Fund: The primary operating fund for the Town is used for the annual budget and collects all monies that are not specifically designated for another purpose. Major sources of funds include property taxes, state aid, and local receipts. This is the largest and most important fund.

2. Enterprise Funds: These funds are established to manage the business-like services of the Town. For example, the Water Enterprise fund manages the provision of water to Town residents and the resulting billing and collection of funds. In addition, Enterprise Funds account for any capital investments in the particular service and related debt. The Town operates four Enterprise Funds: water, sewer, transportation, and solid waste.

3. Grant Funds: The Town is particularly strong at finding and being awarded grants from private, state, and Federal agencies. The revenues and expenditures associated with a grant are accounted for in a separate grant fund. This ensures that grant monies are not intermingled with other Town funds.

4. Revolving Funds: The Town operates a number of programs that charge fees for services. One example is the Recreation Department which charges participation fees for some of its programming. These fees are collected in a revolving fund and then used to pay for the costs associated with service provided. Using the previous example, funds could be used to pay for an instructor to teach a class. It is called a revolving fund because any surplus balance at year end carries over to the next year and can be used to support programming.

Within the Financial Section, each department has its own section that provides greater detail on its budget. The following graphics break down the different sections for each department.



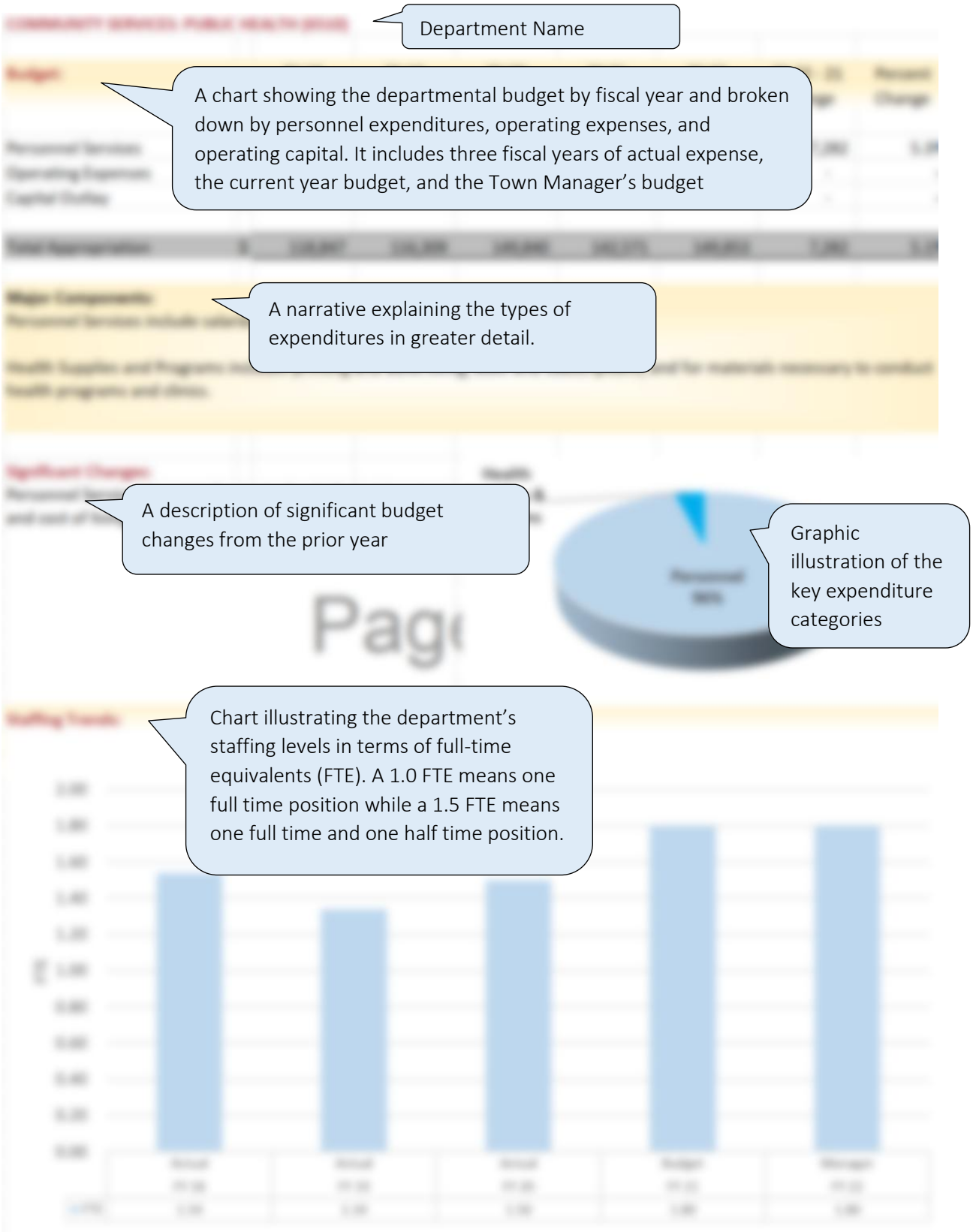
Department Name

A list of departmental accomplishments that have occurred over the previous year.

A list of key challenges and long-term objectives

A status update of all prior year objectives. Objectives will be marked as accomplished, rescheduled, or ongoing.

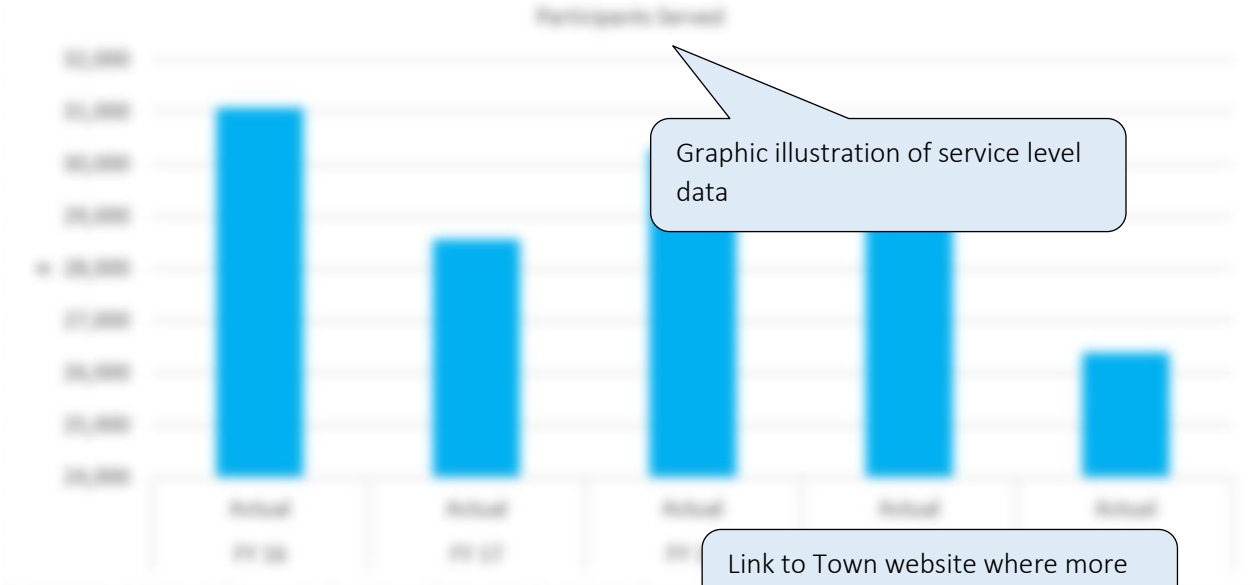
Upcoming objectives that are planned for the next fiscal year.


Department Name
A chart showing the departmental budget by fiscal year and broken down by personnel expenditures, operating expenses, and operating capital. It includes three fiscal years of actual expense, the current year budget, and the Town Manager's budget
A narrative explaining the types of expenditures in greater detail.
A description of significant budget changes from the prior year
Graphic illustration of the key expenditure categories
Chart illustrating the department's staffing levels in terms of full-time equivalents (FTE). A 1.0 FTE means one full time position while a 1.5 FTE means one full time and one half time position.

Department Name

A chart showing key service level information over time.

Describes any significant trends in service levels



Graphic illustration of service level data

Link to Town website where more information can be obtained.

Frequently Asked Questions

What new programs or initiatives are included in this budget proposal?

This proposal permanantly funds the Morning Movement and Mentoring program and the Aquatics Program Director in the Recreation Department. It adds two firefighter/EMT positions – restoring one previously frozen position and adding one new position for a total increasing in staffing of two positions from current levels. It right sizes operating budgets in two departments: Public Works and Recreation. This is the first phase of a multi-year effort to right-size operating budgets in Town departments that have been hit hard by inflation.

What programming reductions are being proposed?

There are no new reductions however of the 6.4 positions that were frozen in FY26, only one is being restored.

How does this budget proposal affect my property taxes?

This proposal operates within the allowable 2.5% increase to the tax levy. It does not require an override which is an increase above and beyond the normal amount. The exact tax rate will not be determined until the end of the calendar year and is dependent upon additional factors such as new building development in Town. Actual tax increases are based on a property's assessed value.

How can I get involved and/or voice my opinion on this budget proposal?

There are mulitple ways to get involved. First, you may want to check the budget calendar which can be found here. This outlines when different departments will be reviewed by the Finance Committee. The Finance Committee will hold a formal public hearing on the entire budget on May 11th. You may want to attend one of these meetings and share your thoughts. Other ways include visiting the Town's website and particpating in other public events that will be posted on the Town wide calendar related to the budget. You can also always email the Town Council at TownCouncil@AmherstMA.gov or the Town Manager at TownManager@AmherstMA.gov.

When will the budget be discussed at a public meeting?

The budget proposal is being presented to the Town Council on May 4th. Other important dates can be found on the budget calendar.

How do I propose a project for funding?

The Town accepts capital project proposals from residents. The window for submitting requests is closed for this year but will open up again in the Fall. The Town Manager is open to suggestions and proposals throughout the year.

Future Challenges

Amherst, like many communities, is confronted by numerous challenges spanning financial, regulatory, and operational areas. Below, we outline the major challenges along with strategies to address them.

Challenge: Funding Level Service Budgets

Strategy:

- Overall budget: Continue to study budget results and refine budget projections to ensure budget projections are accurate and maintain a strong fiscal position.
- Regional School District budget:
    - Work with leaders in the three other district towns (Leverett, Pelham, and Shutesbury), Regional School District School Committee, and district leadership to develop a shared understanding of budget capacity of the four towns and enrollment trends and budget needs of the district to adopt multi-year projections for the towns and the district.
    - Study the feasibility of consolidating the high school and middle school into one facility, eliminating the need to maintain and invest in two facilities.
- Elementary School district budget:
    - Identify and incorporate projected costs savings with the opening of the new net-zero energy Amethyst Brook Elementary School. Savings may include lower electricity and heating expenses, reduced staffing due to consolidation of the operations of two schools, and efficiencies gained by a new, state-of-the-art building.
    - Study the impact of the relocated 6th grade on the district's budget and examine alternatives.
- Library budget:
    - Identify and incorporate potential cost savings due to temporary closure of Jones Library during construction.
    - Identify and incorporate projected costs savings with the opening of the new renovated Jones Library. Project savings may include lower electricity and heating expenses and efficiencies offered by a new, state-of-the-art building.
- Municipal budget:
    - Identify and incorporate projected costs savings with the eventual opening of new public works and fire stations. Projected savings may include lower electricity and heating expenses and efficiencies offered by new, state-of-the-art buildings.
    - Study staffing needs of Town departments to ensure staffing is aligned with the mission and goals of the Town.

Challenge: Aging infrastructure

Strategy:

- Continue to advance construction of the four major building projects (Public Works facility, Fire/EMS station, Jones Library, and Elementary School). The new elementary school project is nearing completion, on schedule and on budget. The Jones Library project is moving forward with projected completion date in March of 2027. Next steps for the Fire/EMS and

Public Works buildings involve initiating schematic design for the Public Works building and identifying a site for the Fire/EMS Station.

- Continue to advocate for State funding programs for municipal buildings like the Fire/EMS station and Public Works buildings.
- Invest in our current buildings paying special attention to roofs, HVAC, and ADA access utilizing the comprehensive analysis of all municipal buildings that is in process.
- Maintain a budget to make investments in facilities and equipment to prolong their lifespan. This budget increases the percentage of the tax levy allocated to capital improvements to 10.5% for FY27.
- Prioritize investing in maintaining the Town's roads and sidewalks to address the backlog of paving needs by dedicating at least $5 million annually, utilizing both Town, Enterprise and State Chapter 90 funds, with the possibility of additional funding if available. Seek and secure State grants when available. Advocating for additional State Aid in the Chapter 90 program over multiple years is a priority.

Challenge: Reducing the Town's reliance on fossil fuels

Strategy:

- Promote and expand Community Choice Aggregation in concert with the City of Northampton and Town of Pelham to provide a sustainable, affordable option for Amherst residents to purchase electricity.
- Continue to allocate $200,000 in the Capital Improvement Program each year to make targeted investments to move away from fossil fuels.
- Implement strategies identified in the Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resilience Plan.
- If adopted by the Town Council, implement the new Solar Energy Infrastructure Zoning Bylaw for the Town.

Challenge: Confronting systemic racism

Strategy:

- Conduct an operational assessment of the CRESS department to ensure the Department is meeting its goals and the needs of the community.
- Continue funding for the Department of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) to identify and implement initiatives that promote DEI goals such as enhancing staff diversity and broadening community engagement.
- Fund and support the creation of the Amherst Black Reparations Committee and its work in developing reparations initiatives within the frameworks of the law.
- Continue to expand the multi-department initiatives to provide programming for youth, such as the Morning Movement and Mentoring program.
- Support the Town Council's review of the recommendation regarding a Resident Oversight Board and incorporate any funding needs in future budgets.

Challenge: Increasing a broad range of housing including market and affordable housing and identifying a permanent shelter for those experiencing homelessness

Strategy:

- Advance projects to increase the Town's affordable housing supply, including developments at the East Street School site, the Belchertown Road site, and the home-ownership opportunities project on Ball Lane.
- Allocate staff resources to work with state and local partners to secure funding and develop a permanent shelter with supportive services for those experiencing homelessness at the recently purchased former VFW site on Main Street.
- Identify additional sites suitable for rental and ownership housing opportunities.
- Propose zoning changes to promote construction of new housing and develop additional housing under the State's ADU law.
- Complete a site planning process for the Wildwood Elementary School once it is turned back over to the Town.
- Advocate/zone for the development of housing for any future use of the Hampshire College property.

Challenge: Water /sewer infrastructure improvements and funding

Strategy:

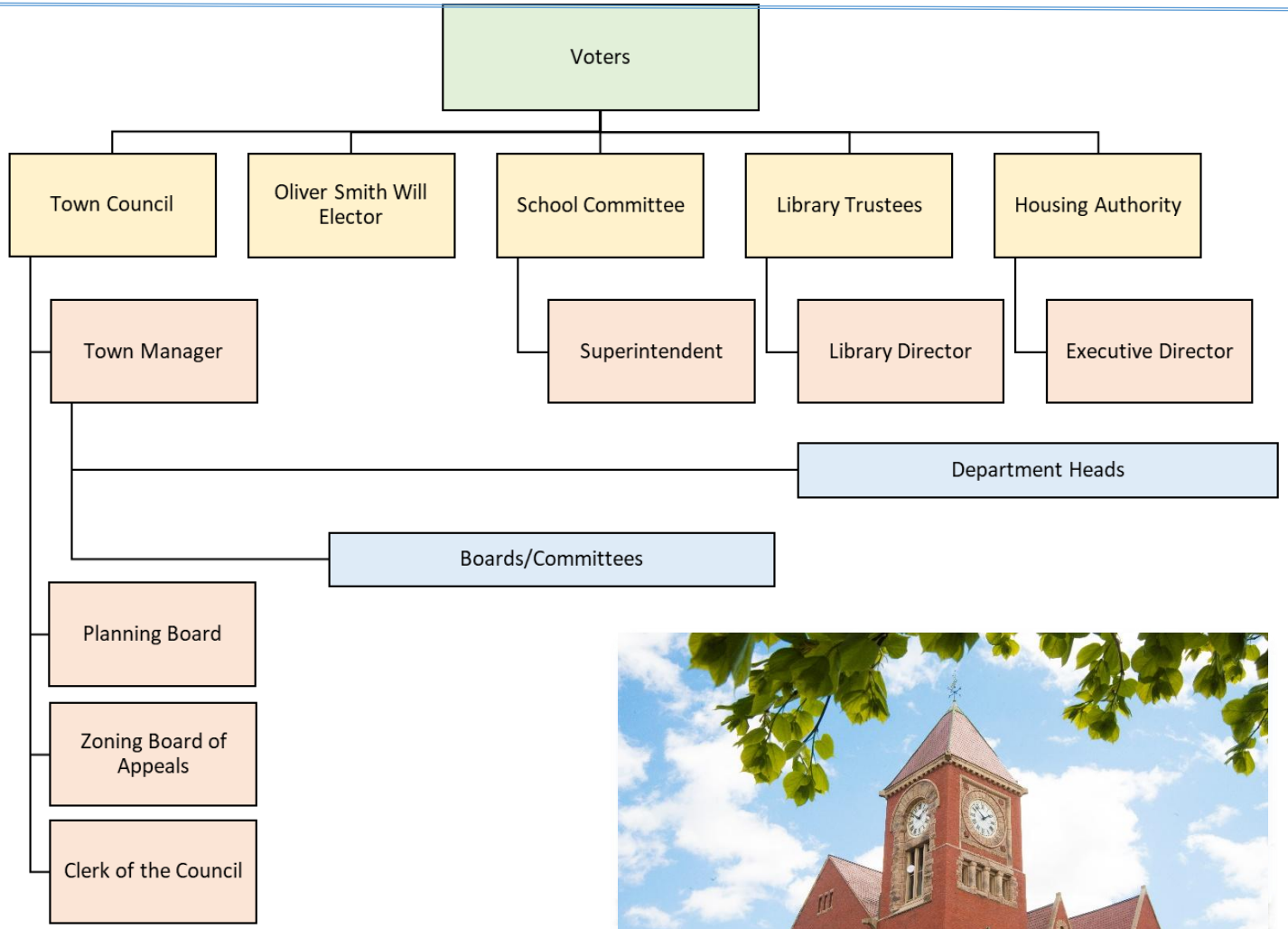
- Conduct a comprehensive needs assessment of the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- Develop an entry fee for outside entities/municipalities/new users when connecting to the Town of Amherst water and/or sewer systems.
- Investigate alternative rate setting strategies for water and sewer users.
- Seek regional opportunities to expand use of the Wastewater Treatment Facility and identify water sources in different watersheds to improve resiliency.

Challenge: Promoting and sustaining robust economic activity in Town to broaden the tax base

Strategy:

- Develop design standards for continued improvements to the downtown area.
- Review Town regulations and operations to reduce barriers to opening and operating a business.
- Work with the University and College to invest in the Town and develop economic development opportunities.
- Review the Zoning Bylaw and other policies to promote economic development, diverse housing options, and support for an increased year-round population.
- Stay actively involved in the future of the Hampshire College site and determine what, if any, actions are needed to promote the Town's interests.

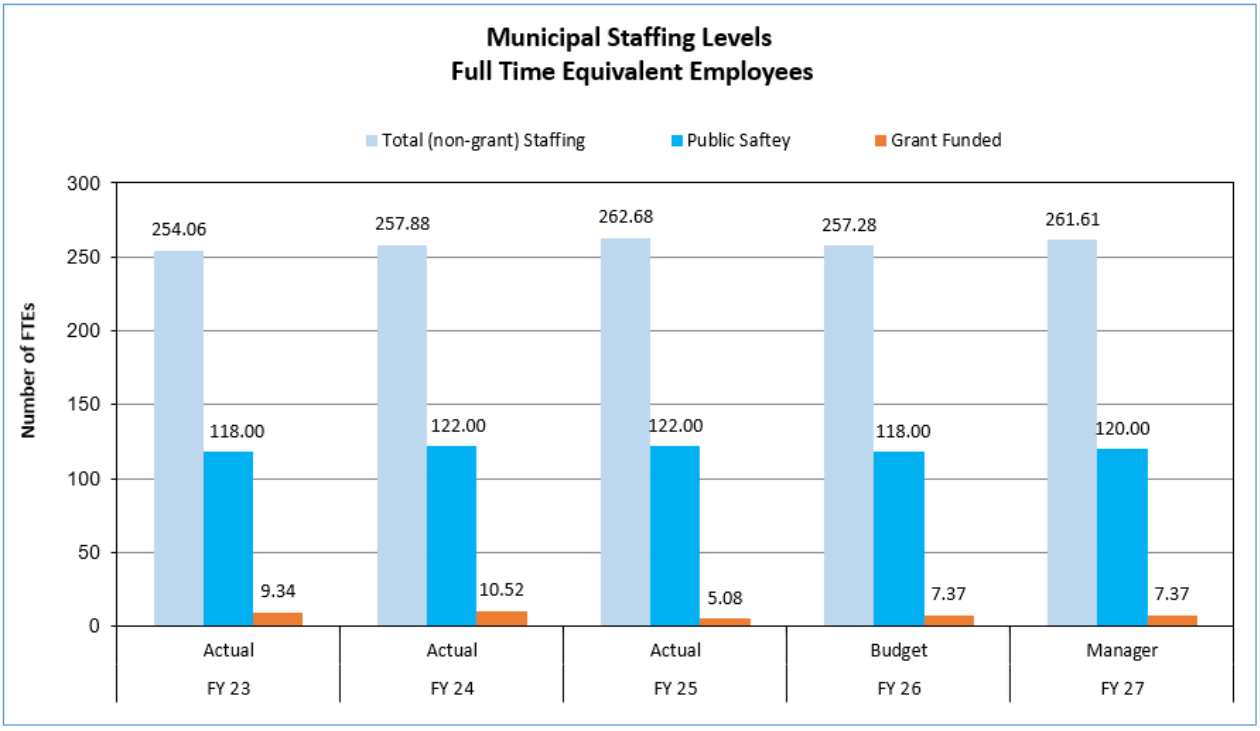
Organizational Chart



Staffing Summary

Full and Part Time Benefited Employees in Full Time Equivalents

Department:	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change
MUNICIPAL BUDGET						
Town Council	0.75	0.75	0.75	0.75	0.75	0.00
Town Manager	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
Finance	12.50	12.50	12.50	11.50	11.50	0.00
Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	0.00
Human Resources	2.00	2.00	2.56	2.56	2.56	0.00
Information Technology	4.58	4.58	4.58	4.58	4.58	0.00
Town Clerk	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
Facilities Maintenance	5.00	5.00	5.80	5.80	5.80	0.00
Total General Government	32.83	32.83	34.19	33.19	33.19	0.00
Police Facility	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00
Police	48.00	48.00	48.00	47.00	47.00	0.00
Fire/EMS	47.00	51.00	51.00	50.00	52.00	2.00
Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service	10.00	10.00	10.00	8.00	8.00	0.00
Communications Center	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	0.00
Animal Welfare	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00
Total Public Safety	118.00	122.00	122.00	118.00	120.00	2.00
Public Works Administration	4.04	4.04	4.04	4.04	4.04	0.00
Highway	13.00	13.00	13.00	12.00	12.00	0.00
Street and Traffic Lights	0.34	0.34	0.34	0.34	0.34	0.00
Equipment Maintenance	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
Tree and Ground Maintenance	7.50	7.50	7.50	7.50	7.50	0.00
Total Public Works	27.88	27.88	27.88	26.88	26.88	0.00
Conservation	5.00	5.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	0.00
Sustainability	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00
Planning Department	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	0.00
Inspections	10.00	10.00	13.00	13.00	13.00	0.00
Total Conservation & Development	19.50	19.50	22.50	22.50	22.50	0.00
Public Health	1.80	1.80	2.00	2.00	2.00	0.00
Senior Center	3.36	3.18	3.42	3.42	3.42	0.00
Recreation	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.45	4.45	0.00
Pools	0.35	0.35	0.35	0.35	0.68	0.33
Golf Course	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	0.00
Total Community Services	11.56	11.38	11.82	11.42	11.75	0.33
TOTAL GENERAL FUND	**209.77**	**213.59**	**218.39**	**211.99**	**214.32**	**2.33**
Water Supply and Distribution	18.35	18.35	18.35	18.85	19.85	1.00
TOTAL WATER FUND	**18.35**	**18.35**	**18.35**	**18.85**	**19.85**	**1.00**
Sewer Maintenance	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	0.00
Wastewater Treatment Plant	16.34	16.34	16.34	16.84	17.84	1.00
TOTAL SEWER FUND	**18.34**	**18.34**	**18.34**	**18.84**	**19.84**	**1.00**
Solid Waste Facility	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
TOTAL SOLID WASTE FUND	**3.00**	**3.00**	**3.00**	**3.00**	**3.00**	**0.00**
Parking Facilities	4.60	4.60	4.60	4.60	4.60	0.00
TOTAL TRANSPORTATION FUND	**4.60**	**4.60**	**4.60**	**4.60**	**4.60**	**0.00**
MUNICIPAL BUDGET TOTAL	**254.06**	**257.88**	**262.68**	**257.28**	**261.61**	**4.33**



Notables Trends:

Overall FTE is proposed to increase in the FY27 Budget Proposal as a result of the following staffing changes:

- restoration of a 1.00 FTE Firefighter/EMT position (previously frozen)
- addition of a 1.00 FTE Firefighter/EMT position
- addition of .33 FTE Aquatics Program Director position (remainder funded by revolving funds)
- addition of 1.0 FTE treatment operator position in the Water Enterprise Fund.
- addition of 1.0 FTE operator position in the Waste Water Fund.

Employee Cost Breakdown:

The cost of an employee to the Town is comprised of the components below. Depending on the type of employee, the Town may incur some or all of these costs.

Wages

Life Insurance

Workers Compensation

Health Insurance

Medicare Tax

Paid Time Off

Pension

Unemployment

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Financial Section

"The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining."

- John F. Kennedy

Revenue & Expenditure Summary

	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 ACTUAL	FY 26 RECAP	FY 27 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg
REVENUES						
PROPERTY TAX						
Base Levy	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,269,595	69,342,653	2,073,058	3.1%
2.5% Allowable Increase	1,546,300	1,610,379	1,681,740	1,733,566	51,826	3.1%
Estimated New Growth	1,049,071	1,255,459	391,318	550,000	158,682	40.6%
General Override						
Levy Limit	**64,403,757**	**67,269,595**	**69,342,653**	**71,626,219**	**2,283,566**	3.3%
Debt Exclusion		691,807	2,125,643	2,333,546	207,903	9.8%
Maximum Allowable Levy	64,403,757	67,961,402	71,468,296	73,959,765	2,491,469	3.5%
Excess Levy Capacity	(87,135)	(157,691)	(12,213)	(5,736)		
Subtotal PROPERTY TAX	**64,316,622**	**67,803,711**	**71,456,083**	**73,954,029**	**2,497,946**	3.5%
LOCAL RECEIPTS						
Motor Vehicle Excise	2,026,029	2,296,744	1,993,908	2,090,000	96,092	4.8%
Hotel/Motel and Meals Excise	915,231	954,737	800,400	889,000	88,600	11.1%
Cannabis Tax	74,334	56,439	-	-	-	--
Penalties and Interest	250,777	305,639	254,900	268,500	13,600	5.3%
PILOT	844,948	857,479	857,698	857,698	-	0.0%
Fees	18,246	16,633	-	-	-	--
Rentals	148,969	160,480	139,599	122,226	(17,373)	-12.4%
Departmental Revenue	1,072,381	1,216,402	843,678	959,100	115,422	13.7%
Licenses and Permits	1,729,213	1,673,931	1,026,968	1,425,310	398,342	38.8%
Special Assessments	1,284,146	1,257,731	1,278,074	1,283,361	5,287	0.4%
Fines and Forfeits	59,550	58,497	60,600	49,300	(11,300)	-18.6%
Investment Income	1,931,628	2,432,312	500,000	500,000	-	0.0%
Miscellaneous (see notes section)	568,444	569,020	115,000	165,000	50,000	43.5%
Subtotal LOCAL RECEIPTS	**10,923,898**	**11,856,044**	**7,870,825**	**8,609,495**	**738,670**	9.4%
STATE AID						
Chapter 70	6,280,773	6,383,109	6,538,659	6,616,134	77,475	1.2%
Charter Assessment Reimbursement	144,627	206,569	262,460	456,743	194,283	74.0%
Unrestricted General Govt Aid	10,064,417	10,366,349	10,480,379	10,741,773	261,394	2.5%
Veterans Benefits	124,597	78,937	135,659	120,073	(15,586)	-11.5%
Exempt Vets, Blind, Surv. Spouses, Elderly	40,209	48,821	58,108	59,512	1,404	2.4%
State Owned Land	326,060	334,216	334,234	334,234	-	0.0%
Offset Receipts						
School Lunch	-	-	-	-	-	--
School Choice Tuition			862,088	846,991	(15,097)	-1.8%
Public Libraries			172,103	173,076	973	0.6%
Subtotal STATE AID	**16,980,683**	**17,418,001**	**18,843,690**	**19,348,536**	**504,846**	2.7%
OTHER FINANCING SOURCES						--
Ambulance Fund	3,164,290	2,947,500	3,474,000	3,215,000	(259,000)	-7.5%
Community Preservation Act (debt service only)	443,460	268,250	176,550	462,416	285,866	161.9%
Enterprise Fund Reimbursements	725,209	952,965	1,043,944	1,075,262	31,318	3.0%
Overlay Surplus	-	-	-	-	-	--
Miscellaneous	275,000	430,440	75,000	450,000	375,000	500.0%
Free Cash	4,518,349	7,744,809	269,704	-	(269,704)	--
Stabilization Fund		-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal OTHER FINANCING SOURCES	**9,126,308**	**12,343,964**	**5,039,198**	**5,202,678**	**163,480**	3.2%
TOTAL REVENUES	**101,347,510**	**109,421,721**	**103,209,796**	**107,114,738**	**3,904,942**	3.78%

	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 ACTUAL	FY 26 BUDGET	FY 27 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg
EXPENDITURES						
OPERATING BUDGET						
Town	25,393,309	23,619,944	29,497,920	30,833,590	1,335,670	*4.53%*
Elementary Schools	25,876,274	26,964,668	28,049,236	29,478,590	1,429,354	*5.10%*
Elementary Schools (1% add'l from Free Cash)			269,704		(269,704)	*-100.00%*
A-P Regional School District (Assessment)	17,772,017	18,838,338	19,744,008	20,434,781	690,773	*3.50%*
Jones Library (Tax Support)	2,213,530	2,302,071	2,394,154	2,486,329	92,175	*3.85%*
Subtotal OPERATING BUDGET	**71,255,130**	**71,725,022**	**79,955,022**	**83,233,290**	**3,278,268**	**4.10%**
CAPITAL BUDGET						
Debt Service - Debt Exclusion		691,807	2,125,643	2,333,546	207,903	9.8%
Debt Service - OTHER NOT TAX FUNDED (CPA/Other)	516,586	339,856	251,550	537,416	285,866	113.6%
Debt Assessment - Region	372,018	388,922	485,000	761,660	276,660	57.0%
Debt Service - Current	299,146	1,341,047	1,204,095	2,000,754	796,659	66.2%
Debt Service - Projected	-	27,500	123,255	100,000	(23,255)	-18.9%
Cash Capital (Tax Support)	5,396,272	4,136,548	4,799,865	4,200,893	(598,972)	-12.5%
Subtotal Tax Funded Capital	**6,584,022**	**6,925,679**	**8,989,408**	**9,934,269**	**944,861**	**10.5%**
Tax Capital Less Debt Exclusion, CPA, Other	6,067,436	5,894,017	6,612,215	7,063,307	451,092	6.8%
% Net Tax Levy	10.2%	9.9%	10.3%	10.5%		
Cash Capital (Prior FY vote in Current FY)						
Cash Capital (Reserves)	1,326,562	3,530,000	-	375,000	375,000	
Cash Capital (Ambulance Fund)	334,516	147,500	674,000	15,000	(659,000)	-97.8%
Subtotal CAPITAL	**8,245,100**	**10,603,179**	**9,663,408**	**10,324,269**	**660,861**	**6.8%**
MISCELLANEOUS						
Assessment - Retirement System	7,500,609	7,426,618	7,777,403	7,836,382	58,979	0.8%
Assessment - Regional Lockup Facility	-	-	-	-	-	--
Other	3,518,349	4,214,809				--
OPEB	550,000	600,000	600,000	600,000	-	0.0%
Reserve Fund						--
Subtotal MISCELLANEOUS	**11,568,958**	**12,241,427**	**8,377,403**	**8,436,382**	**58,979**	**0.7%**
Total APPROPRIATIONS	**91,069,188**	**94,569,628**	**97,995,833**	**101,993,941**	**3,998,108**	**4.1%**
UNAPPROPRIATED USES						
Reserve for Abatements & Exemptions			335,794	358,131	22,337	6.7%
State Assessments (Cherry Sheet)	3,521,322	3,607,799	3,826,446	3,725,067	(101,379)	-2.6%
Cherry Sheet Offsets			1,034,191	1,020,067	(14,124)	-1.4%
Other Amounts to be Raised	7,168	7,348	17,532	17,532	-	0.0%
Subtotal UNAPPROPRIATED USES	**3,528,490**	**3,615,147**	**5,213,963**	**5,120,797**	**(93,166)**	**-1.8%**
TOTAL BUDGET PLAN	**94,597,679**	**98,184,775**	**103,209,796**	**107,114,738**	**3,904,942**	**3.8%**
SURPLUS / (SHORTFALL)	**6,749,832**	**11,236,946**	**(0)**	**-**		

Long Range Financial Outlook

Five Year Forecast	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 ACTUAL	FY 26 RECAP	FY 27 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg	FY 28 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 29 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 30 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 31 PROJ	$ Chg
REVENUES														
PROPERTY TAX														
Base Levy	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,269,595	69,342,653	2,073,058	3.1%	71,626,219	2,283,566	74,066,875	2,440,655	76,568,547	2,501,672	79,132,760	2,564,214
2.5% Allowable Increase	1,546,300	1,610,379	1,681,740	1,733,566	51,826	3.1%	1,790,655	57,089	1,851,672	61,016	1,914,214	62,542	1,978,319	64,105
Estimated New Growth	1,049,071	1,255,459	391,318	550,000	158,682	40.6%	650,000	100,000	650,000	-	650,000	-	650,000	-
General Override														
Levy Limit	**64,403,757**	**67,269,595**	**69,342,653**	**71,626,219**	**2,283,566**	3.3%	**74,066,875**	**2,440,655**	**76,568,547**	**2,501,672**	**79,132,760**	**2,564,214**	**81,761,079**	**2,628,319**
Debt Exclusion		691,807	2,125,643	2,333,546	207,903	9.8%	2,326,900	(6,646)	2,332,150	5,250	2,335,400	3,250	2,326,650	(8,750)
Maximum Allowable Levy	64,403,757	67,961,402	71,468,296	73,959,765	2,491,469	3.5%	76,393,775	2,434,009	78,900,697	2,506,922	81,468,160	2,567,464	84,087,729	2,619,569
Excess Levy Capacity	(87,135)	(157,691)	(12,213)	(5,736)			-		-		-		-	
Subtotal PROPERTY TAX	**64,316,622**	**67,803,711**	**71,456,083**	**73,954,029**	**2,497,946**	3.5%	**76,393,775**	**2,439,746**	**78,900,697**	**2,506,922**	**81,468,160**	**2,567,464**	**84,087,729**	**2,619,569**
LOCAL RECEIPTS														
Motor Vehicle Excise	2,026,029	2,296,744	1,993,908	2,090,000	96,092	4.8%	2,142,250	52,250	2,195,806	53,556	2,250,701	54,895	2,306,969	56,268
Hotel/Motel and Meals Excise	915,231	954,737	800,400	889,000	88,600	11.1%	915,670	26,670	943,140	27,470	962,003	18,863	981,243	19,240
Cannabis Tax	74,334	56,439	-	-	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Penalties and Interest	250,777	305,639	254,900	268,500	13,600	5.3%	268,500	-	268,500	-	268,500	-	268,500	-
PILOT	844,948	857,479	857,698	857,698	-	0.0%	857,698	-	857,698	-	857,698	-	857,698	-
Fees	18,246	16,633	-	-	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Rentals	148,969	160,480	139,599	122,226	(17,373)	-12.4%	125,893	3,667	129,670	3,777	132,263	2,593	134,908	2,645
Departmental Revenue	1,072,381	1,216,402	843,678	959,100	115,422	13.7%	987,873	28,773	1,017,509	29,636	1,037,859	20,350	1,058,617	20,757
Licenses and Permits	1,729,213	1,673,931	1,026,968	1,425,310	398,342	38.8%	1,468,069	42,759	1,512,111	44,042	1,542,354	30,242	1,573,201	30,847
Special Assessments	1,284,146	1,257,731	1,278,074	1,283,361	5,287	0.4%	1,010,046	(273,315)	1,010,046	-	1,010,046	-	1,010,046	-
Fines and Forfeits	59,550	58,497	60,600	49,300	(11,300)	-18.6%	49,300	-	49,300	-	49,300	-	49,300	-
Investment Income	1,931,628	2,432,312	500,000	500,000	-	0.0%	500,000	-	500,000	-	500,000	-	500,000	-
Miscellaneous (see notes section)	568,444	569,020	115,000	165,000	50,000	43.5%	169,950	4,950	175,049	5,099	178,549	3,501	182,120	3,571
Subtotal LOCAL RECEIPTS	**10,923,898**	**11,856,044**	**7,870,825**	**8,609,495**	**738,670**	9.4%	**8,495,249**	**(114,246)**	**8,658,829**	**163,580**	**8,789,274**	**130,445**	**8,922,602**	**133,328**
STATE AID														
Chapter 70	6,280,773	6,383,109	6,538,659	6,616,134	77,475	1.2%	6,642,599	26,465	6,669,169	26,570	6,695,846	26,677	6,722,629	26,783
Charter Assessment Reimbursement	144,627	206,569	262,460	456,743	194,283	74.0%	456,743	-	456,743	-	456,743	-	456,743	-
Unrestricted General Govt Aid	10,064,417	10,366,349	10,480,379	10,741,773	261,394	2.5%	10,956,608	214,835	11,175,741	219,132	11,399,255	223,515	11,627,241	227,985
Veterans Benefits	124,597	78,937	135,659	120,073	(15,586)	-11.5%	120,073	-	120,073	-	120,073	-	120,073	-
Exempt Vets, Blind, Surv. Spouses, Elderly	40,209	48,821	58,108	59,512	1,404	2.4%	59,512	-	59,512	-	59,512	-	59,512	-
State Owned Land	326,060	334,216	334,234	334,234	-	0.0%	334,234	-	334,234	-	334,234	-	334,234	-
Offset Receipts														
School Lunch	-	-	-	-	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
School Choice Tuition			862,088	846,991	(15,097)	-1.8%	846,991	-	846,991	-	846,991	-	846,991	-
Public Libraries			172,103	173,076	973	0.6%	173,076	-	173,076	-	173,076	-	173,076	-
Subtotal STATE AID	**16,980,683**	**17,418,001**	**18,843,690**	**19,348,536**	**504,846**	2.7%	**19,589,836**	**241,300**	**19,835,539**	**245,703**	**20,085,730**	**250,191**	**20,340,499**	**254,768**
OTHER FINANCING SOURCES						--								
Ambulance Fund	3,164,290	2,947,500	3,474,000	3,215,000	(259,000)	-7.5%	4,090,000	875,000	3,715,000	(375,000)	4,550,000	835,000	3,715,000	(835,000)
Community Preservation Act (debt service only)	443,460	268,250	176,550	462,416	285,866	161.9%	520,350	57,934	502,800	(17,550)	475,250	(27,550)	458,200	(17,050)
Enterprise Fund Reimbursements	725,209	952,965	1,043,944	1,075,262	31,318	3.0%	1,107,520	32,258	1,140,745	33,226	1,174,968	34,222	1,210,217	35,249
Overlay Surplus	-	-	-	-	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Miscellaneous	275,000	430,440	75,000	450,000	375,000	500.0%	20,000	(430,000)	-	(20,000)	-	-	-	-
Free Cash	4,518,349	7,744,809	269,704	-	(269,704)	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Stabilization Fund		-	-	-	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Subtotal OTHER FINANCING SOURCES	**9,126,308**	**12,343,964**	**5,039,198**	**5,202,678**	**163,480**	3.2%	**5,737,870**	**535,192**	**5,358,545**	**(379,324)**	**6,200,218**	**841,672**	**5,383,417**	**(816,801)**
TOTAL REVENUES	**101,347,510**	**109,421,721**	**103,209,796**	**107,114,738**	**3,904,942**	3.78%	**110,216,730**	**3,101,992**	**112,753,610**	**2,536,880**	**116,543,382**	**3,789,772**	**118,734,247**	**2,190,865**

	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 ACTUAL	FY 26 BUDGET	FY 27 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg	FY 28 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 29 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 30 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 31 PROJ	$ Chg
EXPENDITURES														
OPERATING BUDGET														
Town	25,393,309	23,619,944	29,497,920	30,833,590	1,335,670	4.5%	31,989,764	1,156,174	33,074,982	1,085,219	33,984,544	909,562	34,919,119	934,575
Elementary Schools	25,876,274	26,964,668	28,049,236	29,478,590	1,429,354	5.1%	30,289,251	810,661	31,122,206	832,954	31,978,066	855,861	32,857,463	879,397
Elementary Schools (1% add'l from Free Cash)			269,704		(269,704)	0.0%		-						
A-P Regional School District (Assessment)	17,772,017	18,838,338	19,744,008	20,434,781	690,773	3.5%	20,996,737	561,956	21,574,148	577,410	22,167,437	593,289	22,777,041	609,605
Jones Library (Tax Support)	2,213,530	2,302,071	2,394,154	2,486,329	92,175	3.9%	2,554,703	68,374	2,624,957	70,254	2,697,144	72,186	2,771,315	74,171
Subtotal OPERATING BUDGET	**71,255,130**	**71,725,022**	**79,955,022**	**83,233,290**	**3,278,268**	**4.1%**	**85,830,456**	**2,597,165**	**88,396,293**	**2,565,838**	**90,827,191**	**2,430,898**	**93,324,939**	**2,497,748**
CAPITAL BUDGET														
Debt Service - Debt Exclusion		691,807	2,125,643	2,333,546	207,903	9.8%	2,326,900	(6,646)	2,332,150	5,250	2,335,400	3,250	2,326,650	(8,750)
Debt Service - OTHER NOT TAX FUNDED (CPA/Other)	516,586	339,856	251,550	537,416	285,866	113.6%	520,350	(17,066)	502,800	(17,550)	475,250	(27,550)	458,200	(17,050)
Debt Assessment - Region	372,018	388,922	485,000	761,660	276,660	57.0%	786,884	25,224	1,000,107	213,223	928,077	(72,030)	1,000,000	71,923
Debt Service - Current	299,146	1,341,047	1,204,095	2,000,754	796,659	66.2%	1,900,200	(100,554)	1,649,550	(250,650)	1,617,400	(32,150)	1,539,900	(77,500)
Debt Service - Projected	-	27,500	123,255	100,000	(23,255)	-18.9%	100,000	-	1,834,903	1,734,903	2,370,403	535,500	2,358,503	(11,900)
Cash Capital (Tax Support)	5,396,272	4,136,548	4,799,865	4,200,893	(598,972)	-12.5%	4,493,895	293,002	3,036,193	(1,457,702)	2,861,142	(175,051)	3,141,294	280,152
Subtotal Tax Funded Capital	**6,584,022**	**6,925,679**	**8,989,408**	**9,934,269**	**944,861**	**10.5%**	**10,128,229**	**193,960**	**10,355,703**	**227,474**	**10,587,672**	**231,969**	**10,824,547**	**236,875**
Tax Capital Less Debt Exclusion, CPA, Other	6,067,436	5,894,017	6,612,215	7,063,307	451,092	6.8%	7,280,979		7,520,753		7,777,022		8,039,697	
% Net Tax Levy	10.2%	9.9%	10.3%	10.5%			10.50%		10.50%		10.50%		10.50%	
Cash Capital (Prior FY vote in Current FY)														
Cash Capital (Reserves)	1,326,562	3,530,000	-	375,000	375,000		20,000	(355,000)	-	(20,000)	-	-	-	-
Cash Capital (Ambulance Fund)	334,516	147,500	674,000	15,000	(659,000)	-97.8%	590,000	575,000	15,000	(575,000)	850,000	835,000	15,000	(835,000)
Subtotal CAPITAL	**8,245,100**	**10,603,179**	**9,663,408**	**10,324,269**	**660,861**	**6.8%**	**10,738,229**	**413,960**	**10,370,703**	**(367,526)**	**11,437,672**	**1,066,969**	**10,839,547**	**(598,125)**
MISCELLANEOUS														
Assessment - Retirement System	7,500,609	7,426,618	7,777,403	7,836,382	58,979	0.8%	8,149,837	313,455	8,475,831	325,993	8,814,864	339,033	9,167,459	352,595
Assessment - Regional Lockup Facility	-	-	-	-	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other	3,518,349	4,214,809				--						-		-
OPEB	550,000	600,000	600,000	600,000	-	0.0%	625,000	25,000	650,000	25,000	675,000	25,000	700,000	25,000
Reserve Fund						--						-		-
Subtotal MISCELLANEOUS	**11,568,958**	**12,241,427**	**8,377,403**	**8,436,382**	**58,979**	**0.7%**	**8,774,837**	**338,455**	**9,125,831**	**350,993**	**9,489,864**	**364,033**	**9,867,459**	**377,595**
Total APPROPRIATIONS	**91,069,188**	**94,569,628**	**97,995,833**	**101,993,941**	**3,998,108**	**4.1%**	**105,343,522**	**3,349,581**	**107,892,827**	**2,549,305**	**111,754,727**	**3,861,900**	**114,031,945**	**2,277,217**
UNAPPROPRIATED USES														
Reserve for Abatements & Exemptions			335,794	358,131	22,337	6.7%	381,969	23,838	394,503	12,535	407,341	12,837	420,439	13,098
State Assessments (Cherry Sheet)	3,521,322	3,607,799	3,826,446	3,725,067	(101,379)	-2.6%	3,836,819	111,752	3,951,924	115,105	4,070,481	118,558	4,192,596	122,114
Cherry Sheet Offsets			1,034,191	1,020,067	(14,124)	-1.4%	1,020,067	-	1,020,067	-	1,020,067	-	1,020,067	-
Other Amounts to be Raised	7,168	7,348	17,532	17,532	-	0.0%	17,532	-	17,532	-	17,532	-	17,532	-
Subtotal UNAPPROPRIATED USES	**3,528,490**	**3,615,147**	**5,213,963**	**5,120,797**	**(93,166)**	**-1.8%**	**5,256,387**	**135,590**	**5,384,026**	**127,639**	**5,515,421**	**131,395**	**5,650,633**	**135,212**
TOTAL BUDGET PLAN	**94,597,679**	**98,184,775**	**103,209,796**	**107,114,738**	**3,904,942**	**3.8%**	**110,599,909**	**3,485,171**	**113,276,853**	**2,676,944**	**117,270,148**	**3,993,295**	**119,682,578**	**2,412,430**
SURPLUS / (SHORTFALL)	**6,749,832**	**11,236,946**	**(0)**	**-**			**(383,179)**		**(523,243)**		**(726,766)**		**(948,331)**	

**Assumes a 2.8% annual increase in departmental operating budgets.*

Summary of Municipal Budgeting & Accounting

Developing and managing the annual budget is a multi-step process that spans the entire year. Below is a breakdown of the key tasks performed each month. The months that these tasks occur may vary from year to year.

September

- Town staff begin to develop financial projections for the following year and create the budget calendar that will include key milestones.
- The Community Preservation Act Committee (CPAC), which develops recommendations for how to expend Community Preservation Act (CPA) funds, begins its process by requesting proposals from the community.

October

- Department heads review fees and fee-based programs and provide guidance on whether the fee should change for the following fiscal year.
- Department heads begin working on their capital improvement program requests for the following fiscal year. In addition, the resident capital request form is posted on the Town website.
- CPAC reviews proposals for CPA funds including listening to presentations from requestors.
- The first quarter budget report is prepared. The quarterly budget reports are posted online and provide the Town Council with information on the condition of the current year's budget.

November

- Proposals to change fees are finalized including possible changes to water and sewer rates.
- The Financial Indicators report is presented to the Town's elected bodies (Town Council, School Committee, and Board of Library Trustees).
- The Budget Coordinating Group (BCG) meets to agree upon a budget schedule for the next few months and to share other pertinent information.
- A budget forum is held. The budget forum, required by the Town Charter, provides an opportunity for residents to provide input or feedback before the budget is developed.
- The Finance Committee develops Budget Guidelines for the Town Council to adopt. Budget guidelines provide parameters to the Town Manager that help guide the development of the budget.
- CPAC holds a public hearing on the proposals it received. Residents can offer feedback on the proposals to help inform the recommendation from CPAC.

December

- Town staff update their sections of the budget document, including service levels.
- The first round of budget and capital meetings is held by the Finance Department with department heads.

January

- The Town Manager meets with department heads to review their budget and capital requests.
- Budget additional proposals are reviewed, and possible reductions are discussed if needed.
- The Governor releases information on State Aid funding levels.
- The Capital Improvement Program begins to take shape based on the meetings with department heads.

- The second quarter budget report is prepared.

February
- The budget document is assembled, and the Town Manager's budget proposal is drafted.
- The Capital Improvement Program, including the capital inventory, is presented to the Joint Capital Planning Committee (JCPC) for feedback. JCPC begins its review process.

March
- JCPC continues to review the Capital Improvement Program and makes a final recommendation to the Town Manager.
- The Library, Elementary School, and Amherst Pelham Regional School District must finalize their budget proposals and submit them to the Town Manager by April 1st.

April
- The Town Manager finalizes the budget document and Capital Improvement Program.
- Changes to the water and sewer rate are presented to Town Council.
- The Regional School District budget is presented to the Town Council. A budget hearing is held on the Region's budget. The Region budget is often considered on a different timeline than the rest of the budget because of the timing of Town Meetings in the other Towns that belong to the Region.
- The third quarter budget report is prepared.

May
- The budget proposal and Capital Improvement Program are presented to the Town Council. These items are referred to the Finance Committee for review.
- The Finance Committee holds a public hearing on the budget and Capital Improvement Program.
- The Finance Committee meets with each department to review its budget proposals.
- The Town Council votes on the Region's budget proposal and related debt assessment.

June
- The Finance Committee completes its review of the budget and Capital Improvement Program and provides a recommendation to the Town Council.
- The Town Council reviews the recommendation from the Finance Committee and votes on the annual budget, the Capital Improvement Program, water and sewer rates, and Community Preservation Act budget.
- The Town Council may also vote on borrowing authorizations related to the budget if applicable in that given year.

July
- The new budget goes into effect.
- Finance Office staff disseminates the information to department heads and updates the financial accounting system.

August
- Finance office staff close out the prior fiscal year and calculate any deficit or surplus.
- Finance office staff prepare financial reports required by the State.
- Finance office prepares for the annual audit.

- The fourth quarter budget report is prepared.

While the annual budget process can seem complex, it ultimately comes down to balancing the Town's revenues and expenditures. This is very similar to the process that individuals would use to calculate their personal budget for the month or year. For the Town, the first step is calculating its revenue for the year. This involves making projections as the exact amount of revenues from most sources is not known at the time the budget is developed. Below are key revenue areas for the Town:

Property Tax: This is by far the largest revenue source for the Town. Each year, a property tax rate is calculated and billed to all property owners (unless exempt). For businesses, this includes personal property like equipment used to operate the business. Residents pay their property taxes quarterly.

Local Receipts: The Town collects revenues for the variety of services it provides. Some examples include providing licenses and permits, charging for specific services, and payments in lieu of taxes. All these receipts help support the budget of the Town.

State Aid: The State allocates funds to cities and towns for a variety of purposes. The two largest sources are Chapter 70 for education and Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA).

Other Financing Sources: The Town receives a few smaller sources of revenues including reimbursements from the State and indirect costs charges to Enterprise funds.

Once a conservative estimate of revenues is created, the next step is to project the expenditures of the Town. The Town Council plays a role in this process by providing budget guidelines that specify how much operating budgets can increase. Outside of the operating budgets, costs for capital, debt, retirement assessments and other state assessments are calculated. The end result is a projection of expenses for the Town.

The projection of revenues is coupled with the projection of expenditures to determine if budget reductions are necessary or if there are funds available to invest in the goals of the Town.

Fund Structure by Department

The General Fund is the primary funding source for the Town's operations. All the major revenue sources of the Town go into the General Fund. The Town Council, through the annual budget process, appropriates expenditures in the General Fund. In addition to the General Fund, there are several other funds used to manage specific activities such as recreation programs, water/sewer, transportation, solid waste, and ambulance billing. The chart below illustrates how various departments and activities are funded.

	General Fund	Recreation Revolving	Water	Sewer	Transportation	Solid Waste	Ambulance
Town Council	A						
Town Manager	A						
Finance	A						A
Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion	A						
Human Resources	A						
Employee Benefits	A						
Information Technology	A						A
Town Clerk/Elections	A						
Facilities	A						
Insurance	A		A	A	A	A	
General Services	A						
Police	A				A		
Fire/EMS	A						A
CRESS	A						
Dispatch	A						
Animal Control	A						
Public Works	A		A	A	A	A	
Conservation	A						
Planning	A						
Inspection Services	A						
Public Health	A						
Senior Center	A						
Veterans Services	A						
Recreation	A	A					

Reserves

Reserves are a key component to maintaining the fiscal health of the Town and are maintained for three strategic reasons:

1. To be used for emergency expenditures such as damaged bridge or a failure of a major building system.
2. To be used as a stabilizing revenue source during an economic downtown when other revenues drop.
3. To save up for large initiatives like a new building.

Amherst has reserves for each of these reasons. The table below provides an approximate breakdown of Town reserves as of May 1, 2026

Reserve Type	Purpose	Amount	Policy
Free Cash	Emergencies	$5,625,507	5% of Budget
General Stabilization Fund	Revenue Stability	$10,682,782	10% of Budget
Reparations Stabilization Fund	Reparations	$671,908	$2,000,000 Funding Goal
Capital Stabilization Fund	Capital Projects	$13,082,428	No Limit
Water Retained Earnings	Water Enterprise	$2,126,241	30% to 50% of Budget
Sewer Retained Earnings	Sewer Enterprise	$1,759,975	30% to 50% of Budget
Transportation Retained Earnings	Transportation Enterprise	$386,246	30% to 50% of Budget
Solid Waste Retained Earnings	Solid Waste Enterprise	$436,865	30% to 50% of Budget

The Town's policy is to maintain a reserve balance of 5% of the operating budget in Free Cash at all times. This emergency fund is the highest priority. The next priority is to maintain a balance of 10% of the operating budget in General Stabilization Fund. This policy goal is based on the amount of funding needed to sustain the Town budget for two to three years of an economic downturn. The next priority is the reparations fund where the Council has set a goal of raising $2 million by allocating an amount equivalent to annual cannabis revenues each year. The final priority is the capital stabilization fund where currently the goal is to save up as much as possible to pay for one of the projects outright to avoid interest costs.

The retained earnings reserve accounts are specific to the Town's Enterprise Funds. These budgets are smaller but vital so the policy goal is higher. The 30% to 50% target is based on the amount of funding needed to sustain operations for two to three years of an economic downturn.

Budget Assumptions

The annual budget is developed several months before the fiscal year begins. There are many unknowns at the time the budget is being developed and as a result, assumptions must be made. These assumptions are made by the Town's professional finance staff based on experience and expectations for the future. These assumptions are updated and refined as newer and better information is gathered. Below is a summary of the key assumptions that guided this year's budget.

Revenues

New growth is the addition to the tax rolls each year from new construction, renovations, additions, or other enhancements to properties. Town staff estimate new growth conservatively by looking at the volume and types of building permits that have been issued. The FY27 budget uses a figure of $550,000 for new growth, which is similar to previous years. During economic slowdowns, this figure may be reduced and similarly this number may be increased when there are several large construction projects going on in Town.

Local receipts include multiple revenue sources derived from economic activity in Town such as meals taxes or building permits. These revenue sources fluctuate with the local economy. The Town's local receipts took a big hit in FY21 due to the pandemic however they have largely recovered.

Expenditures

Wages and staffing are projected by taking the existing workforce and projecting it forward one year considering contractual changes that might increase pay and cost of living adjustments. Placeholders are used for vacant positions that are in the process of being filled.

Health insurance is one of the more unstable line items in the operating budget. While we know the health insurance rate, we do not know exactly how many employees will decide to enroll in the Town's health insurance each year. To help mitigate this unknown, we project a modest increase in plans each year.

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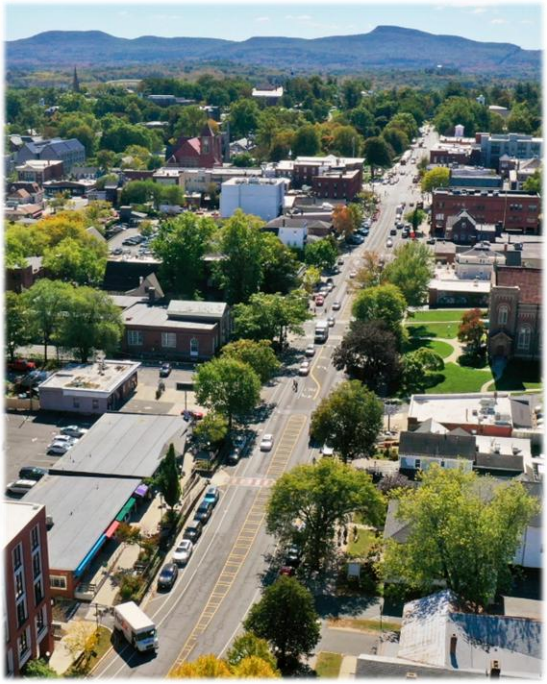


General Fund Revenue Summary & Detail

Overview

The following section provides a summary and additional details about the revenue sources that support the General Fund budget.

GENERAL FUND REVENUES SUMMARY

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26* Budget	FY 27* Manager	FY 27 -26 Change	Percent Change
Property Tax	$	61,725,183	64,316,622	67,803,711	71,456,083	73,954,029	2,497,946	3.5%
Local Receipts	$	9,221,197	10,923,898	11,856,044	7,870,825	8,609,495	738,670	9.4%
State Aid	$	16,560,357	16,980,683	17,418,001	18,843,690	19,348,536	504,846	2.7%
Other Financing Sources	$	21,768,528	9,126,308	12,343,964	5,039,198	5,202,678	163,480	3.2%
Total Revenues	$	109,275,265	101,347,510	109,421,721	103,209,796	107,114,738	3,904,942	3.8%

*State Aid figure totals include offset receipts for school choice and library aid.

Property Tax:

Description: Funds raised through the annual levy of taxes on real estate property. This funding source can increase/decrease due to changes in the level of property values, increases in the tax base from new development, and changes to the tax rate.

State Aid:

Description: Funds provided to the Town from the State for specific purposes. These funds are partially offset by State Assessments in the expenditure budget. The two largest categories are Chapter 70 for education and Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA). Revenues are decided by the State Legislature and aligned with the fiscal health of the economy.

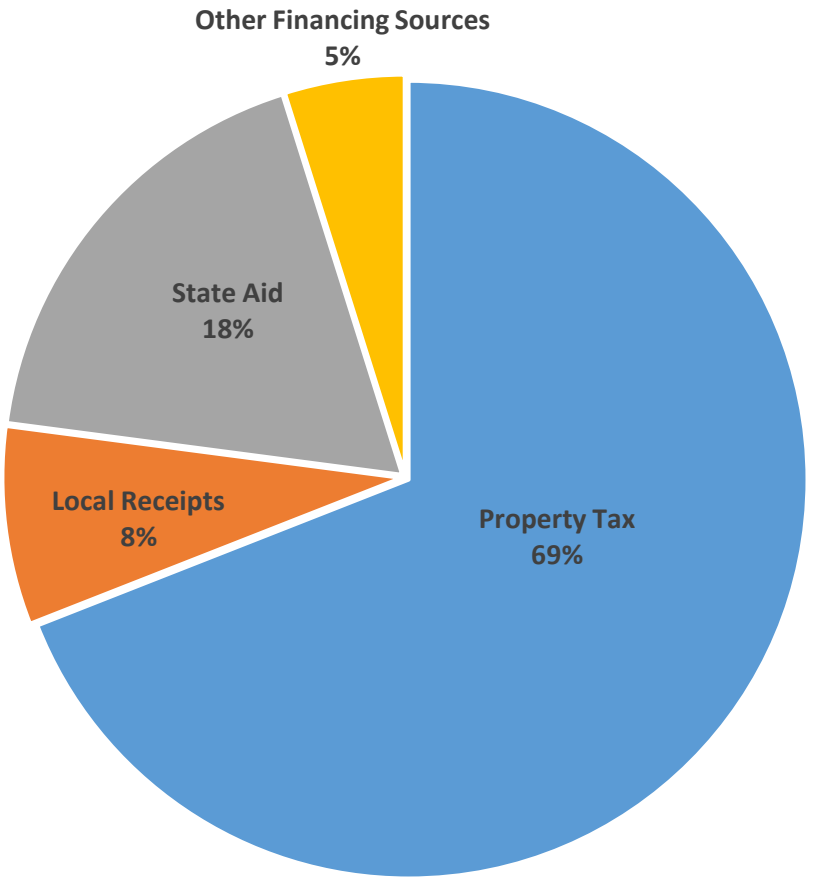
Local Receipts:

Description: Funds generated through a variety of different local activities such as recreation programming, licenses, permits, motor vehicle excise tax, Payment In Lieu of Taxes (PILOT) payments, penalties and fines. These revenues are more closely aligned with the health of our local economy.

Other Financing Sources:

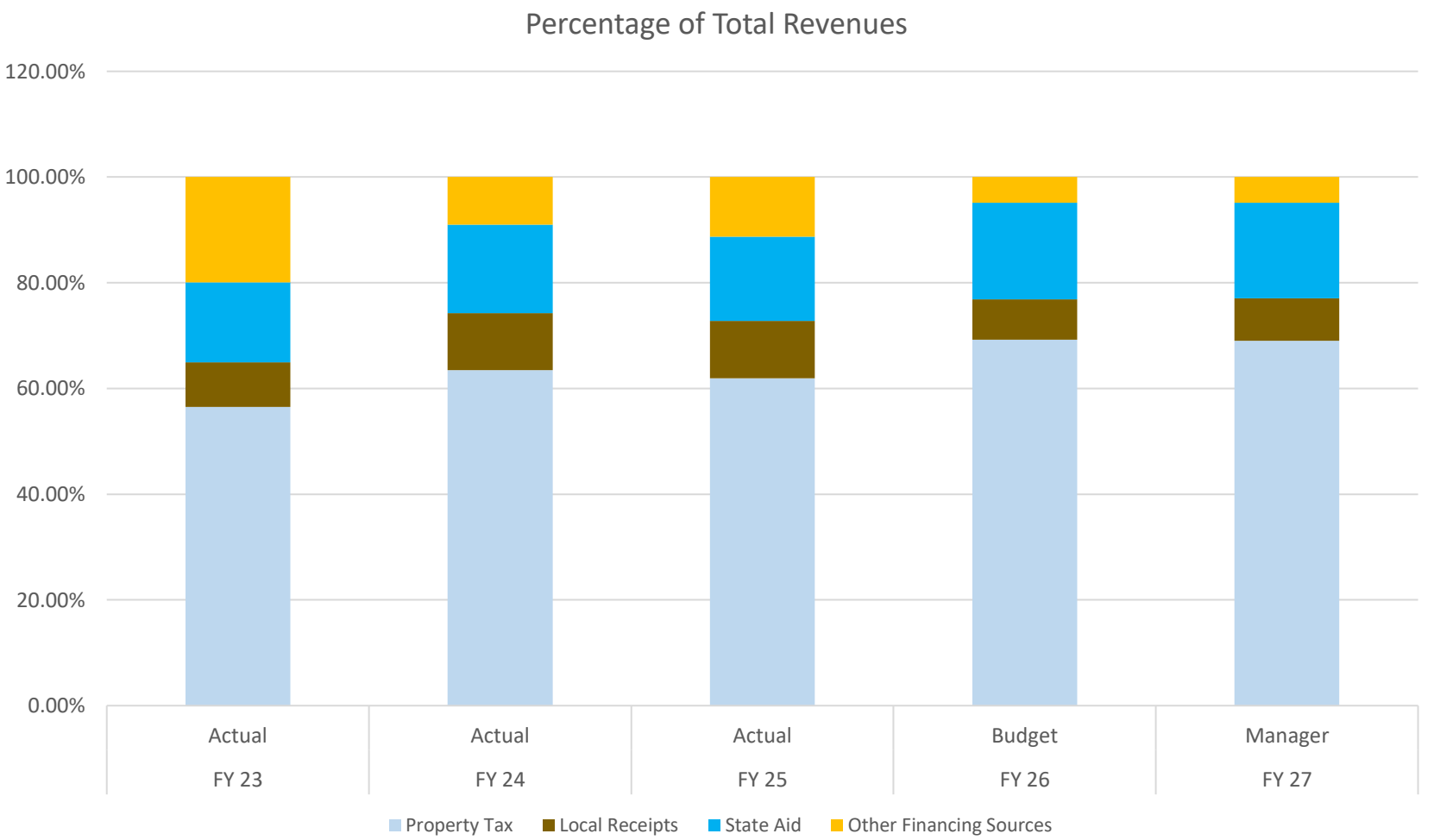
Description: Monies transferred in from other areas like enterprise funds, the ambulance fund, or the community preservation act. This also includes transfers from free cash to the stabilization fund, capital stabilization fund, and reparations fund.

FY27 Allocation of Revenue Sources



GENERAL FUND REVENUES SUMMARY

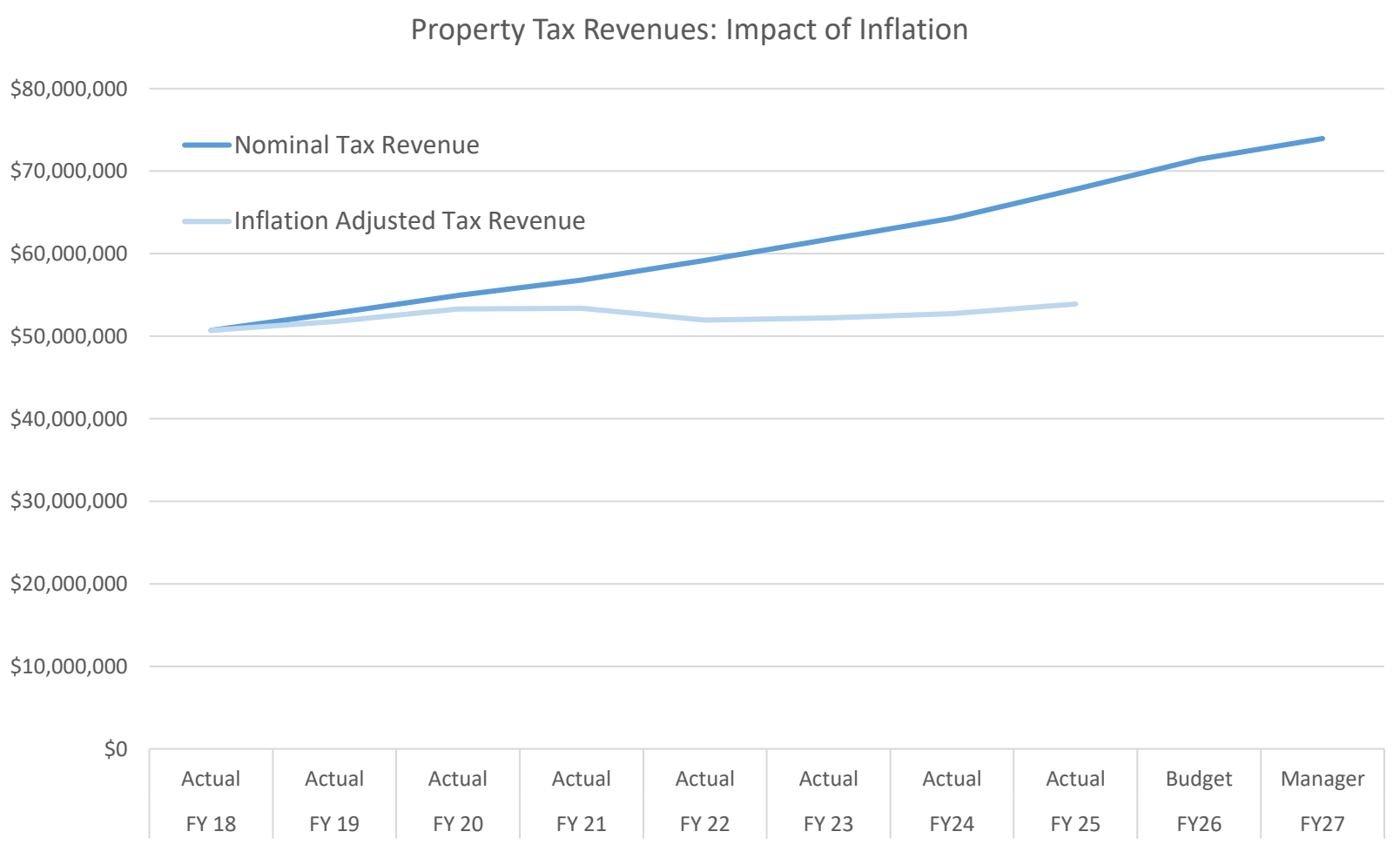
Service Levels:	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager
As a % of total revenues					
Property Tax	56.49%	63.46%	61.97%	69.23%	69.04%
Local Receipts	8.44%	10.78%	10.84%	7.63%	8.04%
State Aid	15.15%	16.75%	15.92%	18.26%	18.06%
Other Financing Sources	19.92%	9.00%	11.28%	4.88%	4.86%



Notable Trends:
The Town continues to see an increased reliance on property tax revenues to support the annual budget as State Aid revenue lags behind. In particular, the Town receives almost zero new funding from the State each year for education programming. New Growth has "grown" in importance as new construction contributes to the rise in the level of property taxes supporting the budget as more housing is added each year.

REVENUES: PROPERTY TAXES

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Recap	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Property Tax								
Base Levy	$	59,375,443	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,269,595	69,342,653	2,073,058	3.1%
2.5% Allowable Increase	$	1,484,386	1,546,300	1,610,379	1,681,740	1,733,566	51,826	3.1%
New Growth	$	948,557	1,049,071	1,255,459	391,318	550,000	158,682	40.6%
General Override	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	
Levy Limit	$	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,269,595	69,342,653	71,626,219	2,283,566	3.3%
Debt Exclusion	$	-	-	691,807	2,125,643	2,333,546	207,903	9.8%
Maximum Allowable Levy	$	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,961,402	71,468,296	73,959,765	2,491,469	3.5%
Excess Levy Capacity	$	(83,203)	(87,135)	(157,691)	(12,213)	(5,736)	6,477	-53.0%
Subtotal Property Tax	$	61,725,183	64,316,622	67,803,711	71,456,083	73,954,029	2,497,946	3.5%



Notable Trends

Property tax revenues have steadily increased over the past decade, as shown on the chart above. These revenues, when adjusted for inflation, have risen at a much slower rate**.** Inflation index used: Boston-Cambridge-Newton, MA-NH, all urban consumers, not seasonally adjusted. The economic benefits of new housing developments can be seen in the table above. The row labeled New Growth shows the addition to the tax levy from new construction and property improvements throughout Town. Without New Growth, the Town would need to find other ways to increase revenues or reduce expenditures.

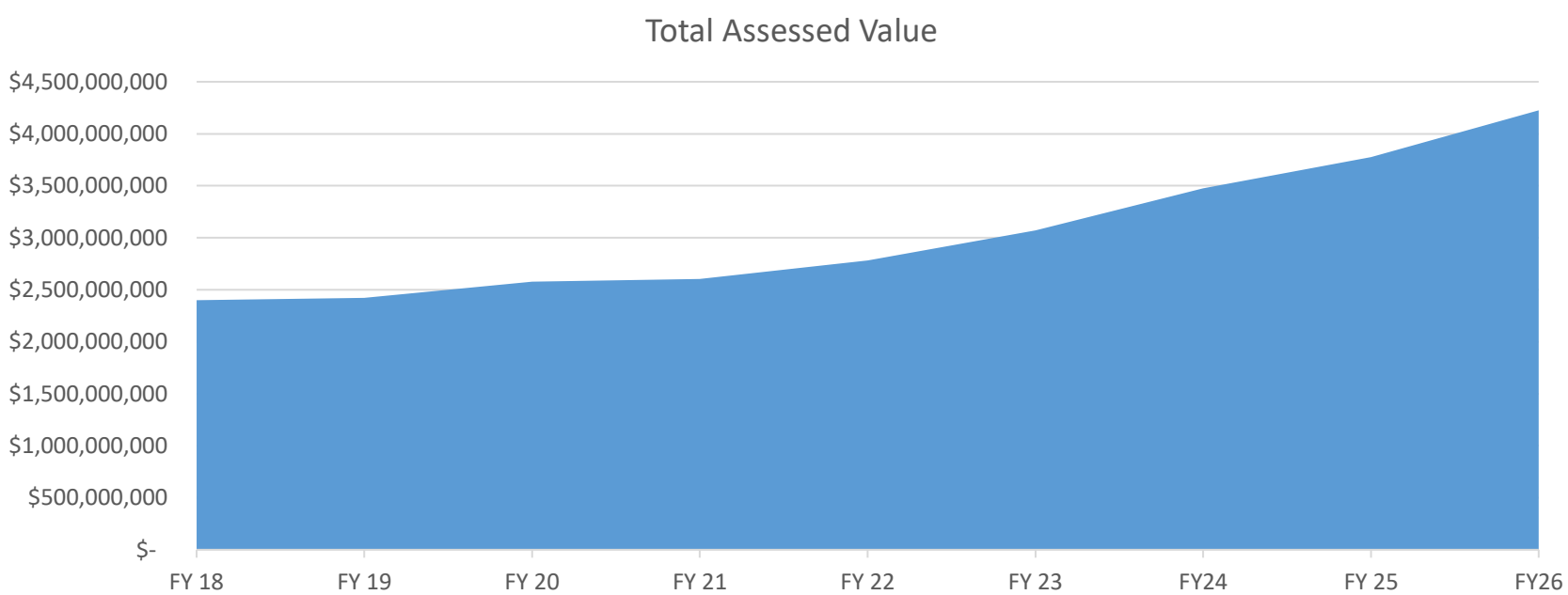
REVENUES: PROPERTY TAXES

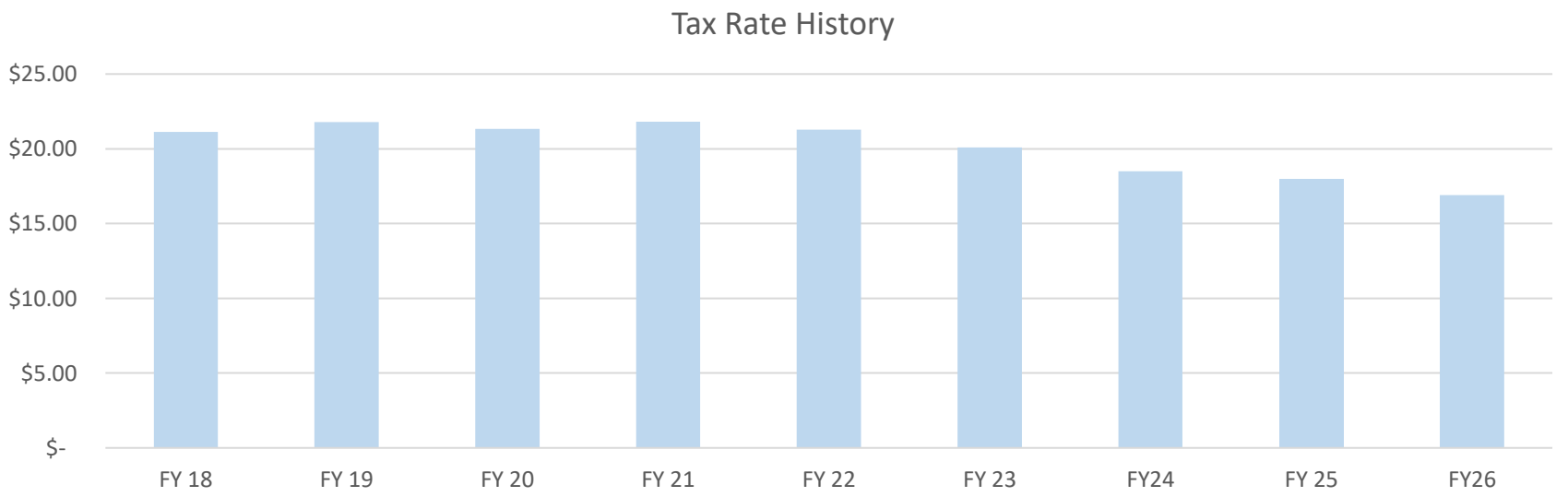
Property Tax Overview:

Funds raised through the annual levy of taxes on real estate property. The Assessor's Office is responsible for determining the value of all properties in Town and for calculating the annual levy. The Assessor is required to update property values according to a cycle set by the State.

Each year, the property tax levy is legally allowed to increase by 2.5%. In addition to the 2.5% allowable increase, the tax levy can grow if the tax base expands by way of new growth (new development). New growth is comprised of large projects like the construction of new buildings or smaller projects like home improvements.

The chart below illustrates the recent history of the Town's total assessed value. This includes residential, commercial, industrial, and personal property assessed values.



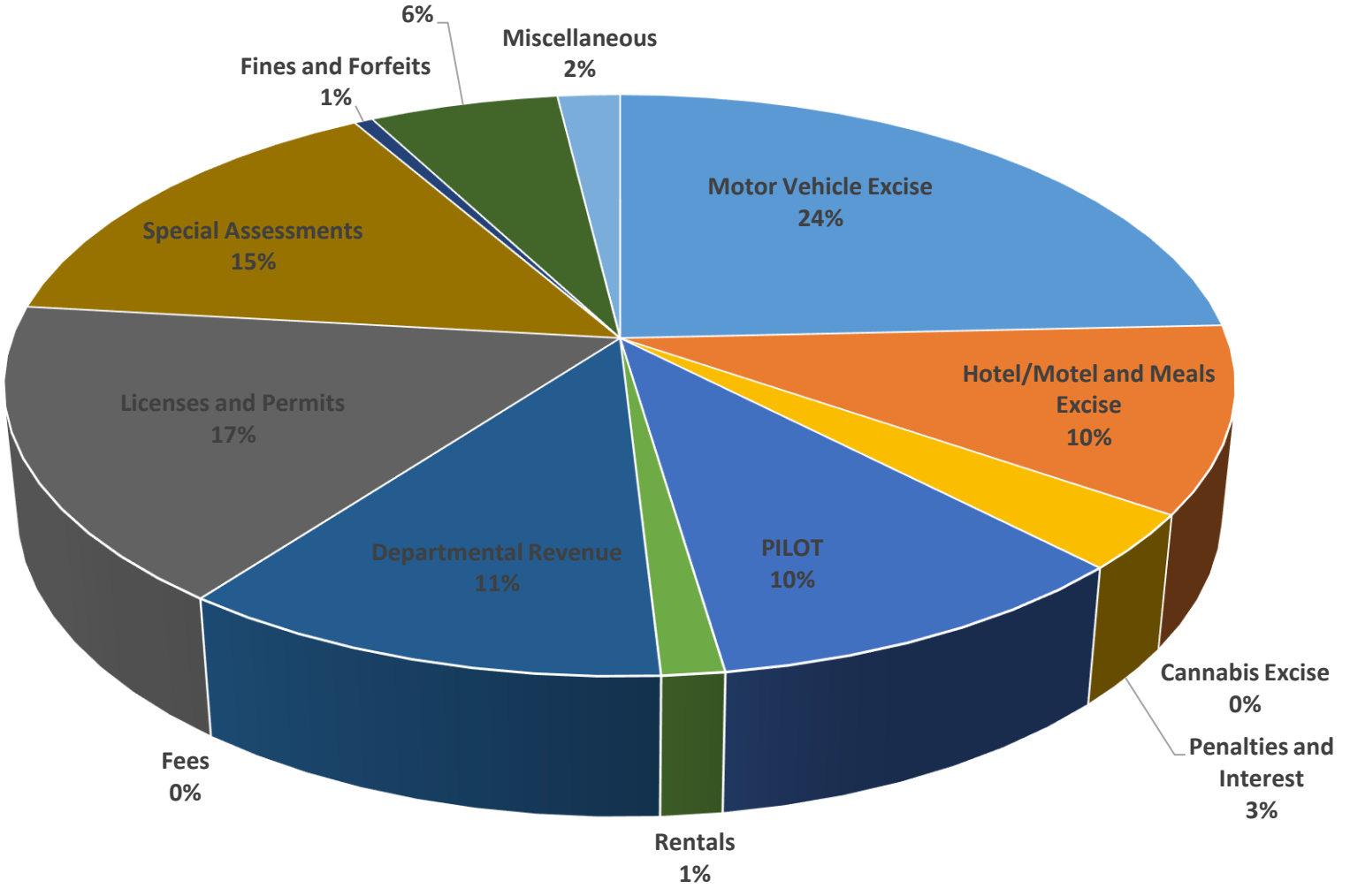


Notable Trends:
Total Assessed Value directly impacts the tax rate. A recent history of the Town's tax rate can be seen above. The Town's tax rate has remained relatively stable over the past ten years and declined in the past couple of years. Rising property values along with New Growth have contributed to the increase in Total Assessed Value that has stabilized the tax rate since 2016.

REVENUES: LOCAL RECEIPTS

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Recap	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Local Receipts								
Motor Vehicle Excise	$	1,959,748	2,026,029	2,296,744	1,993,908	2,090,000	96,092	4.8%
Hotel/Motel and Meals Excise	$	799,432	915,231	954,737	800,400	889,000	88,600	11.1%
Cannabis Excise	$	105,537	74,334	56,439	-	-	-	--
Penalties and Interest	$	305,727	250,777	305,639	254,900	268,500	13,600	5.3%
PILOT	$	822,136	844,948	857,479	857,698	857,698	-	--
Rentals	$	140,006	148,969	160,480	139,599	122,226	(17,373)	-12.4%
Departmental Revenue	$	1,151,131	1,072,381	1,216,402	843,678	959,100	115,422	13.7%
Fees	$	60,923	18,246	16,633	-	-	-	--
Licenses and Permits	$	1,308,024	1,729,213	1,673,931	1,026,968	1,425,310	398,342	38.8%
Special Assessments	$	1,220,293	1,284,146	1,257,731	1,278,074	1,283,361	5,287	0.4%
Fines and Forfeits	$	34,739	59,550	58,497	60,600	49,300	(11,300)	-18.6%
Investment Income	$	747,676	1,931,628	2,432,312	500,000	500,000	-	--
Miscellaneous	$	565,825	568,444	569,020	115,000	165,000	50,000	43.5%
Subtotal Local Receipts	$	9,221,197	10,923,898	11,856,044	7,870,825	8,609,495	738,670	9.4%

FY27 Allocation of Local Receipts Revenue



REVENUES: LOCAL RECEIPTS

Local Receipt Overview:

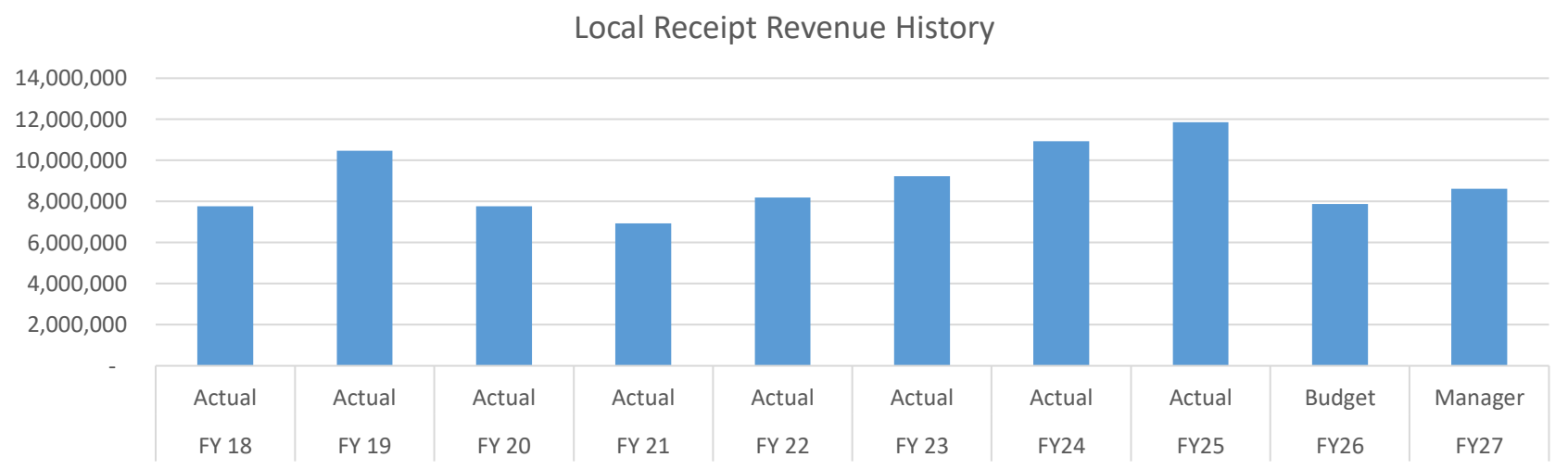
Locally generated revenues, other than real and personal property taxes. The table below shows what is included in a few of the major categories of local receipts. Many of these revenue sources fluctuate based on the health of the local economy.

Departmental Revenue	$$
General Government	
Certificate of Municipal Lien	$ 9,100
Collector's Fees	$ 12,600
Certified Copy Fees	$ 22,000
Other Departmental Fees	$ 44,170
Public Safety	
Police Off Duty Service/Other Fees	$ 57,590
Fire Department Inspections	$ 28,500
Public Works	$ 5,000
Conservation, Planning, Inspections	
Planning Board Fees	$ 17,700
Certificates of Inspections	$ 51,000
Other Departmental Fees	$ 41,850
Community Services	
Recreation	$ 158,000
Pools	$ 78,000
Cherry Hill	$ 295,950
Medicaid Reimbursement	$ 137,640
Total Departmental Revenues	$ 959,100

Licenses & Permits	$$
Public Safety	
Dog Licenses	$ 6,600
Other Permits	$ 99,600
Public Works	$ 14,760
Inspection Services, Town Clerk and Health	
Alcohol Licenses	$ 163,500
Building Permits	$ 485,000
Electrical Permits	$ 230,000
Rental Registration	$ 300,000
Other Licenses and Permits	$ 125,850
Total Licenses & Permits	$ 1,425,310
Miscellaneous	
UMass Strategic Partnership	$ 25,000
UMass Hotel/Motel Occupancy	$ 140,000
Total Miscellaneous	$ 165,000

Special Assessments	
UMass PVTA Assessment	$ 1,093,261
Five College PVTA Assessment	$ 190,100
Total Special Revenue Funds	$ 1,283,361

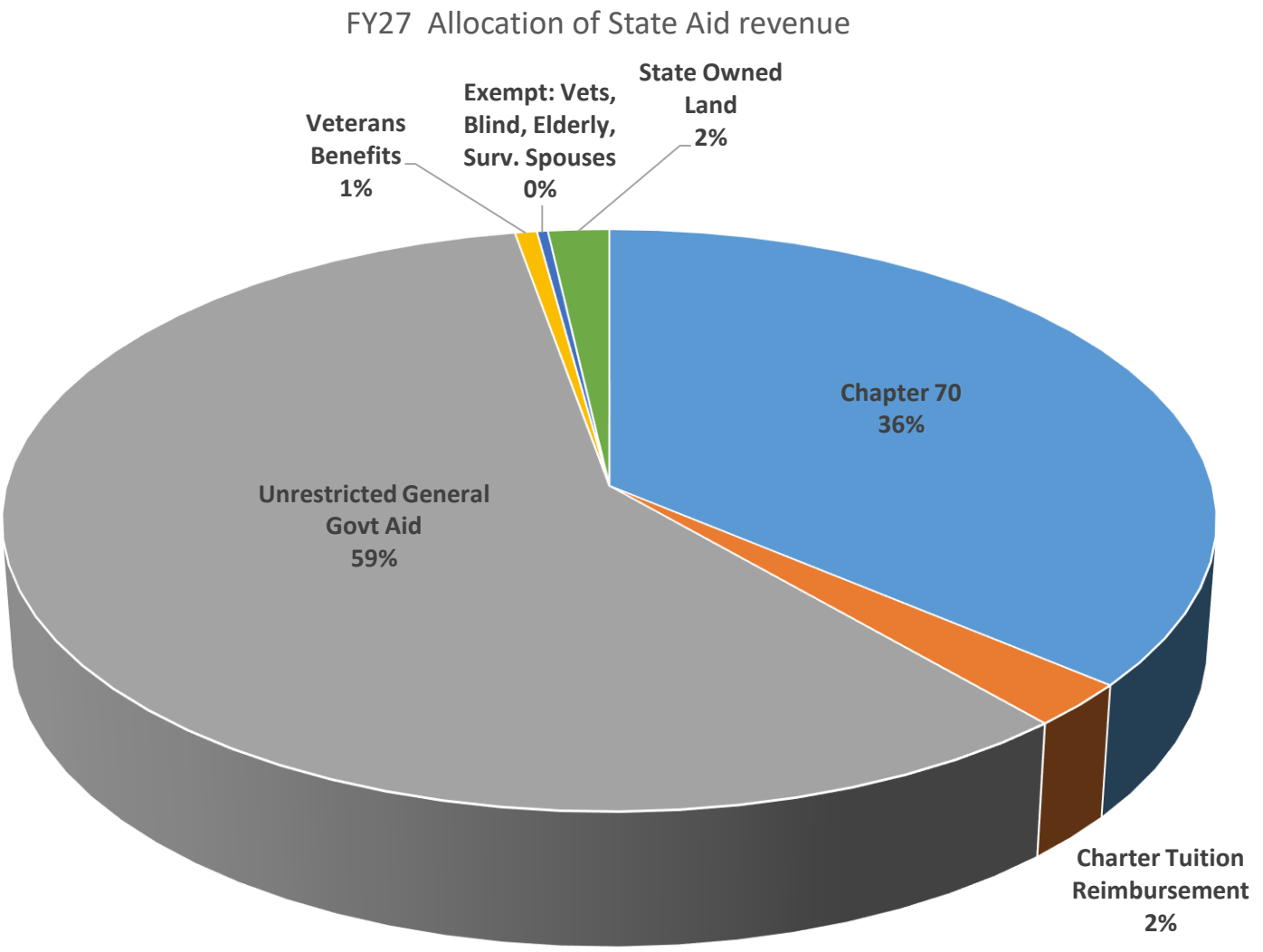
Notable Trends:
One of the largest factors influencing local receipts is construction throughout Town. Permit revenues associated with construction vary significantly from year to year depending on the size of the projects.



REVENUES: STATE AID

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26* Recap	FY 27* Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
State Aid								
Chapter 70	$	6,217,473	6,280,773	6,383,109	6,538,659	6,616,134	77,475	1.2%
Charter Tuition Reimbursement	$	153,318	144,627	206,569	262,460	456,743	194,283	74.0%
Unrestricted General Govt Aid	$	9,752,342	10,064,417	10,366,349	10,480,379	10,741,773	261,394	2.5%
Veterans Benefits	$	100,733	124,597	78,937	135,659	120,073	(15,586)	-11.5%
Exempt: Vets, Blind, Elderly, Surv.	$	39,721	40,209	48,821	58,108	59,512	1,404	2.4%
State Owned Land	$	296,770	326,060	334,216	334,234	334,234	-	--
Subtotal State Aid	$	16,560,357	16,980,683	17,418,001	17,809,499	18,328,469	518,970	2.9%

*Offset receipts for school choice tuition and library aid not shown as those funds go directly to the schools and library.

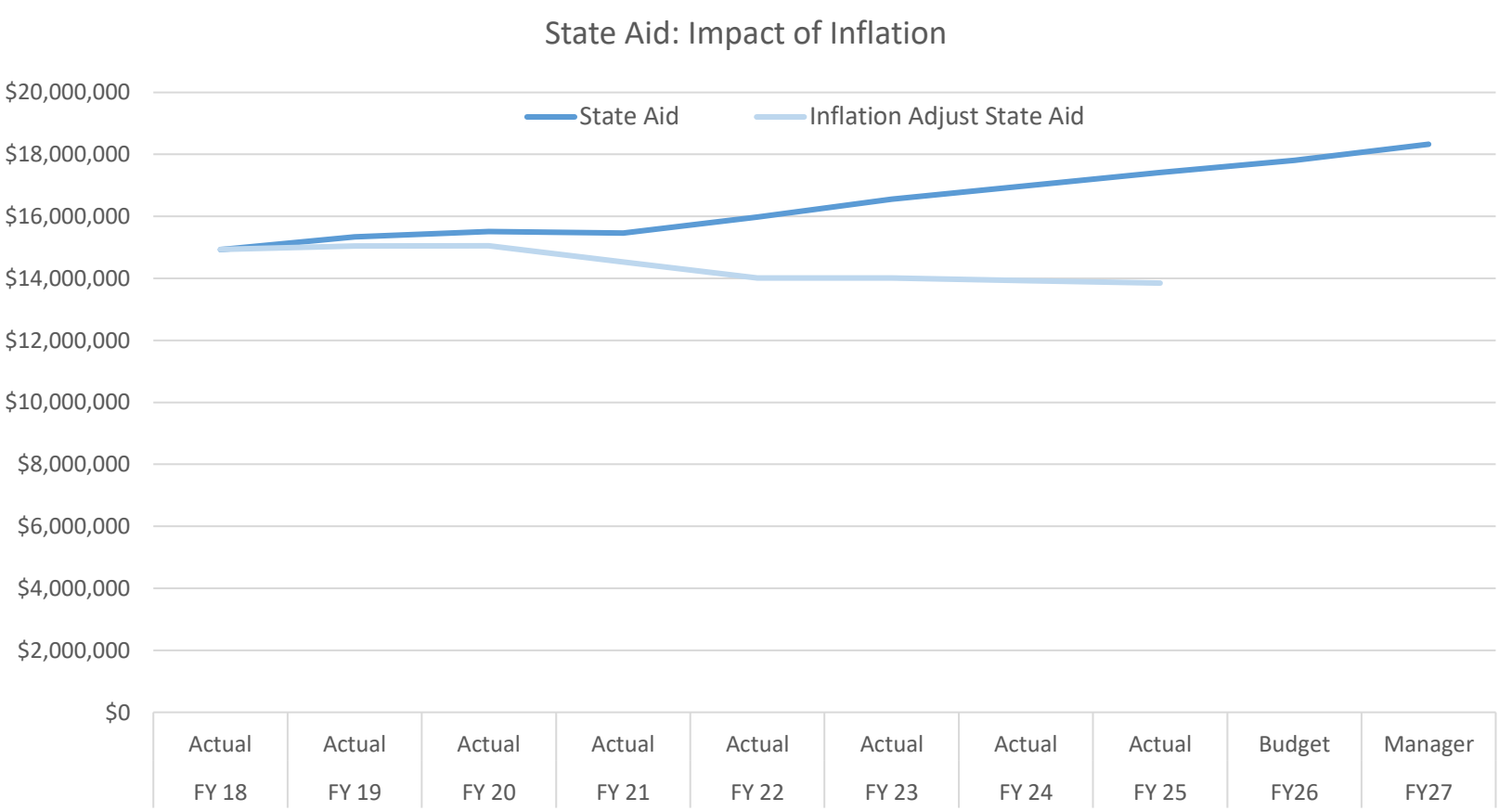


REVENUES: STATE AID

State Aid Overview:

The Town receives various different forms of State Aid each year:

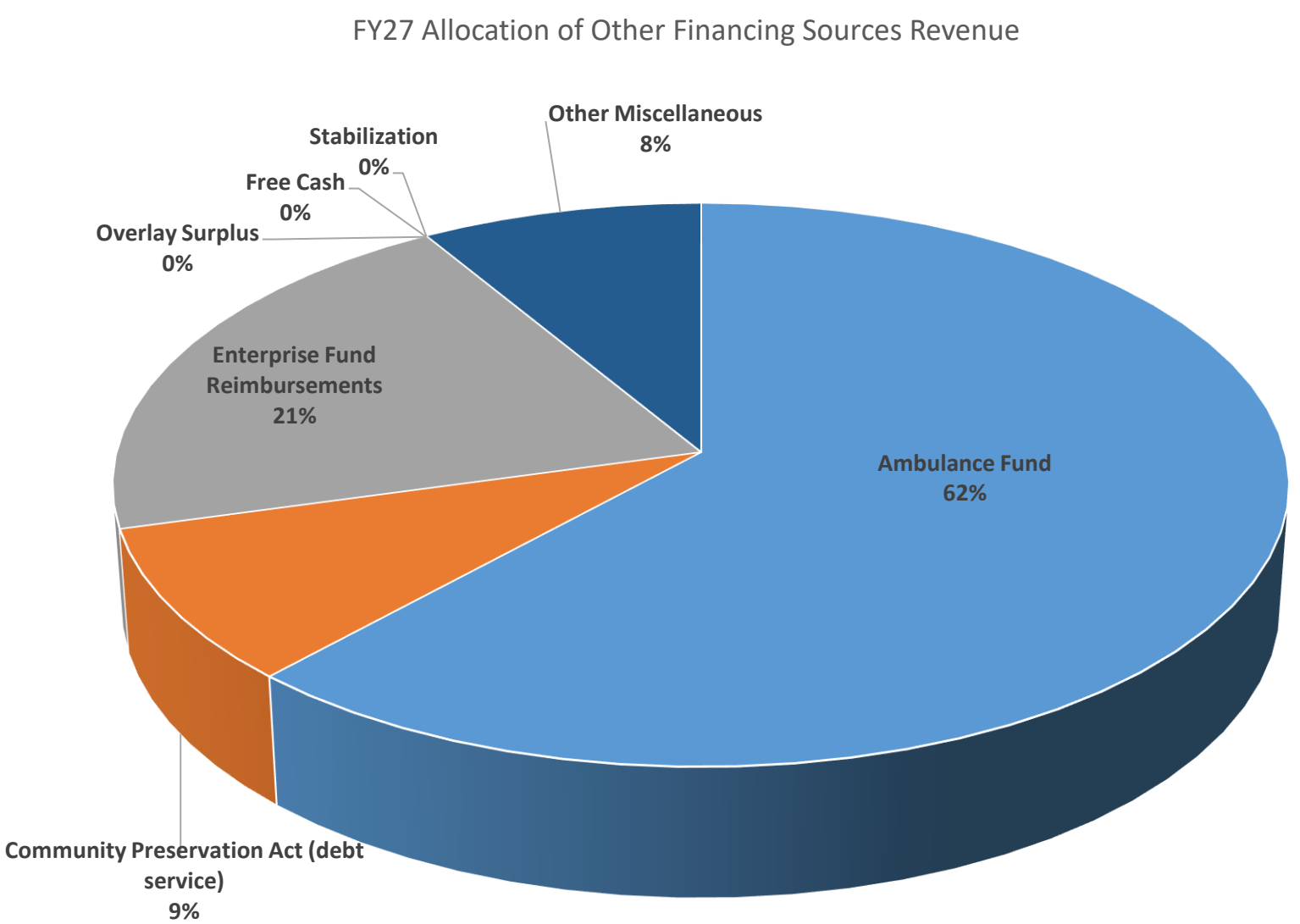
- Chapter 70 aid is targeted for education spending.
- Charter Tuition Reimbursement is a small offsetting revenue based on the amount of tuition the Town pays each year.
- Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA) is flexible in its use and goes to support all Town departments.
- Veterans Benefits is a partial reimbursement from the State tied to the amount of benefits the Town pays out to its veterans each year.
- Exempt: Vets, Blind, Elderly, Surviving Spouses is a state reimbursement for an exemption to property taxes provided to eligible tax payers.
- State Owned Land is a payment from the State for all of the land it owns in Town, primarily on the University Campus.



Notable Trends:
As reflected in the chart above, State Aid revenues show an increase over the past decade. However, these revenues, when adjusted for inflation, have actually remained relatively flat. (Inflation index used: Boston-Cambridge-Newton, MA-NH, all urban consumers, not seasonally adjusted.) The Town works with its legislators and professional organizations like the Massachusetts Municipal Association to advocate for increases to key State Aid accounts. The bottom line is that State Aid has not kept pace with inflation even as the State has experienced a surge in tax revenues. This puts pressure on other revenue categories and the entire budget.

REVENUES: OTHER FINANCING SOURCES

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Other Financing Sources								
Ambulance Fund	$	2,710,200	3,164,290	2,947,500	3,474,000	3,215,000	(259,000)	-7.5%
Community Preservation Act (debt	$	488,720	443,460	268,250	176,550	462,416	285,866	161.9%
Enterprise Fund Reimbursements	$	859,362	725,209	952,965	1,043,944	1,075,262	31,318	3.0%
Overlay Surplus	$	-	-	-	-	-	0	--
Free Cash	$	4,425,901	4,518,349	7,744,809	269,704	-	(269,704)	--
Stabilization	$	13,109,345	-	-	-	-	0	--
Other Miscellaneous	$	175,000	275,000	430,440	75,000	450,000	375,000	500.0%
Subtotal Other Financing Sources	$	21,768,528	9,126,308	12,343,964	5,039,198	5,202,678	163,480	3.2%



REVENUES: OTHER FINANCING SOURCES

Other Financing Sources Overview:

These funds are transferred in from other sources.

The ambulance fund is a receipt reserved for appropriation fund and it collects all revenues related to the Town's ambulance services (such as insurance billings). Each year, the Town allocates an amount of funding to support operating expenses related to the ambulance fund which are contained within the general fund budget.

The Community Preservation Act (CPA) has the ability to recommend projects that will be paid for by way of borrowing. The annual debt service payment related to these projects comes from the CPA fund and is reflected in this section.

The Town provides an array of administrative services to the enterprise funds including payroll, purchasing, human resources, and technology support. The Town bills the enterprise funds an indirect charge to account for these services. The payment of the indirect charges by enterprise funds is reflected as a revenue in this section.

There are a few other sources such as using free cash, stabilization funds, or overlay surplus to support the budget.

Notable Trends:
The ambulance fund support for the operating budget is trending upward due to the restoration of one frozen firefighter/EMT position and the addition of one new position. The overall amount is going down because there is no ambulance replacement proposed for FY27 in alignment with the Town's ambulance replacement schedule.

Community Preservation Act debt is rising because of first year payments for the ARHS Track and Field and the Jones Library Special Collections project.

There is no Free Cash support proposed in this budget.

Other Miscellaneous is rising due to the use of prior year closed capital funds and Transportation Network Funds to support road improvements.

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General Fund Expenditure Summary & Detail

Overview

The following section provides a summary and additional details about the departmental expenditures within the General Fund budget.

GENERAL FUND EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
General Government	$	7,826,510	8,091,961	5,219,744	10,184,708	10,546,134	361,426	3.5%
Public Safety	$	11,215,161	11,585,581	12,102,398	12,634,492	13,212,289	577,797	4.6%
Public Works	$	2,442,881	2,542,144	2,819,031	2,768,078	2,985,930	217,852	7.9%
Conservation & Development	$	1,640,938	1,685,621	1,879,729	2,126,668	2,225,012	98,344	4.6%
Community Services	$	1,449,870	1,488,002	1,599,043	1,783,974	1,864,225	80,251	4.5%
Total Appropriation	$	24,575,359	25,393,310	23,619,944	29,497,920	30,833,590	1,335,670	4.5%

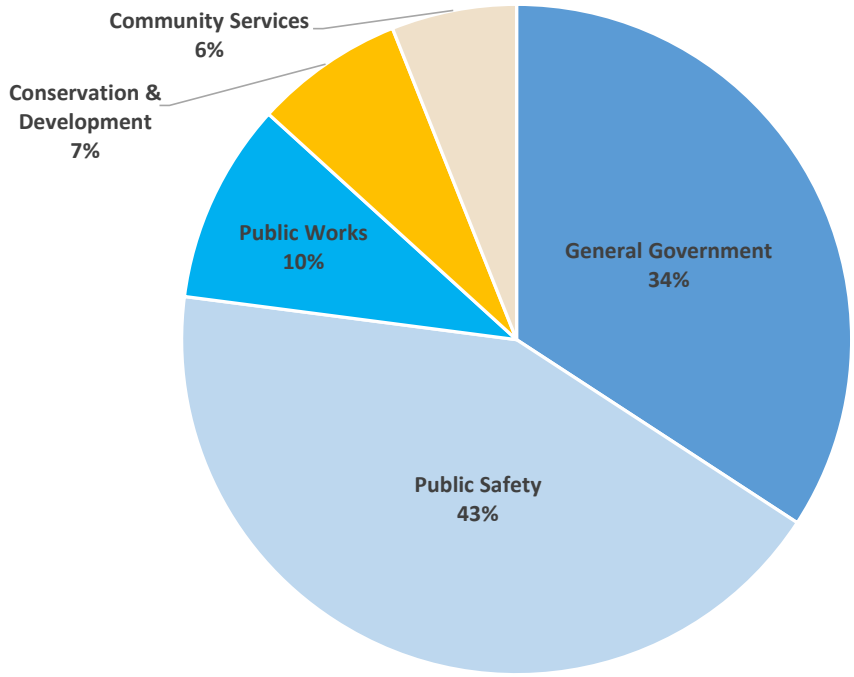
Significant Budget Changes:

The overall municipal operating budget is increasing by 4.5%. The largest increase is in Public Works where the Town is investing in higher wages and operating budgets. Public Safety is increasing by 4.6% in part due to the restoration of two firefighter/EMT positions, one position that had been frozen and the addition of one new position. Other increases are primarily driven by collective bargaining agreements or other wage increases where typically there is a 3% step and a 2% cost of living adjustment. In General Government, Health Insurance premiums are anticipated to rise 8.5% for FY27 but the impact on the budget is less due to enrollment patterns, plan design adjustments, and other budgetary offsets.

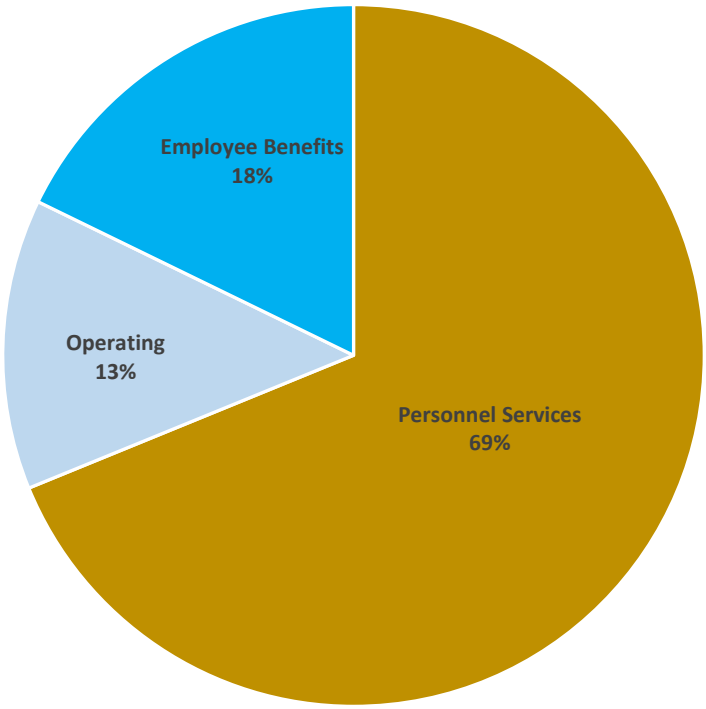
(Photo of Town Hall)

GENERAL FUND EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

FY27 Allocation of Budget by Function:



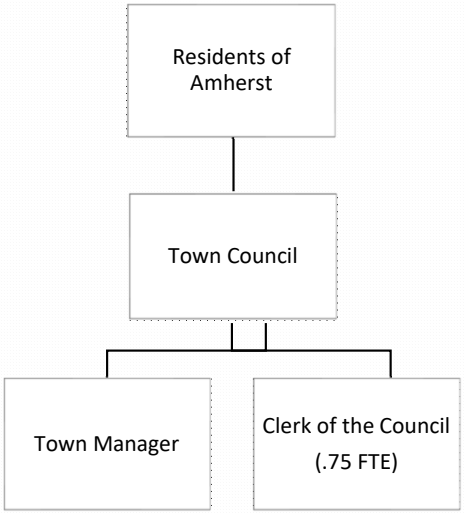
FY27 Allocation of Budget by Expenditure Type:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

Function: The Town Council serves as the legislative body of the Town. It provides policy leadership; approves the annual operating budget, capital improvement program, and financial orders; adopts and amends zoning and general bylaws; and appoints the Town Manager.

Organization:



(Photo of Town Council)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Adopted amendments to the Accessory Dwelling Unit (ADU) bylaw to ensure compliance with state law.
- Established a Transportation and Parking Commission to provide clarity and consistency for requests affecting public ways.
- Acted on the Charter Review Committee's charter amendment recommendations within the timeframe required by the Charter.
- Approved the FY26 Budget and Capital Improvement Program, with continued commitments to climate action, community health and safety, economic vitality, housing affordability, major capital investments, and racial equity and social justice.
- Completed the 2025 Town Manager evaluation and adopted 2026 Town Manager goals, implementing a new format aimed at improving the evaluation and goal-setting process.
- Adopted the 2025 Housing Production Plan.
- Adopted budget guidelines for FY27.
- Successfully onboarded the fourth Town Council session.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To improve avenues for receiving community feedback on actions under consideration.
- To continue monitoring and supporting progress toward achieving Amherst's Climate Action goals.
- To advance efforts to make Amherst an anti-racist community.
- To address ongoing budget challenges, particularly where expenditures are increasing faster than revenues.
- To review and implement a financing plan to advance construction of a new DPW facility and Fire/EMS facility.
- To support the priorities identified in the 5-year Capital Improvement Program.
- To adopt and revise zoning bylaws to implement the Master Plan and the 2025 Housing Production Plan.
- To address the backlog of road and sidewalk repairs and improve overall infrastructure conditions.
- To continue taking actions that support economic development.
- To review and consider recommendations from the Town Manager and multi-member bodies.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To review and revise general and zoning bylaws. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To adopt complementary strategies to policing that advance racial equity and social justice. **Ongoing**
- To review and adopt a FY26 comprehensive capital plan. **Accomplished**
- To develop guidelines for the FY27 budget and review & adopt the FY26 budget. **Accomplished**
- To evaluate the Town Manager for 2025 and continue to examine improvements to the annual evaluation process. **Accomplished**
- To complete changes and additions to the Refuse Collection and Recyclable Materials Bylaw, to include composting and a pay-as-you-throw fee structure. **Ongoing**
- To review and consider actions on recommendations from various Town committees, including the African Heritage Reparation Assembly, Community Safety and Social Justice Committee, and Solar Bylaw Working Group. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To work with legislators to advocate for funding and policy changes that benefit Amherst residents. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To act on Charter Review Committee recommendations. **Accomplished/Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To adopt complementary strategies to policing that advance racial equity and social justice.
- To review and adopt an FY27 Budget and Capital Improvement Program.
- To develop Budget Guidelines for FY28.
- To evaluate the Town Manager for 2026 and complete improvements to the annual evaluation process.
- To complete review of proposal to amend the Refuse Collection and Recyclable Materials Bylaw.
- To adopt a Clean Energy Bylaw prior to the effective date of the state regulations.
- To work with legislators to advocate for funding and policy changes that benefit Amherst residents.
- To act on Charter Review Committee recommendations.
- To begin the 2026 General Bylaw review as required by the Charter.
- To open the new Amethyst Brook Elementary School and Jones Library.
- To fund the first year of a multi-year road improvement plan.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

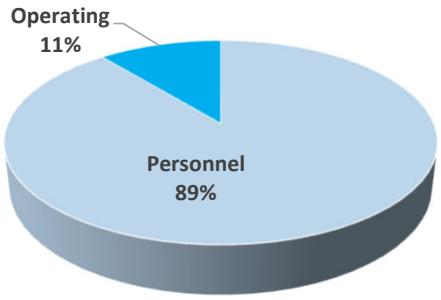
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	139,392	148,590	225,679	235,765	239,747	3,982	1.7%
Operating Expenses	$	14,155	10,369	12,885	33,500	29,500	(4,000)	-11.9%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	153,547	158,959	238,564	269,265	269,247	(18)	0.0%

Major Components:

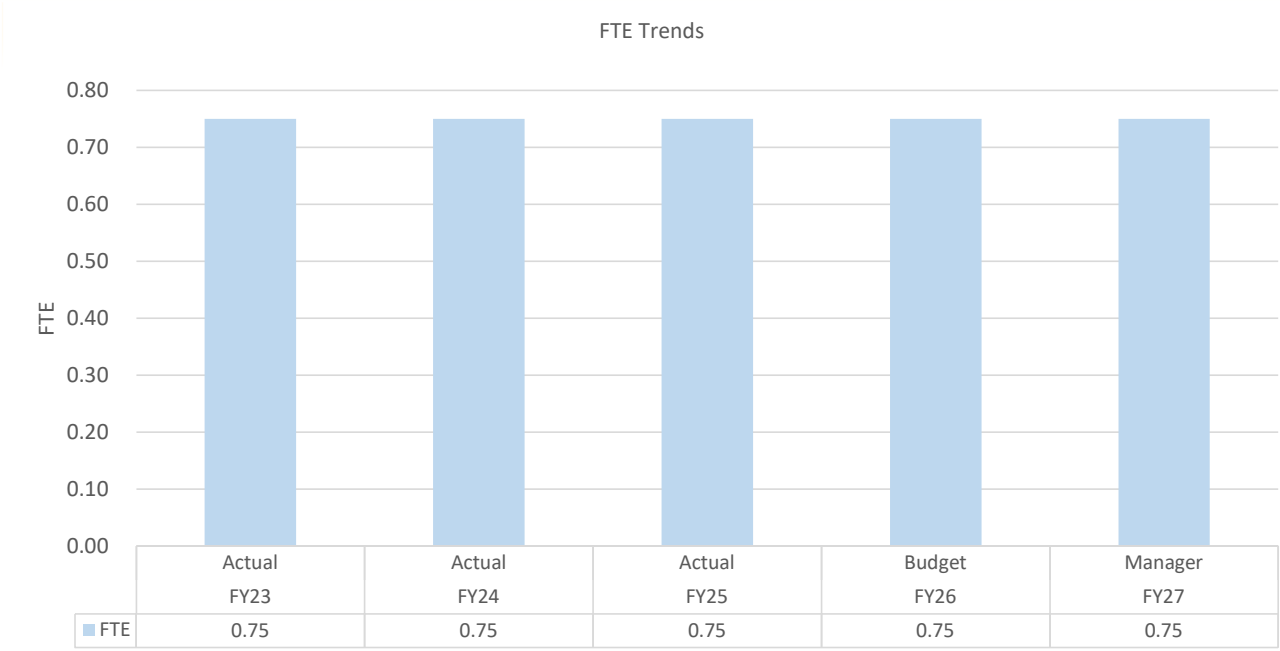
Personnel Services include stipends for the 13 member Council at $10,000 each and $12,000 for the Council President. It also includes stipends for the 5 member school committee at $3,000 each and $4,000 for the Chair. This section also includes 75% of the salary for the Clerk of the Council. Operating expenses include funds for training, travel, and other miscellaneous expenditures.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected salary steps/colas. Operating Expenses reduced to reflect historical spending patterns for printing and advertising.



Staffing Trends:

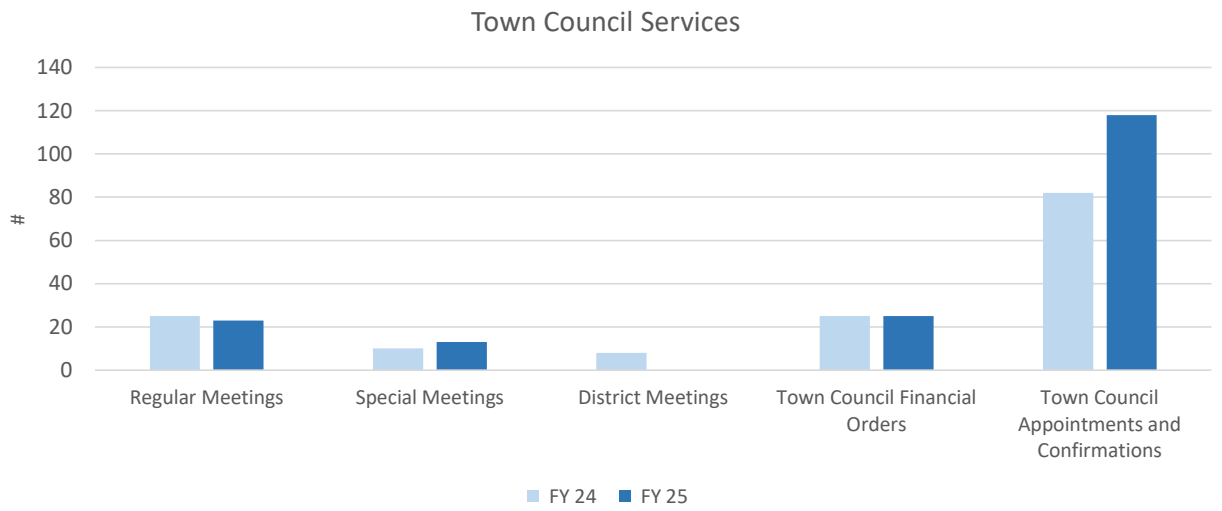


GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Regular Meetings	26	25	25	25	23
Special Meetings	44	24	16	10	13
District Meetings	11	9	10	8	10+
Town Council Financial Orders	37	40	24	25	25
Town Council Appointments and Confirmations	114	118	96	82	118
Long Term Use & Permanent	14	16	12	14	13
Changes to Public Ways					
Open Meeting of the Residents	0	0	0	0	0
Proclamations/Resolutions/Commemorations	28	25	21	26	25
Forums	11	8	5	9	8
Finance Committee Meetings	41	25	25	26	29
Community Resource Committee Meetings	35	27	25	24	23
Town Service and Outreach Committee Meetings	25	24	20	22	21
Governance, Organization & Legislation					
Committee Meetings	29	25	20	20	19
Free Petitions	0	0	0	0	0
Initiative Measures	0	0	0	0	0
Voter Veto	0	0	0	0	0
Zoning Bylaw Amendments	4	9	0	1	1
General Bylaw Amendments	7	3	5	2	2

Notable Trends:

None.

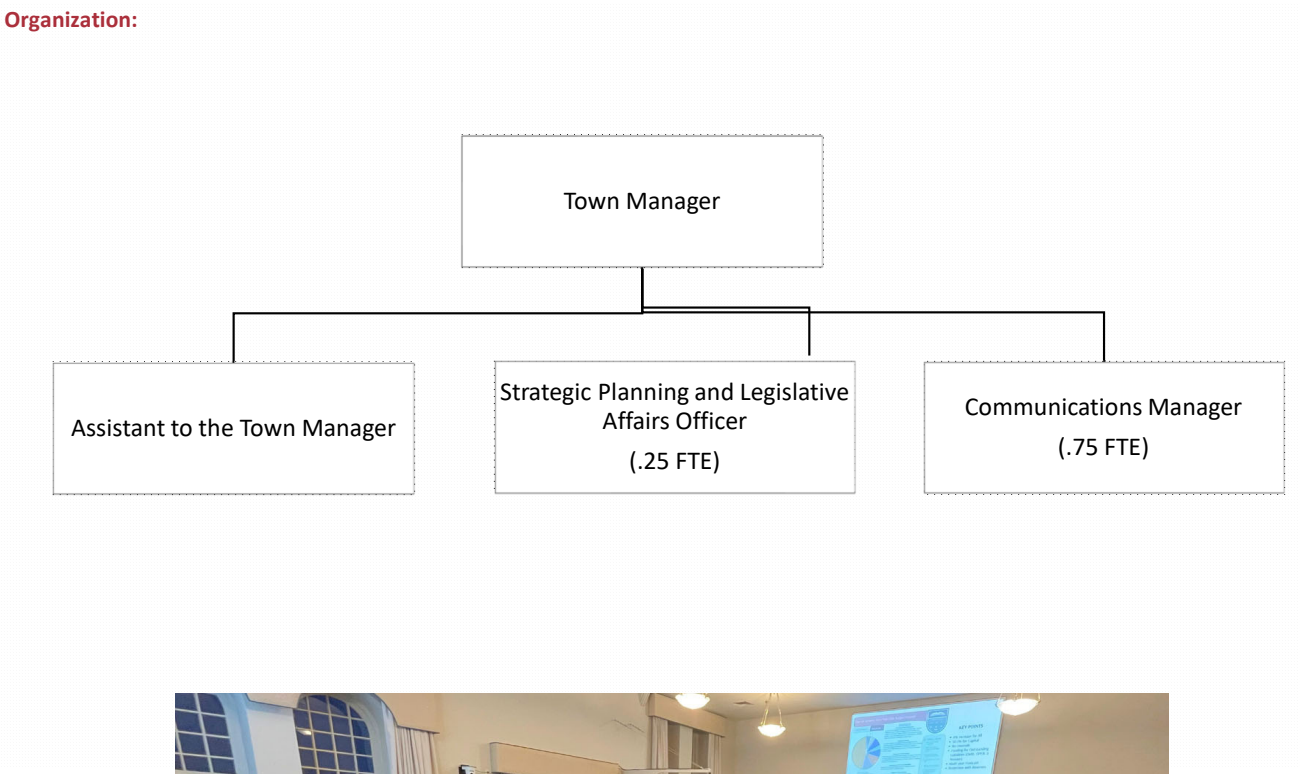


For more information, visit the Town Council's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3435/Town-Council

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

Function: The Town Manager serves as the chief executive officer of the Town and is responsible to the Town Council for the proper operation of Town affairs for which the Town Manager is given responsibility under the Amherst Home Rule Charter. The Town Manager heads the executive branch and is responsible for the administration of all Town fiscal, prudential, and municipal affairs.

Organization:



(Town Manager Paul Bockelman presenting during our first Civic Academy)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Bid awarded, contract executed, permits granted, ceremonial groundbreaking held, and construction underway for Jones Library Renovation Project.
- Continued construction progress and oversight of Amethyst Brook Elementary School, projected opening Fall 2026.
- Construction completed, including roadway, walkway, crosswalk, and ADA improvements at Historic North Common; ribbon cutting ceremony Fall 2025.
- Construction completed at Centennial Water Treatment Facility; ribbon cutting ceremony Fall 2026.
- Construction completed for Wastewater Treatment Facility Gravity Belt Thickener.
- Road repaving at downtown intersection and numerous thoroughfares.
- Recruited and appointed new department heads including Communications Manager Samantha Giffen, Finance Director Sean Mangano, Fire Chief Lindsay Stromgren, Town Clerk Amber Martin, and Director of Senior Services Lisa Borchetta.
- Renovation of track and fields at Amherst Regional High School.
- Creation of new committees: Department of Public Works Building Committee, Cherry Hill Working Group, Amherst Black Reparations Committee, and Cable Television Advisory Committee.
- Adopted the Zero Emissions Vehicle First Fleet Policy and the Municipal Decarbonization Roadmap for municipal buildings.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To develop a long range strategy to ensure the fiscal stability of the Town, schools, and library within the constraints of existing and projected resources.
- To continue progress in building the four major Capital Investment Projects (new public works building, new fire station, new elementary school, and renovated and expanded library).
- To maintain a commitment to address the Town's infrastructure needs including roads, sidewalks, buildings, water, and sewer.
- To use a lens of Climate Action to prioritize and begin to implement regulatory, fiscal, and other actions to meet energy, sustainability, and resilience goals.
- To address systemic racism in Town government and in the delivery of public safety and other services.
- To undertake targeted management restructuring to improve communication, increase cohesion across departments, and align leadership structures with organizational goals.
- To recruit and retain strong department leaders and support the work of all staff.
- To work with the Commonwealth and local higher education institutions to increase revenue through economic

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To achieve the goals established by the Town Council. **Ongoing**
- To oversee the building of the new Amethyst Brook Elementary School Building. **Ongoing**
- To break ground on the renovation and expansion of the Jones Library Building. **Accomplished**
- To finalize a new location for the new Fire Station. **Ongoing**
- To begin schematic design and finalize a funding plan for a new DPW facility. **Ongoing**
- To extend outreach efforts to include a civic academy, Town Hall road show, and other initiatives. **Accomplished**
- To begin the license renewal process with Comcast. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To achieve the goals established by the Town Council.
- To oversee the building of the new Amethyst Brook Elementary School and Jones Library renovation and addition.
- To finalize a location for the new Fire Station.
- To begin schematic design and finalize a funding plan for a new DPW facility.
- To complete the license renewal process with Comcast for cable television services for Town residents.
- To lead the Town's planning and development work for the Hampshire College campus**.**

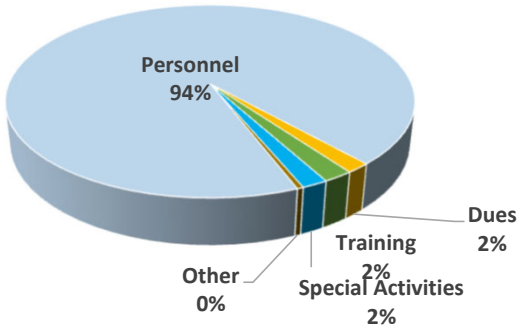
GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	358,106	371,578	388,224	408,255	431,472	23,217	5.7%
Operating Expenses	$	33,907	16,269	15,159	30,140	26,650	(3,490)	-11.6%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	392,013	387,847	403,383	438,395	458,122	19,727	4.5%

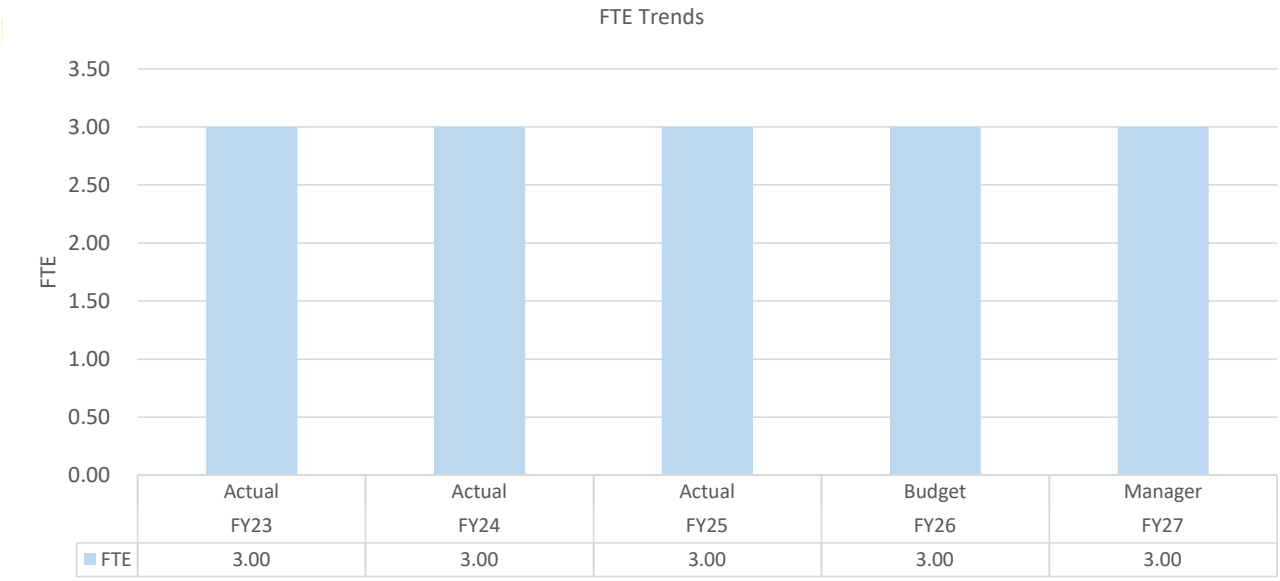
Major Components: Personnel Services includes salaries for the Town Manager, Assistant to the Town Manager, Strategic Planning and Legislative Affairs Officer who is shared with the Town Council Department, and the Communications Manager who is shared with the Information Technology Department. Dues include the Town's membership in the Massachusetts Municipal Association which includes the Massachusetts Municipal Councilors Association, and the Town's membership in the Massachusetts Municipal Management Association, International City Management Association, Massachusetts Government Finance Officers Association, and Small Town Administrators of Massachusetts.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected salary steps/colas and longevity payments. Operating Expenses reduced to reflect historical spending patterns on Special Activities.



Staffing Trends:

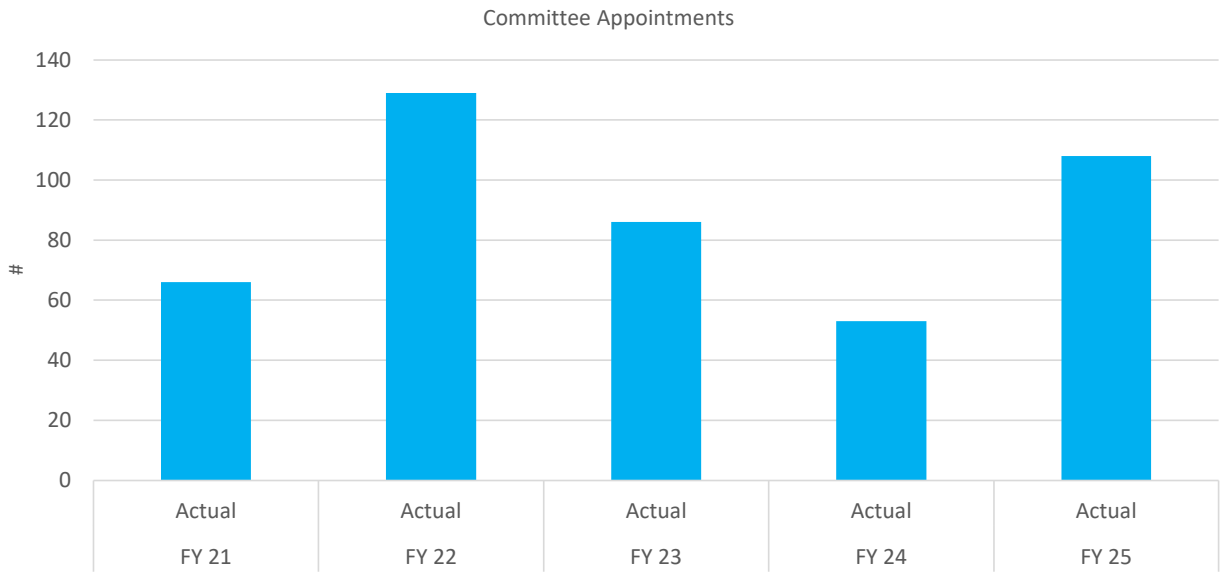


GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Collective Bargaining Agreements/Amendments	6	6	6	6	6
Committee Appointments	66	129	86	53	108
Committees Staffed	9	6	6	6	6
Rental License Agreements	7	7	7	7	6
Town Way Reservations	15	39	25	54	38
Sweetser Park	15	9	3	3	2
Kendrick Park	9	7	3	3	7
Cuppa Joe with Paul	N/A	8	8	4	11
Staff District Meetings	11	9	10	8	8
Community Events	N/A	15	38	28	32
Town Manager Reports	24	22	11	10	12
Community Activity Forms Received	84	183	90	61	73

Notable Trends:

Increased community engagement has been achieved through monthly "Cuppa Joe with Paul" events and expanded information tables at Town events, a direct result of the meaningful work of Communications Manager Samantha Giffen. Rejuvenation projects at the North Common and the High School Track facility created opportunities for the community to come together and celebrate positive changes through ribbon-cutting and groundbreaking ceremonies. Community Participation Officers continue to collaborate with the Schools, the DEI Department, the Recreation Department, the Amherst BID, the Chamber of Commerce, and Town Councilors to engage residents and visitors in cultural, heritage, and school-related gatherings. These community events reflect the values of the Core Equity initiatives within the municipal workplace. Inter-departmental work promoting inclusivity and teamwork across departments will remain a central focus for the Town Manager's Office staff.



For more information, visit the Town Manager's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/77/Town-Manager

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

Function: To assure the continuous, reliable delivery of Town services through effective management of financial resources and courteous, comprehensive service to the public and internal departments. Each department furthers this mission:

Finance: through the development and coordination of policies and processes that identify, evaluate, develop, and facilitate the efficient allocation of resources.

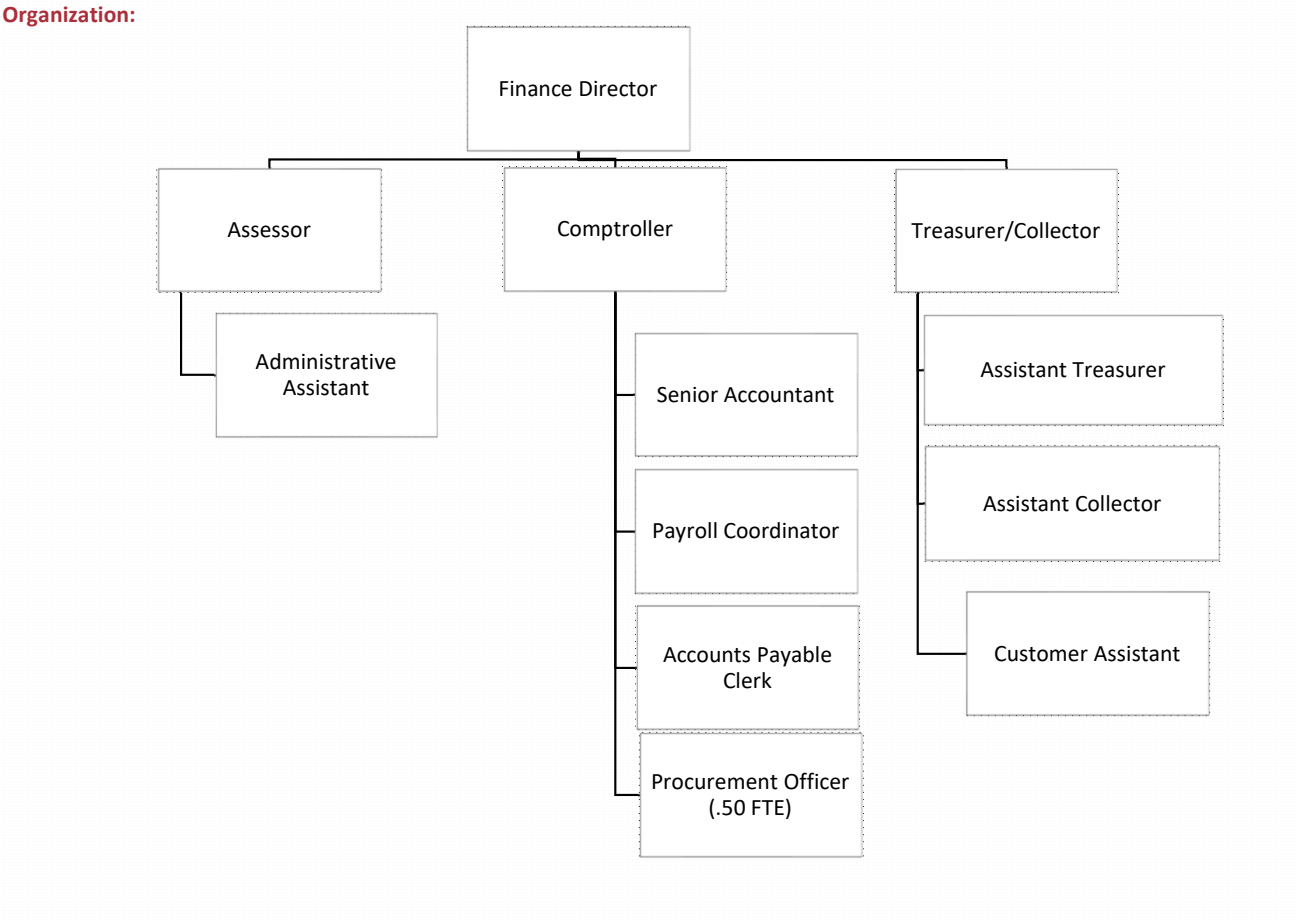
Accounting: through maintenance of appropriate records and financial reports and through monitoring of all financial activity for accountability and legal compliance, including procurement, centralized purchasing, managing general services, property and liability insurance management, and payroll and benefits.

Assessing: through the fair and equitable distribution of property taxes and motor vehicle excise taxes via an open process that makes information available to residents and professionals in a timely and efficient manner.

Collection: through timely, accurate billing and collection of revenue and a central point of services across traditional departmental functions.

Treasury: through effective investment and management of Town funds and the effective use of debt financing where appropriate.

Organization:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Certified Free Cash and set the tax rate.
- Distributed property tax information newsletter to all households.
- Hired and successfully onboarded new Comptroller and Finance Director.
- Completed the FY24 audit successfully with no findings.
- Completed bond rating call and maintained strong bond rating of AA+.
- Increased investment income greatly by taking advantage of high interest rates and unencumbered capital funds.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to refine the budget cycle and process.
- To develop staff members to include cross training and organizational efficiency.
- To plan and manage the four building projects (procurements, financings, budgeting).
- To support advocacy that generates more revenue in Town.
- To maximize return on investment of Town funds.
- To manage debt and accelerate payments to reduce debt in anticipation of future borrowings.
- To continuously improve the Town-wide procurement system.
- To support advocacy for legislation focused on obtaining fair financial or in-kind support from tax exempt entities.
- To establish fair values for all non-taxable properties.
- To maintain adequate staffing, and to cross-train and retain employees.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To support successful staff transitions and professional development. **Accomplished**/**Ongoing**
- To refine the plan for financing four building projects. **Ongoing**
- To connect the new permit system to real estate appraisal system. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To support successful staff transitions and professional development.
- To refine the plan for financing four building projects.
- To connect the new permit system to real estate appraisal system.
- To manage the financial activity of the Jones Library Renovation and Addition project and the Amethyst Brook Elementary School new construction.
- To make improvements to the budget process and budget document based on feedback from the Charter Review Commission and Town Council.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

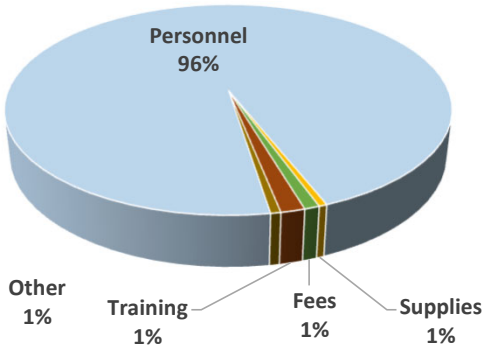
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	981,899	937,623	1,004,654	1,070,371	1,100,705	30,334	2.8%
Operating Expenses	$	51,062	35,478	27,935	40,303	40,303	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	1,032,962	973,101	1,032,588	1,110,674	1,141,008	30,334	2.7%

Major Components:

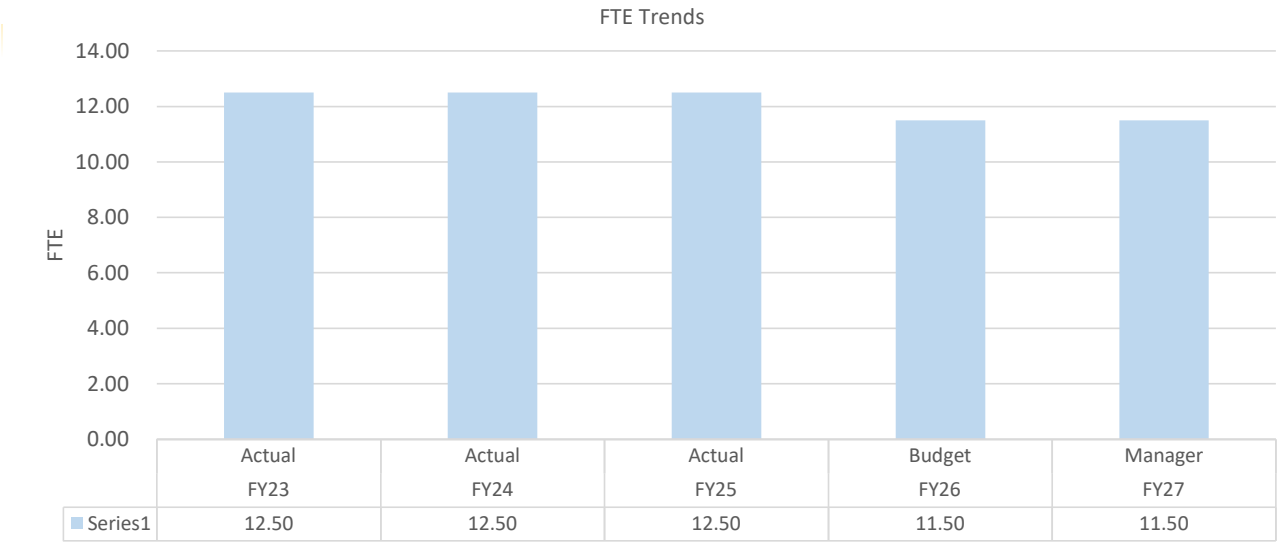
Personnel Services include salaries for a Finance Director, Comptroller, Principal Assessor, Collector/Treasurer, 7 full time Financial positions, and a Procurement Officer shared with the Water, Sewer, and Transportation Funds. Operating expenses include banking fees, dues and subscriptions, bonds, and Registry fees. Also included in operating expenses are printing supplies and other specialized assessing, billing, collection, and accounting forms. Other expenses include costs for training.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected step/colas.



Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Grants Maintained/Monitored	58	59	52	48	43
EFTs processed	959	1,087	1,162	1,437	2,460
Contracts Processed/Maintained/Monitored	93	96	82	95	103
Bids and Proposals Reviewed/Monitored	40	49	58	64	70
Real Estate Property Assessments	7,345	7,341	7,323	7,307	7,291
Site Reviews	97	110	500	1,000	800
Personal Property Assessments	188	177	198	189	207
Abatement Application Reviews					
Real Estate/Personal Property	50	31	48	64	86
Motor Vehicle Excise	2,344	1,464	442	573	322
Appeals Granted Real/PP	38	21	29	33	44
Tax Dollars Abated	$ 127,316	$ 36,176	$ 74,504	$ 63,343	$ 70,291
Tax Abated as % of Levy	0.22%	0.06%	0.12%	0.09%	0.10%
Tax Exemptions	$ 118,319	$ 115,318	$ 104,091	$ 117,804	$ 123,709
Exemptions as % of Levy	0.21%	0.19%	0.17%	0.18%	0.18%
Motor Vehicle Excise Collection Rate	89%	93%	93%	94%	93%
Real Estate/Personal Property					
Tax Collection Rate	98%	99%	99%	99%	99%
Water/Sewer Collection Rate	99%	96%	99%	98%	99%
Parking Tickets Collection Rate	80%	80%	72%	70%	70%
Ambulance Bills Collection Rate (One Yr)	64%	71%	71%	70%	69%
Parking Ticket Appeals/Hearings	646	688	497	426	407
Parking Permits Issued	543	648	573	570	512
Tax Liens Processed and Recorded	27	46	14	30	1
Central Service Counter Transactions	13,819	13,761	14,195	16,302	17,033
Online Transactions	21,210	19,955	20,114	21,897	22,302
Tax Liens Redeemed	13	34	26	15	17
Bond Rating (Standard & Poor's)	AA+	AA+	AA+	AA+	AA+

Notable Trends:

The Town continues to shift the way it pays vendors from paper checks to Electronic Fund Transfers (EFTs) which are a more timely and secure way of paying bills.

The Assessor is doing more site reviews as the department updates property assessments.

Overall collection rates remain high however Parking Ticket rates have dropped.

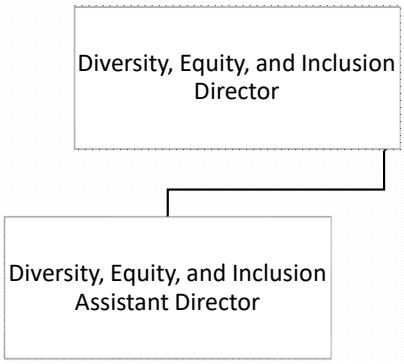
The combination of online transactions and counter transactions have increased 12% over the past five years.

For more information, visit the Finance department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/92/Finance

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Function: To support the Town in its goal of embracing diversity and creating an equitable and inclusive environment to live and work. The office supports the work of three standing committees: the Amherst Black Reparations Committee, the Commission for People with Disabilities, and the Human Rights Commission.

Organization:



(Photo of community events)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Finalized the report and provided a recommendation to establish the Resident Oversight Board.
- Expanded youth empowerment programming.
- Developed a strategic plan to ensure Town committees and boards reflect the community.
- Continued participation in Massachusetts DEI Coalition.
- Established three new community events; Amherst Global Village, the Pride Parade, and a Celebration of Disability Awareness Month.
- Established a monthly newsletter for staff and the community.
- Established a quarterly meeting for DEI practitioners in the Amherst.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To finalize the report and provide a recommendation to establish the Resident Oversight Board.
- To expand youth empowerment programming.
- To promote equity, and inclusion values and incorporate them throughout Town government.
- To work with the Human Resources Department to attract and retain a workforce reflective of the community.
- To develop a strategic plan to ensure Town committees and boards reflect of the community.
- To continue participation in Massachusetts DEI Coalition.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To expand youth events, including a Youth entrepreneurship program and a Youth 'know our rights' program. **Accomplished**
- To provide DEI workshops to Town boards, committees and commissions. **Accomplished**
- To establish a closer working relationship with nonprofits, cultural organizations, and business organizations. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To create Friends' Group for the DEI. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To establish and work with the Law Enforcement Resident Oversight Board. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To establish an annual Amherst Global Village Festival. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To expand youth events, including a youth entrepreneurship program.
- To provide DEI workshops to Town boards, committees and commissions.
- To establish a closer working relationship with nonprofits, cultural organizations, and business organizations.
- To work with the Amherst Black Reparations Committee.
- To continue the annual Amherst Global Village Festival.
- To create a digital Cultural Center.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	157,103	182,945	176,767	192,841	202,600	9,759	5.1%
Operating Expenses	$	4,554	12,608	5,095	13,500	13,500	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	161,656	195,552	181,862	206,341	216,100	9,759	4.7%

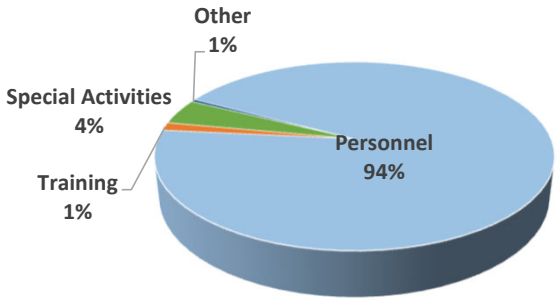
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Director and Assistant Director.

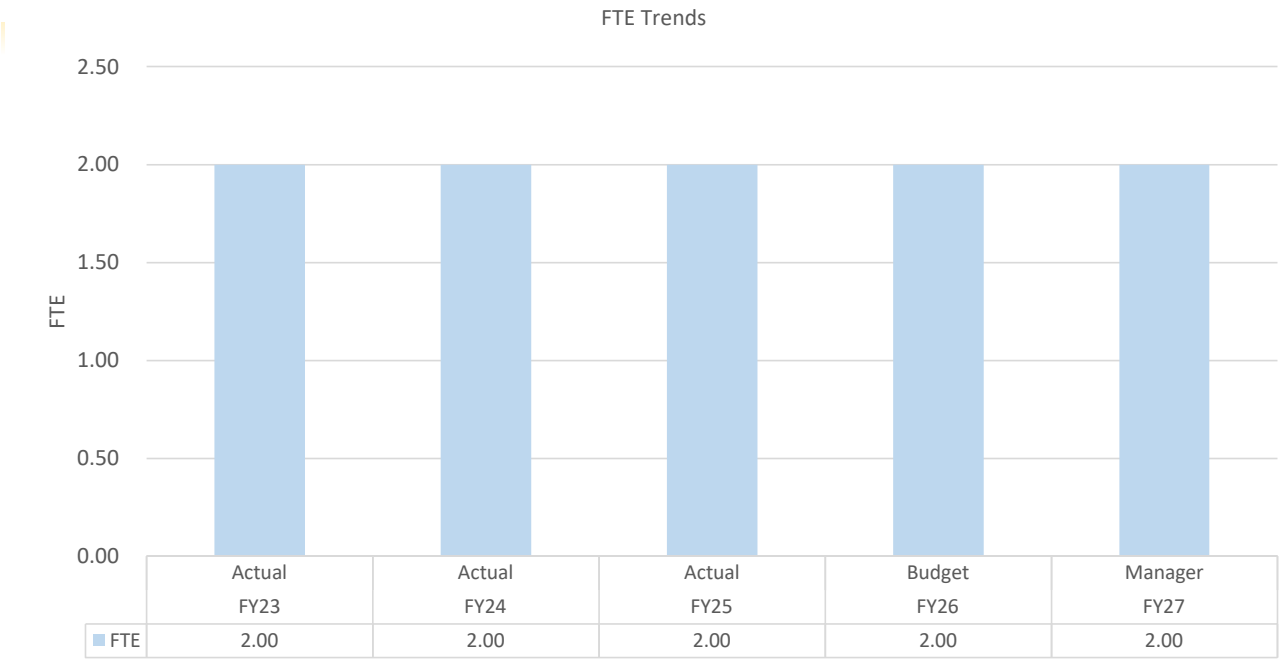
Operating Expenses include: Departmental training, professional development events, special activities for department events and initiatives. Other expenses include funds for office supplies and dues & subscriptions.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected steps/colas.



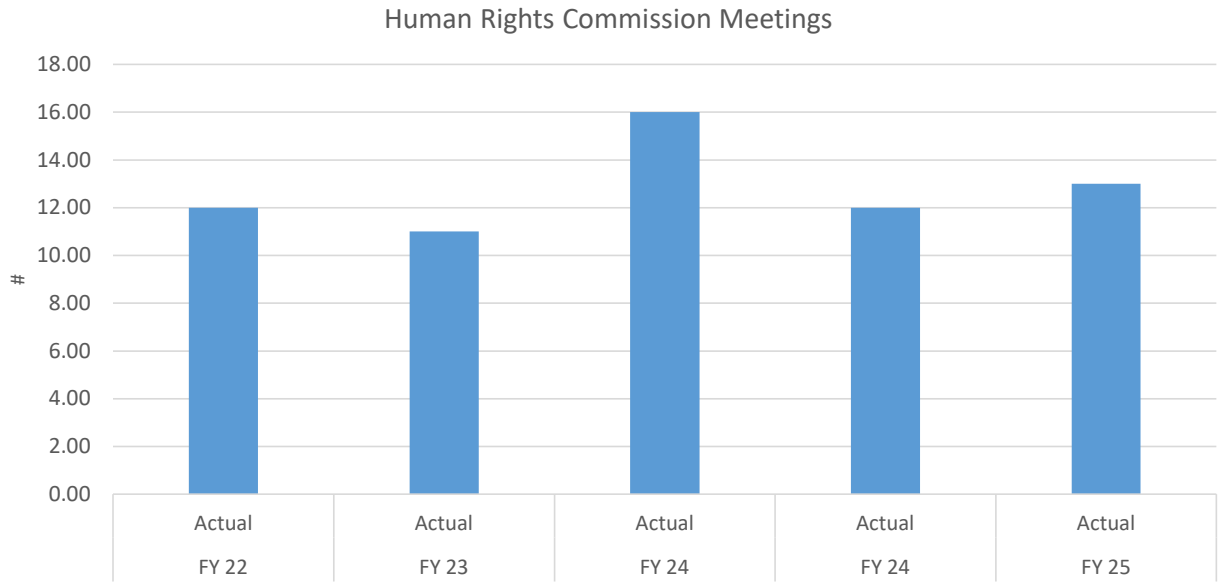
Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Service Levels:	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Human Rights Commission Meetings	12	11	16	12	13
Human Rights Commission Events	-	10	16	3	3
Other Committee/Board Meetings	0	36	70	38	29
Human Rights Complaints	2	6	4	6	8
Staff Development/Training Sessions	0	4	10	12	10
DEI Community Events	0	4	4	4	16

Notable Trends:
The number of events hosted by the department have increased since its formation.

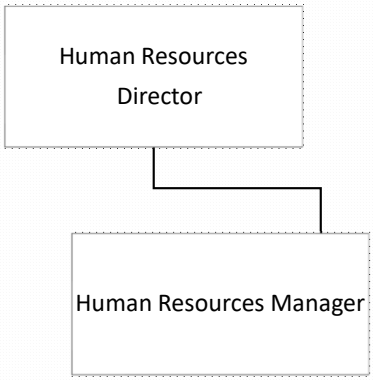


For more information, visit the Diversity, Equity and Inclusion webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3588/Diversity-Equity-Inclusion

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Function: To assist Town management to fairly, consistently, and lawfully create and administer policies and practices that attract, develop, and retain a motivated, diverse, and high-performing workforce.

Organization:



(Photo of HR Director Melissa Loiodice-Walker, right, and HR Manager Serena Harris, left)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Implemented written search procedures in multiple Town departments.
- Settled four collective bargaining agreements.
- Drafted and implemented a simple off-boarding procedure.
- Implemented the recently-revised Personnel Procedures Manual.
- Instituted annual management training schedule.
- Arranged for and participated in a comprehensive assessment of Recreation Department personnel and structure.
- Developed and began implementation of a new elecronic applicant tracking system.
- Piloted a remote-work policy.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To implement additional Employee Self-Service features.
- To transition to a new Applicant Tracking System platform.
- To draft an informational guide to assist managers in their roles.
- To achieve/maintain a strong and capable Town workforce through increased retention, recruiting, and staff training.
- To incorporate anti-racist practices into the recruitment, hiring, and onboarding process.
- To further expand the pool of diverse qualified candidates, to represent a broad range of races, cultures, and backgrounds, for Town positions.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To finalize and implement Search and Hiring Procedures. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To negotiate and settle five collective bargaining agreements. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To implement the recently-revised Personnel Procedures Manual. **Accomplished**
- To develop more comprehensive off-boarding procedures in collaboration with IT. **Accomplished**
- To vet and implement the Remote Work Policy. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To work with the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion office to expand the pool of diverse qualified candidates, to represent a broad range of races, cultures, and backgrounds, for Town positions. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To implement electronic employee onboarding processes. **Ongoing**
- To complete the implementation of a new electronic applicant tracking system. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To finalize and implement Search and Hiring Procedures for all appropriate departments.
- To negotiate any remaining collective bargaining agreements and prepare for the next round of negotiations.
- To vet and implement the Remote Work Policy Town-wide.
- To implement electronic employee onboarding processes.
- To complete the implementation of a new electronic applicant tracking system.
- To work with the Finance and IT Departments to implement improvements to the payroll process.
- To expand employee wellness program to include further fitness components.
- To review and research Third Party Administrators (TPAs) for Workers Compensation.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	232,504	237,605	287,015	285,756	297,905	12,149	4.3%
Operating Expenses	$	31,111	57,134	39,102	60,830	60,830	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-				-	--
Total Appropriation	$	263,615	294,739	326,117	346,586	358,735	12,149	3.5%

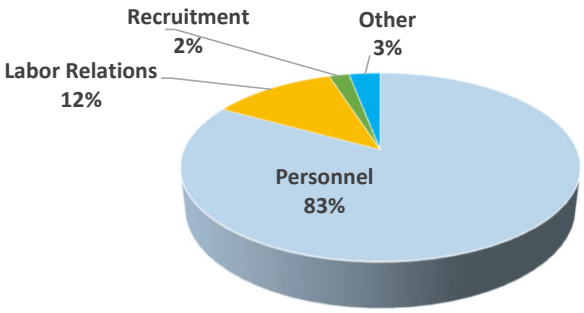
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for a Human Resources Director, Human Resources Manager, and wages for extra help.

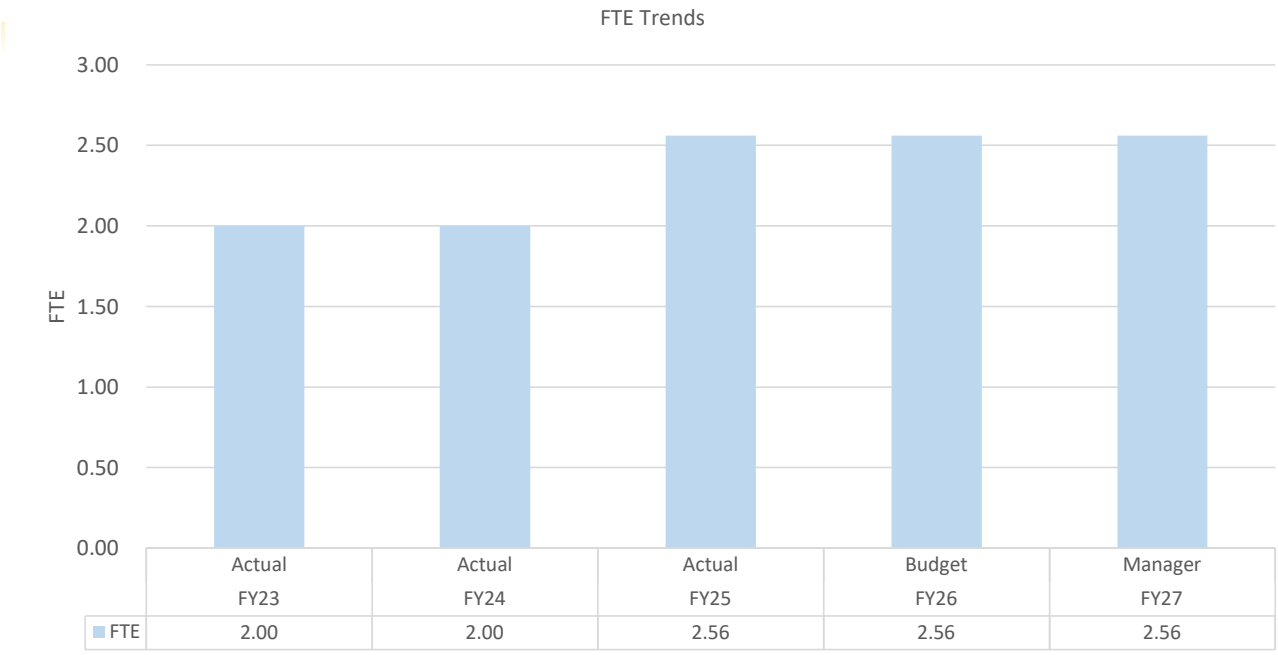
Operating Expenses include: Recruitment that provides the funding for newspaper and web advertisements, career fair registrations, exams, and background checks as needed. Labor Relations provide the funding for contract negotiations. Other expenses include funds for training, conferences, and dues & subscriptions.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected steps/colas.



Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Recruitments and Fully Benefitted Hires	16	37	35	32	32
Personnel Board/Insurance Advisory Comm.	5	6	5	7	8
Collective Bargaining Meetings	19	49	15	9	11
Grievances Resolved	0	0	2	2	3
Staff Development/Training Sessions	5	6	6	8	16

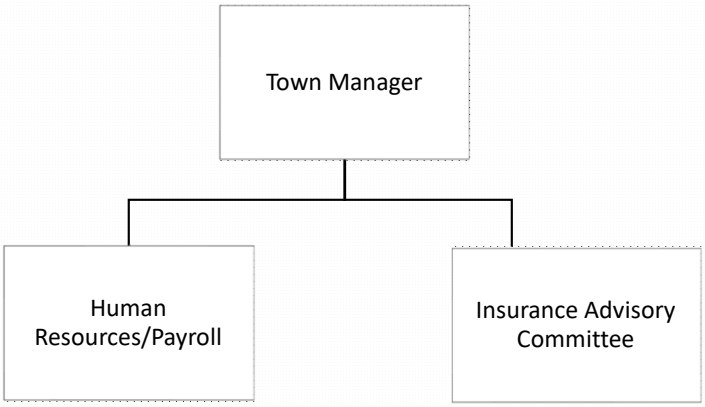
Notable Trends:
Collective Bargaining Meetings fluctuate based upon the number of contracts being negotiated.

For more information, visit the Human Resources webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/648/Human-Resources-Human-Rights

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Function: To administer and manage the full range of benefits provided to current and retired employees of the Town. To provide counsel to employees and retirees, and provide a forum for group discussion and analysis of the variable costs, options, and implications of benefit plan design. To provide quality benefits while seeking ways to reduce or control the cost of those benefits through education, safety awareness, and proactive claims administration.

Organization:



(Photo of Healthy Snacks program delivery)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Continued to provide numerous wellness activities for staff.
- Worked with the employee Insurance Advisory Committee and the Town's health insurance provider (MIIA) to implement modifications to the way employees enroll in optional benefits.
- Verified competitiveness of current health insurance plan by comparing it to the Group Insurance Commission.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To enhance employee communication and education materials and marketing on health insurance and other available benefits.
- To continue to review and monitor the workers compensation and Police/Fire Injured on Duty claims administration policies and practices.
- To review all voluntary benefit plans and vendors.
- To continue to explore tiered health plans and alternative insurance packages in order to lower insurance costs for employees and for the Town.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To review the Worker's Comp and Injured on Duty coverages. **Ongoing**
- To enhance the annual health fair with vendor participation and exhibits to increase employee attendance and experience. **Accomplished / Ongoing**
- To explore tiered health plans and alternative insurance packages in order to lower insurance costs for employees and for the Town. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To implement a new online self-service system for optional benefits for employees.
- To transition life insurance accounts and voluntary benefit accounts to new provider.
- To review the Worker's Compensation and Injured on Duty coverages.
- To enhance the annual health fair with vendor participation and exhibits to increase employee attendance and experience.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	3,722,212	3,925,908	710,831	5,286,429	5,484,428	197,999	3.7%
Operating Capital	$	-	-				-	--
Total Appropriation	$	3,722,212	3,925,908	710,831	5,286,429	5,484,428	197,999	3.7%

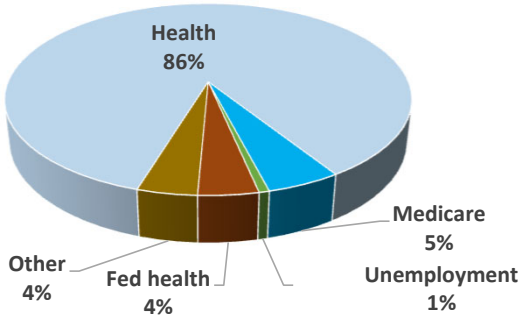
Major Components:

Health insurance is $4,730,740. Medicare is $273,833. Unemployment insurance is $37,770. Federal Health Insurance is $221,073.

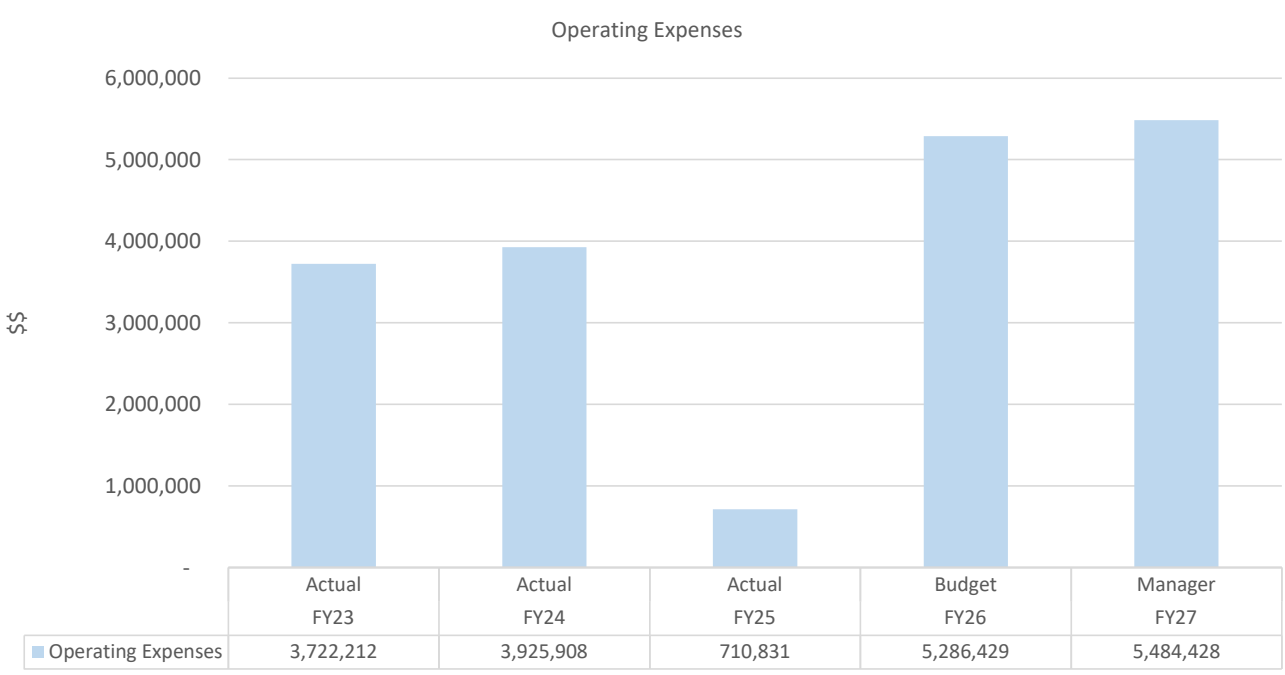
Other includes salary reserve, worker's compensation, life insurance, flexible benefits, and police/fire injured-on-duty funding.

Significant Changes:

The increase for employee health insurance for FY27 is included in this budget line.



Expenditure Trends:

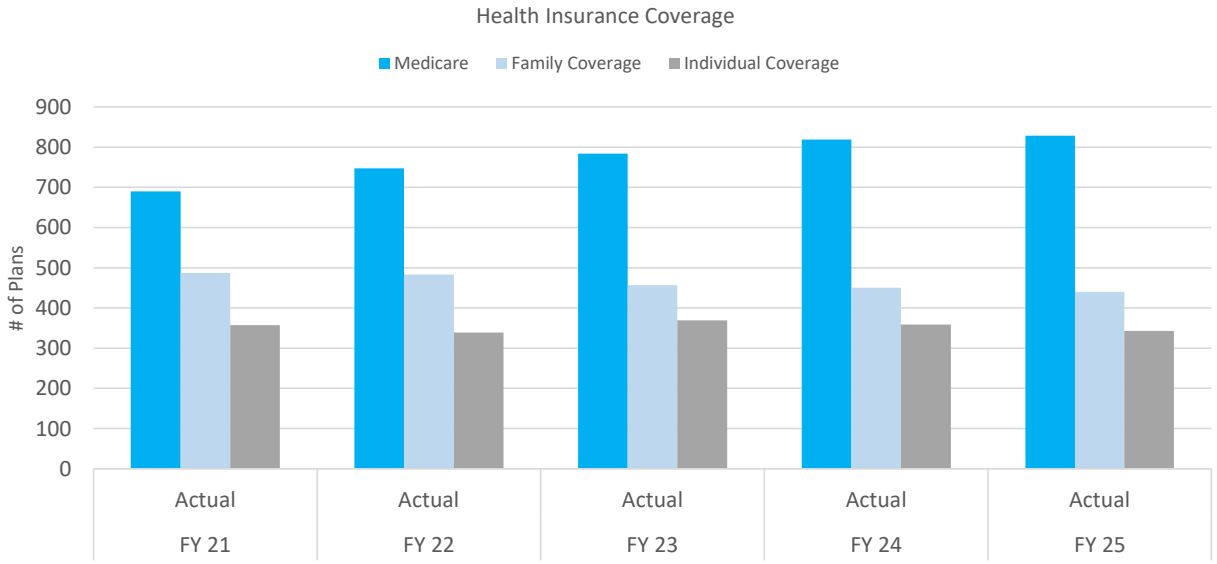


GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Health Insurance					
Family Coverage	487	483	457	450	440
Individual Coverage	357	339	369	359	343
Medicare	690	747	784	819	828
Life Insurance	1,173	1,260	1,254	1,263	1,263
Unemployment Claims	225	32	39	31	17
Works Comp/Public Safety IOD Claims Medical Only	23	16	70	23	14
Works Comp/Public Safety IOD Claims Lost Time	9	9	11	10	11

Notable Trends:

The number of employees enrolled in HMO and PPO plans is decreasing while Medicare plans are increasing due to new retirees.

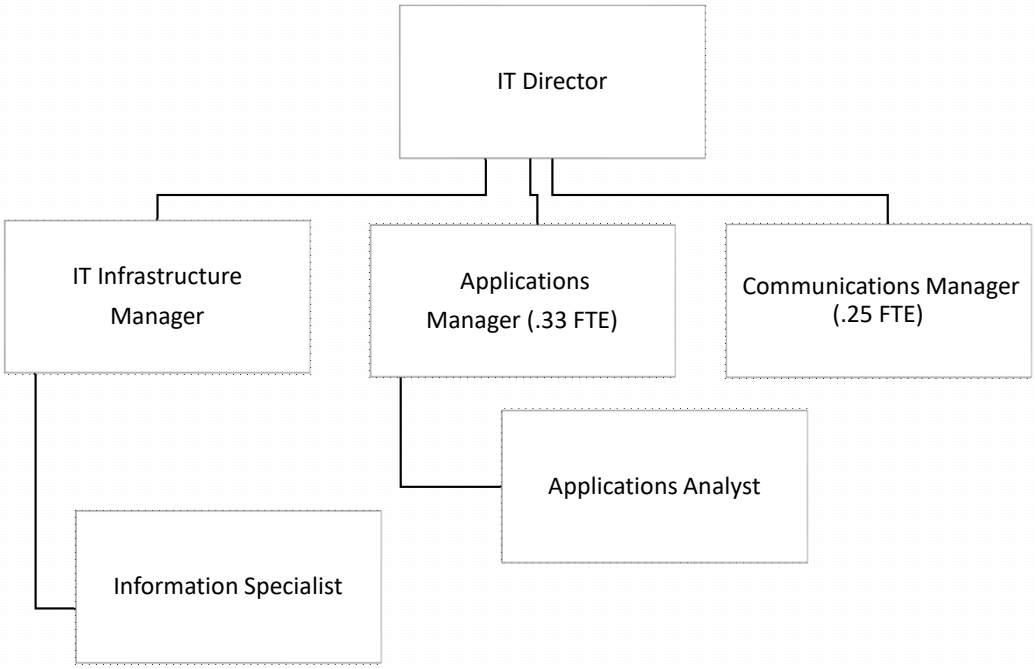


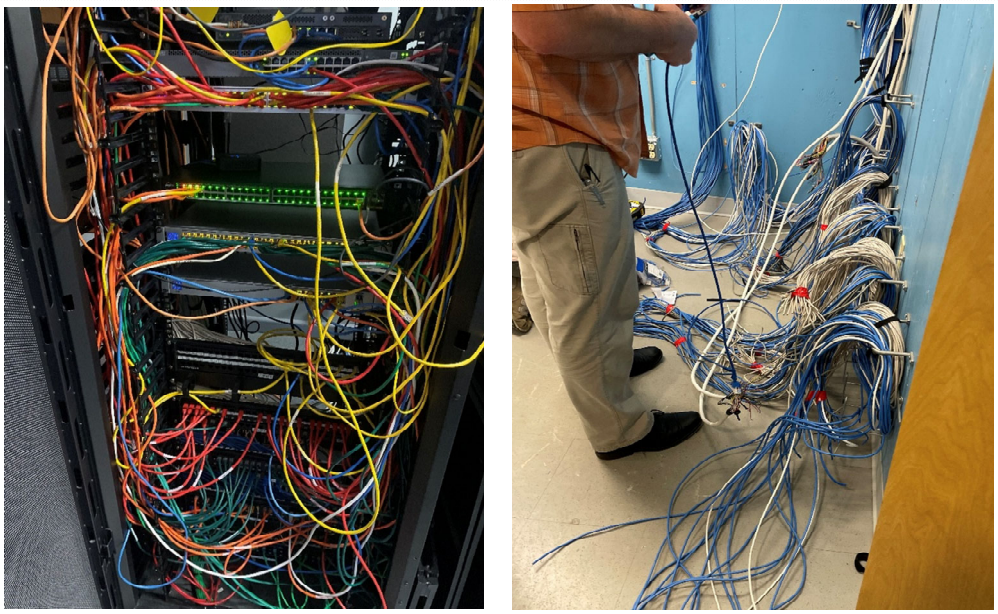
For more information, visit the Employee Benefits webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3526/Employee-Benefits

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

Function: To select, implement, and maintain technology systems to best enhance services delivered by Town departments.

Organization:





(Left - Network wiring for Police Department. Right - IT staff settiing up wiring for Jones Library Temportary Location)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Collaborated with the University of Massachusetts Amherst to connect the temporary Jones Library and Amherst Media office on University Drive to the Town's network with fiber optic cable.
- Established a fiber optic link to the University of Massachusetts Amherst for public safety radios.
- Awarded the bid to improve Town fiber resiliency and connected the Wastewater Treatment facility to Town fiber, both using grant funding.
- Connected the Centennial Water Treatment facility to the Town's fiber.
- Established an Emergency Operations Center (EOC) in Town Hall.
- Added Planning, Town Clerk, and Assessors departments to OpenGov for online applications.
- Implemented new Police Department scheduling software.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To provide technology training to Town staff to better utilize the Town's systems.
- To maintain and improve the Town's cyber security policies and technologies.
- To provide all users with training for cyber security, Munis financial accounting system, Microsoft Teams and Office, and other key applications.
- To provide technology support for public meetings.
- To select and implement a legislative management system.
- To support management of existing software and implementation of new software.
- To manage 24/7/365 IT support with increasing cybersecurity threats and technology events.
- To support IT infrastructure and technology needs for new and temporary facilities.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue to make cybersecurity improvements. **Ongoing**
- To replace four servers. **Ongoing**
- To install equipment and software for backup infrastructure replacement. **Ongoing**
- To connect fiber and install outdoor WiFi at Recreation sites (Mill River pool, Groff park, War Memorial pool). **Accomplished**
- To implement new applicant tracking system for Human Resources Department. **Ongoing**
- To begin the upgrade to the Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) software for Dispatch. **Ongoing**
- To integrate time keeping systems with MUNIS. (Police, Fire, Recreation, Schools) **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue to make cybersecurity improvements.
- To replace four computer servers.
- To install equipment and software for backup infrastructure replacement.
- To support the implementation of a new applicant tracking system for Human Resources Department.
- To begin the upgrade to the Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) software for the Emergency Communication Center.
- To integrate time keeping systems with MUNIS. (Police, Fire, Recreation, Schools)
- To continue connecting new and existing facilities to the Town's fiber network.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

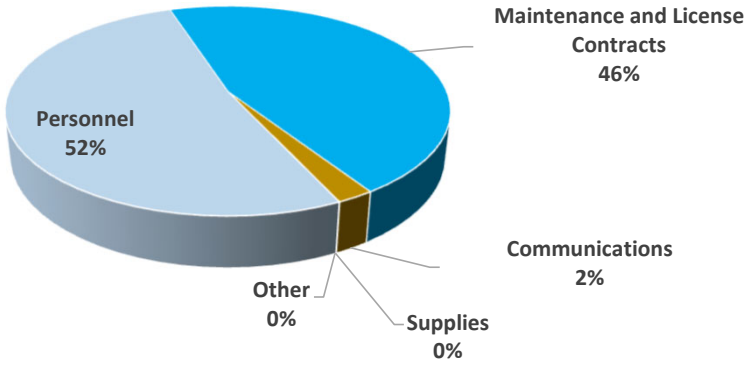
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	406,179	422,345	404,595	454,364	477,269	22,905	5.0%
Operating Expenses	$	307,198	348,427	355,461	393,177	442,052	48,875	12.4%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	713,378	770,772	760,056	847,541	919,321	71,780	8.5%

Major Components:

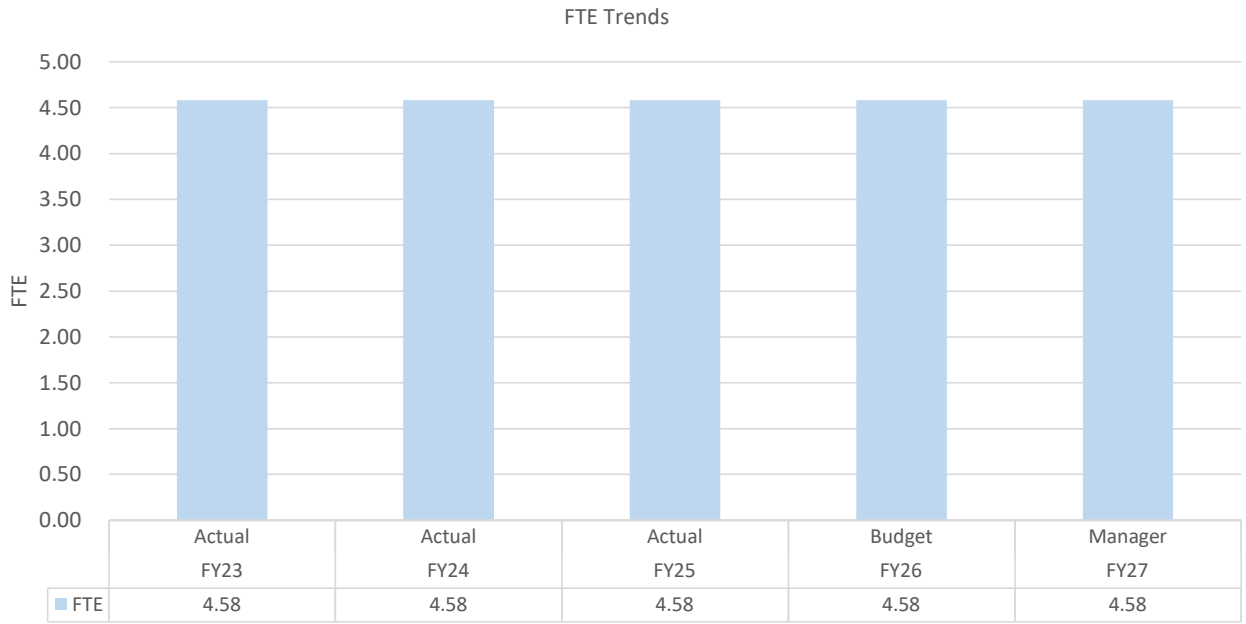
Personnel Services include salaries for the Director, an Infrastructure Manager, .33 of an Applications Manager (shared with the Water and Sewer Funds), an Information Specialist, .25 of the Communications Manager, and an Applications Analyst. Relicensing Agreements, $420,722 provide for the payment of relicense and maintenance agreements on a variety of software and operating systems. All software maintenance costs are part of the Department's budget. Communications includes phone lines and Internet access.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas. Operating Expenses rising due to software fee increases and absorbing the cost of software previously paid from grants.



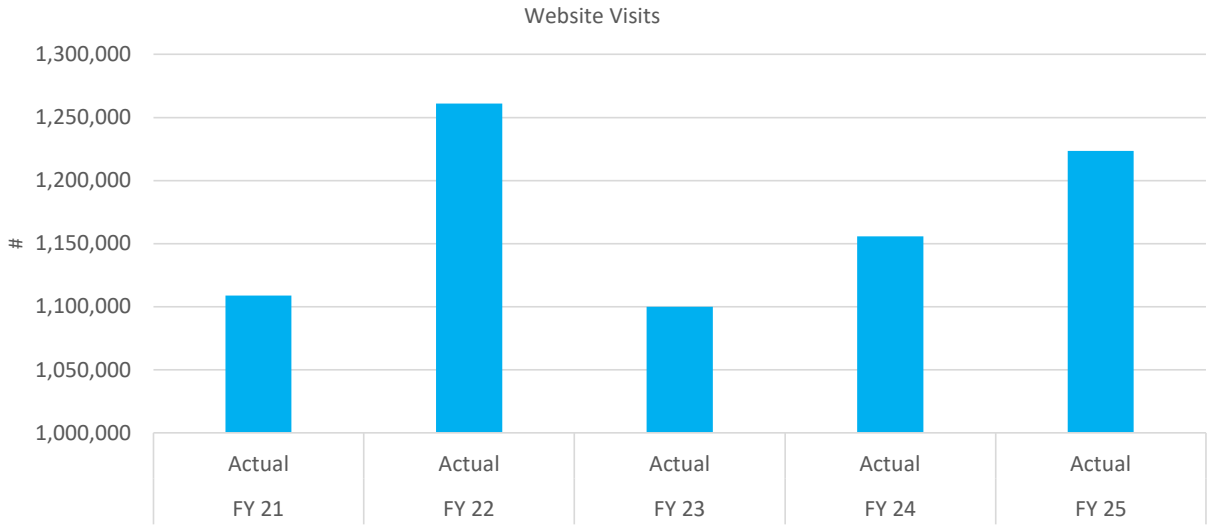
Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Buildings Connected to the WAN	18	20	20	20	23
Network User/Group Accounts	967	1,015	1,031	1,043	1,079
Desktop/Notebook Computers	674	689	673	440	472
Virtual Servers	74	64	51	33	33
Printers & Multifunctions	69	72	72	71	72
IP Phones	328	251	258	252	259
Network Database Software Packages	54	55	55	55	55
Websites	8	8	8	8	8
Website Visits	1,109,022	1,261,046	1,100,000	1,155,977	1,223,538
Amherst YouTube Channel Views	6,784	10,625	73,360	17,895	19,700

Notable Trends:
The Town's online presence continues to see extensive engagement with over one million website visits and thousands of YouTube video views.

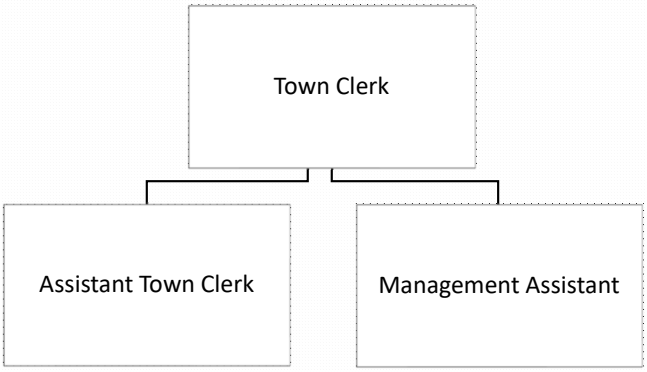


For more information, visit the Information Technology webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/341/Information-Technology

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Function: To serve the public with efficient, quality, and courteous service. To continue the preservation of the Town's vital and permanent records and ensure compliance with State and local laws while promoting transparency through access to public records.

Organization:



(Town Clerk and Assistant Town Clerk helping residents register to vote at a community event.)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Successful transition of Assistant Town Clerk to Town Clerk.
- Successful implementation of Massachusetts Vital Records Information Collaborative (MAVRIC). This program maintains and generates death records for the Commonwealth.
- Town Clerk graduated from the New England Municipal Institute and Academy after completing the 3 year program.
- Town Clerk obtained designation as a Certified Municipal Clerk.
- Hired Assistant Town Clerk.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to provide educational opportunities for office staff in all Town Clerk functions.
- To provide trainings for boards, committees and staff members on Conflict of Interest, Open Meeting, and Public Records laws.
- To provide trainings for new staff member liaisons in how to submit a meeting posting for Boards and Committees.
- To enhance overall delivery of services, especially online, in an effort to improve customer service.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To apply for a Community Preservation Act grant for funds to maintain an ongoing schedule for restoration and preservation of historical records. **Ongoing**
- To work with Town Manager's staff and I.T. Dept in determining how to combine board/committee databases. **Accomplished**
- To have Assistant Town Clerk attend Year 3 of the New England Municipal Clerk Academy. **Accomplished**
- To successfully implement the new MAVRIC (Massachusetts Vital Records Information Collaborative) program by the State Registry of Vital Records and Statistics. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To apply for a Community Preservation Act grant for funds to maintain an ongoing schedule for restoration and preservation of historical records.
- To collaborate with Information Technology to implement a new public records management system and provide trainings to Department Heads, using existing software.
- To develop comprehensive internal guides on posting public body meetings/open meeting law and handling public records requests.
- To continue developing methods for storing Town records electronically in order to make them more accessible to the public and Town departments.
- To work towards higher accreditation as a Master Municipal Clerk and Certified Master Municipal Clerk and provide professional development opportunities for Assistant Town Clerk.
- To provide back up support to Clerk of the Town Council.
- To transition to OpenGov for the purchasing of licenses, permits, and vital records.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	200,483	209,025	233,353	241,177	222,567	(18,610)	-7.7%
Operating Expenses	$	5,837	5,343	4,606	6,260	6,260	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	206,321	214,368	237,958	247,437	228,827	(18,610)	-7.5%

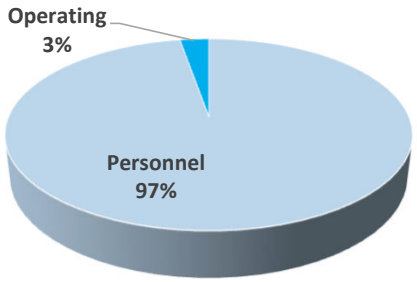
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Town Clerk, Assistant Town Clerk, and Management Assistant.

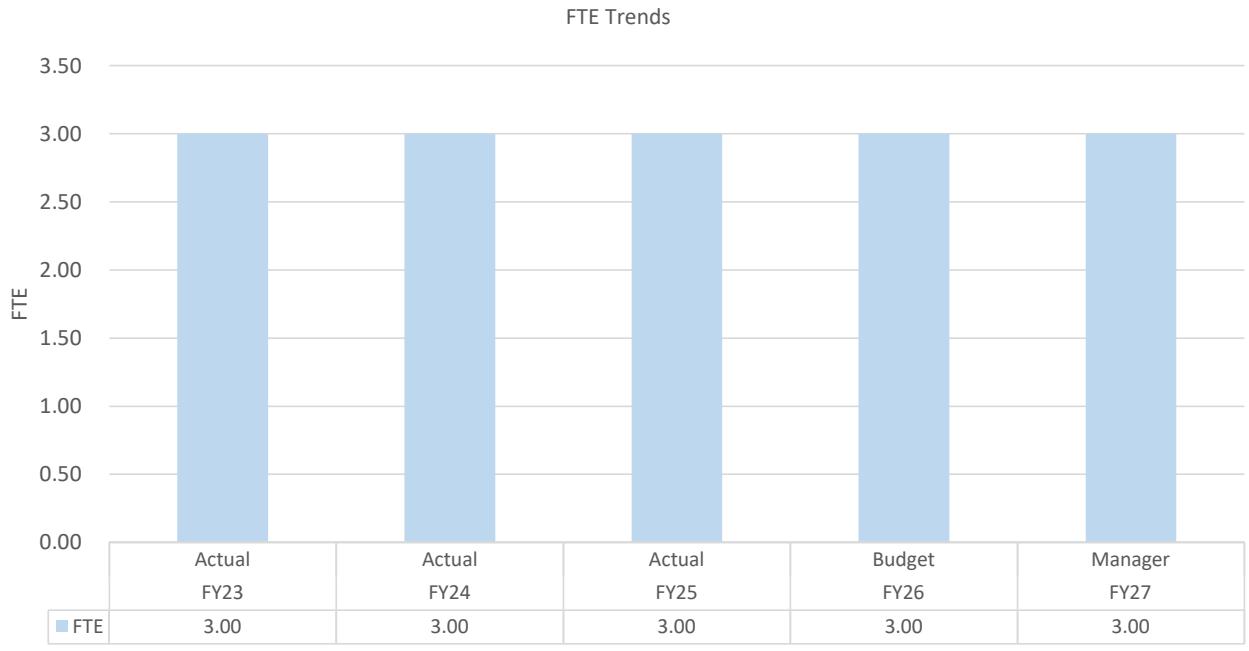
Operating costs include training, dues and subscriptions, communications, and supplies for storage of vital records and dog licensing.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected step increases. This increase has been offset by staff turnover savings.



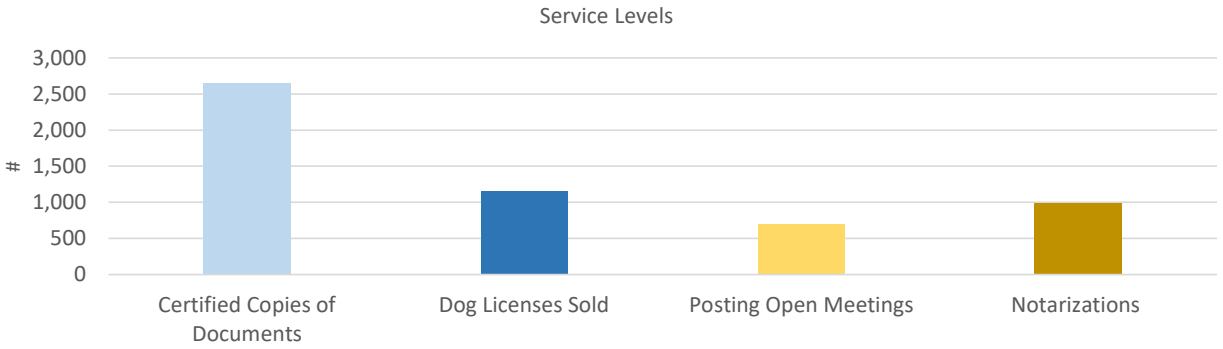
Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Certified Copies of Documents	1,723	2,244	2,213	1,961	2,652
Marriage Intentions	5	69	122	133	146
Marriage Licenses	4	67	119	128	141
Dog Licenses Sold	789	974	1,094	1,087	1,155
Poll and Underground Conduits	1	0	2	9	4
Zoning Board of Appeals Applications/ Decisions	42	14	16	41	25
Public Records Requests	61	60	57	114	97
Conflict of Interest Law Compliance	518	927	639	365	726
Street Lists Sold	8	37	11	24	12
Posting Open Meetings	718	693	668	615	696
Planning Board Applications/Decisions	22	25	11	24	29
Business Notices (d/b/a)	157	145	109	125	146
Raffle Permits	3	4	4	8	6
Underground Storage Registrations	23	19	13	11	9
Cemetery Deeds	12	10	8	2	3
Notarizations	91	1,260	1,106	886	991
Burial Permits	148	177	172	166	210
Request for Voter Information	66	39	140	36	153
Performance Oath	117	180	182	200	181
Non-certified Copies of Documents	33	289	39	160	223
Vital Records Recorded	326	390	470	493	518
Vital Records: Filing/Amendments	8	5	4	10	19
Passport Photos	0	18	27	12	4
Planning Board filings	23	20	11	6	29
Court case filings	7	6	7	7	2
Resignations from Boards/Committee	20	29	13	33	11
Claims for Damages	53	39	12	82	131

Notable Trends:
Dog licenses have increased 46% over the past five years. Many data points are up from FY21 numbers which were negatively impacted by Covid-19.

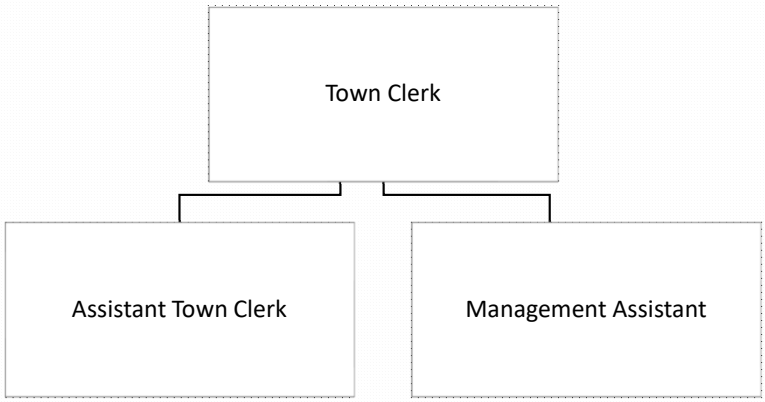


For more information, visit the Town Clerk's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/80/Town-Clerk

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

Function: To register voters, maintain the Voter Registration Information System, and preserve the integrity of elections in accordance with all applicable State and Federal laws.

Organization:



(Photo of a VOTE HERE TODAY sign)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Successful administration of the November 4, 2025 Biennial Town Election.
- Hired adequate number of election workers to be able to shorten Election Day shifts to 5 hours instead of 7-8 hours.
- Promoted three Clerks to Wardens.
- Increased outreach efforts by Town Clerk to college students and encouraged voting in local elections / serving as an election worker.
- Collaborated with the Election Security Partnership division of the Secretary of State's office and developed a Business Continuity Plan.
- Participated in testing the new Voter Registration Information System (VRIS).

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To work with Town departments and committees on outreach and education for the promotion of ranked-choice voting for municipal elections.
- To continue to hire and train new election workers to ensure adequate staffing at the polls.
- To provide ongoing education for the Board of Registrars members in their legal duties per State law.
- To continue working with the three institutions of higher education through the Resident Life offices, as well as the superintendent's office at the high school on voter outreach.
- To work with major stakeholders to develop effective and viable voter outreach and education programs geared toward the Town's underserved populations and students.
- To closely monitor legislative changes resulting in implementation of new Election regulations requiring added responsibilities.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To prepare for and facilitate the upcoming November 4, 2025 Biennial Town Election. **Accomplished**
- To prepare for the transition of the Town Clerk upon her retirement. **Accomplished**
- To expand outreach efforts at the University, colleges, and high school to ensure every eligible voter is registered and has access to vote. **Accomplished/Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To expand voter outreach efforts to the University, colleges, and high school to ensure every eligible voter is registered and has access to vote.
- To work with major stakeholders to develop effective and viable voter outreach and education programs geared toward the Town's underserved populations and students.
- To successfully transition to the new Voter Registration Information System (VRIS).
- To train an Assistant Town Clerk.
- To collaborate with the Election Security Partnership division of the Secretary of State's office on the development of an Incident Response Plan.
- To prepare for and conduct the State Primary on September 1, 2026.
- To prepare for and conduct the State Election on November 3, 2026.
- To closely monitor legislative changes resulting in implementation of new Election regulations.
- To continue to hire and train new election workers as needed and update training materials.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	60,036	39,655	48,378	43,853	43,853	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	16,391	21,263	19,659	23,975	23,975	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	76,427	60,918	68,037	67,828	67,828	-	--

Major Components:

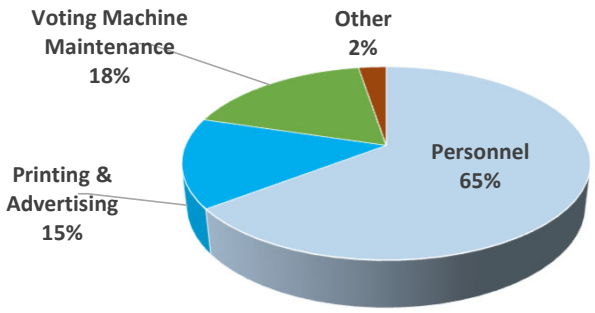
Personnel Services include stipends for the Board of Registrars and remuneration for Election Workers.

Voting Machine Maintenance includes programming and annual maintenance of voting equipment.

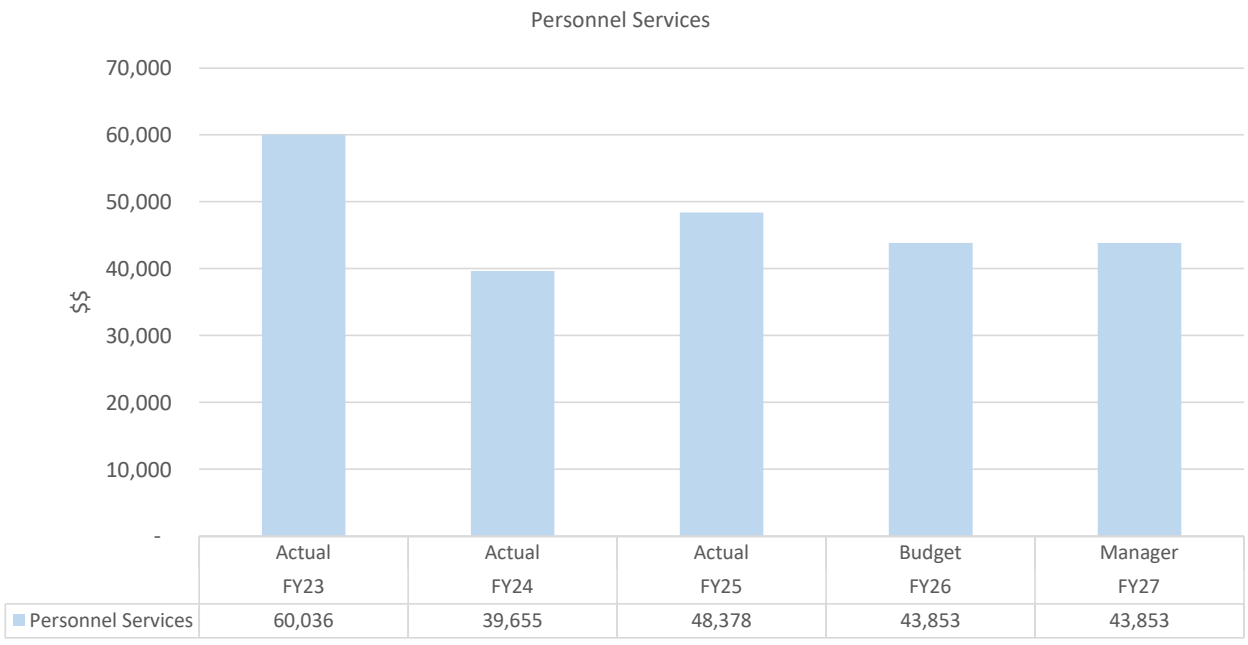
Printing costs include Town election ballots, census mailers, confirmation cards, and annual street list.

Significant Changes:

No changes.



Expenditure Trends:

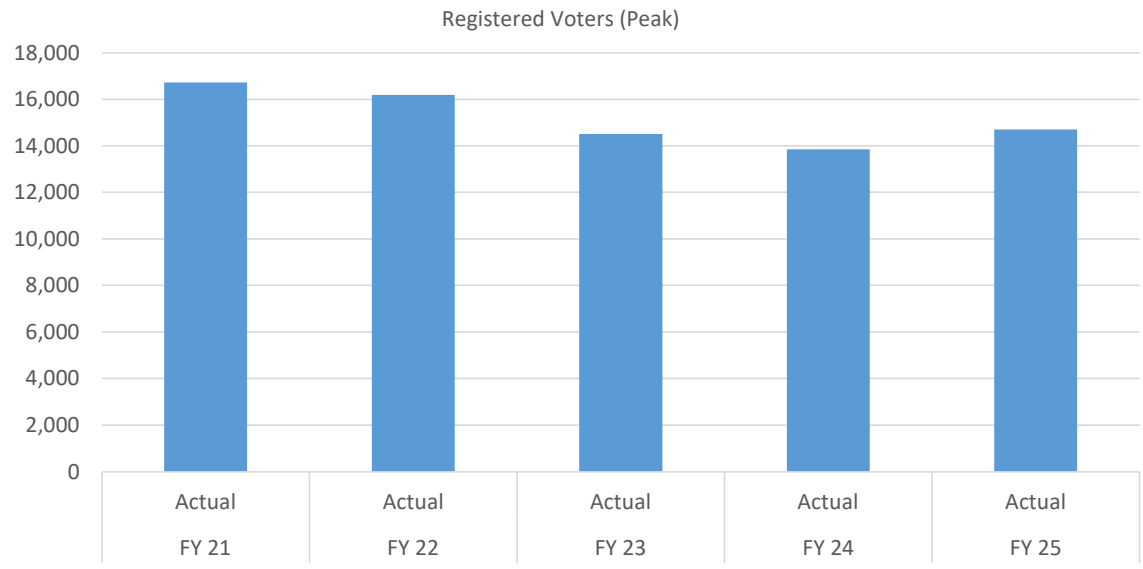


GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Elections	2	2	3	2	2
Election Worker Training Sessions	7	4	10	4	4
Voter Registration Sessions	1	2	3	2	3
Voter Registrations: New, Changes, Deletions	23,715	9,045	10,085	9,927	18,153
Registered Voters (Peak)	16,721	16,187	14,504	13,844	14,704
Town Elections	n/a	31.15%	30.24%	33.55%	n/a
Town % By Mail	n/a	2.00%	32.00%	38.70%	n/a
Presidential Primary	n/a	n/a	n/a	28.12%	n/a
Presidential % By Mail	n/a	n/a	n/a	53.80%	n/a
State Primaries	42.94%	n/a	27.08%	n/a	20.26%
State Primaries % By Mail	0.84	n/a	79.00%	n/a	7.20%
State Elections (incl. Presidential/Special	71.89%	n/a	56.26%	n/a	73.06%
State Elections % By Mail	57.00%	n/a	46.00%	n/a	32.10%
Petition/Nomination Signatures	1,645	5,108	67	8,850	507
Petition/Nomination Papers	265	2,141	15	4,159	134
Annual Street Listing Forms (first mailing)	10,358	11,000	8,500	8,834	9,571
Confirmation Cards (second mailing)	4,861	3,884	3,767	3,075	4,119

Notable Trends:

None.

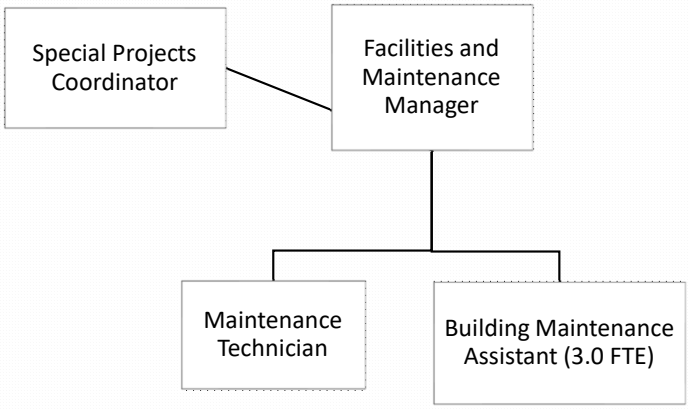


For more information, visit the Board of Registrars webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/472/Board-of-Registrars

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

Function: To maintain a safe, healthy, clean and efficient environment for conducting Town business and other public activities through comprehensive building operations and preventative maintenance programs that also serve to preserve and extend the life of the Town's physical assets.

Organization:



(Photo of Contractors assessing the Town Hall roof in preparation for replacement.)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed the Town Hall Main Street Door Restoration.
- Completed the Town Hall Historic Slate Roof Replacement Design.
- Completed the Town Hall Human Resources Office Renovation.
- Sealed the roof at War Memorial Pump house.
- Completed the Munson Memorial Library Slate Roof Restoration.
- Completed the Munson Memorial Library Fire Alarm System Design and Installation.
- Completed the Atkins Water Treatment Facility Roof Replacement Design.
- Completed accessibility improvements at the Munson Memorial Library Building.
- Coordinated the following capital projects: Track and Field, Hickory Ridge Clubhouse demolition, Jones Library Renovation, Amethyst Brook Elementary School, Bangs Community Center renovations.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To address deferred maintenance on all buildings.
- To manage impact of increased use of buildings on nights and weekends.
- To continue to work with the Director of Sustainability to apply for Green Community grant funding.
- To achieve watertight roofs on all buildings with a plan for replacement as needed.
- To protect the Town's assets through preventative maintenance and ongoing capital improvements.
- To manage the space needs within the buildings to provide for necessary long-term storage.
- To explore opportunities to increase revenues using Town assets.
- To develop and begin implementing a plan for building improvements that reduces the Town's carbon footprint.
- To continue to schedule and complete previously funded capital projects.
- To address and implement the accessibility initiatives across Town buildings and property, tied to the self-evaluation and accessibility survey.
- To enhance the safety and security of Town buildings.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To develop a strategic plan to address needed roof repair and replacement for Town buildings. **Ongoing**
- To complete the ADA improvements at the Munson Memorial Library Building. **Accomplished**
- To manage the restoration of the slate roofs on Town Hall and Munson Memorial Building. **Ongoing**
- To enhance the safety and security of Town buildings. **Ongoing**
- To complete the design to replace the HVAC systems at the Munson Memorial Library Building. **Ongoing**
- To complete the installation of a fire alarm control system at Munson Memorial Library Building. **Accomplished**
- To complete the study and design of the replacement of the boiler at the Amherst Childcare Center. **Ongoing**
- To work with the Department of Public Works to address the Traffic and Grounds building energy performance and deferred maintenance. **Ongoing**
- To seal the roof at War Memorial Pump house. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To complete the study and design of the replacement of the boiler at the Amherst Childcare Center.
- To work with the Department of Public Works to address the Traffic and Grounds building energy performance and deferred maintenance.
- To manage the restoration of the slate roofs on Town Hall and Munson Memorial Library Building.
- To enhance the safety and security of Town buildings.
- To complete the design to replace the HVAC systems at the Munson Memorial Library Building.
- To develop a strategic plan to address needed roof repair and replacement for Town buildings.
- To develop a plan for the Town Hall South Entrance Restoration.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

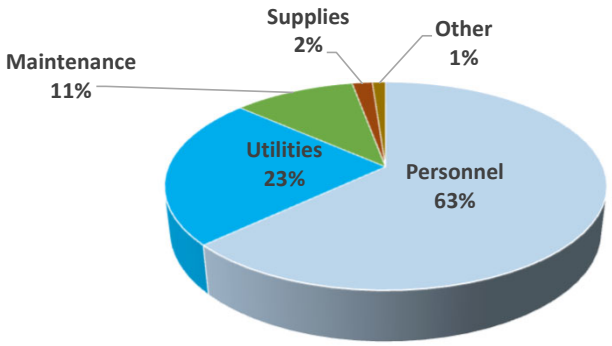
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	288,181	315,099	368,183	423,012	431,918	8,906	2.1%
Operating Expenses	$	235,425	243,271	243,131	255,600	253,000	(2,600)	-1.0%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	523,606	558,369	611,314	678,612	684,918	6,306	0.9%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for a Facilities and Maintenance Manager, a Maintenance Technician, three Building Maintenance Assistants, and the Special Projects Coordinator.

Utilities are for Town Hall, the Bangs Community Center, the Munson Memorial Library building, the North Amherst School, the South Amherst Campus, North Amherst Library, and the East Street School building. Fuel, electricity, water, sewer, and refuse collection are included.

Maintenance includes maintenance and repair of buildings and to routine cleaning and maintenance of building systems, HVAC, and sprinklers occupied by Town departments and those leased to other providers.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas.

Staffing Trends:

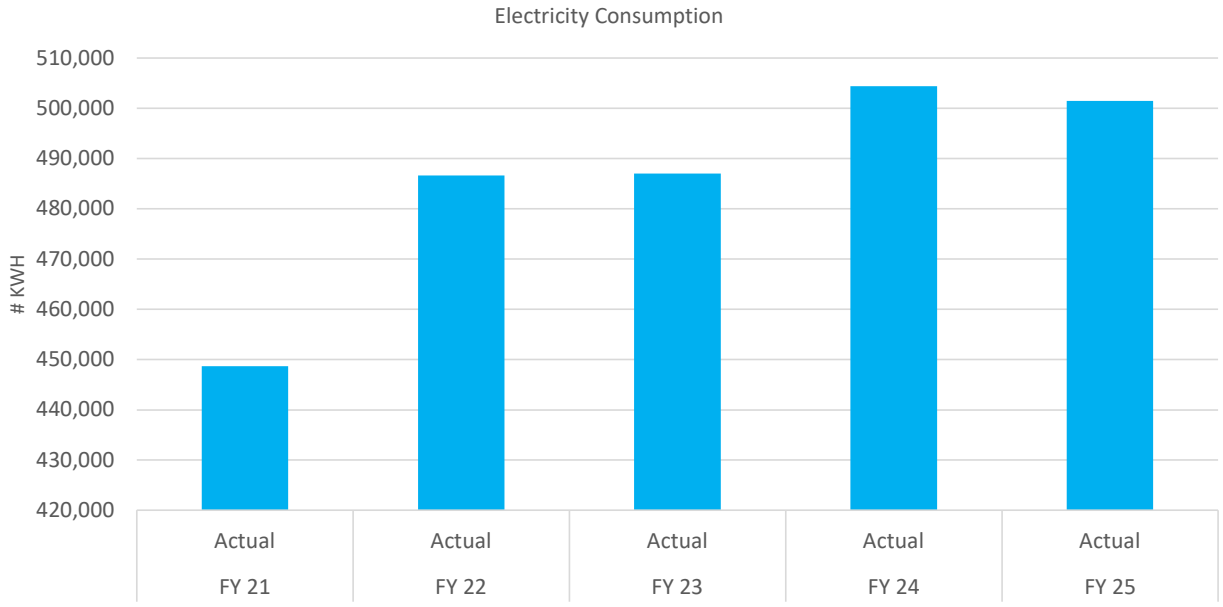
GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Utility Usage					
Electricity (kWh)*	448,696	486,658	487,006	504,370	501,499
Fuel – Gas (cf)*	30,302	29,008	26,682	25,602	23,591
Fuel – Oil (gal)*	2,057	2,016	2,168	2,193	2,101
Water & Sewer (cf) (all municipal buildings)	674,200	856,600	1,316,700	906,500	845,600
Square Feet Maintained	101,805	101,805	104,690	211,000	211,000
Facilities Managed	9	9	10	14	14
Automated Computer Systems Monitored	5	5	5	7	7
Building Usage (hrs/wk)	310	310	330	785	785
Maintenance (hrs/wk)	252	261.5	261.5	261.5	261.5
Meetings Scheduled (includes APD)	1,238	4,618	4,580	3,429	N/A
Emergency Responses	NA	NA	NA	NA	85 HRS
Rental Contracts	4	4	4	4	4

*(Town Hall, Bangs Community Center, Munson Memorial Library, East Street School, South Amherst Campus, 1200 North Pleasant Street)

Notable Trends:

Most data points are up from FY21 due to Covid-19 and its impact on the Town's operations. The department has added more buildings under its supervision in the past few years including South Amherst Campus and North Amherst Library.

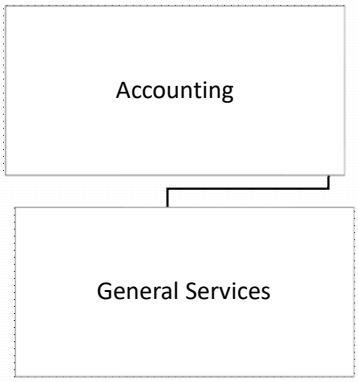


For more information, visit the Facilities webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/358/Facilities

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

Function: To manage the centralized purchasing of services, supplies, and equipment; contracts for maintenance of office equipment; legal services; and property and casualty insurance in order to maximize savings and efficiencies with competitive purchasing. This includes municipal property and casualty insurance, risk management, the annual independent audit, legal services, central telephones, copiers, mailing services, and equipment and central bulk office supplies.

Organization:



(Photo of office equipment managed within this section of the budget)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Continued to maintain competitive rates on property and casualty insurance for Town, Library, Schools, and Enterprise departments.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to control costs for centralized services.
- To maintain a balance between age of equipment, new acquisition costs, and maintenance costs.
- To conduct a risk assessment and to implement programs that reduce liability insurance cost.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue to look for savings for centralized services for the Town. **Ongoing**
- To put out a Request for Proposals for FY27 property and casualty insurance. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue to look for savings for centralized services for the Town.
- To put out a Request for Proposals for FY27 property and casualty insurance.
- To implement Amazon Business Account which aligns with State procurement laws, reduces costs, and provides greater purchasing control.
- To complete telephone and utility account audit.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

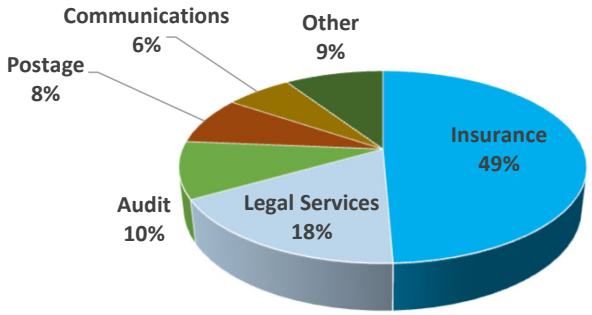
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	580,772	551,428	649,034	685,600	717,600	32,000	4.7%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	580,772	551,428	649,034	685,600	717,600	32,000	4.7%

Major Components:

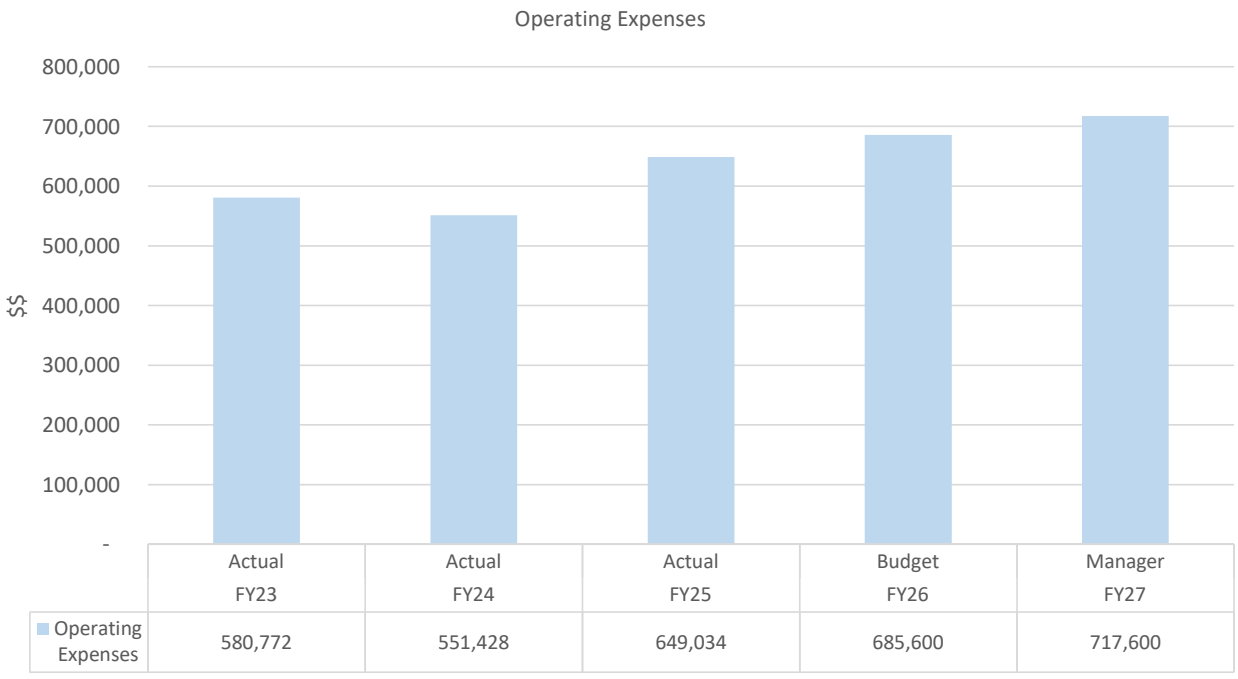
Insurance, $354,100, includes general liability, auto, public official and professional liability, and boiler insurance. Legal Services, $125,000. Postage, $58,000. Communications, $45,000. Supplies, $24,000, include office, copier paper, and miscellaneous supplies for all departments. Audit, $68,500. Equipment rental & maintenance, $28,000, covers contracts, where economical, on photocopiers, computers, printers, fax machines, telephones, etc. Technical Services, $15,000.

Significant Changes:

Operating Expenses increasing due to anticipated rise in liability insurance premiums for FY27.



Expenditure Trends:

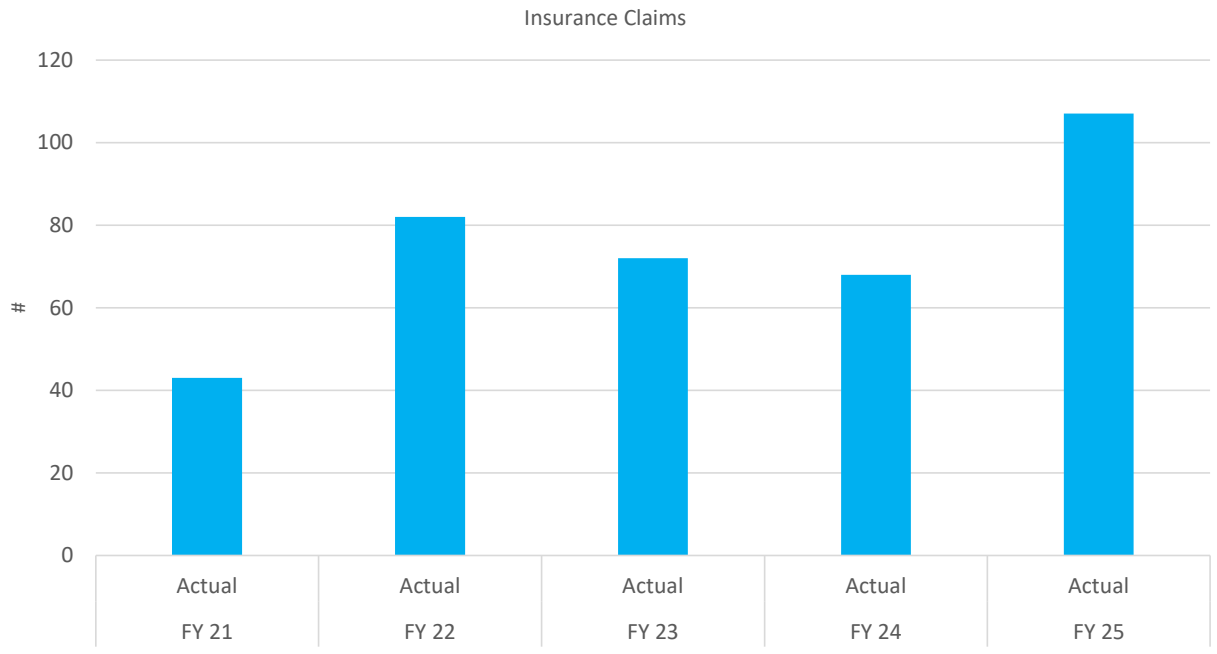


GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Vehicles Insured	224	220	225	230	241
Buildings Insured	60	60	63	63	61
Insurance Claims Processed (Property/Auto)	43	82	72	68	107
Supply Requisitions Filled	112	78	86	65	55

Notable Trends:

The number of insured vehicles has increased over the past five years. The Town is working on a plan to reduce the number of vehicles it owns and insures in FY27.



PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Function: To operate and maintain a secure, healthy, comfortable, and safe mission-critical facility for all users, twenty-four hours per day, seven days per week, fifty-two weeks per year. The building also serves as the Emergency Operation Center for the Town during emergencies.

Organization:

(Photo of the Police Station)

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed the replacement of the Chiller system serving the Police Station.
- Completed the bench replacement in the Locker Rooms.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To manage higher use of the building and the directly proportional amount of maintenance work needed. Weekend staffing needs are a challenge for existing staff schedules.
- To implement energy saving initiatives to further the Town's sustainability goals and eliminate the use of fossil fuels consistent with Town's goals for de-carbonization.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To implement energy savings initiatives tied to the audits done by Eversource and consultants. **Ongoing**
- To complete the replacement of the Chiller system serving the Police Station. **Accomplished**
- To complete the design and replacement of the exterior stairs and sidewalks at the rear of building. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To complete the design and replacement of the exterior stairs and sidewalks at the rear of building.
- To implement energy savings initiatives tied to the audits done by Eversource and consultants.

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	58,602	63,090	65,372	69,878	73,003	2,920	4.2%
Operating Expenses	$	164,698	139,244	132,988	146,755	146,755	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	223,300	202,334	198,360	216,633	219,758	3,125	1.4%

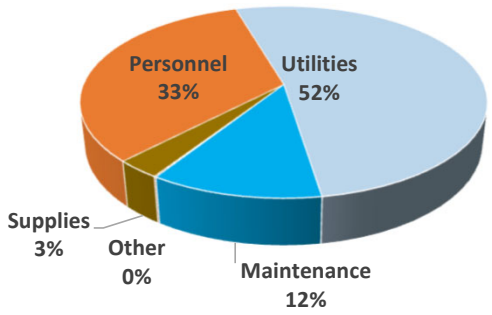
Major Components:

Personnel Services include the salary for a full-time Custodian, a weekend Custodian, and overtime.

Operating Expenses include, Maintenance (contracted services for the elevator, HVAC, security system, building, grounds, and equipment maintenance), Utilities (heating fuel, electricity, water, sewer, and trash removal) Supplies (cleaning supplies and uniforms).

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected step/colas.



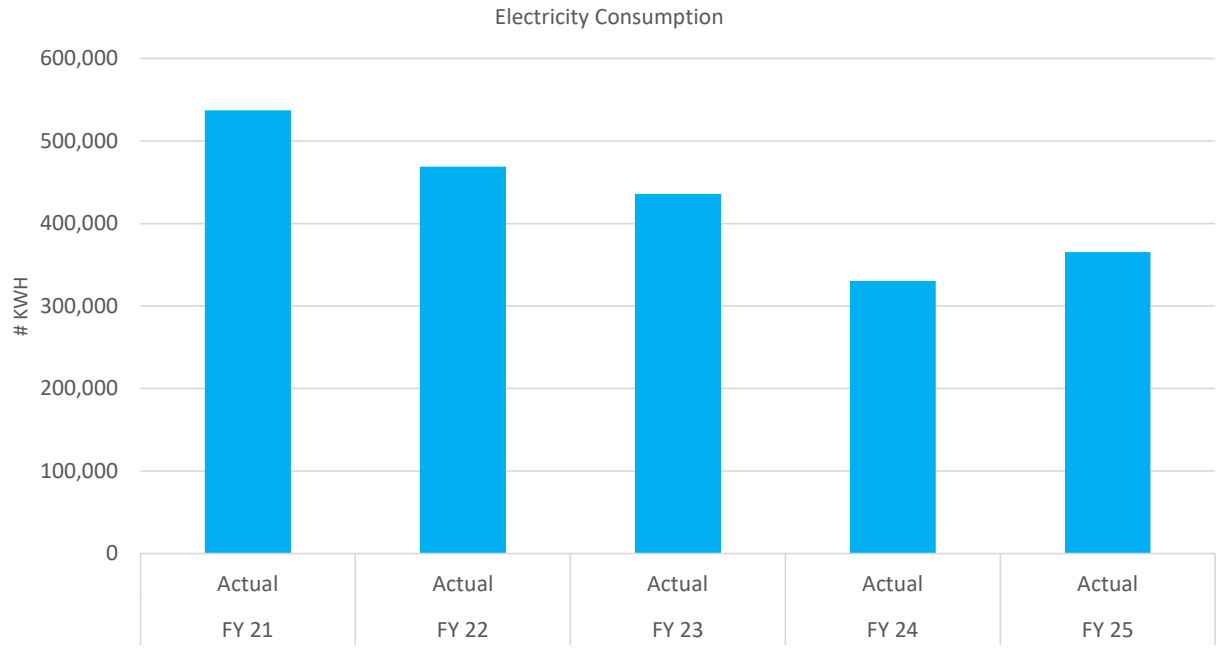
Staffing Trends:

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Fuel (Gas) (ccf)	16,210	16,409	17,420	17,022	17,818
Electricity (kWH)	536,960	468,800	435,680	330,560	365,440
Water and Sewer (cu. ft.)	26,600	25,200	24,600	22,300	18,500
Hours of Operation (weekly)	168	168	168	168	168
Usable space (sq. ft.)	24,865	24,865	24,865	24,865	24,865
Meetings Scheduled (Conference)	61	64	76	98	92
Meetings Scheduled (Community)	47	90	77	66	118

Notable Trends:

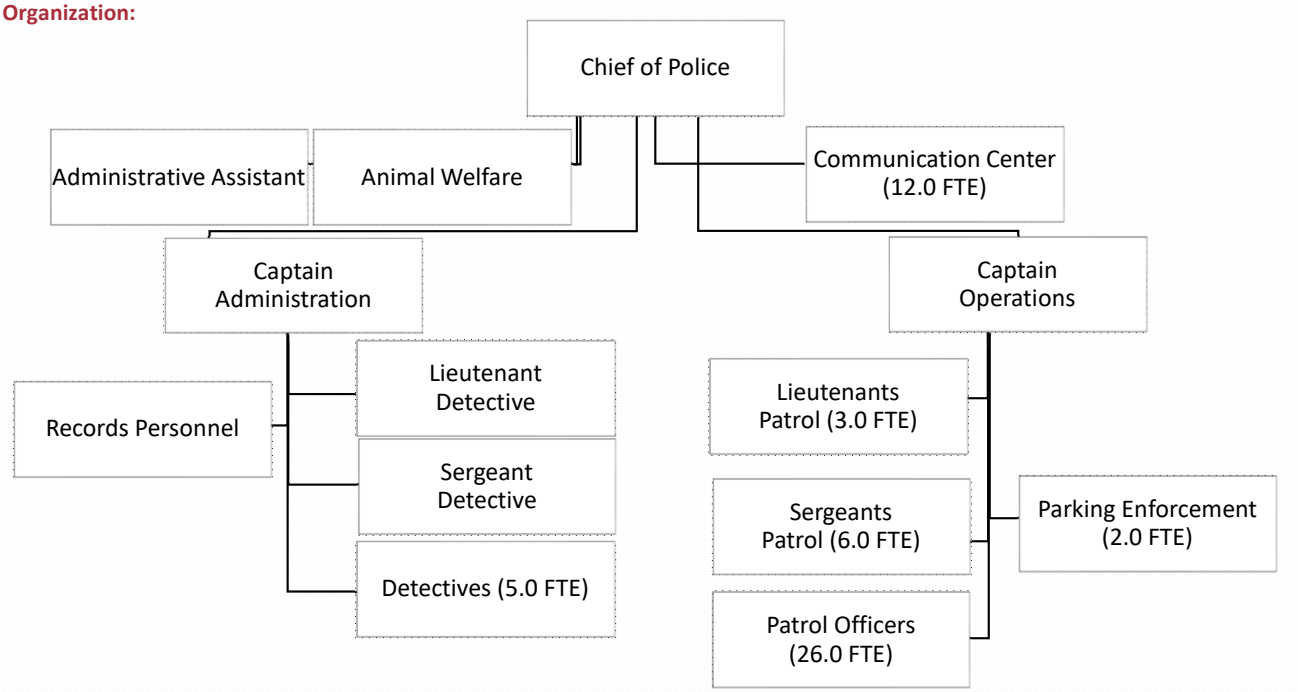
Electricity consumption has declined by 30%, in part due to the installation of a more efficient heating and cooling system.



PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

Function: The Amherst Police Department (APD) values the dedication and integrity of all members of the Department. APD values the diversity of the Amherst community and is grateful for its support and partnership. APD strives to protect the safety, rights, and property of every person within the Town. APD holds itself to the highest professional and ethical standards

Organization:



(Members of the Amherst School, Recreation, and Police Department with other Town officials accepting an award that recognizes the impact of the Morning Movement and Mentoring Program.)

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Successfully completed Massachusetts Police Accreditation Commission three-year assessment to attain accreditation.
- Developed a Community Policing unit including an LGBTQ Liaison Officer.
- Assisted the CRESS department Emergency Communications Center with the integration of 911 driven call response.
- Developed a new policy for the Deaf and Hard of Hearing.
- Acquired K-9 Mojo, the Department's newest tracking dog, and successful training for new K-9 Officer Santos.
- Hired and onboarded five new police officers.
- Extensive involvement and support for the the award-winning Morning Movement and Mentoring program.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- Continue to adapt to the changing and demanding language as the Massachusetts Peace Officers Standards & Training Commission (POST) commission evolves.
- Provide additional training for new academy level recruits.
- Reimagine and expand our existing community outreach efforts.
- Adapt a more contemporary promotion examination process for first line supervisors.
- Continue to collaborate with the CRESS Department for policy development and coordination of activities.
- Reinvent and establish an annual community police academy.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To support the growth and evolution of the CRESS Department. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To create a strategic succession plan for existing and anticipated command vacancies. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To continue to meet certification standards established by Massachusetts POST Commission. **Accomplished**
- To reach 100 % of all Town departments with Alert, Lockdown, Inform, Counter, Evacuate (ALICE) training to provide a safety plan. **Ongoing**
- To work with the Town management to develop new approaches to maintaining community safety. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To develop policies and investigate budget implications of body-worn cameras. **Ongoing**
- To fully staff our sworn personnel to the allotted levels. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To fully staff department sworn personnel to necessary allotted levels.
- To submit department policies and directives to CALEA scrutiny to meet national accreditation standards.
- To restructure the department's outreach programming based on community goals, feedback, and values.
- To expand community outreach/participate in national night out.
- To support the growth and evolution of the CRESS Department.
- To create a strategic succession plan for existing and anticipated command vacancies.
- To reach 100 % of all Town departments with Alert, Lockdown, Inform, Counter, Evacuate (ALICE) training to provide a safety plan.
- To work with the Town management to develop new approaches to maintaining community safety.
- To develop policies and investigate budget implications of body-worn cameras.

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

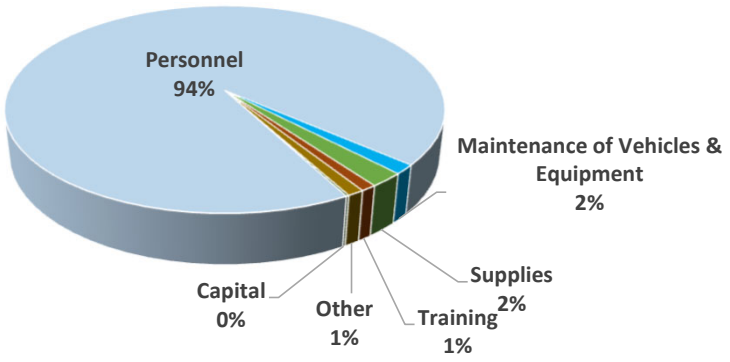
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	4,631,943	4,825,562	5,023,594	5,054,562	5,281,420	226,858	4.5%
Operating Expenses	$	299,392	306,803	257,712	318,250	318,250	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	1,433	180	9,300	9,300	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	4,931,335	5,133,799	5,281,486	5,382,112	5,608,970	226,858	4.2%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Chief, 2 Captains, 4 Lieutenants, 5 Detectives, 7 Sergeants, 26 Officers, and 2 Support Staff. Also included are educational incentives and overtime.

Operating Expenses include, Maintenance (vehicles serviced by outside vendor, radio equipment, breathalyzers, etc.), Supplies (gasoline, tires, vehicle supplies, office and computer supplies, and uniforms), Other (dues and subscriptions, meals for prisoners, photography supplies, police physicians, telephones, printing and advertising, towing, etc.).

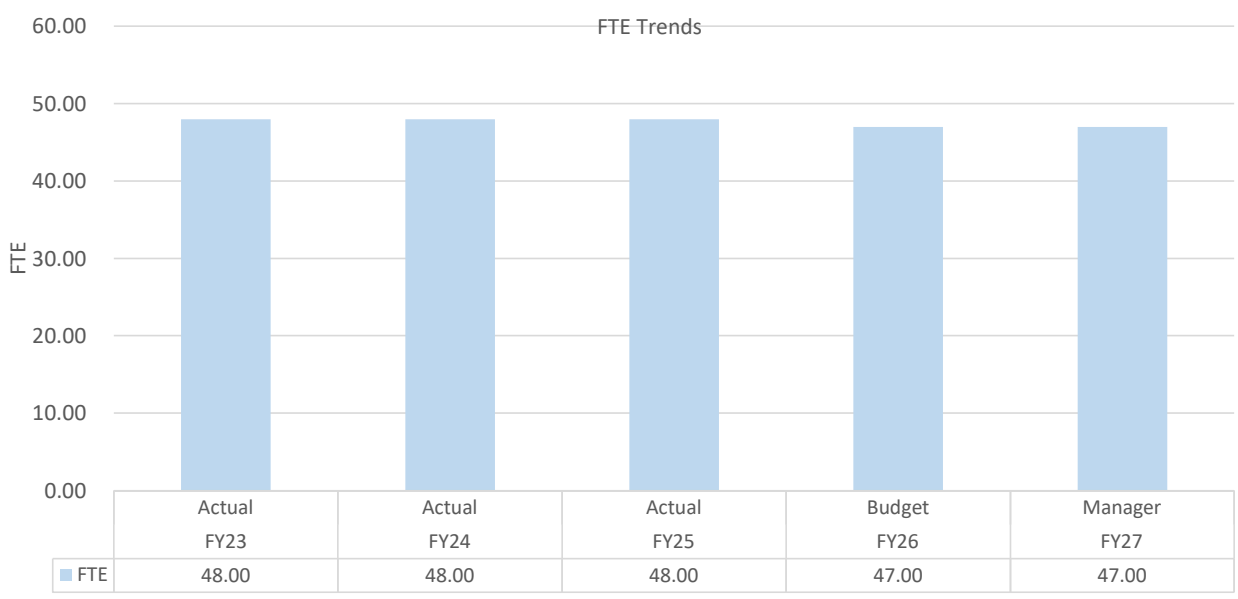
Operating Capital include small equipment, electronic speed signs, etc.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas.

Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Calls for Service	16,362	16,380	13,920	17,472	19,488
Total Officers Responding	21,420	21,651	18,752	22,521	24,620
Arrests, Summons, TBL	986	833	554	800	863
Disorderly Conduct Arrests	26	43	19	46	46
Resisting Arrest	8	11	9	15	11
Assaulting a Police Officer	6	14	6	15	10
Operating Under the Influence Arrests	72	145	74	50	105
Under 21 Alcohol Arrests	97	85	11	51	107
Protective Custody	5	2	10	8	9
Homicide	0	0	0	0	0
Rape	13	16	11	14	18
Sexual Assaults (other)	25	36	37	32	40
Deaths	15	31	25	15	19
Robbery	0	1	0	1	0
Aggravated Assaults	8	10	11	17	5
Assault	18	38	19	39	23
Burglary	25	25	29	14	21
Motor Vehicle Burglary	19	14	36	35	19
Larceny	100	136	101	105	118
Motor Vehicle Thefts	11	9	0	4	8
209A-Restraining Order	248	299	247	234	239
Domestic Violence	200	166	188	177	200
Vandalism	80	126	108	62	55
Missing Person	12	11	26	18	29
Disturbances (Disturb, Fight, Noise)	1,132	1,082	830	809	796
Suspicious Activity	935	1,100	889	806	713
Assist Citizen	597	723	684	768	1,428
Medical Assists	216	292	295	588	600
Assist Fire Department	110	112	85	121	141
Community Outreach	451	357	428	619	482
Mental/Med Assist	902	566	776	454	584
Motor Vehicle Crashes	423	633	665	642	665
Alarms	405	441	395	432	431
Motor Vehicle Violations	2,446	2,348	2,236	3,188	4,755
Nuisance House Violations	12	17	4	25	7
Co-responses with CSO	0	0	0	0	0
Shoplifting	14	11	12	22	19

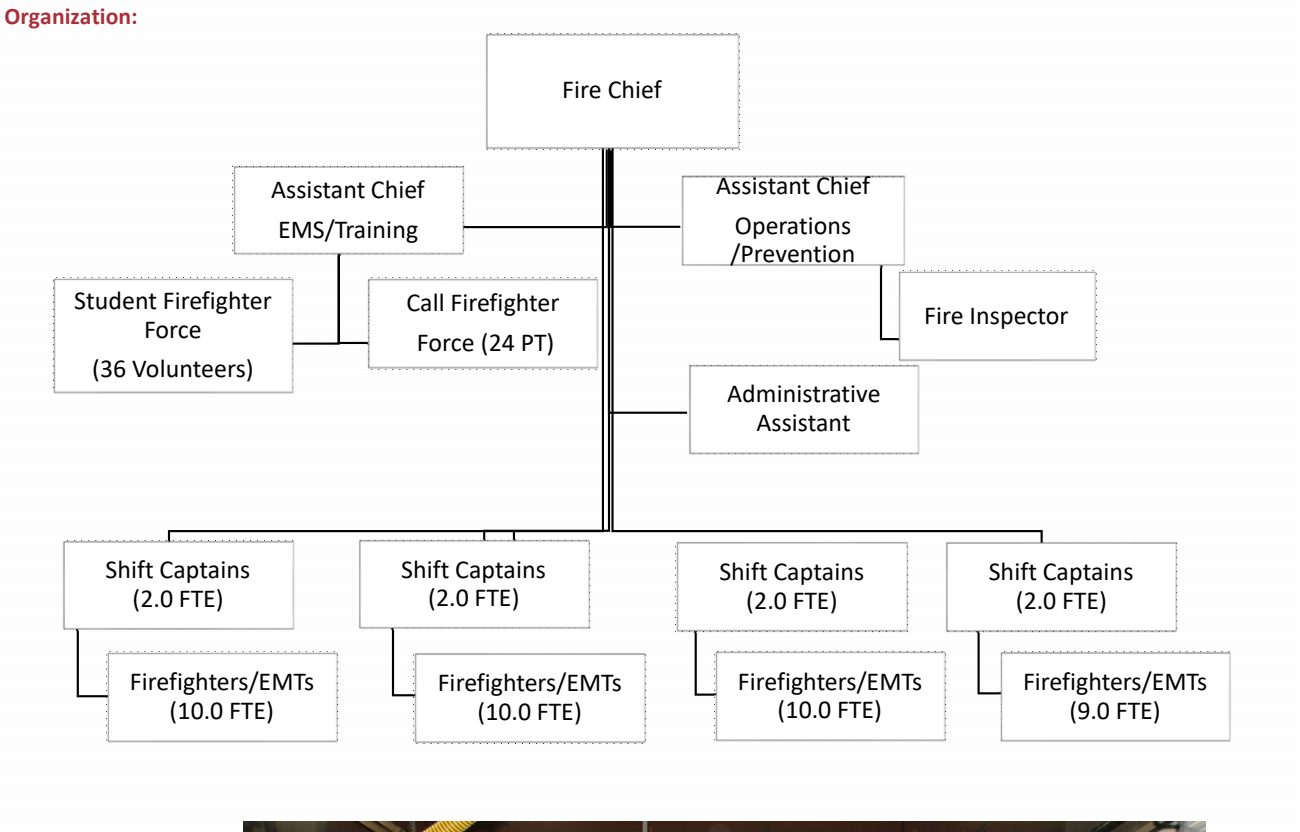
Notable Trends:
Total calls for service increased 11% from FY24 to FY25. Citizen assist calls nearly doubled from FY24 to FY25.

For more information, visit the Police Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3558/Police

PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

Function: To enhance the quality of life in the Amherst community by providing quality emergency and support services. The Department strives to be a leader in "All Hazards" preparation, response, mitigation, and recovery. The Department provides the highest level of service as it conducts fire suppression, emergency medical services, rescue services, fire prevention, safety education, hazardous material incident response, and disaster operations.

Organization:



(Photo of Town of Amherst Firefighters)

PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Filled vacant full-time positions with paramedics, or Basic-EMTs starting paramedic school.
- Transitioned to new department management with new Fire Chief and Assistant Chief for operations.
- Took delivery and placed in-service four major pieces of equipment: two new fire engines, a ladder tower, and a new ambulance.
- Four full-time members graduated from the Massachusetts Fire Academy recruit program.
- Acquired grants from the Department of Fire Services, and the Massachusetts Emergency Management Agency.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain full-time staffing in light of a highly competitive employment environment and regional shortage of paramedics.
- To address the dwindling number of part-time Call Force staff and difficulty in recruiting.
- To sustain a vehicle fleet and its maintenance needs given the challenge of longer delivery times for replacement parts, and equipment, combined with escalating costs.
- To increase full-time staffing, to enable our minimum on-duty staffing, and increase it to a level that allows us to adequately meet the demand for service.
- To continue to support and advocate for the replacement of the Central Fire Station.
- To complete the sustainability and maintenance plan for North Fire Station.
- To determine the viability of Community Paramedicine (CP) and its impact on the way the Town delivers Emergency Medical Services.
- To expand opportunities for non-Public Safety Town employees to participate in emergency management training, to include development of plans for operation of Emergency Operations Center, Shelters, and other emergencies.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To fill vacant fulltime positions with Firefighter/Paramedics. **Accomplished**
- To fill vacant Call Firefighter positions. **Ongoing**
- To complete replacement of radio communications system. **Ongoing**
- To place in service the new Ladder-Tower truck with expected delivery in September 2025. **Accomplished**
- To update and consolidate department rules and regulations and standard operating procedures. **Ongoing**
- To develop a repair and maintenance plan for Central Station. **Ongoing**
- To work with the Town Manager and building committee to select a site for new fire station and preliminary design plans. **Ongoing**
- To develop a Town Continuity of Operations Plan. **Ongoing**
- To complete update of the Town Hazard Mitigation Plan. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

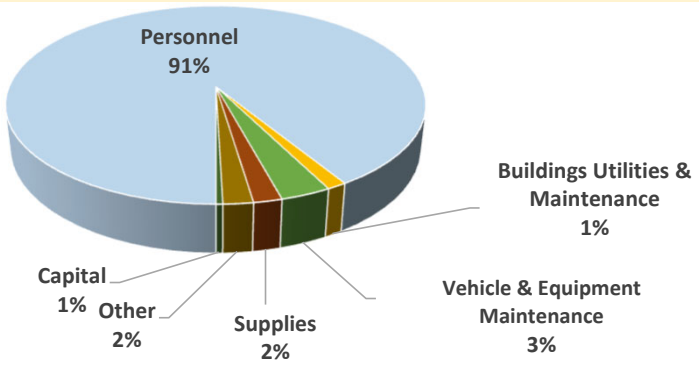
- To fill vacant fulltime positions with Firefighter/Paramedics.
- To increase minimum on-duty staffing by increasing number of full-time firefighter positions.
- To review the role of Call Force in Department Operations.
- To complete replacement of radio communications system.
- To update and consolidate department rules and regulations and standard operating procedures
- To develop a repair and maintenance plan for Central Fire Station.
- To work with the Town Manager and building committee to select a site for new fire station and develop preliminary design plans and financing options.
- To develop a Town Continuity of Operations Plan.
- To complete the update of the Town Hazard Mitigation Plan.

PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	4,339,406	4,346,218	4,733,519	5,084,748	5,400,681	315,933	6.2%
Operating Expenses	$	529,080	567,362	584,034	496,020	496,530	510	0.1%
Operating Capital	$	19,613	17,987	15,202	25,590	25,500	(90)	-0.4%
Total Appropriation	$	4,888,099	4,931,568	5,332,756	5,606,358	5,922,711	316,353	5.6%

Major Components:

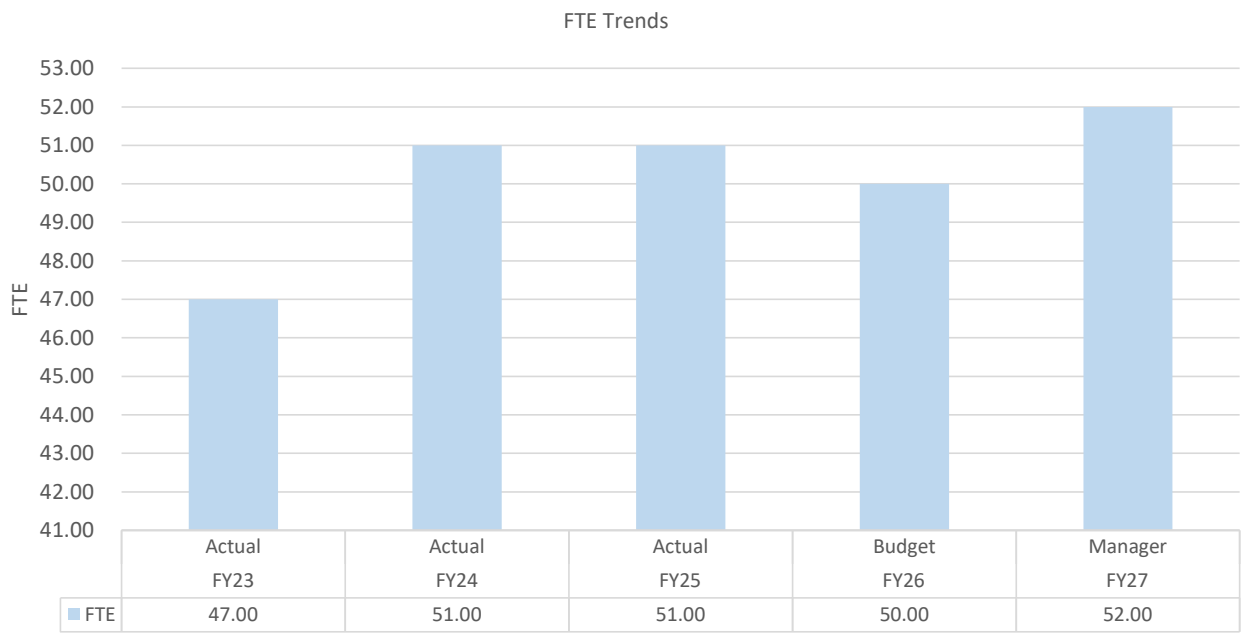
Personnel Services include salaries for the Chief, 2 Assistant Chiefs, 8 Captains, 40 Firefighters, and one Support Staff. All staff (excluding support staff) are EMTs, 73% of whom are certified as Paramedics. Other costs include overtime, education incentive, and Call Firefighter Force. Operating Expenses include, Building and Grounds Maintenance some of which is provided by firefighting staff, Utilities (fuel, electricity, water/sewer, etc.), Vehicle and Equipment Maintenance (vehicles, communication equipment, emergency medical equipment), Supplies (gas and diesel, medical supplies, and departmental).
Operating Capital includes small equipment.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas. A frozen position has been restored and a new firefighter/EMT has been added.

Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Total Emergency Responses	5,116	6,799	6,772	7,345	7,606
Fire Responses:					
Total Fire Calls:	1,852	2,380	2,420	2,652	2,850
Fires (all types)	83	82	77	58	93
Rescue (includes MVCs)	848	1,163	1,169	1,197	1,311
Other Alarms:	251	257	287	334	294
False/Accidental:	670	878	887	1,063	1,152
Station Coverage Requests					
Permanent Force:	99	128	108	125	144
Call Force:	58	88	70	55	92
Student Force:	14	67	60	52	86
Injuries Due to Fires:	0	0	0	2	3
Fire Deaths:	0	0	0	0	0
Firefighter Injuries:	14	15	26	19	23
Firefighter Lost Time Injuries:	5	9	11	14	19
Ambulance Responses:					
Total EMS Calls:	3,428	4,423	4,352	4,693	4,756
Advanced Life Support (ALS) level:	1,100 *	2,610	2,738	2,202	2,942
Basic Life Support (BLS) level:	1,240 *	1,558	1,407	995	1,543
Patient Contacts:	3,111	4,262	4,145	4,436	4,698
Patient Contacts; Treat; No Transport:	771	1,033	333	1,164	1,203
Patients Transported by AFD:	2,340	3,147	3,143	3,197	3,045
Mutual Aid Ambulance into Amherst:	52	127	95	141	211
Mutual Aid Ambulances out of Amherst:	97	162	247	195	187
Fire Mutual Aid into Amherst:	0	0	3	2	3
Fire Mutual Aid out of Amherst:	8	20	11	13	22
Fire Inspections/Prevention:					
Residential Smoke Detectors:	341	667	272	257	338
Misc. Inspections:	554	544	632	702	745
University/Colleges:	61	63	87	78	95
Fire Education:	54	62	72	85	76

Notable Trends:

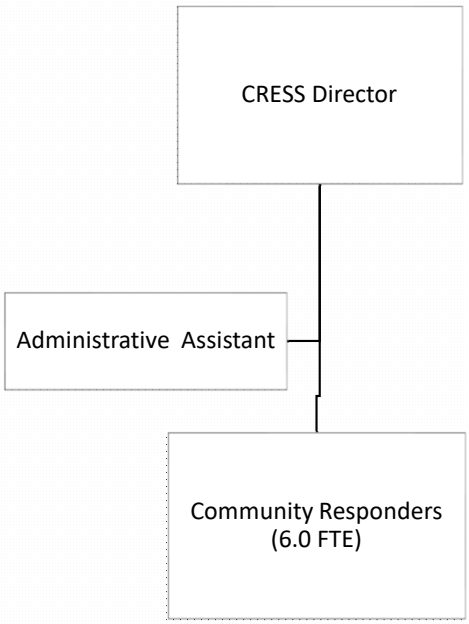
Total emergency responses continue to increase by approximately 3 to 4% annually (3.5% in FY25). Our elder population and mental health calls continues to be the leading demographic in terms of growth, although all types of EMS calls and populations are seeing an increase.

For more information, visit the Fire Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/124/Fire

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Function: The Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service (CRESS) Department's mission is to fill service gaps in the Town and to connect people to services and resources. CRESS is an unarmed public safety department that supports the Amherst community. Its work is rooted in trauma-informed and anti-racist frameworks. The Department provides community safety services in situations that do not involve violence or serious crime.

Organization:



(Photo of CRESS Director Camille Theriaque and CRESS Responders)

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Integrated into 911 dispatch as of January 2026.
- Adopted new policies and updated existing CRESS policies.
- Fully implemented Qualtrics for data collection and reporting.
- Launched Community Perception Survey in February.
- Achieved full staffing for FY26: Director, Administrative Assistant, and 6 responders (final hire starting by end of March).
- Developed and distributed a monthly CRESS newsletter via the Town website and growing subscriber list, improving transparency and public awareness.
- Successfully expanded CRESS Connections school program with increasing attendance.
- Completed Community Needs Assessment in partnership with Tury Research.
- Supported weekly Universal Unitarian Breakfast program through FY26.
- Continued support of bi-monthly Veterans Breakfast (now in second year).
- Partnered in Craig's Doors Hotel Stays Program for a second winter season and ongoing FY26 support.
- Assisted the Survival Center through food collection efforts and upcoming grant funding for continued services.
- Completed ALICE training for emergency preparedness, awareness, and prevention.
- Achieved Advanced CPR certification.
- Completed Food Safety and Allergen Awareness training.
- Provided integrated support for University of Massachusetts Amherst unsanctioned March event, including launching the first-ever hydration station with high utilization.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To create policies, procedures, and protocols and continue to develop working relationships with community stakeholders (Craig's Doors, Clinical Support Options, Amherst Survival Center, the local colleges and university, Eliot Homeless Services, etc.) and Town departments (Police, Fire, Senior Center, DEI, Public Health, DPW, Recreation, Jones Library, public schools, Town Clerk, Community Participation Officers).
- To host quarterly public forums with Community Stakeholders and Town Residents to uphold contractual obligations.
- To provide on-going professional development training for CRESS Responders including core competencies such as racial justice, motivational interviewing, alternatives to suicide, hearing voices, and trauma-informed care.
- To establish additional call types with our public safety partners: police, fire, and dispatch to become fully operational in the Emergency Comunications Center.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To expand department staffing to include administrative assistant, assistant director, and clinical component. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To expand dispatch call types. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To expand connections to local social service organizations and agencies. **Ongoing**
- To join UMass/Town of Amherst on-call meeting group. **Ongoing**
- To implement software for data collection (Qualtrics) to capture the qualitative and quantitative impact of the CRESS Department. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To expand department staffing to include administrative support and a clinical component.
- To expand dispatch call types.
- To expand connections to local social service organizations and agencies.
- To participate in University/Town on-call meeting group.

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	334,827	429,950	409,272	499,640	522,808	23,168	4.6%
Operating Expenses	$	9,474	25,314	11,392	23,000	29,000	6,000	26.1%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	344,302	455,264	420,664	522,640	551,808	29,168	5.6%

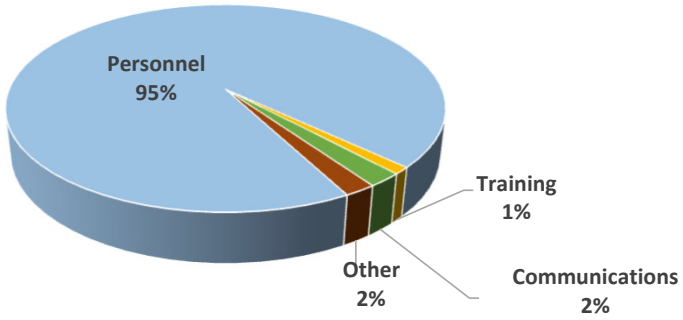
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for one Director, one Administrative Assistant, and six Community Responders.

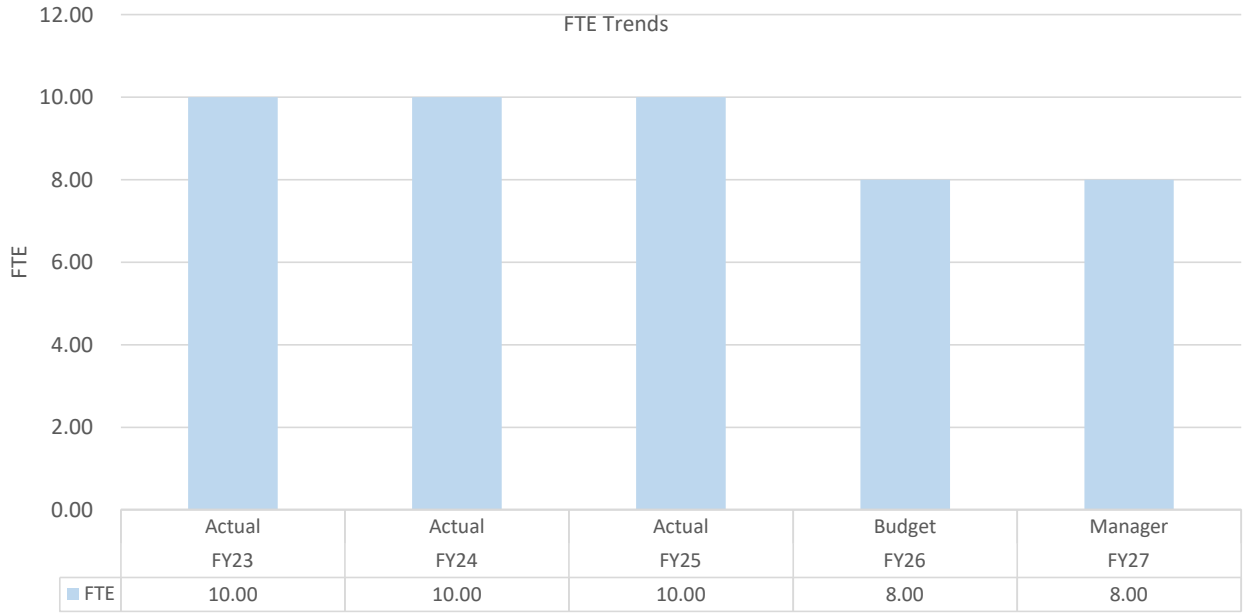
Operating Expenses include training, office supplies, vehicle maintenance, communications, uniforms, and dues and subscriptions.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas. Operating Expenses increasing due to the addition of supply funding as part of a transition from an expiring grant.



Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Service Levels:	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Total calls for service	-	-	199	502	759
Total Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) calls (began 12/18/23)	-	-	25	502	759
Direct calls for service (bypassed from dispatch)	-	-	198	492	744
Calls for service from dispatch	-	-	0	10	15
Community engagement/outreach	-	-	24	82	242
CRESS Follow-Up	-	-	4	43	74
CRESS Wellbeing Check	-	-	10	18	36
CRESS Mental Health	-	-	1	4	2
CRESS Assist Neighbor	-	-	101	119	246
CRESS Assist Business/Agency (includes departments)	-	-	29	153	80
CRESS Admin	-	-	-	80	22
CRESS Assist AFD	-	-	-	1	5
CRESS Assist APD	-	-	-	1	3
CRESS Transport	-	-	-	1	49

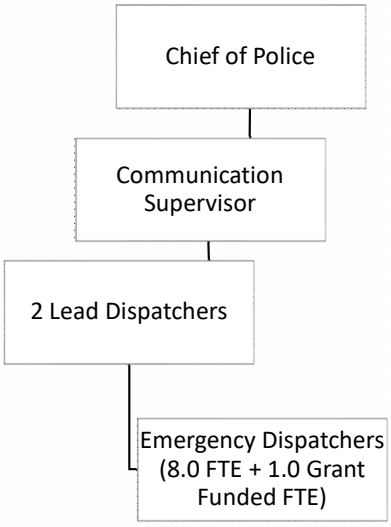
Notable Trends:
The department is still ramping up its response and the types of calls it responds to. The trends above should continue to rise in the coming years.

For more information, visit the CRESS Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3655/Community-Responders-for-Equity-Safety-S

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Function: To provide the public with the vital link to emergency services and to provide emergency service professionals who deliver expedient, courteous, and quality service. The Dispatch Center strives for excellence through dedication, training, and teamwork. This expectation of excellence extends beyond the Amherst border to neighbors in Pelham, Leverett, and Shutesbury.

Organization:



(Photo of Amherst Emergency Communications Center)

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Filled second lead dispatcher position.
- Onboarded CRESS to dispatch.
- Participated in multiple public events to promote 911 education.
- Collaborated with Amherst College to host state 911 training for local dispatch centers.
- Maintained grant funding for one dispatch position plus overtime costs.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain health and safety standards, while continuing to staff a 24/7 operation.
- To work with the State 911 department to obtain necessary training to maintain certification.
- To maintain mandatory staffing levels while balancing long- and short-term leaves.
- To attract qualified candidates for open telecommunicator positions.
- To continue to upgrade the back-up communications center as new technology becomes available.
- To renovate the Emergency Communications Center to address space and ergonomic issues.
- To replace radio console equipment.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To further integrate the Community Responders for Equity, Safety and Service (CRESS) into our dispatch policies and procedures. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To host State 911 approved and funded trainings. **Accomplished**
- To extend Police radio channel redundancy and to address known radio dead spots in Town through push to talk technology. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To investigate replacement, refresh, or upgrade of the computer aided dispatch software. **Ongoing**
- To address the need for proper staffing levels to provide coverage for contractual leaves. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To extend Police radio channel redundancy and to address known radio dead spots in Town through push to talk technology.
- To investigate replacement, refresh, or upgrade of the computer aided dispatch software.
- To address the need for proper staffing levels to provide coverage for contractual leaves.
- To further integrate the Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service (CRESS) into our dispatch policies and procedures.
- To find alternative sources of funding to increase training minimums of telecommunicators.

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	743,983	778,820	787,888	815,902	816,765	863	0.1%
Operating Expenses	$	16,048	16,107	11,524	17,450	17,450	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	760,031	794,927	799,412	833,352	834,215	863	0.1%

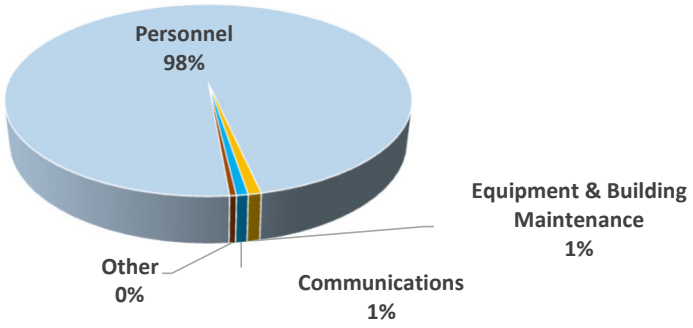
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for 11 full time Emergency Dispatchers and for overtime and holiday pay.

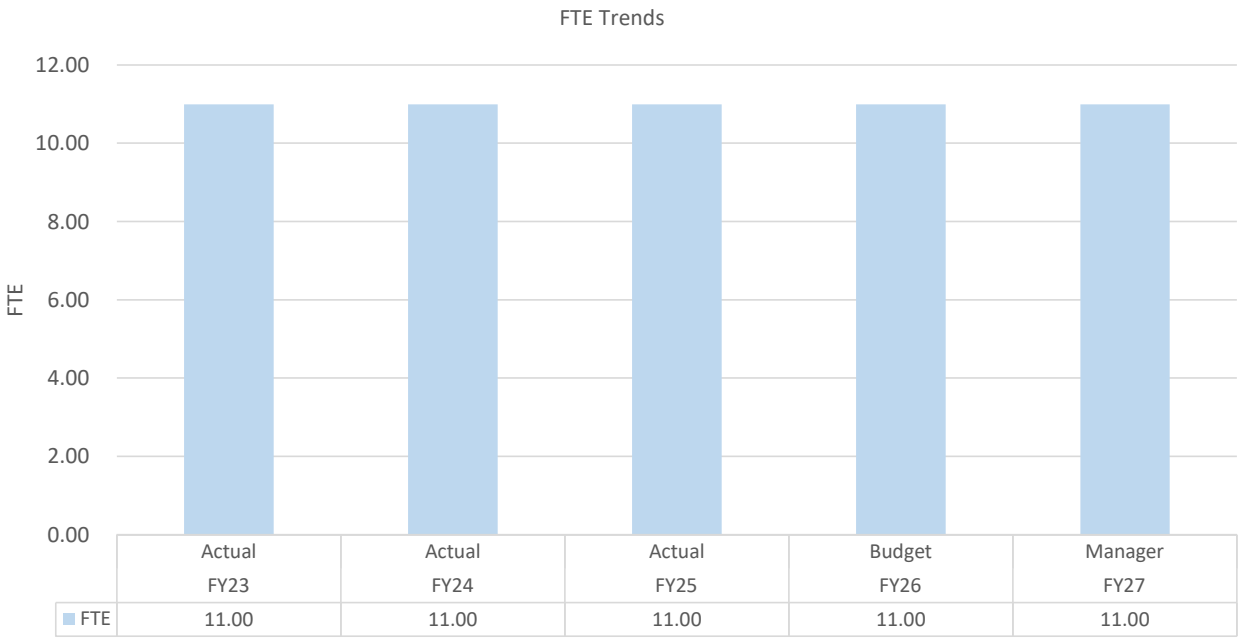
Other costs include maintenance contracts on radio communications equipment, specialized telephone/radio circuits, training, supplies, dues, and subscriptions.

Significant Changes:

None.



Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
911/Emergency Calls Received	5,920	6,822	5,994	11,866	11,251
Business Line Calls	54,722	59,420	61,325	65,813	58,147
Radio Transmissions	129,353	136,594	132,971	144,640	111,315
Calls:					
Police	16,336	16,380	17,709	17,463	18,869
Fire/In Amherst	1,042	1,174	1,196	1,555	1,688
EMS/In Amherst	3,148	3,956	3,706	3,928	4,144
EMS Mutual Aid Management	52	138	134	163	216
Medical Emergencies Requiring:					
Emergency Medical Dispatching	2,657	3,079	2,837	3,173	3,325
Station Coverage	173	285	238	232	325
Animal Control	446	478	440	498	487
CRESS CAD Documentation				502	1,007
CRESS Calls Dispatched				10	8
CSO CADs				242	711
Other Fire/EMS Service Requests					
Leverett (E)	100	108	124	158	134
Pelham (E)	111	118	140	160	148
Shutesbury (E)	77	103	101	80	65
Mutual Aid (E)	98	158	247	187	187
Mutual Aid (F)	8	19	12	13	22
Out of District Paramedic Intercept	15	12	21	20	30
CAD Calls Initiated	21,464	23,217	20,509	24,549	28,266
Burning Permits Processed	328	453	311	396	357
Fire Service Inspections	436	489	342	269	211

Notable Trends:

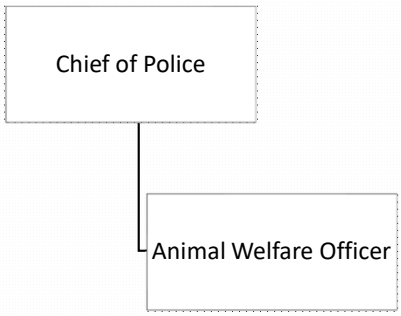
Calls for police, fire and EMS services are steadily rising each year.

For more information, visit the Communications Center webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/282/Communications

PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Function: Animal Welfare is committed to protecting the health and safety of the community through the effective control of animals. The Town provides responsible pet care through public education of the leash law, license requirements, and other Town policies relative to the welfare of animals. Animal Welfare strives to find solutions to address disputes with and between dog owners.

Organization:



(Photo of Animal Welfare Officer, Carol Hepburn)

PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Successfully managed the bird flu epidemic.
- Formalize a Memorandum of Understanding with the Town of Hadley for dog shelter usage.
- Rehoming animals while working with larger area shelters.
- Increased dog licensing by more than 5%.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- Managing the Memorandum of Agreement with the Town of Hadley for occasional use of the dog shelter.
- Managing the uptick in dead bird investigations due to the transmission of bird flu.
- Continuing to educate and enforce the leash law which is a constant issue.
- Achieving 100% compliance with dog licensing.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To work with the Conservation Department to support management of new trails at Hickory Ridge and Robert Frost trails. **Ongoing**
- To continue inspections of all barns with farm animals. **Ongoing**
- To continue monthly inspections of farm animals per agreement with the MSPCA from a previous investigation. **Ongoing**
- To continue the successful placement of 100% for all animals brought to the shelter through adoption, rescue organizations, and by utilizing foster homes. **Accomplished/Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To work with the Conservation Department to support management of new trails at Hickory Ridge and Robert Frost trails.
- To continue inspections of all barns with farm animals.
- To continue monthly inspections of farm animals per agreement with the MSPCA from a previous investigation.
- To continue the successful placement of 100% for all animals brought to the shelter through adoption, rescue organizations, and by utilizing foster homes.

PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	62,286	62,657	64,257	65,892	67,322	117	0.2%
Operating Expenses	$	5,809	5,032	5,462	7,505	7,505	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	68,095	67,689	69,719	73,397	74,827	1,430	1.9%

Major Components:

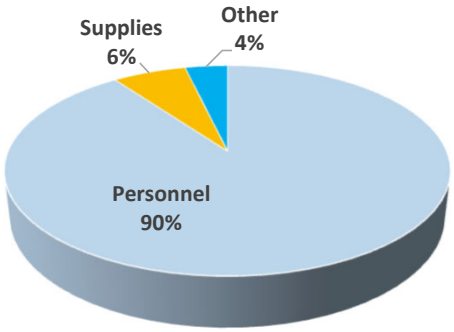
Personnel Services include funding for a full-time Animal Welfare Officer and overtime.

Supplies, provide for gasoline and other vehicle supplies, uniforms, and office supplies.

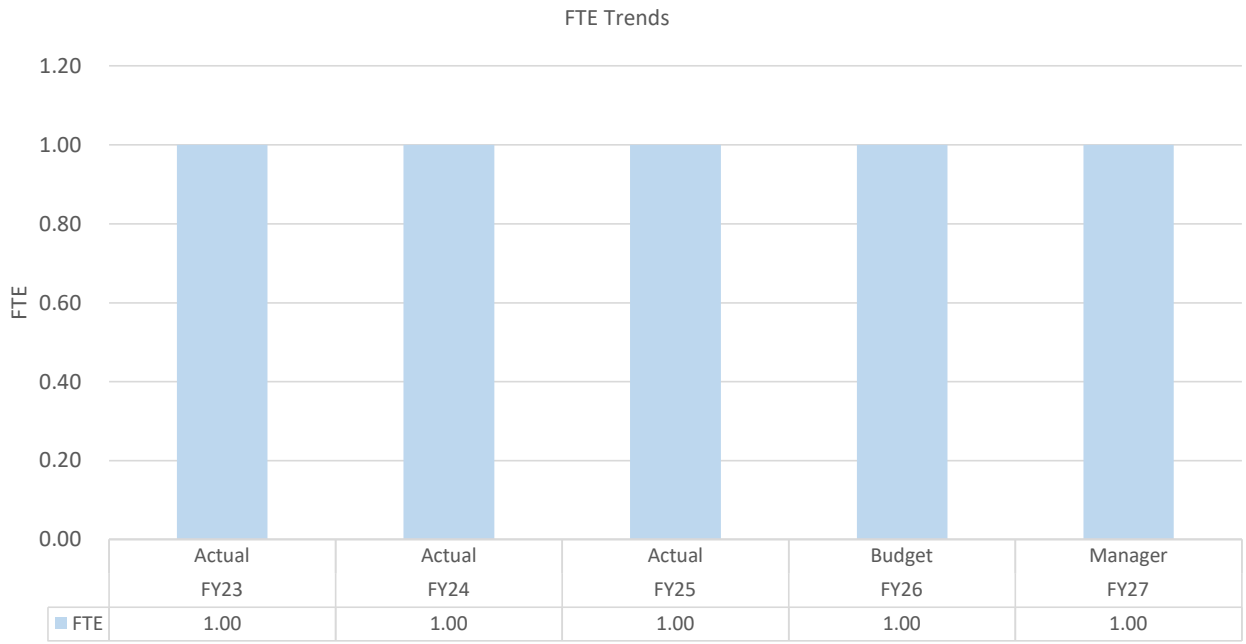
Other expenses include funds for veterinary expenses, vehicle maintenance, telephone, dog food, and other miscellaneous expenses.

Significant Changes:

None.



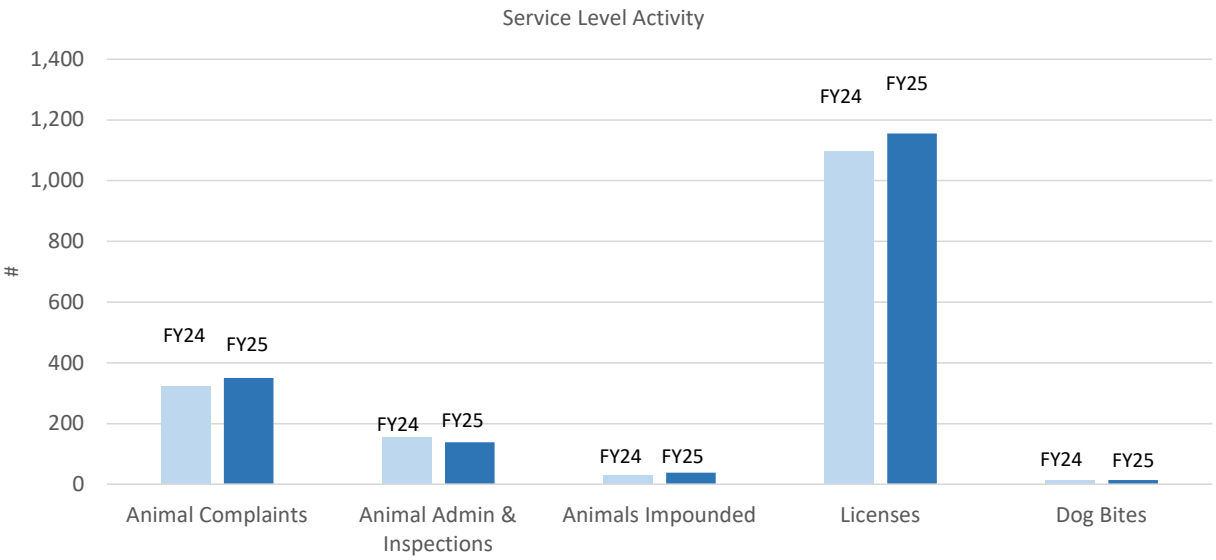
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Animal Complaints	399	359	345	324	350
Animal Admin & Inspections	67	125	131	153	138
Animals Impounded	18	21	38	29	38
Licenses	1,133	949	1,054	1,096	1,155
Dog Bites	13	10	9	12	14

Notable Trends:
None.

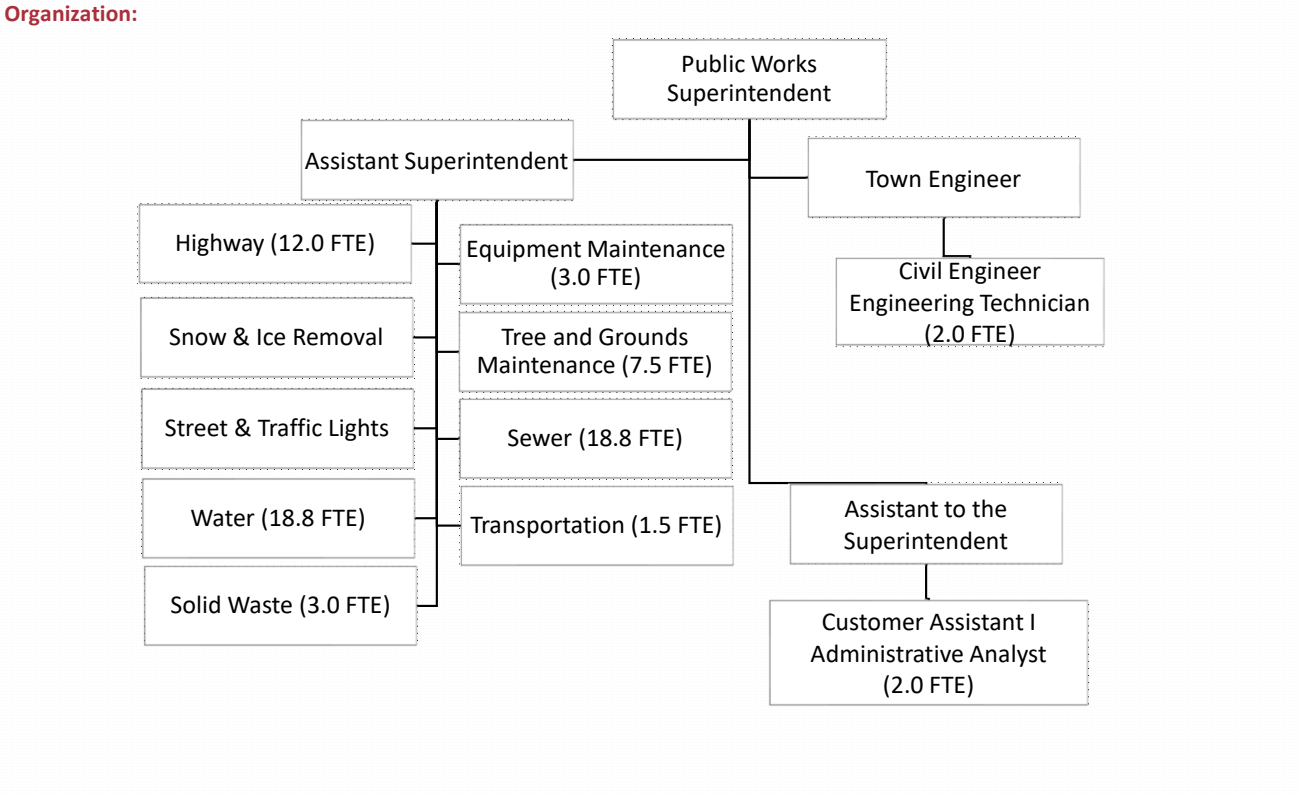


For more information, visit the Animal Welfare webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/279/Animal-Welfare

PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Function: To manage all public works functions and activities in a manner that protects the health and safety of Amherst residents and visitors.

Organization:



(Photo of the revitalized North Common)

PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Conducted interviews to fill 18 vacancies. Filled 15 and are in the process of filling 3 more; nearly 1/3 of the DPW positions.
- Awarded a grant with the Town of Pelham for a sewer and water project in Pelham.
- Awarded a grant with the Town of Hadley to continue looking at design of sewer connection between two communities.
- Staffed the DPW building committee.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To recruit and maintain a qualified and capable Public Works staff while managing significant retirement and turnover in the public works field with a regional shortfall of skilled workers.
- To implement the next phase of the Environmental Protection Agency's Phase II Stormwater program. This will include identifying stormwater outfalls and potential areas of concern.
- To continue to develop and manage numerous Town projects.
- To balance the need to maintain the existing infrastructure with the newly built infrastructure with limited budget.
- To develop work plans with equipment that meet the Town's goal for carbon reduction while maintaining or improving service levels.
- To implement the next phase of the Department of Public Works (DPW) facility replacement project as recommended by the feasibility study.
- To develop funding and other strategies to address the need for road repairs.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue construction management of the replacement Centennial Water Treatment Facility. **Accomplished**
- To continue management of the schematic design phase of the DPW facilities plan including planning for transitioning to alternative locations to facilitate construction of the DPW. **Ongoing**
- To complete the construction of the 2025 Concrete Asphalt Rehabilitation Project (CARP, to include sidewalks on Chestnut Street, North Whitney and North Pleasant St). **Accomplished**
- To complete construction of upgraded sidewalks on North Pleasant Street near Puffton Village. **Accomplished**
- To begin construction of Amity Street and University Drive intersection improvements. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue the schematic and final design phase of the DPW facilities plan including planning for any transitioning to alternative locations to facilitate construction of a new DPW facility or facilities.
- To continue construction of the Amity Street and University Drive intersection improvements.
- To bid and construct the water and sewer line improvements in Pelham.

PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	396,385	429,124	427,432	437,625	461,143	23,518	5.4%
Operating Expenses	$	46,195	37,306	29,652	40,700	54,900	14,200	34.9%
Operating Capital	$	1,462	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	444,042	466,430	457,084	478,325	516,043	37,718	7.9%

Major Components:

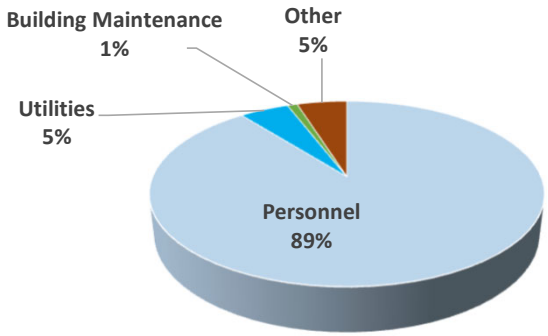
Personnel Services include salaries for the Superintendent of Public Works, an Administrative Assistant, and 1/3 each of the Assistant Superintendent/Operations Director, a Management Assistant, an Administrative Analyst, an Engineering Technician, the Town Engineer, and the Assistant Town Engineer shared with the Water and Sewer Funds. Building Maintenance, includes the cost of routine maintenance of the Public Works facility. Custodial and maintenance tasks are performed by staff in other public works budgets.

Utilities include heating fuel, electricity, and water and sewer.

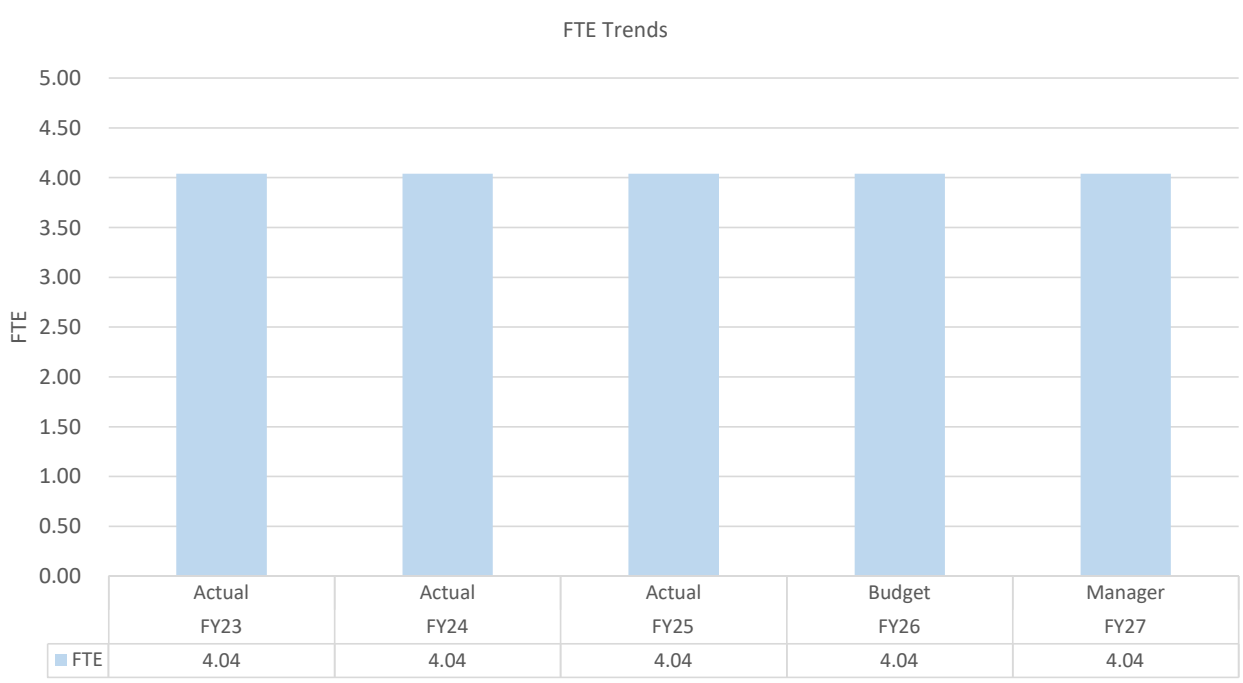
Other expenses include postage, office supplies, dues and subscriptions, etc.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas. Operating Expenses are increasing due to the addition of funds to offset the impacts of inflation on the department's budget.



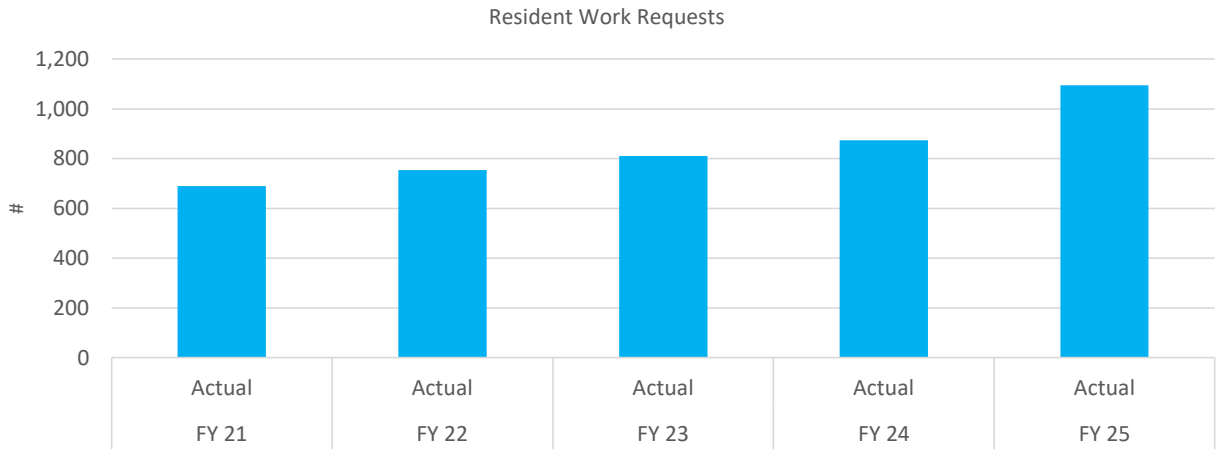
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Resident Work Requests	690	754	811	874	1,095
Driveway Permits	59	55	36	53	62
General Excavation Permits	81	51	61	65	43
Sale of Cemetery Lots	12	11	7	1	4
Specifications Prepared	6	13	11	15	11
Refuse Disposal Billing	675	623	628	523	956
Water Permits: New Services & Relays	21	13	12	13	13
Water & Wastewater Reports	240	240	240	240	240
Wastewater Reports to EPA	12	12	12	12	12
Sewer Entrance Permits	18	14	13	13	17
Committees Staffed	3	3	3	3	2
Subdivision (Review and Support to Planning Dept.)					
Engineering Review	0	2	0	2	3
Construction Oversight	6	7	4	1	1
Site Plan Review (private project reviews)	35	33	28	32	30
Project Design:					
In House	34	21	18	19	22
Consultant	16	7	4	3	2
Construction Oversight:					
Contractor Work	9	15	10	13	8
DPW Crews	6	6	5	2	2
Contractor/Consultant	6	5	3	4	2

Notable Trends:
Work requests by residents continues to increase.

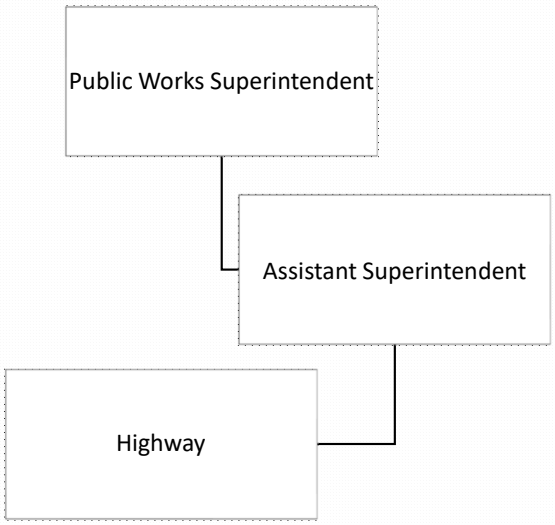


For more information, visit the Department of Public Works webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/149/Public-Works

PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Function: To maintain the highways, streets, and sidewalks of the Town at a safe usable level based on funding and user expectations. To provide support services to the other functional areas of the Department as needed.

Organization:



(Photo of DPW staff filling potholes)

PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed a temporary repair to the gravity sewer main near Greenleaves Apartments.
- Continued to provide service with the reduction of one employee and staff vacancies.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To effectively maintain roadside vegetation so that it is not an impediment to users of sidewalks, bike lanes, or the travel way.
- To retain current employees while recruiting replacements for current vacancies and provide training to upgrade employee skills.
- To address legacy private roads that need to be maintained by the property owners or properly upgraded and transferred to become public ways.
- To address, effectively and efficiently, resident work requests in the performance of routine and planned work.
- To examine possible changes to the Division's structure to handle the upcoming storm water permit requirements.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To repave two miles of roads, depending on funding available. **Accomplished**
- To repave 1-2 miles of sidewalk. **Accomplished**
- To provide weekly street sweeping downtown, weather permitting. **Accomplished**
- To provide support to the various construction projects in Town. Specifically the Mill River ADA improvements. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To push back the soil on the edges of the roads in town to improve storm runoff.
- To fix broken berm/curbing on roads that are not being repaved this year.
- To repave two miles of roads or more, depending on funding available.
- To repave 1-2 miles of sidewalk.
- To provide weekly street sweeping downtown, weather permitting.
- To provide support to the various construction projects in Town, specifically the Mill River accessibility improvements.

PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	721,999	820,877	861,648	845,291	915,758	70,467	8.3%
Operating Expenses	$	41,431	57,317	52,896	59,611	104,300	44,689	75.0%
Operating Capital	$	-	2,550	4,118	7,000	4,000	(3,000)	-42.9%
Total Appropriation	$	763,430	880,744	918,661	911,902	1,024,058	112,156	12.3%

Major Components:

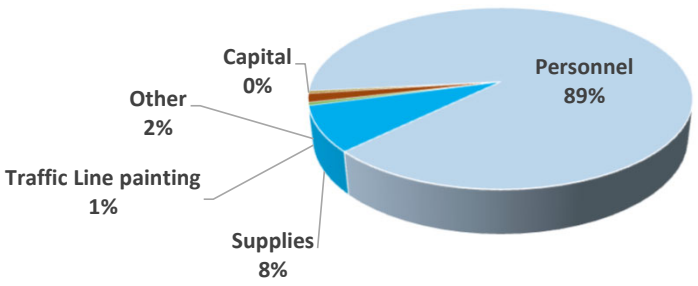
Personnel Services include salaries for a Division Director, 3 Senior Crew Supervisors, 1 Sign Maintenance Worker, 3 Skilled Laborers/Truck Drivers (two shared with the Sewer Fund), and 5 Equipment Operators (two shared with Sewer). Also included is $20,000 for overtime and $10,000 for extra help.

Supplies, include materials for road maintenance: asphalt, concrete, culverts, stone and gravel, signs, and small tools.

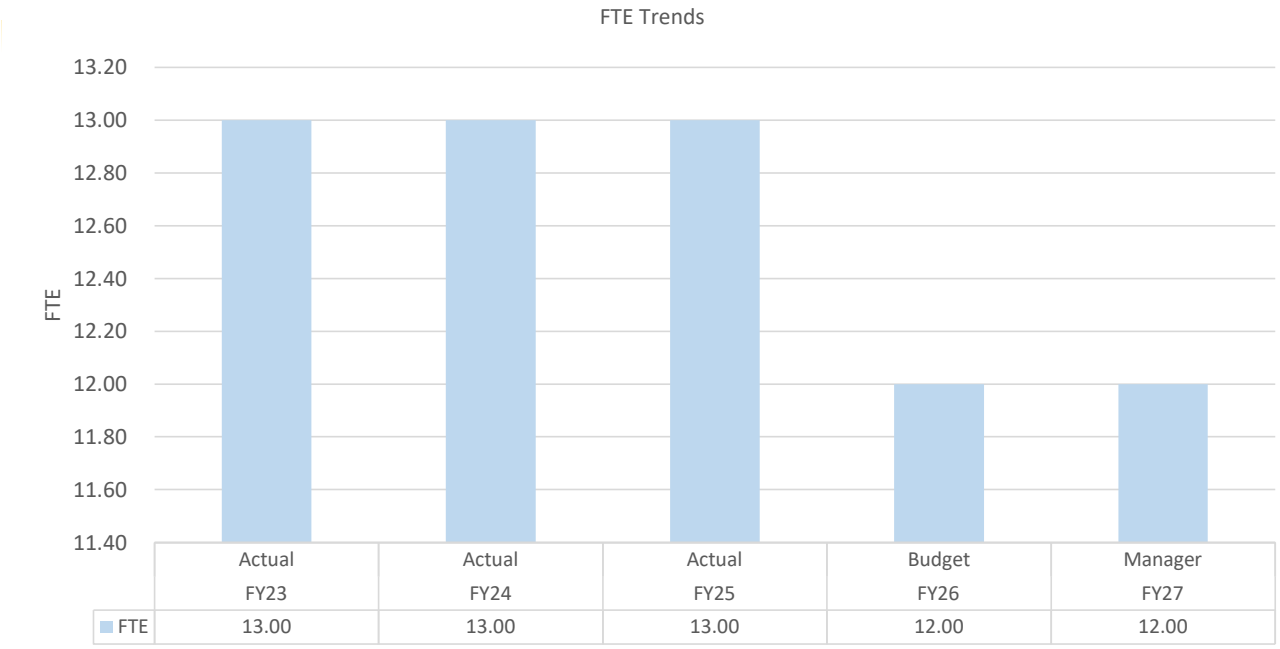
Purchase of services includes $5,000 for traffic line painting.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services are increasing due to steps/colas. Operating Expenses are increasing due to the addition of funds to offset the impacts of inflation.



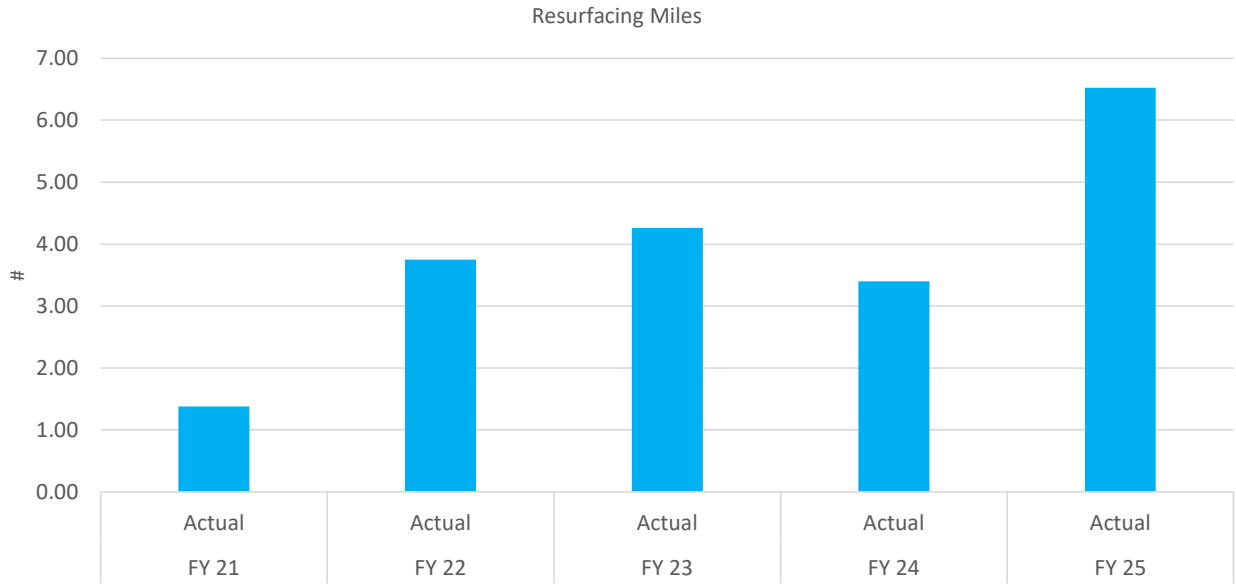
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Resurfacing (mi)	1.38	3.75	4.26	3.4	6.53
Drainage Pipe Installed (ft)	60	250	300	275	0
Catch Basins Cleaned	100	125	100	78	63
Road Sweeping (mi)	270	270	275	275	275
Drainage Ditch Cleaning (mi)	2	2	2	2	2
Street & Traffic Sign Work Requests	115	113	78	69	47
General Street Maintenance:					
Pothole Patching (tons)	580	570	650	600	700
Street Center Line Painting (ft)	94,351	76,435	145,185	123,561	343,375
Crosswalks Painted	193	155	93	108	155
Road Edge Line Painting (ft)	6,980	63,488	173,937	158,179	230,601
Granite Curbing Repaired or Installed (ft)	17,785	0	0	30	0
Repairs to Sidewalks (linear ft)	20	400	600	230	300
New Sidewalk (linear ft)	700	0	2,200	5,438	2,700
Sewer Pipe Installed (ft)	300	120	150	170	30
Roadside Mowing (mi)	104	325	325	325	325
Crack Sealing (mi)	3.25	6.95	6.2	12.74	7.12
Shimming (tons)	0	0	11	0	0

Notable Trends:
The Town's investment in road improvements can be seen in the uptick in miles resurfaced and increased patching tonnage.

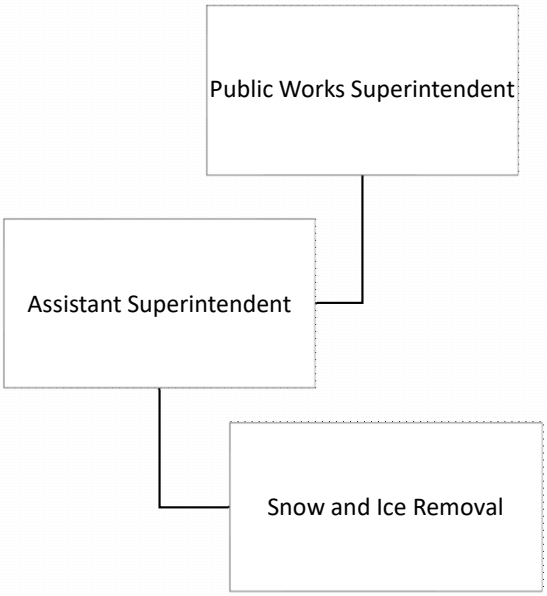


For more information, visit the DPW Highways webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/153/Highways

PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Function: To ensure the safety of motorists and pedestrians using public ways during winter weather. To provide access for emergency vehicles by ensuring that ice and snow operations are performed in a timely fashion.

Organization:



(Photo of dump truck plow)

PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Met winter requirements with current staff.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To provide desired level of snow removal services with a diminishing fleet and the community's desire to move away from carbon-fueled vehicles.
- To communicate progress of snow removal.
- To improve sanding controls to apply product where and when needed.
- To adjust winter operations to meet changing demands in winter services and longer duration storms.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To train and integrate new employees into the Town's snow operations processes**. Ongoing**
- To reduce chemical usage on Town roads. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To train and integrate new employees into the Town's snow operations processes.
- To reduce chemical usage on Town roads.

PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	43,189	43,133	89,888	71,750	71,750	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	170,819	105,301	321,295	203,660	203,660	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	2,268	-	5,000	5,000	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	214,008	150,703	411,184	280,410	280,410	-	--

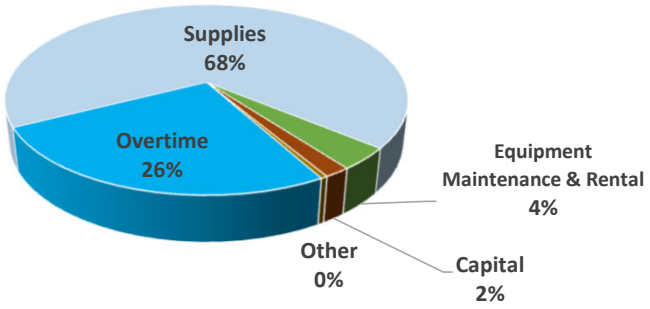
Major Components:

Overtime provides funds for snowplowing. Plowing done during the workday is charged to other Public Works Department budgets. Plowing required beyond the workday, or beyond an employee's 40 hour workweek, is charged to this budget as overtime.

Equipment Maintenance, $7,000, includes the cost of vehicle supplies such as wiper blades, flashers, beacon lights, chains, etc. Equipment Rental, $3,500, provides funds to rent dump trucks for snow removal.

Supplies, $191,860, include salt, calcium chloride, Ice Ban Magic, sand, gasoline, and diesel.

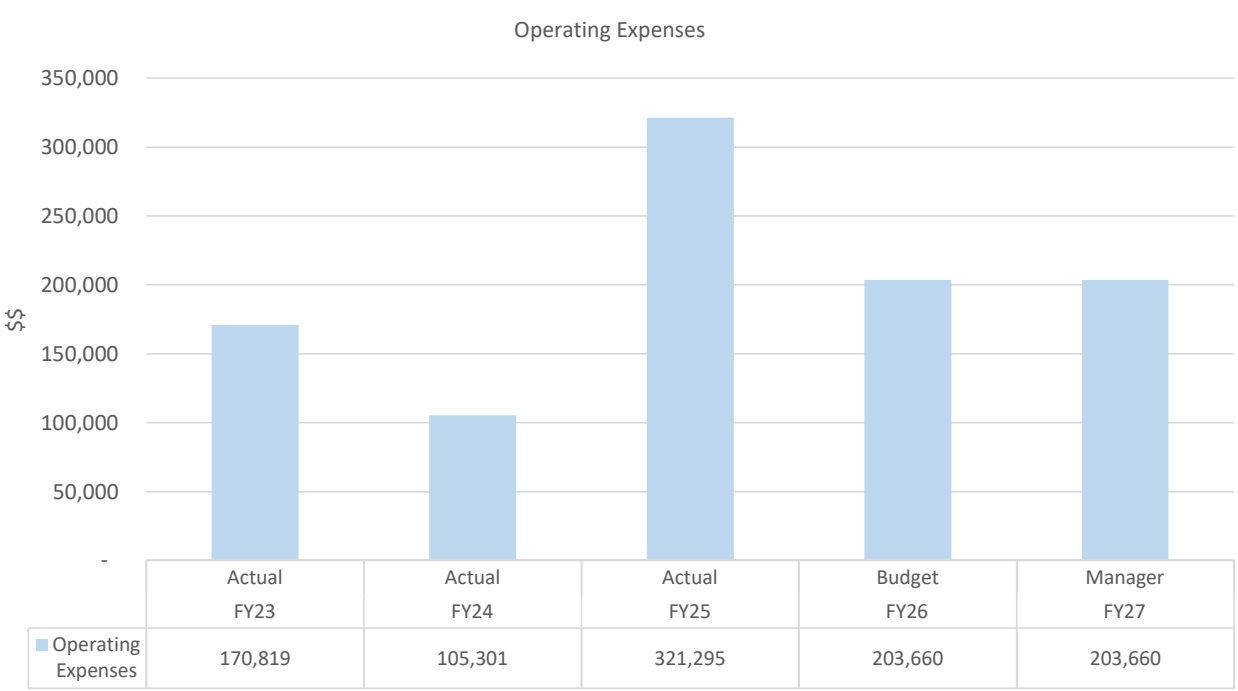
Capital provides for the replacement of a snowplow, part of an annual replacement program.



Significant Changes:

No change.

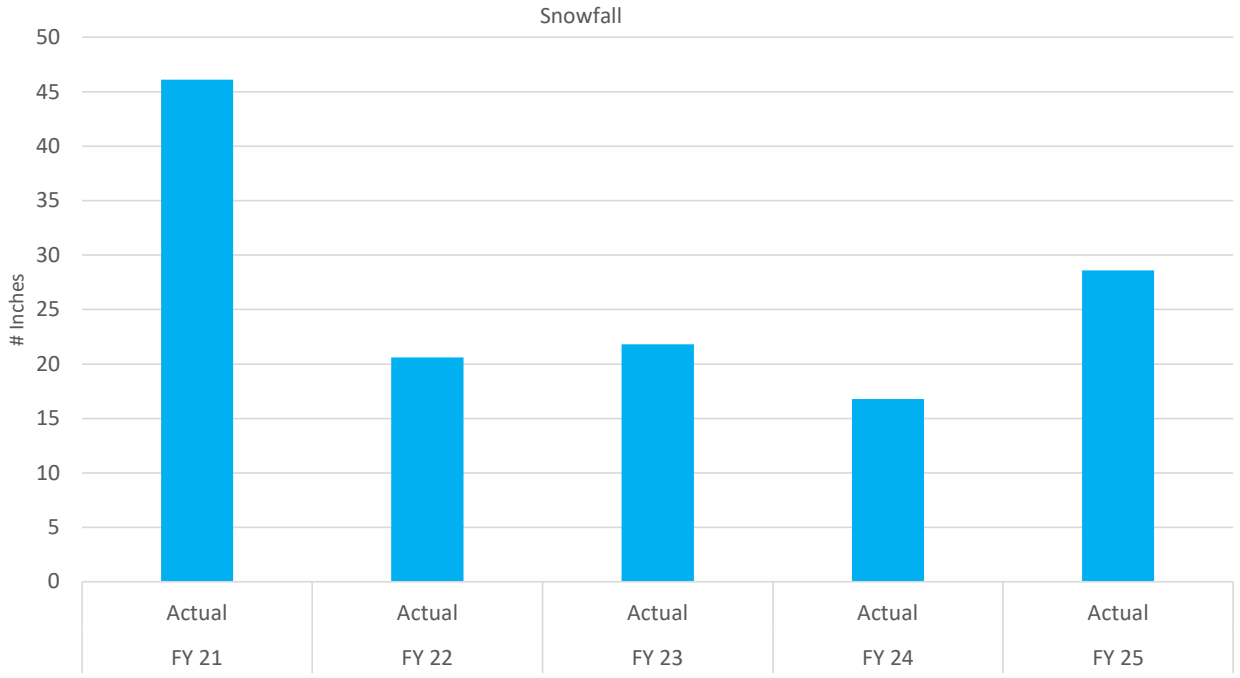
Expenditure Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Lane Miles Plowed	256	256	256	256	256
Sidewalk Miles Plowed	62	62	62	62	62
Snow Storms	7	15	12	13	23
Snow Fall (inches)	46.1	20.6	21.8	16.8	28.6
Sand Used (tons)	40	109	100	75	208
Salt Used (tons)	2,500	1,840	1,420	814	2,741
Ice Ban Magic (gal)	2,000	0	2,000	0	0

Notable Trends:
The number of snow storms and severity of the winter impact the amount of material (salt and sand) that is used.

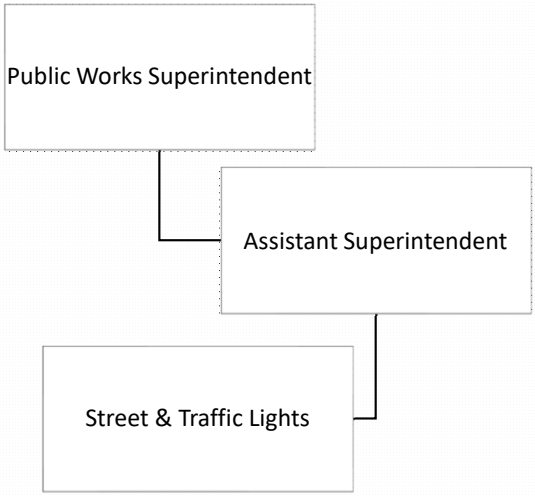


For more information, visit the DPW Snow & Ice webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/165/Snow-Ice

PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

Function: To ensure the safety of those using public ways by maintaining Town owned street lights and pedestrian and traffic signals in operating condition.

Organization:



(Photot of DPW staff installing a new streetlight on Main Street.)

PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed the electrical work at Southeast Street Sewer Pump Station #4 to install the new system and remove the old Station.
- Replaced the Program Logic Control Computer for Stanley Street Sewer Pump Station.
- Completed the wiring and light installation for the North Common Revitalization Project.
- Supported the house move from Southeast Street to Harkness Road.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To quickly and efficiently resolve backlogged SeeClickFix issues and tasks.
- To find and take classes and courses to continue to help minimize and repair PLC and Automation processes that arise.
- To continue to work with Dean Tech Vocational High School in Holyoke and to provide Co-op opportunities to train students in the electrical field.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To install 'NoTraffic' smart intersection systems at the Main Street/Amity Street intersection. **Ongoing**
- To remove traffic intersection of Amity Street/University Drive for upcoming roundabout project **Ongoing**
- To install lighting at North Pleasant Street and Kendrick Park. **Ongoing**
- To complete installation of lighting for North Common Revitalization project. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To support the Amity Street and University Drive Roundabout installation.
- To install a NoTraffic system at the Main Street and Amity Street intersection.
- To catch up on the street light issues now that the new bucket truck has arrived.
- To reinstall one of the West Street Pump Station motors that needs to be reworked.
- To install lighting at North Pleasant Street and Kendrick Park.

PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

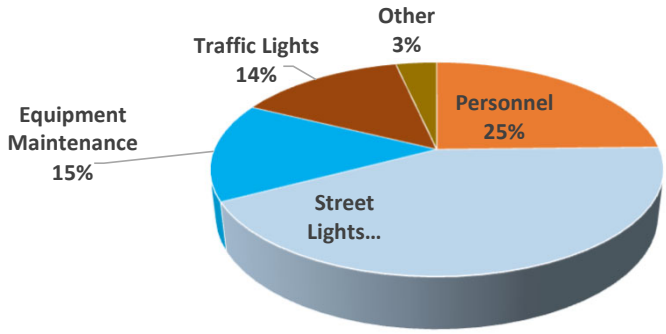
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	27,144	22,125	27,535	30,469	32,971	2,502	8.2%
Operating Expenses	$	99,038	113,777	87,986	99,650	100,750	1,100	1.1%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	126,183	135,902	115,521	130,119	133,721	3,602	2.8%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for 1/3 Division Supervisor shared with the Water and Sewer Funds.

Street lighting budget provides for electricity and maintenance of 1,200+ streetlights. Traffic lighting budget provides electricity for 12 signalized intersections. Equipment Maintenance provides the funds for the parts and service necessary to maintain traffic lights.

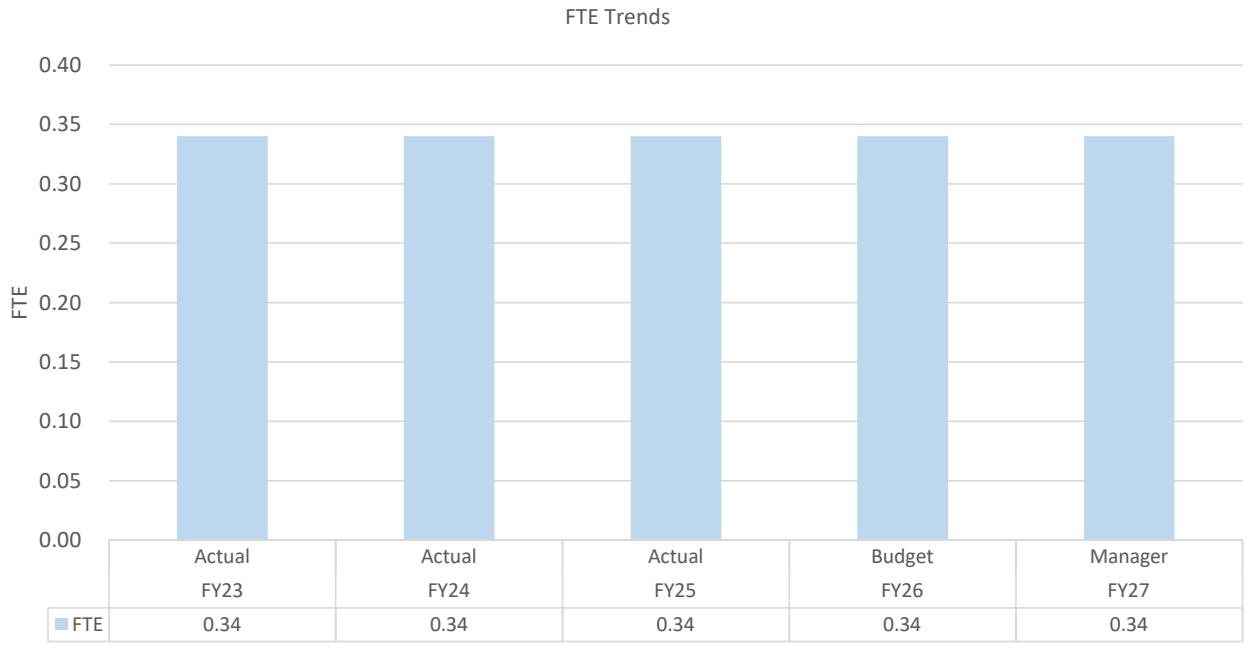
Other includes supplies.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected steps/colas.

Staffing Trends:

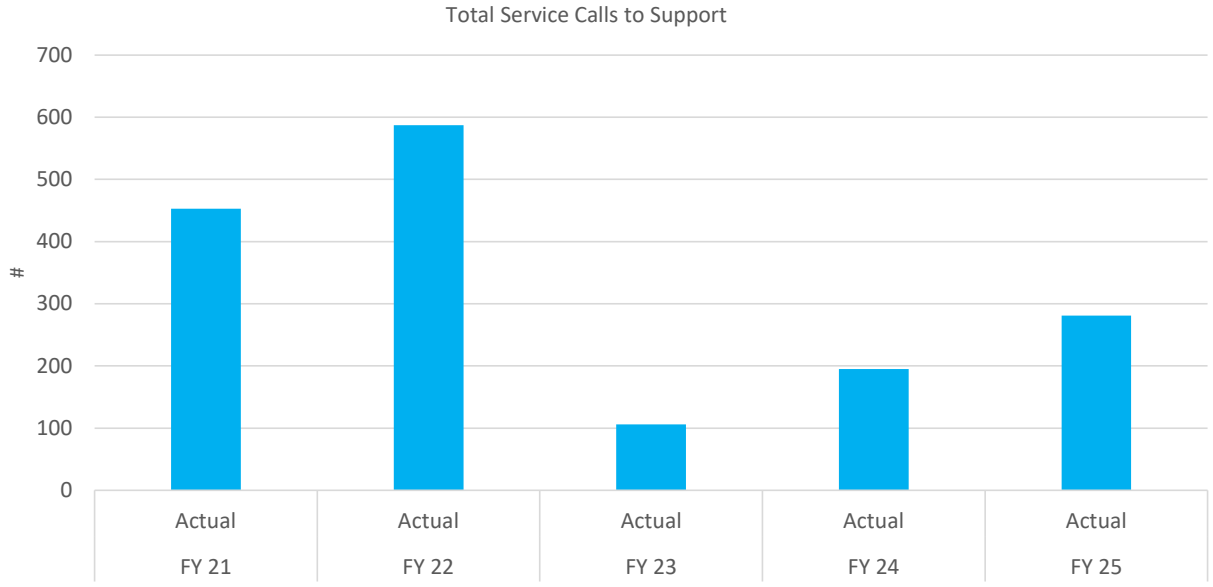


PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Streetlights Maintained	1,198	1,198	1,198	1,209	1,342
School Zone Lights Maintained	7	9	9	9	9
Traffic Lights Maintained	13	13	12	12	12
Traffic Light Knockdowns	7	4	1	5	9
Street Light Trouble Calls	191	201	156	105	35
Service Calls to Support:					
Water Division	121	187	15	63	55
Wastewater Division	165	208	30	47	95
Parking	4	0	0	0	6
Tree & Grounds	48	78	10	20	30
DPW Buildings	71	56	25	23	35
Police and Fire	7	12	10	9	15
Town Hall	16	10	2	1	11
Schools	4	20	0	13	2
Amherst BID	12	6	4	15	25
Bangs Center	5	10	10	4	7

Notable Trends:

The number of streetlights maintained has grown in the past couple years as more lights are added.

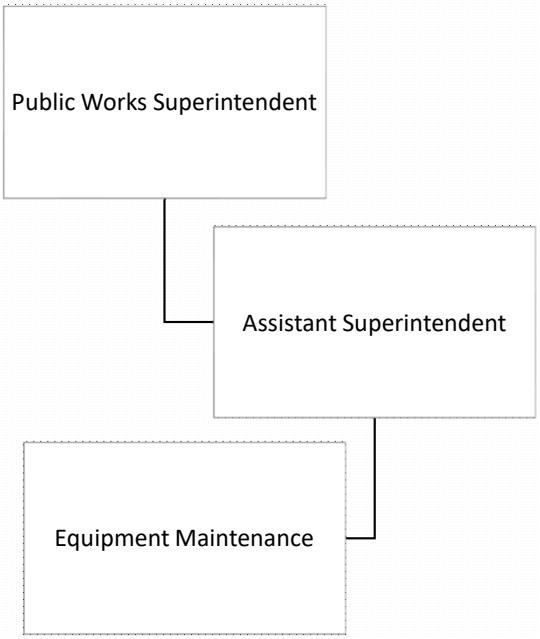


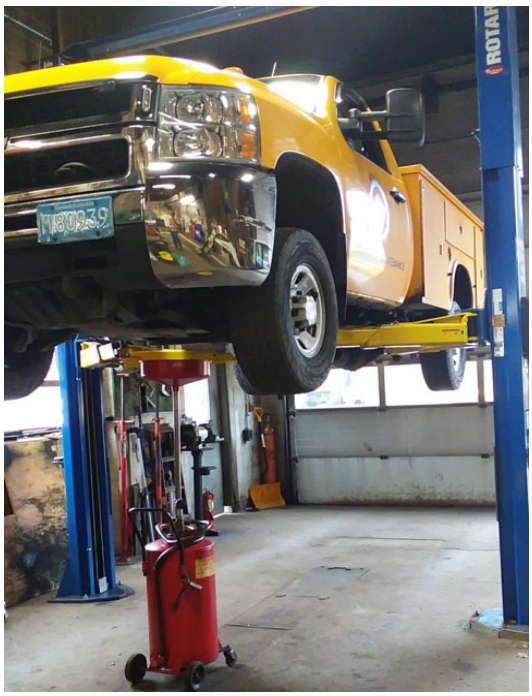
For more information, visit the DPW Street & Traffic Lights webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/1835/Street-and-Traffic-Lights

PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Function: To enable the other divisions to meet their missions by maintaining the Department's fleet of vehicles, construction equipment, and various portable pieces of equipment in excellent operating condition.

Organization:





(Photo of maintenance shop)

PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Updated the vehicle software used to trouble shoot Town vehicles.
- Completed the conversion of truck #15 from a bucket truck to a dump truck and plow. Truck #15 aerial lift was damaged beyond use in an accident. The truck chassis and frame were usable.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to meet daily vehicle maintenance needs, repair break downs, and perform routine State Inspections on most Town vehicles.
- To evaluate a vehicle maintenance system.
- To maintain the fleet with severe supply chain shortages on parts.
- To continue planning and transition to an electric/hybrid fleet when possible.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue to provide vehicle inspections for Town vehicles. **Ongoing**
- To repurpose salvaged bucket truck chassis to be used as a dump/flatbed truck. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue to provide vehicle inspections for Town vehicles.
- To maintain the Town's fleet.

PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	194,056	206,835	214,974	222,696	254,650	31,954	14.3%
Operating Expenses	$	123,263	93,182	85,706	96,221	99,865	3,644	3.8%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	3,918	2,500	2,500	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	317,319	300,017	304,597	321,417	357,015	35,598	11.1%

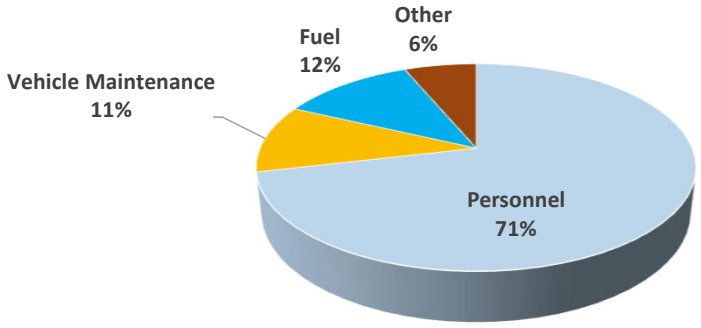
Major Components:

Personnel Services provide for a Supervisor/Mechanic and two Mechanics.

Vehicle maintenance, $38,000, includes funds for vehicle parts and supplies for approximately 53 vehicles.

Fuel includes $41,784 for gas and diesel for all DPW general fund vehicles.

Operating Capital provides funds for small equipment replacement.



Significant Changes:

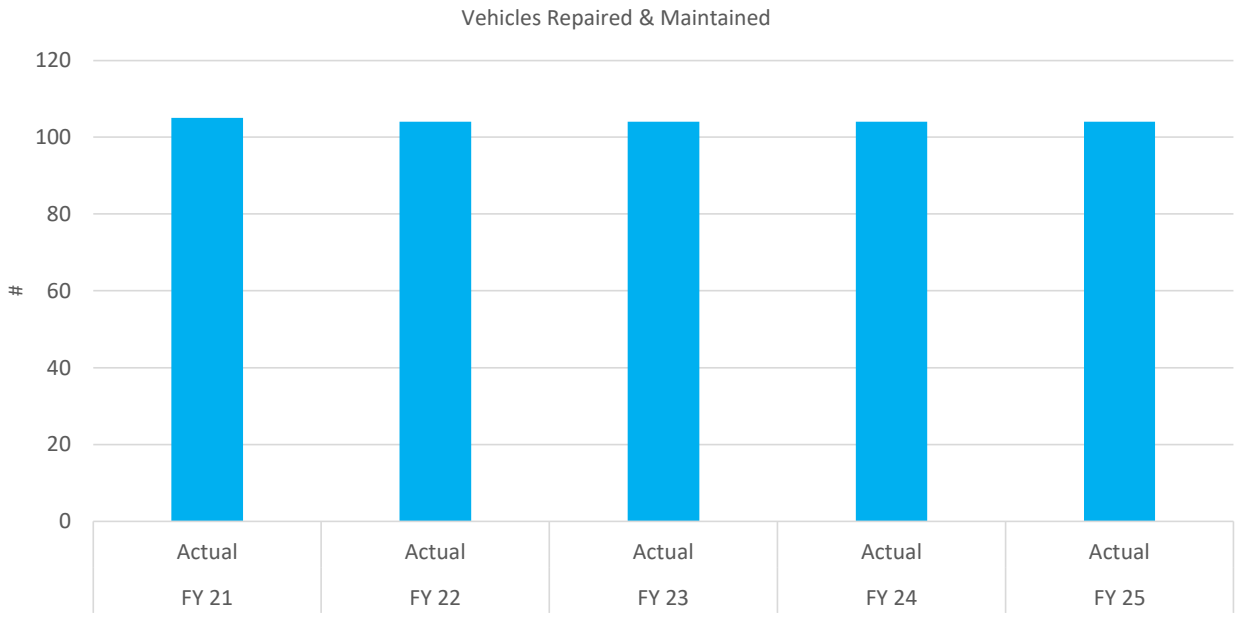
Personnel Services increase due to projected steps/colas.

Staffing Trends:

PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Vehicles Repaired & Maintained	105	104	104	104	104
Equipment Repaired & Maintained	180	180	180	180	180
Gasoline Consumption (gal)	30,535	30,581	25,841	26,701	26,704
Oil Supplies (gal)	900	875	875	845	875
Diesel Consumption (gal)	16,448	18,449	17,448	17,405	14,641

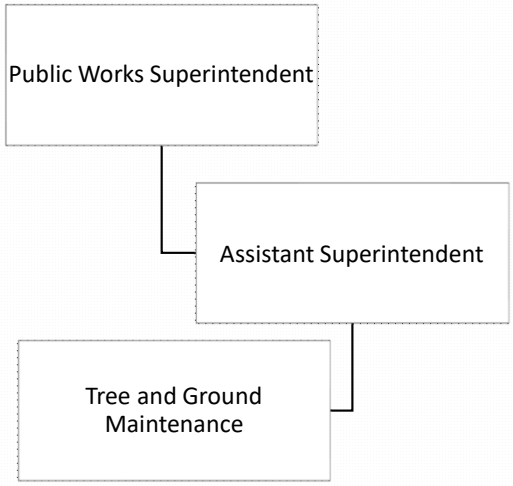
Notable Trends:
None.



PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Function: Enhance the quality of life for residents and the business community by providing an exceptional, diverse, and healthy urban forest, connected by a system of parks, cemeteries, open spaces, and recreational facilities that are safe, accessible, and well maintained.

Organization:



(Photo of Public Shade Tree members planting a red maple tree at the Munson Memorial Library)

PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Installed a new Becsy7 water controllers at Groff Spray Park and Mill River filter rooms. This controller is connected to new fiber optics that allow remote monitoring of the filtration systems. This improves the water quality at the facilities. The work was done with support from the Information & Technology Department and the DPW Electric Division.
- Installed two new main drains in War Memorial Pool bringing the pool into compliance with Virginia Graeme Baker Pool and Spa Safety Act (VGBA).
- Applied Beech Leaf Disease treatment to the Beech trees on the South Common and North Common.
- Began maintenance of the new North Common utilizing existing staff and funds.
- Worked with the DPW Engineering staff to improve ADA access at the Mill River Recreation area and Pavilion.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- Accelerated tree mortality from Maple decline, Emerald Ash Borer infestation and drought has placed unusual demands on existing staff.
- Expectations for service levels for athletic fields, including fields owned by the Regional School District, and park infrastructure is a significant challenge.
- Attracting, training, and retaining employees.
- Managing the rapidly growing wood waste resource and the need to develop a wood bank for wood from public shade trees.
- To evaluate the need for and siting of additional cemetery land.
- To work with Schools and Recreation to develop consolidated grounds maintenance activities.
- To renovate the fountain in Sweetser Park.
- To upgrade the War Memorial pool bathhouse.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To complete Memorandum of Agreement with Schools, Recreation and Department of Public Works for field usage. **Ongoing**
- To complete the design for changes/upgrades to War Memorial Pool bath house. **Ongoing**
- To complete filtration systems at War Memorial Pool. **Accomplished**
- To work with Facilities to address the Traffic and Grounds building energy performance and deferred maintenance. **Ongoing**
- To seal the roof at War Memorial Pump house. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To complete a Memorandum of Agreement with Schools, Recreation and Department of Public Works for field usage.
- To complete the design for changes/upgrades to War Memorial Pool bath house.
- To work with Facilities to address the Traffic and Grounds building energy performance and deferred maintenance.
- To seal the roof at War Memorial Pump house.
- To explore creation of a Tree Crew Foreman position.

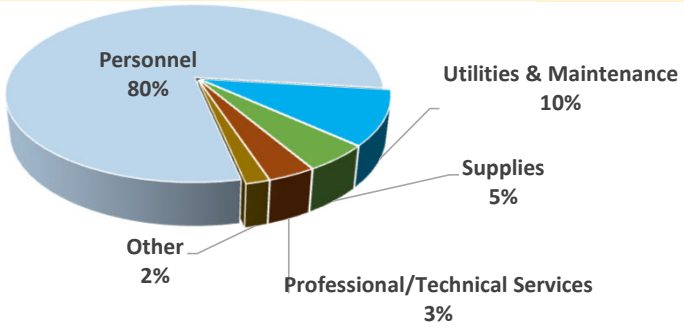
PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	463,473	472,703	484,844	524,513	541,359	16,846	3.2%
Operating Expenses	$	114,428	135,605	127,139	119,692	131,624	11,932	10.0%
Operating Capital	$	-	39	-	1,700	1,700	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	577,900	608,348	611,983	645,905	674,683	28,778	4.5%

Major Components:

Personnel Services provide salaries for a Division Director, a Crew Supervisor, 3 Maintenance Workers, two Laborers, and a Skilled Laborer/Truck Driver which is shared with the Transportation Fund. Utilities and Maintenance, $66,374, include funds for lighting parks and commons (electricity for Community Field not included) and providing field, equipment, and building maintenance at picnic areas and other park facilities. Supplies, $32,275, include funds for fertilizer, gas and diesel fuel, and materials necessary to maintain equipment and clean park facilities.

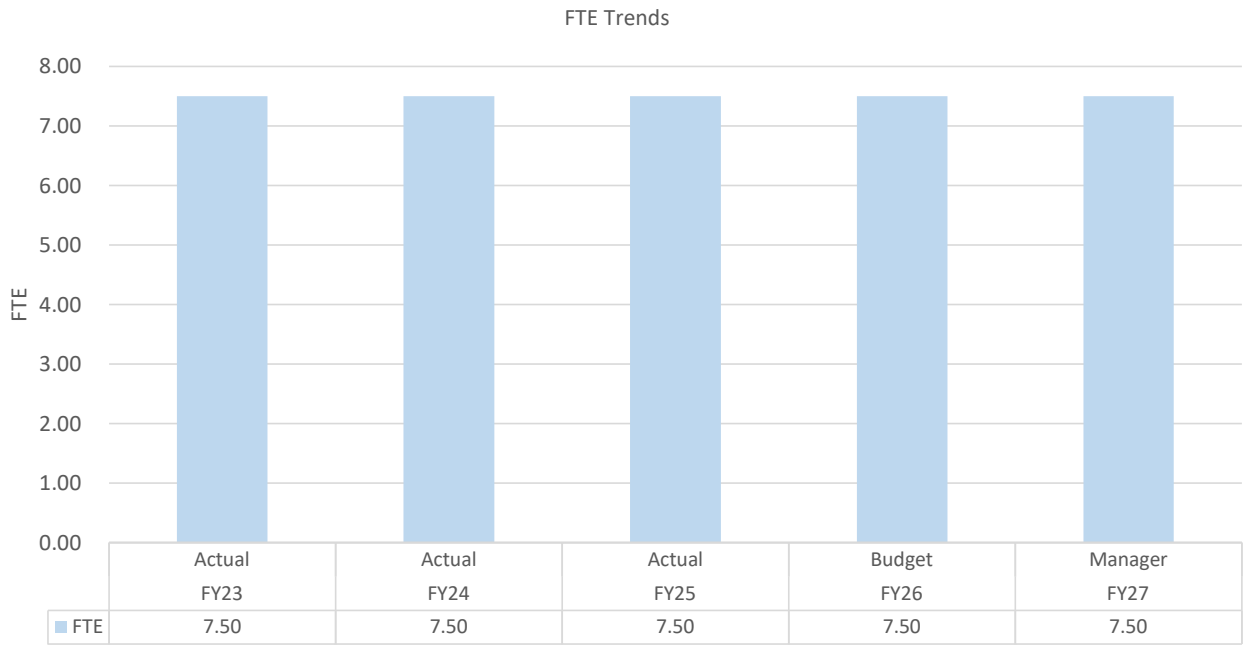
Other provides funds for purchase, replacement or rental of small equipment, uniforms, and training.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected steps/colas. Operating Expenses are increasing due to the addition of funds to offset the impacts of inflation.

Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Burials	15	21	12	20	15
Grave Stones Repaired	4	91	113	4	251
Sale of Lots	8	11	2	1	4
Mowing: Community Field, Mill River,					
Groff Park, Town Commons and					
all School Areas	42	42	42	42	42
Field Maintenance					
Baseball/Softball Field Maintenance	20	20	20	20	20
Football Fields	8	8	8	8	8
Soccer Fields	10	10	10	10	10
Field Hockey Fields	6	6	6	6	6
Lacrosse Fields	8	8	8	8	8
Swimming Pools (Recreation)	3	3	3	3	3
Wading Pools (Recreation)	2	2	2	2	2
Picnic Areas	3	3	3	8	8
Parks & Commons	18	18	18	18	18
Litter Basket Pickup	6,679	6,679	6,679	6,679	6,679
Tennis Courts	2	2	2	2	2
Basketball Courts	3	4	4	4	4
Building Maintenance	7	9	9	9	9
Youth Soccer Fields	1	1	1	1	1
School Frisbee Fields	3	3	3	3	3
Removal of Public Trees	204	223	206	101	98
Public Shade Trees Planted	89	85	87	72	53
Public Shade Trees Trimmed	296	310	290	300	227
Stump Removal	47	52	45	41	12
Roadside Brush Cleaning (miles)	0.25	0.35	0.25	0.25	0.25
Banners Erected & Removed	18	18	25	23	25

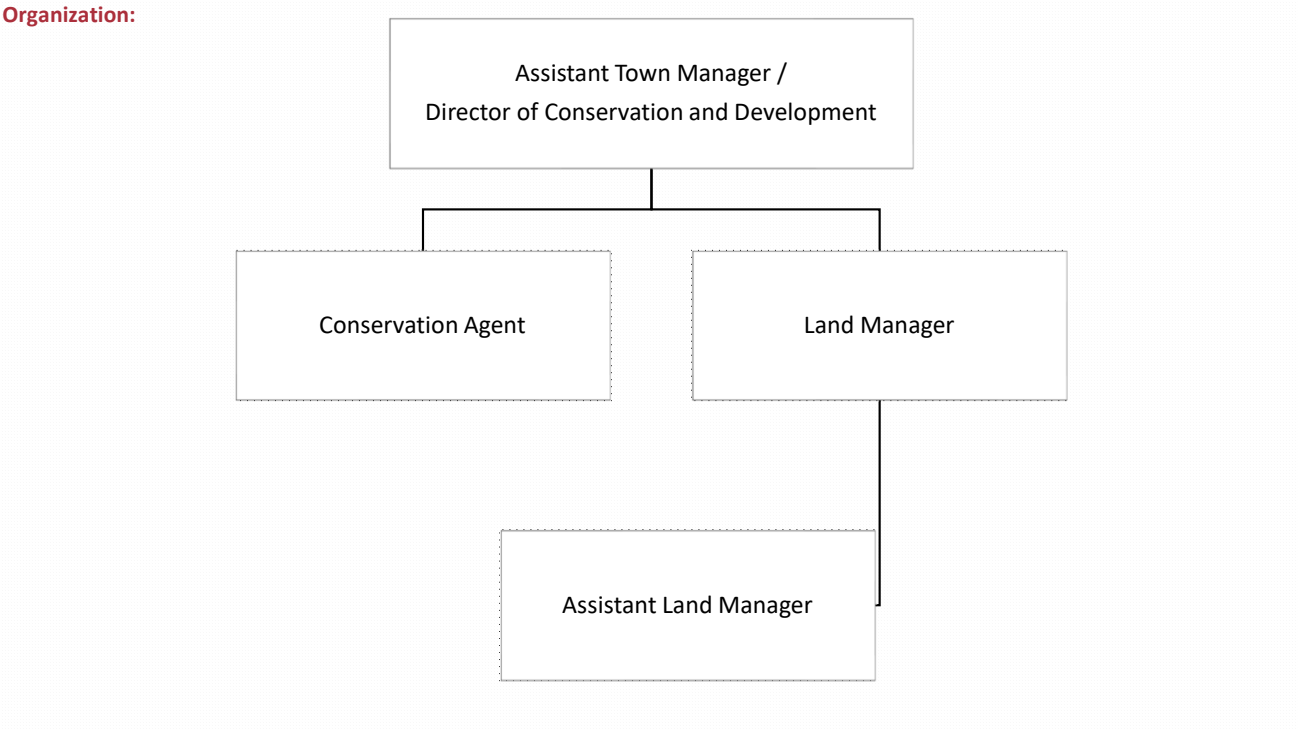
Notable Trends:
None.

For more information, visit the DPW Tree & Grounds webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/1745/Tree-and-Grounds

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

Function: To plan and manage programs and initiatives that protect the natural resources of Amherst, promote a sustainable environment for current and future generations, and ensure a natural environment resilient to the impacts of climate change, while providing staff support to the Conservation Commission and Agricultural Commission on issues related to wetlands, open space, farmland preservation, and climate change. The Assistant Town Manager/Director of Conservation and Development works to coordinate projects between multiple departments and carries out special initiatives as determined by the Town Manager.

Organization:



(Photo of crews constructing a new trail at Hickory Ridge and a new bridge that was built as part of a trail at Hickory Ridge.)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Secured a $250,000 grant for Dam and Seawall Program to design and permit repairs to the dam and dike at Puffer's Pond.
- Secured a $427,000 grant from the Municipal Vulnerability Program (MVP) to assess all of the culverts in Amherst, Belchertown, Hadley, Pelham and Shutesbury.
- Completed the update of the Open Space and Recreation Plan (OSRP).
- Collaborated with the Kestrel Trust to design, fund, and build a new boardwalk and bridge at the Sweet Alice Conservation Area.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain the level of service that residents demand relative to maintaining 124 miles of trails, the use of Puffer's Pond by thousands of visitors annually, and the management of more than 2,000 acres of Conservation land.
- To expand and enhance access to conservation areas throughout Town with limited staff and funding.
- To continue to develop a comprehensive plan (including funding sources) to address required improvements to the dam and dike at Puffer's Pond as well as dredging and beach improvements.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To open multiple trails at Hickory Ridge in the summer of 2025. **Ongoing**
- To complete all work related to the Massachusetts Trails Grant at Hickory Ridge. **Ongoing**
- To design and build a reroute for a significant portion of the Robert Frost Trail in Lawrence Swamp. **Ongoing**
- To repair three ADA trails. **Ongoing**
- To construct and open the Tucker Trail in South Amherst. **Ongoing**
- To complete the new Land Use Policy for all Conservation Areas. **Ongoing**
- To complete design and permitting process for dam and dike improvements at Puffer's Pond. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To open multiple trails at Hickory Ridge in the summer of 2026.
- To complete all work related to the Massachusetts Trails Grant at Hickory Ridge.
- To design and build a reroute for a significant portion of the Robert Frost Trail in Lawrence Swamp.
- To repair three ADA trails.
- To construct and open the Tucker Trail in South Amherst.
- To complete the new Land Use Policy for all Conservation Areas.
- To complete design and permitting process for dam and dike improvements at Puffer's Pond.

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

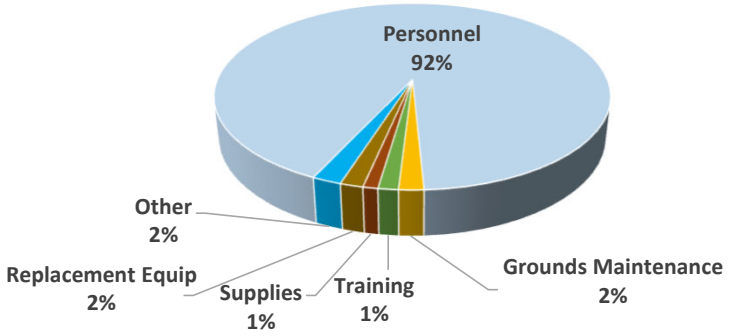
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	408,135	423,825	366,870	390,667	407,561	16,894	4.3%
Operating Expenses	$	30,118	33,974	29,553	22,079	27,079	5,000	22.6%
Operating Capital	$	3,171	2,875	2,565	7,000	7,000	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	441,425	460,674	398,988	419,746	441,640	21,894	5.2%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Assistant Town Manager/Director of Conservation and Development, a Land Manager, an Assistant Land Manager, and a Conservation Agent.

Grounds maintenance provides funds for materials and supplies such as lumber, gravel, and mulch for more than 2,000 acres of Conservation Land including Puffer's Pond, Larch Hill, Amethyst Brook, and Mt. Pollux and approximately 125 miles of trails.

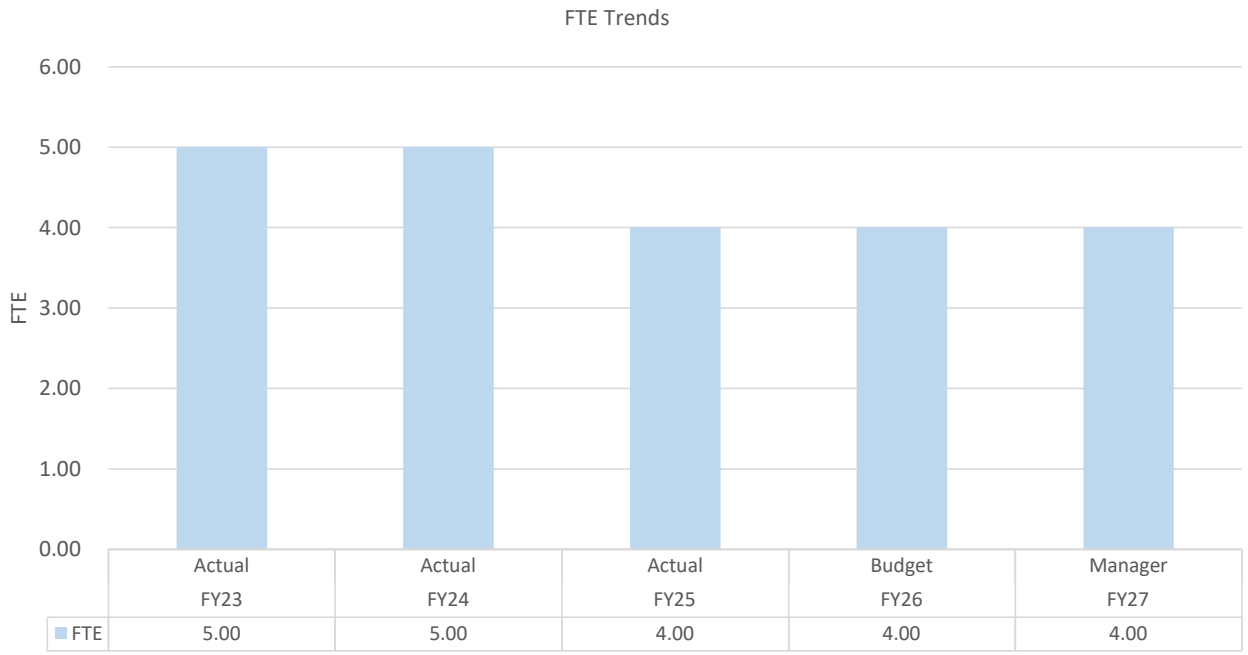
Supplies include tools and small equipment, gasoline, office and vehicle supplies. Other includes utilities, uniforms, and other small expenses.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected step/colas. Operating Expenses increase due to funding add for professional development for Conservation Commission.

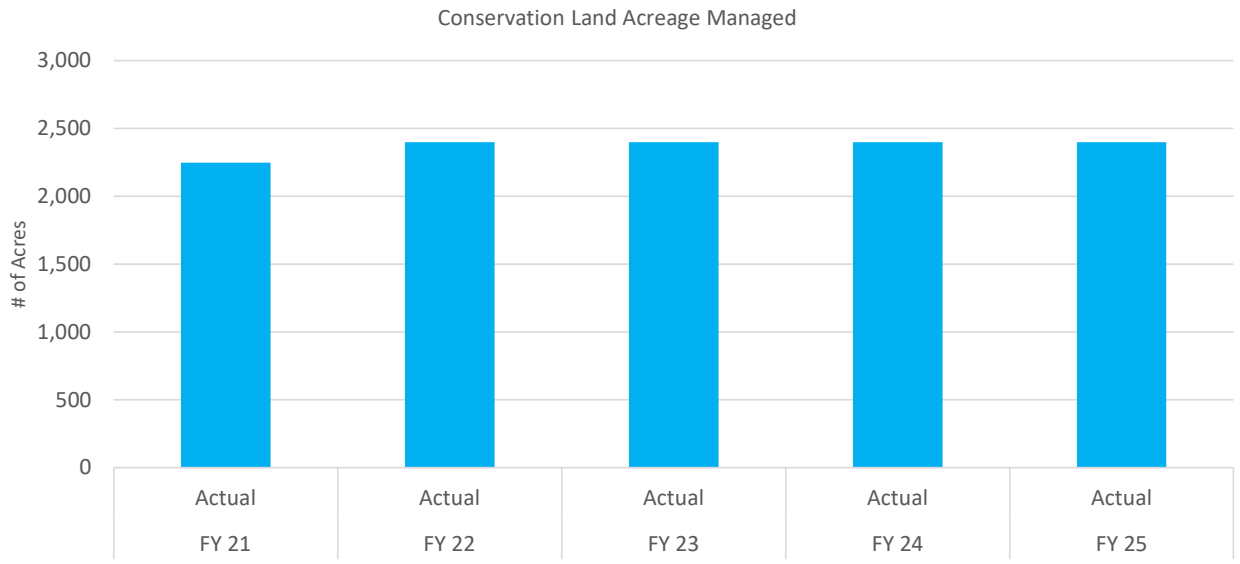
Staffing Trends:



CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Conservation Land Acreage Managed	2,247	2,397	2,397	2,397	2,397
Trail Miles Maintained	80	85	80	124	124
Accessible Trails Maintained	4	4	4	4	4
Acres Monitored – Agricultural Preservation Restrictions	2,102	2,102	2,102	2,102	2,102
Acres under Conservation Restrictions	202	202	202	202	202
Acres of Farmland Rented Out	45	45	45	45	45
Wetlands Act Notice of Intent and Determinations	33	33	31	33	21
Wetlands Act Major Cases Handled	5	6	9	9	7
Emergency Certifications (wetlands)	10	16	15	11	14
Bridges Built or Replaced	12	21	12	8	6
Volunteers	50	75	65	50	60

Notable Trends:
None.



For more information, visit the Conservation department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/285/Conservation

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Function: To plan and manage programs that promote a sustainable and resilient environment for current and future generations from the impacts of climate change, while providing staff support to the Energy and Climate Action Committee. The Director of Sustainability works to coordinate projects between multiple departments and carries out special sustainability initiatives as determined by the Town Manager.

Organization:

(Photo of Amherst Sustainability Festival)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Installed two DC fast-charge electric vehicle stations in the North Pleasant Street ("CVS") parking lot.
- Received Massachusetts DOER Climate Leader Community designation.
- Launched the Amherst Heat Pump Program, providing an additional local financial incentive (in addition to state and federal incentives) to homeowners converting from fossil fuels to electrification for their home heating and cooling needs.
- Awarded technical assistance from the Massachusetts Clean Energy Center (MA CEC) for identification of on-street electric vehicle charging locations.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To meet the 2050 de-carbonization goals set by the Town Council.
- To collaborate with the Energy and Climate Action Committee (ECAC) and Department Heads on identification and development of Climate Action, Adaptation and Resilience Plan (CAARP) implementation strategies.
- To address the intersection of sustainability in municipal and community sectors.
- To maintain the Sustainability Dashboard.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue to oversee the Valley Green Energy community choice aggregation. **Ongoing**
- To begin implementing energy efficiency, weatherization and HVAC conversions in collaboration with the Facilities Department at the Bangs Community Center, Police Department, Town Hall, and Munson Library. **Ongoing**
- To sustain and possibly expand the Valleybike program station network. **Ongoing**
- To implement the community heat pump program to facilitate the installation of heat pumps for Amherst residents. **Ongoing**
- To expand the number of Electric Vehicle charging stations throughout Town and at Town owned facilities. **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To continue to support and improve Community Garden infrastructure. **Ongoing**
- To become a Climate Leader Community as designated by Massachusetts Department of Energy Resources. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue to oversee the Valley Green Energy community choice aggregation.
- To begin implementing energy efficiency, weatherization and HVAC conversions in collaboration with the Facilities Department at the Bangs Community Center, Police Department, Town Hall, and Munson Library.
- To sustain and possibly expand the ValleyBike program station network.
- To continue to oversee the community heat pump program to facilitate the installation of heat pumps for Amherst residents.
- To expand the number of Electric Vehicle charging stations throughout Town and at Town-owned facilities.
- To continue to support and improve Community Garden infrastructure.
- To update the Town's Greenhouse Gas Emissions Inventory in order to assess meeting 2025 carbon reduction goals.

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	105,816	111,617	117,479	5,862	5.3%
Operating Expenses	$	-	-	1,840	19,340	14,340	(5,000)	-25.9%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	-	107,656	130,957	131,819	862	0.7%

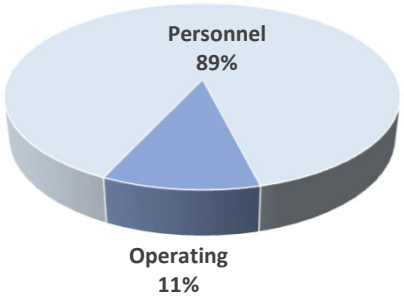
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Director of Sustainability.

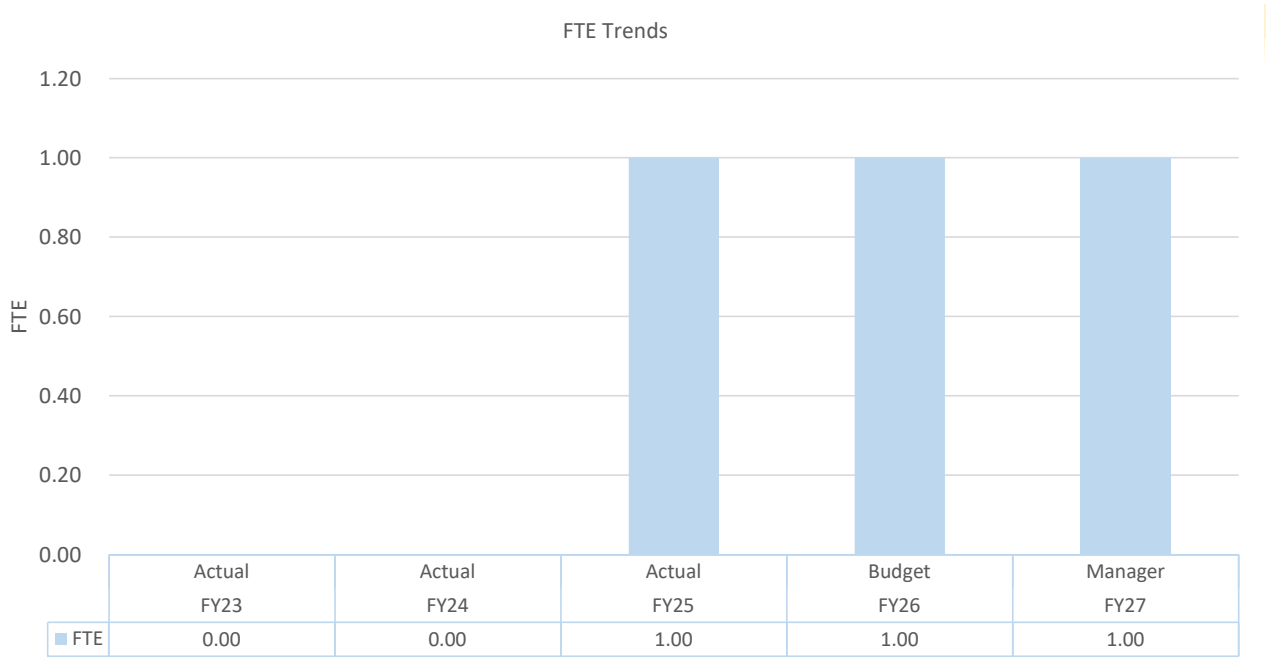
Operating expenses include training, printing & advertising, supplies, travel and dues and subscriptions.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected step/colas. Operating Expenses decrease based on historical spending patterns.



Staffing Trends:



CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Studies/special projects managed	-	8	10	9	6
Grant applications processed /administered	-	5	6	6	6
Town Board & Committee meetings attended	-	270	252	315	56
Trainings or other project related meetings attended	-	36	82	73	112
Partnerships/collaborations	-	10	9	9	8
EV charging (kWh)	-	20,088	32,986	58,141	93,140
EV charging ghg savings (kg)	-	16	25	47	78

Notable Trends:

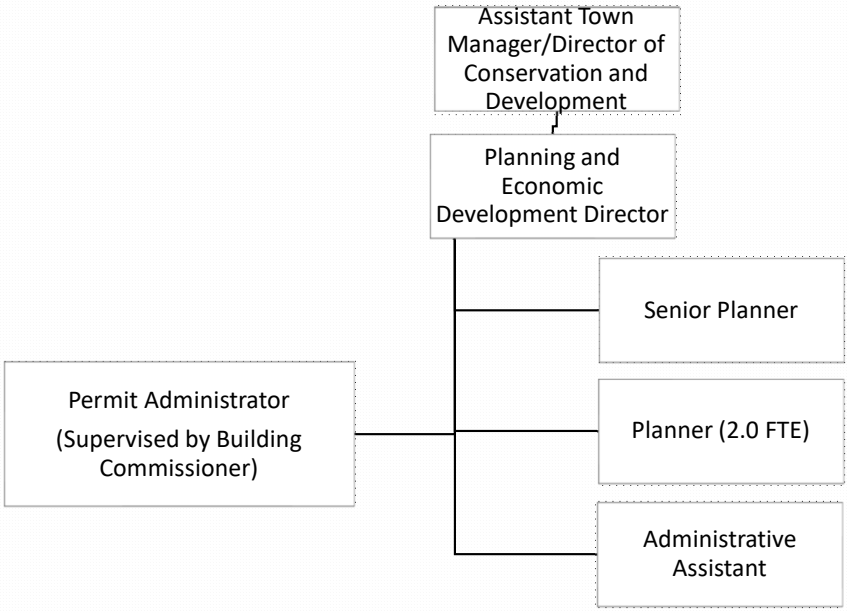
EV Charging has grown as the Town has expanded the number of charging stations available to the public.

For more information, visit the Conservation department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/1671/Sustaining-Amherst

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Function: To protect and enhance the environmental, economic, and social quality of life for residents and visitors by creating and implementing appropriate plans and regulations for the preservation of community resources and the orderly, rational, and sustainable development of the Town.

Organization:



(Photo of Downtown Design Standards Workshop)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Recent Accomplishments:

- New Planning and Economic Development Director began in December 2025 and participated in the "Cuppa' Joe" series to help increase transparency and awareness of projects and initiatives within the Planning Department. The Town also promoted the Senior Planner to Assistant Director of Planning and Economic Development.
- Completed the first phase of visioning for potential reuse of the South Amherst school property.
- Oversaw adoption of the Housing Production Plan.
- Awarded $75,000 from Community One-Stop for Growth to examine East Amherst and consider zoning amendments that will help support and guide potential future development.
- Awarded $850,000 from Community Development Block Grant for five Social Service programs (Survival Center food pantry, Big Brothers Big Sisters youth mentoring, Center for New Americans ESOL classes, Family Outreach housing support, Amherst Mobile Market healthy food access project) and pedestrian improvements near Kendrick Park.
- Designation of the Town as a Housing Choice Community to recognize Amherst's leadership in producing new housing and adopting best practices to promote sustainable housing development.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain the level of service that residents expect and demand such as providing information about proposed projects and proposed zoning amendments, providing mechanisms by which residents' voices can be heard, and encouraging low income and hard-to-reach populations to participate in the public process.
- To respond to the increasing complexity of private development applications and the public permit review process.
- To fully adopt an electronic document management system for all Conservation and Development records.
- Increase efforts to support and expand economic development activities and supporting efforts to increase revenue.
- Develop strategies to address student housing (limits, regulations, and allowable areas) with key stakeholders.
- Consider areas suitable for zoning changes that support new growth.
- Continue to support various housing projects including but not limited to the VFW, Wayfinders, Beacon Communities and options for the South Amherst School property.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To develop zoning amendments with a focus on the East Village, downtown, North Amherst, Accessory Dwelling Units (ADU's) and increasing density in existing housing developments. **Ongoing**
- To complete the update to the Housing Production Plan (HPP). **Accomplished**
- To work with the Fire Department to update to the Hazard Mitigation Plan. **Accomplished**
- To begin planning for the update of the Master Plan. **Ongoing**
- To explore housing options for the former South Amherst School property. **Ongoing**
- To begin to develop a plan and rezoning for the development of East Amherst Village Center to increase housing supply and expand economic opportunities. **Ongoing**
- To work with design consultants, the public, local businesses, boards, and committees to develop Downtown Design and Streetscape Standards. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To develop zoning amendments with a focus on the East Village, downtown, North Amherst, Accessory Dwelling Units (ADU's) and increasing density in existing housing developments.
- To begin planning for the update of the Master Plan.
- To explore housing options for the former South Amherst School property.
- To begin to develop a plan and rezoning for the development of East Amherst Village Center to increase housing supply and expand economic opportunities.
- To work with design consultants, the public, local businesses, boards, and committees to develop Downtown Design and Streetscape Standards.
- To complete an updated market analysis and update other relevant data regarding Amherst's economy, and, create a comprehensive Economic Development.
- To create a reuse plan for Wildwood School Campus inclusive of a series of community engagement sessions, conceptual site/building plans, order of magnitude cost estimates, and a cohesive multi-year strategy for reuse of the site.
- To participate in the planning and development of the Hampshire College campus.

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	332,504	341,996	377,418	406,022	421,497	15,475	3.8%
Operating Expenses	$	23,574	31,555	25,560	27,925	27,925	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	356,078	373,551	402,977	433,947	449,422	15,475	3.6%

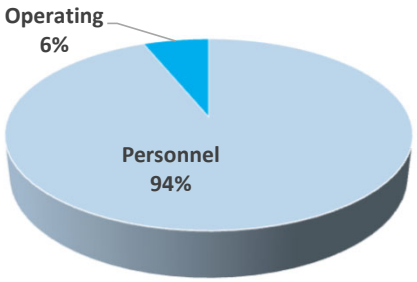
Major Components:

Personnel Services includes salaries for a Planning Director, a Senior Planner, two Planners (one of them is 50% funded with CDBG), and a Permit Administrator.

Operating costs include public hearing legal ads, professional development and travel, materials associated with mapping, computers, printers/copiers, and other departmental supplies.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected steps/colas.



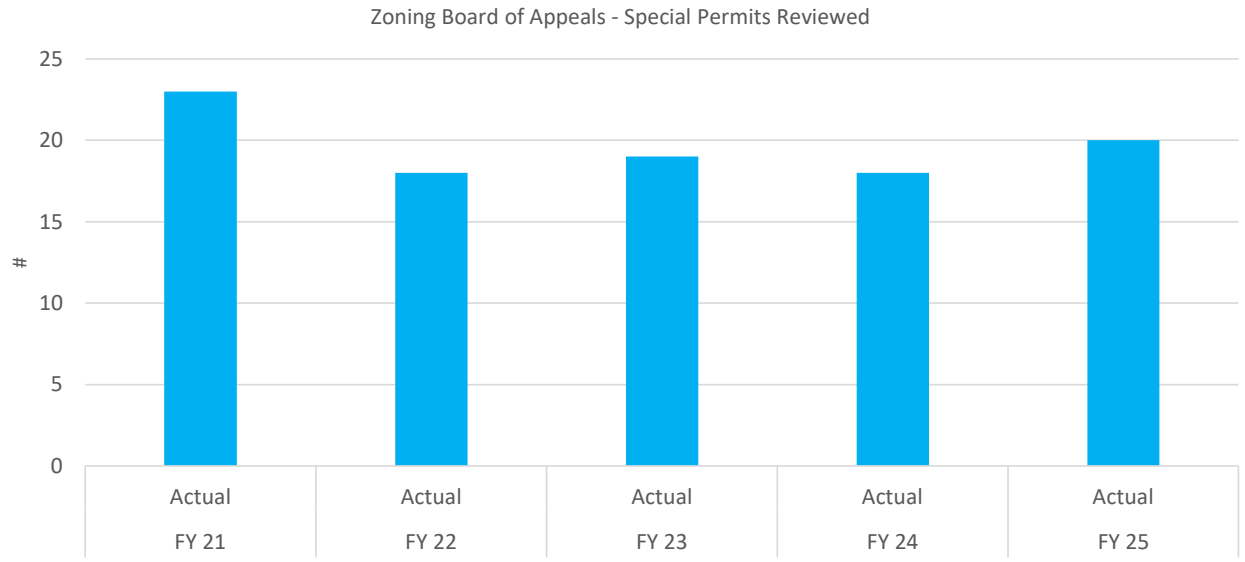
Staffing Trends:

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Zoning/Subdivision/Regulation Amendments Worked On	11	13	4	3	3
ANR/Subdivision Plans Reviewed & Processed	10	14	9	8	6
Planning Board Special Permits	3	5	4	5	1
ZBA Special Permits Reviewed	23	18	19	18	20
Design Review Board Reviews	24	21	23	17	19
Demolition Delay Applications	14	11	12	6	14
Other Development Applications Processed (Local Historic District)	11	6	14	20	9
Planning Board Site Plan Reviews	12	15	8	11	11
Grant or Other Non-Town Funding Project Applications Processed/Administered	8	8	8	5	8
Contracts Administered	15	12	10	7	13
Special Planning Studies/Projects	16	9	12	5	5
Review of Other Projects	2	2	1	4	1
Committees/Boards Assisted	11	11	10	13	11
Committee & Board Meetings	244	302	170	236	177

Notable Trends:

None.

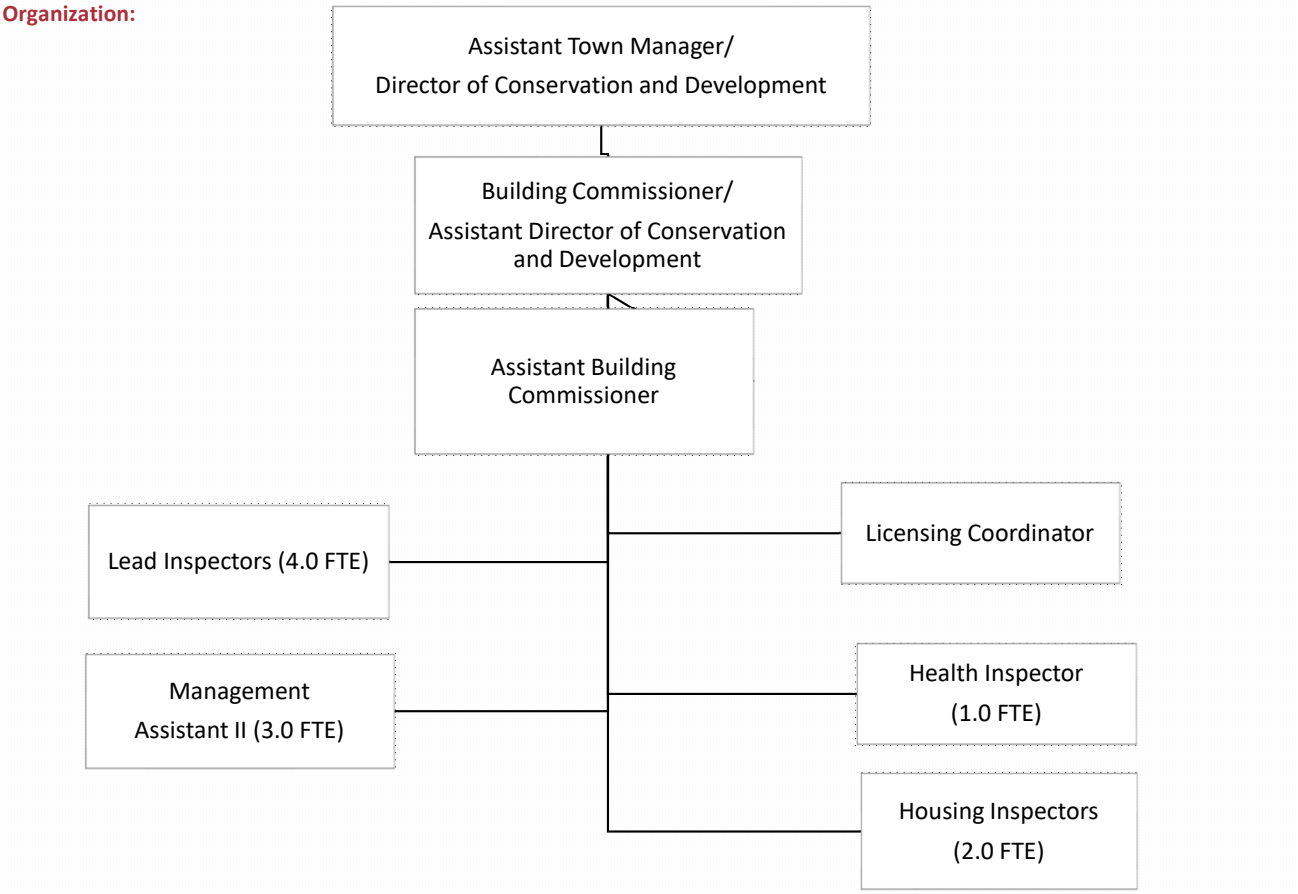


For more information, visit the Planning department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/651/Planning-Zoning

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Function: To ensure the public health, safety, and welfare of the inhabitants of the Town by administering the General Laws and Regulations of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts and Town of Amherst Bylaws as they relate to land use and to the construction and occupancy of buildings and structures.

Organization:



(Photo of outdoor dining)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Successful launch of residential rental property inspection in October 2025.
- Improved residential rental property permit renewal system.
- Expanded data collection and organization of prior permits for residential rental properties.
- Certificate of Inspection for assisted living and residential care facilities.
- All programs except weights and measures are active in OpenGov.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To fill inspector vacancies left by long-dterm staff retirements.
- To implement an electronic document management system established for all Conservation and Development records.
- To improve the Inspection Services website to expand information and resources.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To launch the Residential Rental Inspection Program. **Accomplished**
- To transition fully from a complaint-only to a proactive inspection program for residential rental properties. **Accomplished**
- To continue to provide public education about codes, regulations, and permitting procedures. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To create certificate of inspection for multi-family properties.
- To create certificate of inspection for all non-residential properties.
- To develop OpenGov solution for publically displaying code enforcement activities and status.
- To continue to provide public education about codes, regulations, and permitting procedures.

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	823,292	831,798	938,569	1,112,523	1,172,636	60,113	5.4%
Operating Expenses	$	20,143	19,598	31,540	29,495	29,495	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	843,435	851,396	970,108	1,142,018	1,202,131	60,113	5.3%

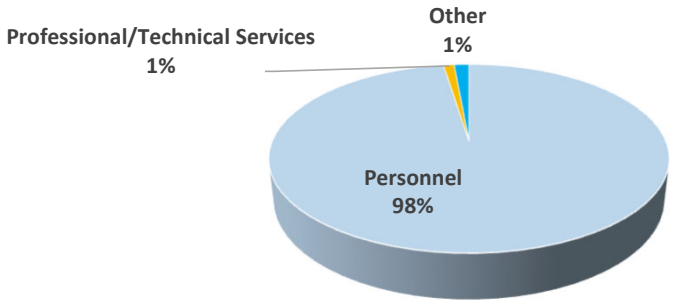
Major Components:

Personnel Services provide funds for the Building Commissioner, Assistant Building Commissioner, 3 Lead Inspectors, 1 Building Inspectors, 1 Health Inspectors, a licensing coordinator, 3 Management Assistants, 2 Housing Inspectors, and part-time or substitute Plumbing, Electrical, and Gas Inspectors.

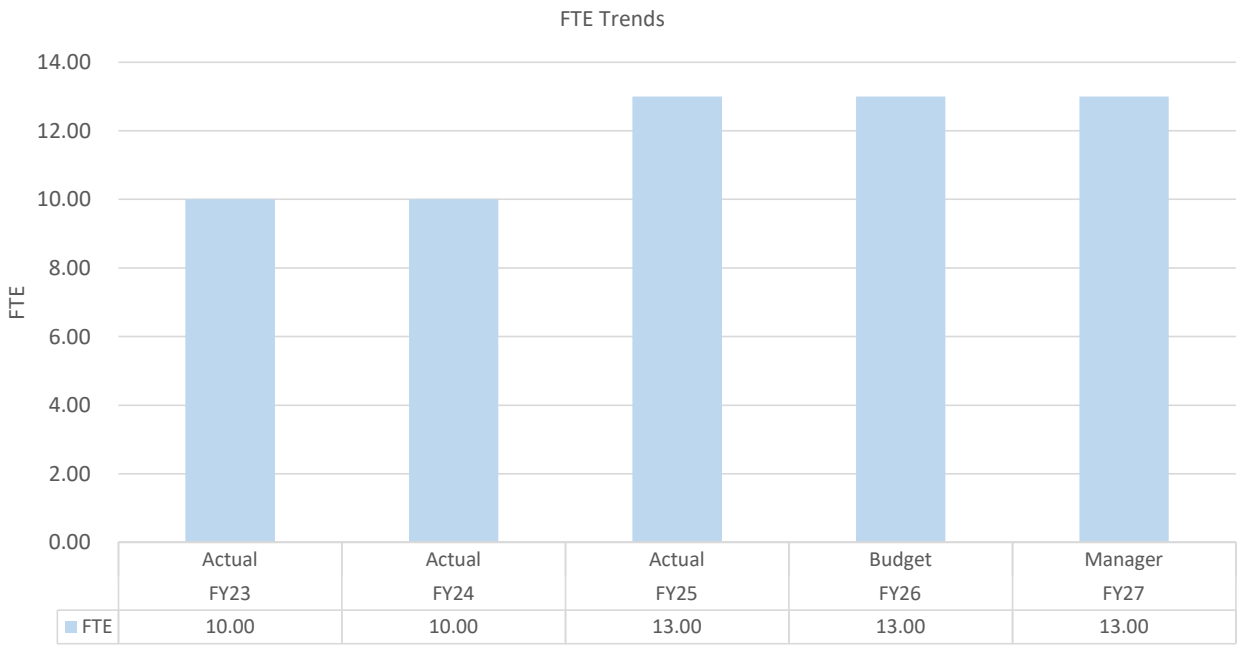
Professional/Technical Services provides the funds for the regional sealer of weights and measures program.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected steps/colas.



Staffing Trends:



CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
PERMITS ISSUED:					
Building Permits	888	1107	1,288	1,189	1,009
Electrical Permits	751	998	1158	1,020	876
Gas Permits	168	205	183	199	170
Plumbing Permits	251	301	345	376	317
Mechanical	13	2	7	8	4
Demolition Permits	24	18	18	14	14
Certificates of Inspection	106	85	68	241	234
Certificates of Occupancy	31	34	32	15	14
Total Permits	2,232	2,750	3,099	3,062	2,638
INSPECTIONS					
Building	811	1,994	2,469	1,793	1,651
Electrical	501	1,138	1,837	1,762	653
Gas	107	327	289	209	357
Plumbing	204	540	592	389	1401
Total Building Inspections	1,623	3,999	5,187	4,114	4,062
Business Licenses	172	270	234	240	252
Health Permits/Licenses	218	363	279	337	519
Health Inspections	441	446	505	565	505
Rental Permits	1,380	1,369	1,223	1,227	1,257
COMPLAINTS AND VIOLATIONS					
Zoning	15	15	12	19	279
Code	45	251	112	185	163
WEIGHTS AND MEASURES					
Inspections	24	31	29	28	26

Notable Trends:

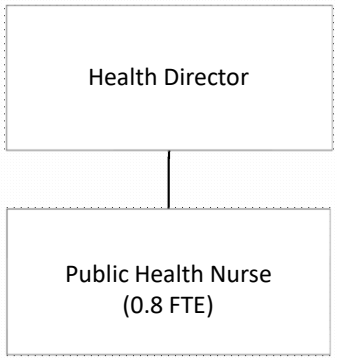
Total Building Permits issued were down in FY25 compared to the two previous years. Health Permits/Licenses have more than doubled in the last five years.

For more information, visit the Inspection Services webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/231/Inspection-Services

COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Function: To promote the health and well-being of the Amherst community and eliminate health inequities. The work of the Health Department is organized into five major service areas: Access to Health Care; Infectious Disease Control; Disease Prevention and Health Promotion; Health Policy; and Emergency Preparedness.

Organization:



(Photo of Public Health Department staff tabling at a community event.)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Served as the lead on the development of a regional website - Valleyvax.org - to ensure the community has access to accurate, evidence-based information about vaccines.
- Successfully added the Nicotine Free Generation provision to the Town's tobacco regulations, prohibiting the sale of tobacco products to anyone born after January 1, 2005.
- Provided childhood immunizations to more than twice as many children from Amherst Regional Public Schools as in previous years through the Vaccines for Children program.
- Held four COVID/flu vaccine clinics for the community, including two at Craig's Doors, and provided vaccines to homebound residents.
- Added a kiosk at the Bangs Community Center for free and easy drop-off of sharps with as many as 3,500 sharps being disposed of each month.
- Completed a community needs assessment on the impact of the opioid epidemic, prioritizing the input of people who use drugs, people in recovery, and their friends and families.
- Conducted ongoing mosquito surveillance and larval mitigation treatment in selected areas of town.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To sustain a workforce that meets the needs of the Town in light of the changing health landscape.
- To continue to incorporate health equity and anti-racist principles into the work of the Department, with attention to the social determinants of health.
- To collaborate with Town departments and regional coalitions on emergency preparedness planning that addresses new challenges posed by climate change and other factors.
- To collaborate with other departments on health-promoting strategies that respond to the shifting demographics of the community, including the needs of immigrant families, unhoused individuals and people with mental health challenges.
- To ensure members of our community have access to vaccines and to accurate information about vaccine safety.
- To mitigate the impact of the opioid epidemic through prevention education, harm reduction and recovery support.
- To continue shared service programming through the Public Health Excellence Grant.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To reinstate the Human Services Network meetings for local human service organizations. **Ongoing**
- To assess community need for strategies and programs to reduce opioid overdose and implement harm reduction efforts. **Accomplished**
- To sustain wastewater surveillance for infectious disease and potentially expand the scope to include more organisms - **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- To promote vaccine safety and efficacy and provide resources to facilitate access to vaccines for our community - **Accomplished/Ongoing**
- In host an intergenerational Wellness Learning Community and offer other public health programming such as drop-in blood pressure clinics. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To reinstate the Human Services Network meetings for local human service organizations.
- To develop and implement interventions to address the opioid epidemic, based on the community needs assessment.
- To sustain wastewater surveillance for infectious disease and potentially expand the scope to include more organisms.
- To provide evidence-based information and resources about vaccines and facilitate vaccine access for our community.
- To update the Town's emergency management plan, inform the public about the plan and participate in regional emergency planning activities.
- To provide timely public health updates to the community through the public health website, the Town's text alert system and social media.

COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	165,187	156,817	186,720	213,413	223,200	9,787	4.6%
Operating Expenses	$	6,404	10,922	13,827	14,803	14,803	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	171,591	167,739	200,547	228,216	238,003	9,787	4.3%

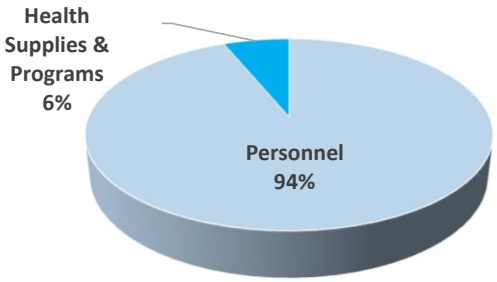
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for a Health Director and a Public Health Nurse. Part time administrative help is also included.

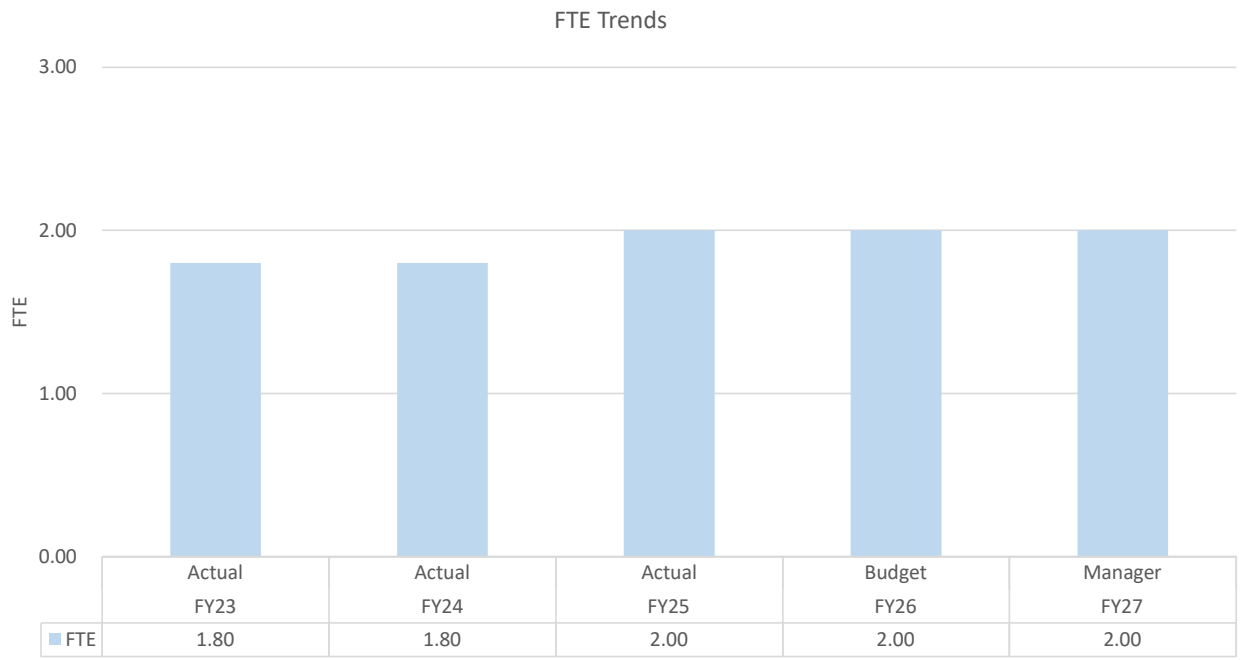
Health Supplies and Programs includes printing and advertising, dues and subscriptions, and for materials necessary to conduct health programs and clinics.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected steps/colas.



Staffing Trends:

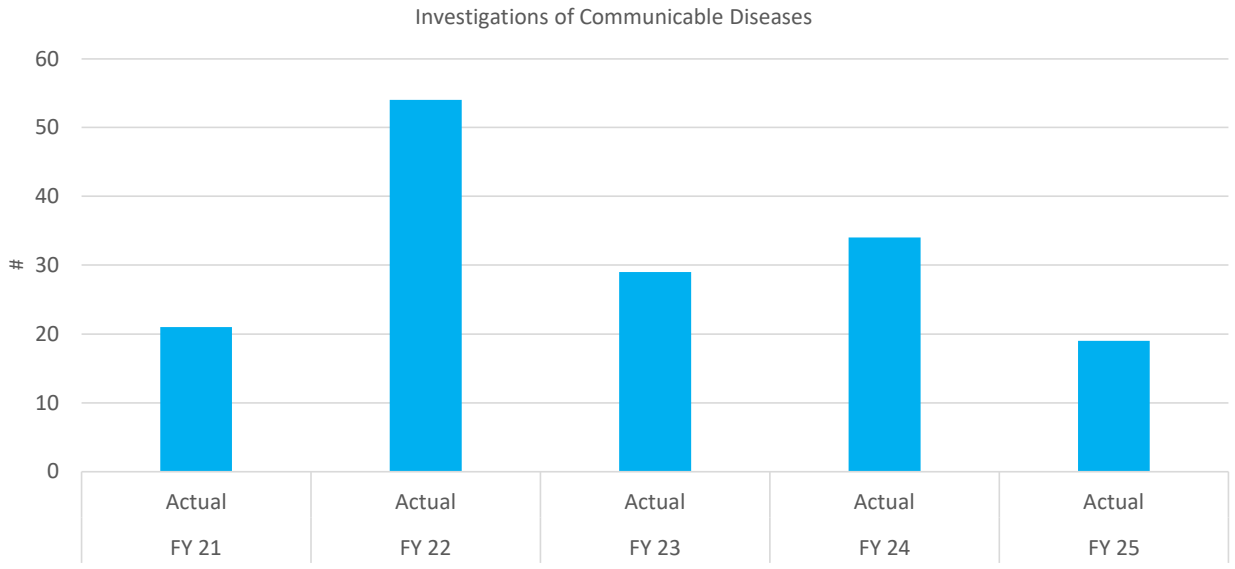


COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Community Health Planning /Promotion					
Sponsor Local/Regional Educational Programs	1	1	2	6	4
Grants Applied For	0	0	0	2	0
Grants Administered	1	1	1	0	0
Vaccinations					
Influenza	55	60	32	115	95
COVID-19	17,290	550	1,409	158	137
Childhood Vaccines	0	0	48	142	370
Children Immunized	0	0	20	66	139
Investigation of Communicable Diseases					
COVID-19 Cases	2,658	6,882	987	327	198
Infectious Disease Cases (Not Tuberculosis or COVID-19)	26	108	247	127	247
Tuberculosis Screening/Prevention	21	54	29	34	19
Total	2,705	7,044	1,263	488	464
Tobacco Compliance Checks	60	76	54	56	40

Notable Trends:

None.

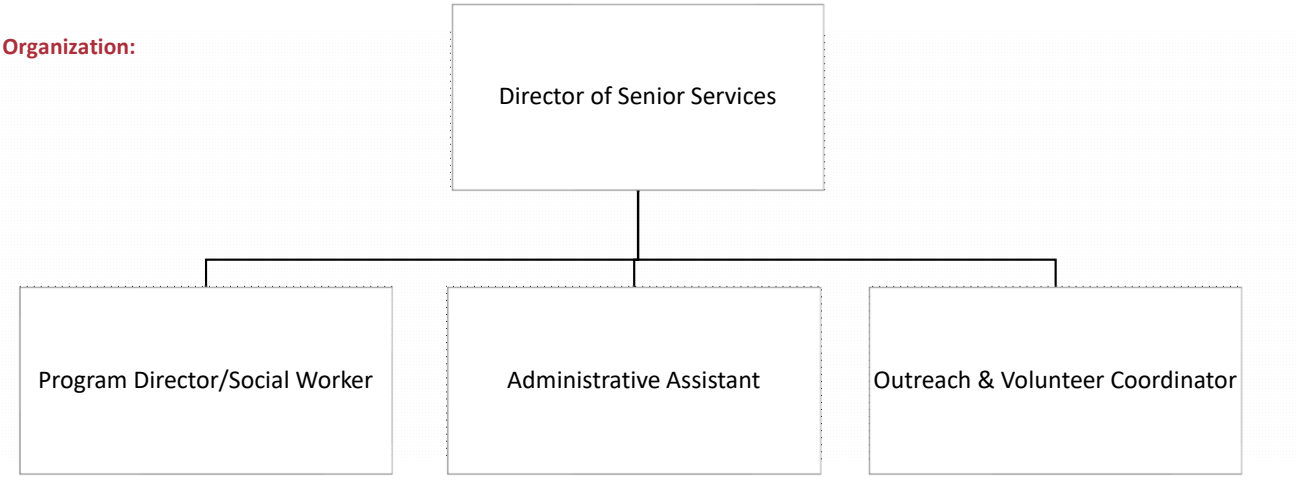


For more information, visit the Public Health Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/65/Health

COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Function: To welcome and serve the needs of the many diverse populations of older adults in Amherst and those who support them. To optimize the quality of life for older adults; empower them to remain independent; promote physical, mental and emotional well-being; and encourage participation in community life. To provide services, programs, and advocacy that value older people as important assets in the community.

Organization:



(Photo of Senior Services Staff and Senior Center Volunteer Appreciation Dinner)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed the refurbishment of game room - Includes: Ping-Pong and Pool tables.
- Collaborated with Public Health on Wellness Learning Communities.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To develop space for an exercise room to strengthen resilience and reduce isolation.
- To navigate the challenges of enhancing programming through grants and the Friends of the Senior Center funding.
- To increase BIPOC leadership, recruitment, outreach, and services.
- To explore options for creation of a new or updated Senior Center.
- To improve Senior Center safety infrastructure.
- To fully staff and support the Silver Shuttle Ridership program.
- To make the Senior Center an exciting, welcoming hub for seniors.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To increase average daily attendance by 10%. **Ongoing**
- To obtain Dementia-Friendly designation for the Town. **Ongoing**
- To increase volunteer recruitment to match FY22 levels. **Ongoing**
- To recruit new partners/vendors for Wednesday Market. **Ongoing**
- To examine operational efficiencies and development improvements for file storage and communication. **Accomplished**
- To make the Senior Center an exciting, welcoming hub for seniors. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To increase average daily attendance by 10%.
- To obtain Dementia-Friendly designation for the Town.
- To increase the variety of volunteer opportunities.
- To recruit new partners for Wednesday Market.
- To develop and improve communication methods.
- To return to mailing the Senior newsletter to all 60+ residents .

COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	194,207	221,627	218,255	250,954	266,151	15,197	6.1%
Operating Expenses	$	2,776	2,300	5,473	5,473	5,473	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	196,983	223,927	223,728	256,427	271,624	15,197	5.9%

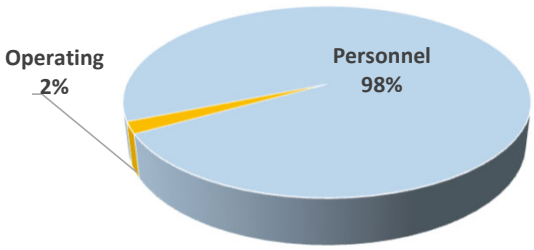
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Director of Senior Services, a Program Director/Social Worker, an Administrative Assistant, and an Outreach & Volunteer Coordinator. State funding offsets $40,000.

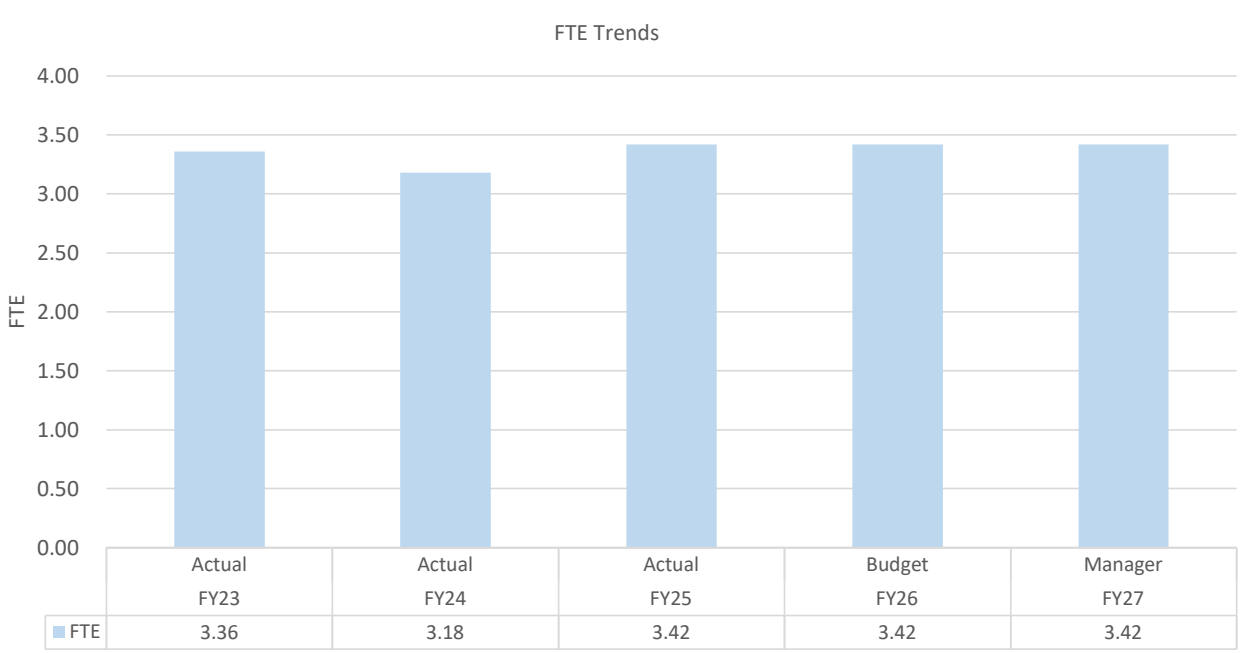
The Friends of the Amherst Senior Center, a non-profit organization, provides funding to cover many additional operating expenses.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas.



Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Average daily attendance	130	105	110	100	105
Nutrition					
Congregate & To-Go Meals Served	6,501	8,369	9,568	7,760	6,230
Home Delivered Dinner or Baby Berk Truck Lunch - UMass	2,500	0	0	0	0
Home Delivered Hot Lunch - Highland Valley Elder Services	6,922	11,918	13,352	20,384	23,307
Support Services					
AARP Tax Preparation	N/A	N/A	N/A	191	208
Newsletters Mailed (6x/year)	22,000	21,600	21,600	800	480
Case Management/Information Referral/Advocacy	8,500	6,329	5,981	5,642	2,016
Health Benefits Counseling (SHINE) Visits/Client	152/123	231/204	254/217	234/212	109/101
Legal Assistance Referrals (to Western Mass. Legal Services)	20	4	165	88	7
Tax Work-Off Program Participants	27	20	16	15	21
Medical Ride Program	0	0	0	0	0
Medical Equipment Loans	65	113	188	230	85
Recreation/Education/Health Programs (participants)	0	0	0	54/844	128/857
Silver Shuttle Riders/ Rides	N/A	N/A	N/A	54/844	30/503
Cultural Events (Classes, Seminars, Concerts)	1,768	2,115	2,331	1,971	1,021
Exercise/Recreation	4,361	4,160	6,239	4,051	3,974
Health Screenings and Clinics (Nursing Center, Foot Assessment & E	1,008	495	510	597	226
SC Nursing Center Visits	1160	0	0	0	0
Volunteer Overview					
Total volunteers	130	80	47	42	28
Total # of Volunteer hours	7,351	1,932	3,451	2,889	1,239

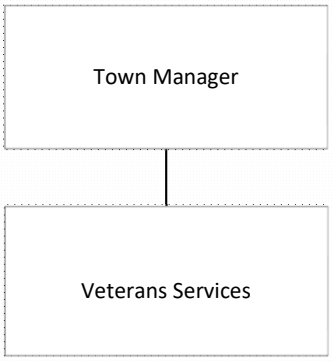
Notable Trends:
Overall meals delivered has increased through expanded partnership with Highland Valley Elder Services. Case Management is down over the past five years related to staff turnover.

For more information, visit the Senior Center's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/269/Senior-Services

COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Function: To aid, support, and advocate for the veterans of our community and/or their dependents by identifying benefits on the local, state, and Federal level and providing financial, fuel, and medical assistance to veterans and/or their dependents who are eligible under M.G.L. Ch. 115. Amherst is a member of the Central Hampshire Veteran Services district with its headquarters located in Northampton. The district currently includes 11 communities: Amherst, Northampton, Pelham, Hadley, Williamsburg, Goshen, Cummington, Chesterfield, Worthington, Middlefield, and Chester.

Organization:



(Photo of Veterans Day Ceremony)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Recent Accomplishments:

- The district department is operating with 4 full-time staff to meet the demands of our new 14 community district.
- Amherst has become a designated Purple Heart Community joining 11 other communities in our district.
- Western Mass Veterans Outreach Project created a website https://www.wmvop.org/ providing in depth information regarding the needs of today's veterans and their families, and a comprehensive list of resources available in Western Massachusetts to meet those needs.
- Western Mass Veterans Outreach Project finished the "Just Ask" campaign in the winter of 2026 establishing prior military service being identified by intake at Cooley Dickinson Hospital and becoming a permanent identifier on their permanent digital medical records to better serve the needs of this unique population.
- Participated in the Open House program at the Bangs Community Center and share with Amherst residents the mission of our department.
- Collaborates with CRESS to host bimonthly Veterans Breakfasts at Bangs Community Center.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To find new and innovative methods of outreach to ensure all who need assistance receive it.
- Determining caseload limits for staff filing of federal VA benefits and what to do if the demand grows.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To propose to rearrange the current structure of the organization to realign resources to allow for four full-time staff in accordance as approved by the Executive of Veterans Services. **Accomplished**
- To plan two educational events around specific topics that are regarded as newly emerging or difficult to manage. Eg. moral injury, spouse/child transitional care including creating training videos for ongoing education. **Ongoing**
- To create of a Veterans' Commemoration Committee to honor and recognize the service and sacrifices of veterans in the community through organized commemorations, educational initiatives, and community engagement. **Ongoing**
- To establish Amherst as a "Purple Heart Community". **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To create of a Veterans' Commemoration Committee to honor and recognize the service and sacrifices of veterans in the community through organized commemorations, educational initiatives, and community engagement.
- To coordinate with the UMass Veterans Office to bring our "Veterans Game Night" sponsored by The Springfield Vet Center and Western Mass Veterans Service Office to the younger veterans and their family members in Amherst and surrounding communities.

COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	276,662	251,411	247,392	271,609	278,493	6,884	2.5%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	276,662	251,411	247,392	271,609	278,493	6,884	2.5%

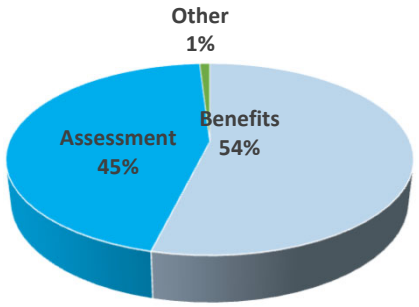
Major Components:

Assessment paid to the Central Hampshire Veterans' Services district.

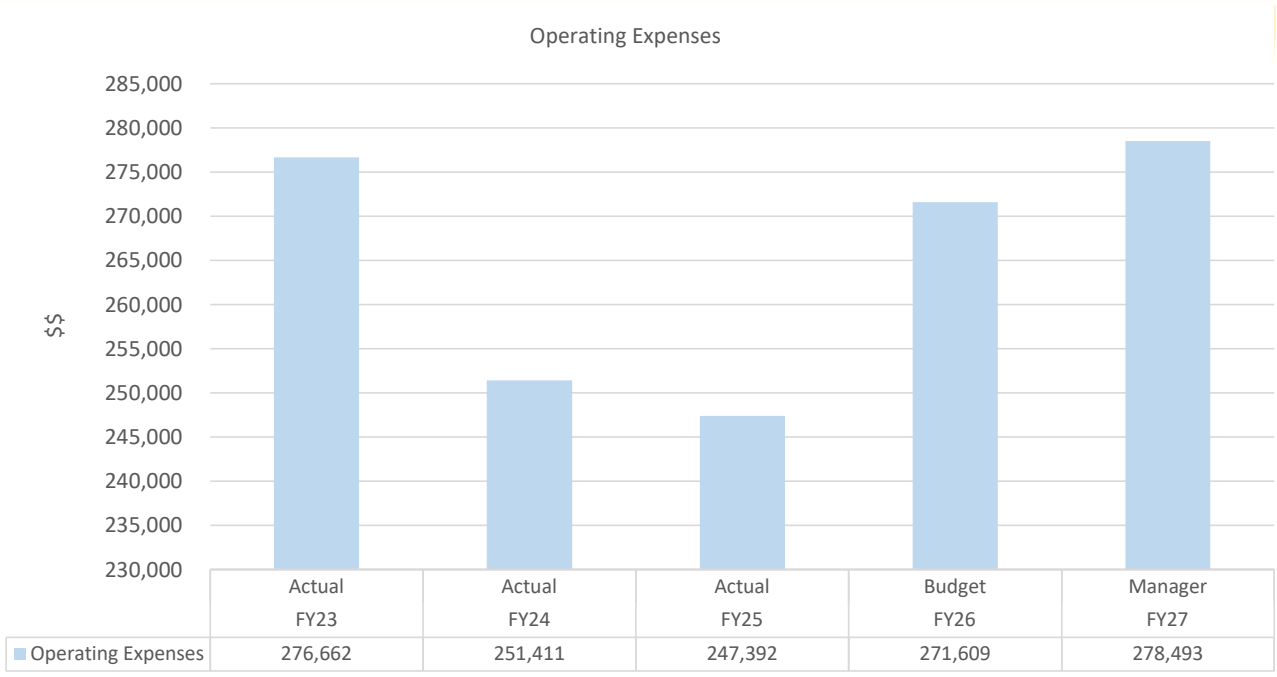
Benefits include funds for cash, rental, and medical assistance for qualifying veterans.

Significant Changes:

None.



Expenditure Trends:

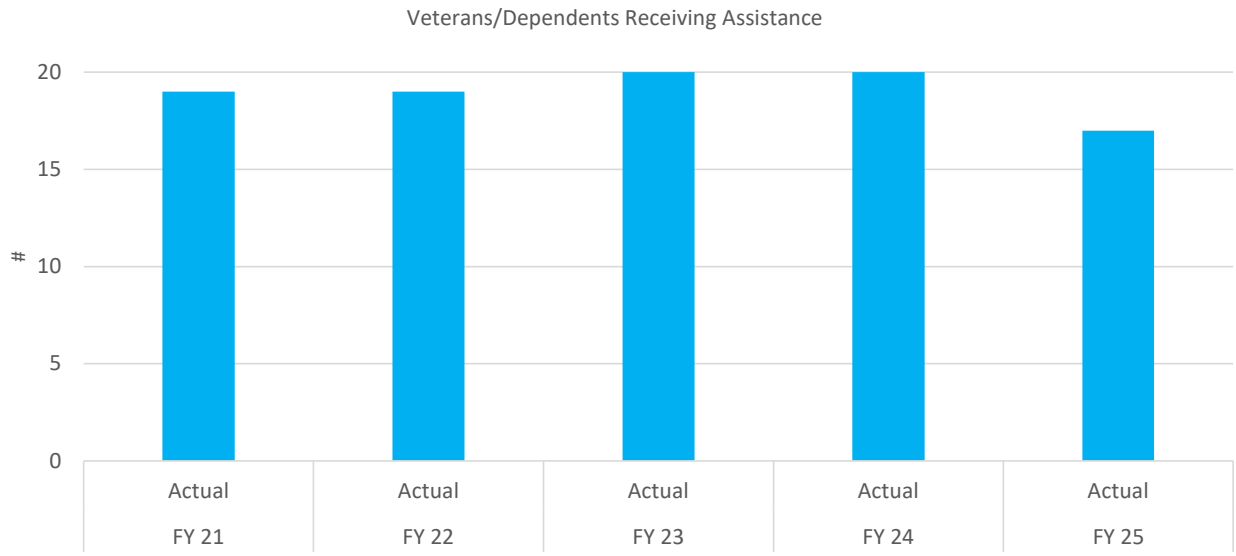


COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Veterans/Dependents Receiving Assistance	19	19	20	20	17
Veterans/Dependents Assisted with VA Claims	23	26	30	28	30
Benefits Paid Out	$ 130,013	$ 137,954	$ 166,129	$ 137,919	$ 135,674
75% State Reimbursement	$ 98,368	$ 103,465	$ 120,950	$ 103,439	$ 102,057

(reimbursements are one full year behind)

Notable Trends:
None.

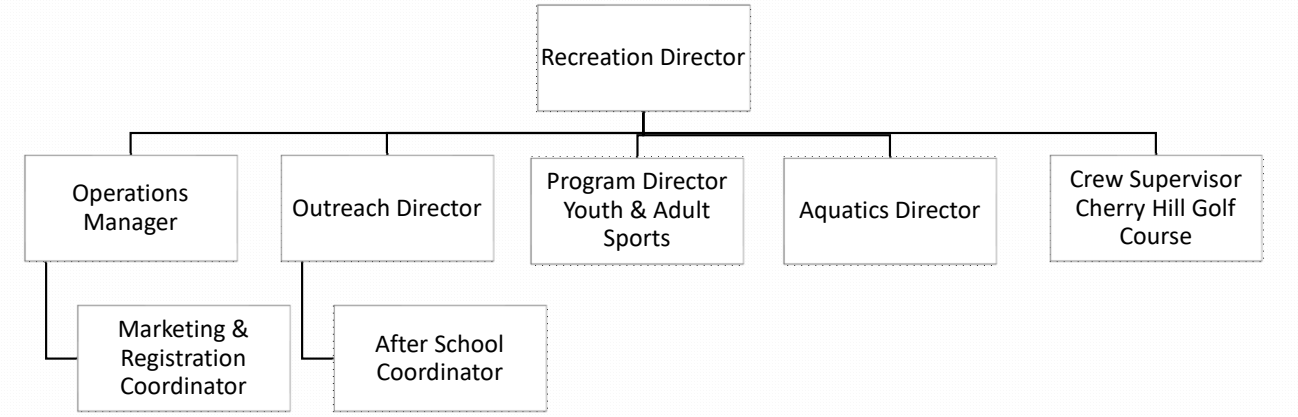


For more information, visit the Veterans Services webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/435/Veterans-Services

COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Function: To enrich the quality of life for all members of the community by providing the highest level of recreational opportunities.

Organization:



(Photos of Morning Movement Program)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Expanded adult sports programming with a second Men's Basketball League, a second weekly sandlot volleyball offering, and growing participation for archery and pickleball.
- Introduced Cancer Awareness Walk at Mill River Recreational Area, with 100 participants.
- Introduced inclusive AYBL K-2 basketball program.
- Partnered with Amherst Police to continue the RISE program for middle school students in a workshop series building community, identity, and responsibility from a DEI perspective.
- Transitioned Morning Movement and Mentoring Program (MMMP) from a Town-funded to a Town-funded, Town-run program, providing daily service to growing number of Amherst students.
- Recognized at 2026 MMA annual conference with Municipal Innovation Award for MMMP.
- Piloted a business program, NFTE BizCamp, empowering high school students to develop entrepreneurial mindsets and launch their own business models.
- Hosted 782 children in child care programs (Summer Camp, Primetime, Vacation Camp).
- Hosted a series of popular community engagement activities: "Salsa in the Park," "Pop-up in the Park", Halloween Spooktacular, Easter Egg Hunt, Luminaria on the Town Common, and Winterfest events.
- Estimated over 12,000 people attended Rec organized events (July 4th, Halloween, Winterfest, Merry Maple).

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To simplify and improve processes for Financial Assistance Program.
- To advance in pursuit of permanent playing options for pickleball.
- To continue to address community objectives and recommendations as a result of feedback from 2024 Community Survey.
- To continue a process of re-branding Amherst Recreation.
- To effectively manage new responsibilities of athletic feeder programs.
- To take inventory and evaluate existing programs offered and review fee schedules.
- To continue to provide high quality recreational programming while ensuring the community's health and safety.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To advance in pursuit of permanent playing options for pickleball. **Rescheduled**
- To simplify and improve processes for Financial Assistance Program. **Ongoing**
- To rebuild enrollment numbers in Youth Sports **Ongoing**
- To pilot a successful Youth Entrepreneurship Program **Accomplished**
- To evaluate/secure the long-term viability of MMMP and RISE as youth programming initiatives **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To assess the viability of a scholarship program to increase access for the community.
- To rebuild enrollment numbers in Youth Sports.
- To build a stronger marketing presence for programming and subsidy opportunities.
- To coordinate internal communications system within the department for purpose of planning and cross-promotional value.
- To assess long-term value of Independence Day Celebration inside the Department funding and management structure.

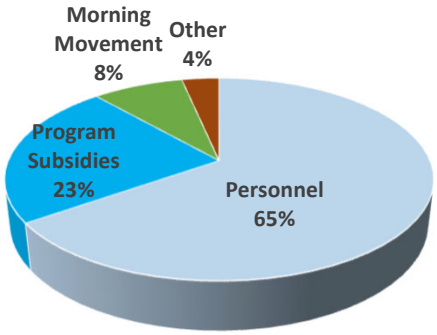
COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	273,104	335,437	348,971	341,813	359,108	17,295	5.1%
Operating Expenses	$	90,187	71,632	90,601	225,816	190,816	(35,000)	-15.5%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	363,290	407,069	439,572	567,629	549,924	(17,705)	-3.1%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Director (shared 70/20/10% with the Pools and Cherry Hill Golf Course), a full time Program Director (shared 90/10% with Cherry Hill Golf Course), an Outreach Director, the Operations Manager (shared 92.5/7.5% with the Pools), and two Customer Assistants (one shared 92.5/7.5% with the Pools and one part-time). The Director also oversees Cherry Hill, After School, and Revolving Fund activities.

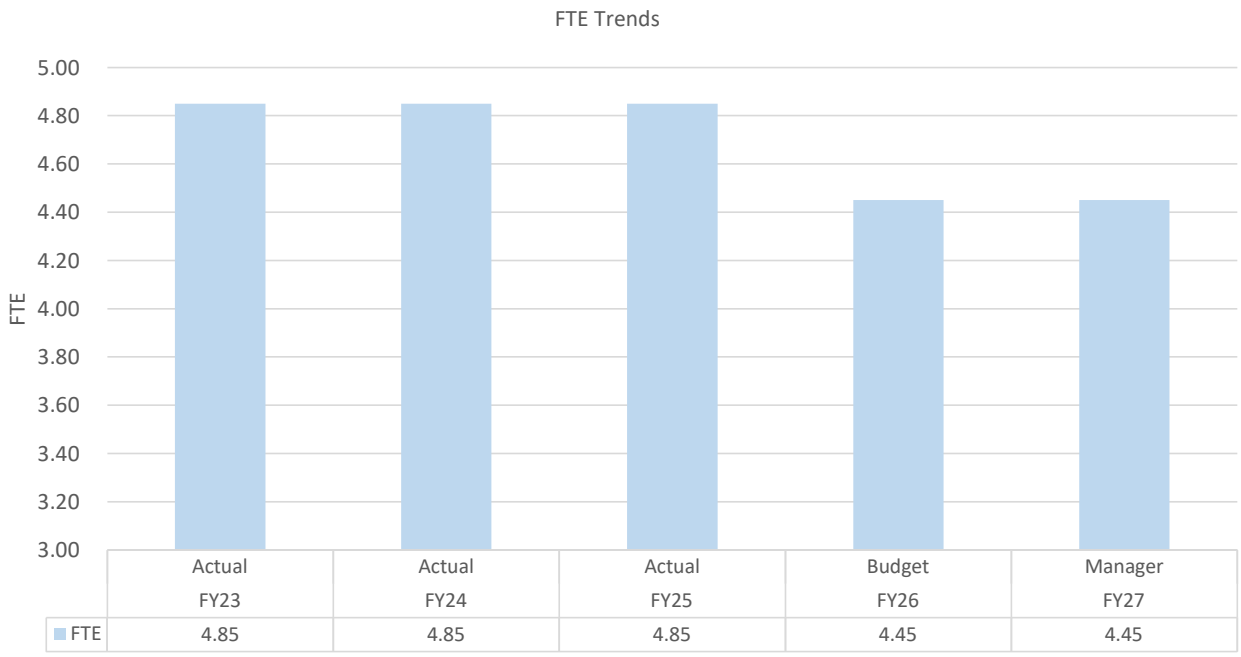
Program Subsidies provide tuition assistance to low-income families.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to steps/colas. Operating Expenses reduced to reflect historical and anticipated spending patterns.

Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Youth Programs Run	34	212	206	233	212
Adult Programs Run	11	17	18	23	24
Participants Served	4,114	13,147	19,303	17,820	16,977
Total Registrants	1,529	2,897	2,742	3,520	3,205
Total Community Events Attendees	2,585	10,250	14,070	14,200	14,440
Youth Sports Coaches Trained	12	90	80	82	80
Coaches Training Sessions Offered	1	1	1	1	2
Community Theater Tickets Processed	0	0	4,280	3,627	4,820
Fee Subsidy Families Served	103	236	228	239	247
Fee Subsidy Individuals Served	1,494	987	915	1,057	1,105
Recreation Commission Meetings	12	9	9	10	6
Program Volunteers Utilized	209	180	200	200	200
Estimated Volunteer Hours	12,508	5,760	6,520	6,231	8,120
Committees Staffed	3	4	2	2	3
Partnerships/Collaborations	7	12	12	14	16

Notable Trends:

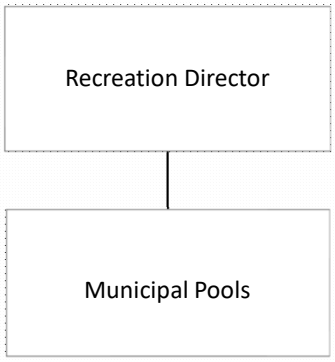
None.

For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3564/Recreation-Department

COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

Function: To provide high quality aquatics programs and experiences that are safe, fun and affordable, and that promote water safety and the enjoyment of swimming as a life-long recreational pursuit.

Organization:



(Photo of outdoor municipal pool)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Launched Aquatics Revolving Fund to support expanded programming and staffing needs for indoor and outdoor activities.
- Provided 2,400+ free swims as Town cooling center during two critical heat advisory dates.
- Provided increased pool pass access through continued partnerships with community service organizations (including ARPS Family Center, Amherst Survival Center, Amherst Housing Authority.
- Increased participation in adaptive and inclusive aquatics programs.
- Increased participation in adult swim lesson.
- Managed expanded demand for Amherst United Youth Rec Swim Team between indoor and outdoor seasons.
- Negotiated increased access to Hampshire College's pool for adult swim.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To make progress in the goal of ensuring that every Amherst child learn how to swim regardless of ability to pay.
- To manage the increasing seasonal demands of the pools.
- To offer special attention to 1-1 formats for children with special needs learning to swim.
- To equitably manage scheduling difficulties with an increasing popularity of highlighted programs in finite space.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To accommodate the increasing demands of successful aquatics offerings: Adaptive Aquatics, Masters Swimming and Amherst United. **Accomplished**
- To secure the resources necessary to commit to these expanding programs in the present and future. **Accomplished**
- To provide more creative ways of engaging the community in Amherst Recreation Outreach initiatives. **Ongoing**
- To make progress to meet the goal of ensuring that every Amherst child learn how to swim regardless of ability to pay. **Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To provide more creative ways of engaging the community in Amherst Recreation Outreach initiatives.
- To make progress to meet the goal of ensuring that every Amherst child learn how to swim regardless of ability to pay.
- To assess needs in the early stages of Aquatics Revolving Fund and provide support for any accounting challenges.
- To address access needs through potential partnerships in the colleges and wider community.

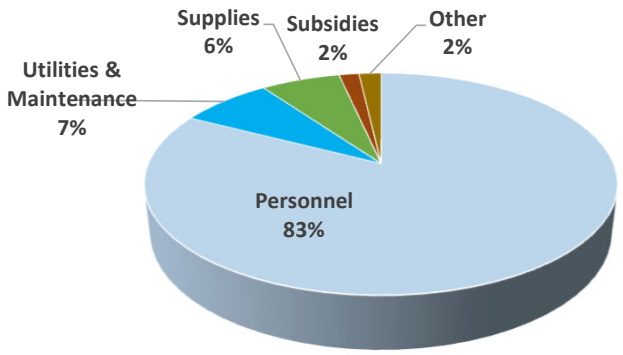
COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	167,183	142,698	180,065	177,266	203,205	25,939	14.6%
Operating Expenses	$	33,968	40,131	35,443	42,800	42,800	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	201,151	182,830	215,508	220,066	246,005	25,939	11.8%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include the Director's salary (shared 20/70/10% with the Recreation and Cherry Hill Golf Course), the Program Director (33%), the Operations Manager and a Customer Assistant are shared (7.5/92.5%) with Recreation, and part-time non-benefited lifeguards and instructors.

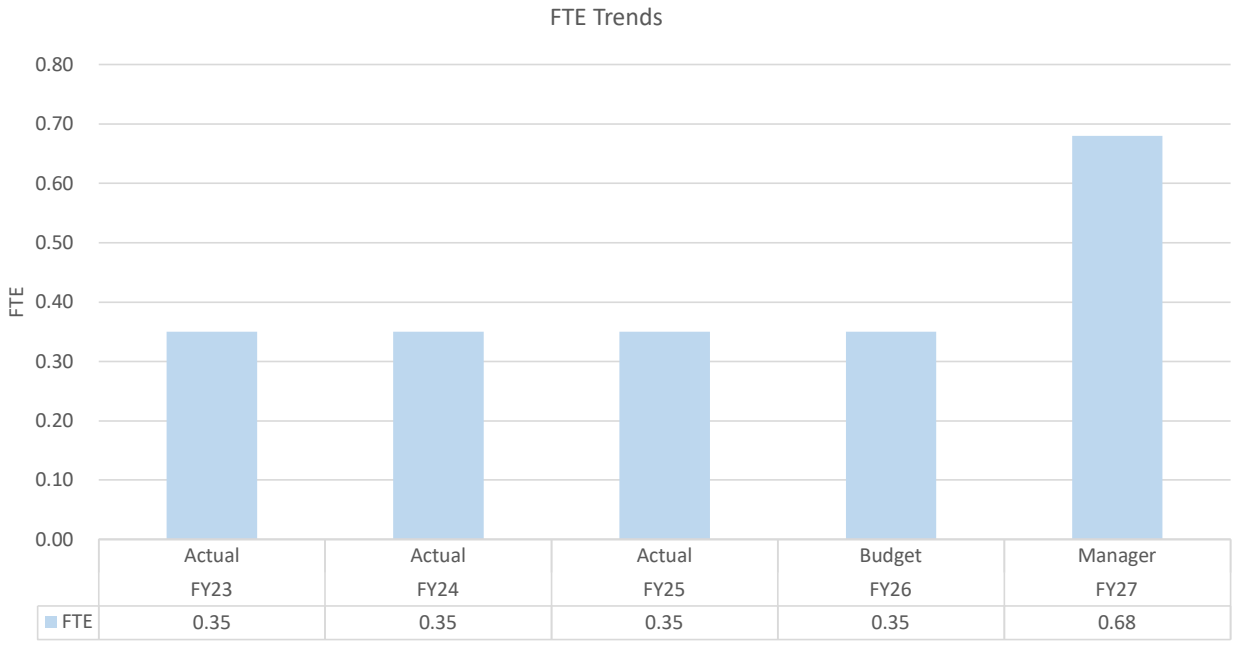
Operating Expenses include Utilities & Maintenance (electricity, fuel, water/sewer etc.), Supplies (chemicals, cleaning and other departmental supplies, as well as state-mandated uniforms), Subsidies that provide financial assistance to low income families, Other (training, credit card fees, inspections, communications and small tools and equipment).



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services reflects the addition of a .33 FTE Aquatics Program Director along with projected steps/colas.

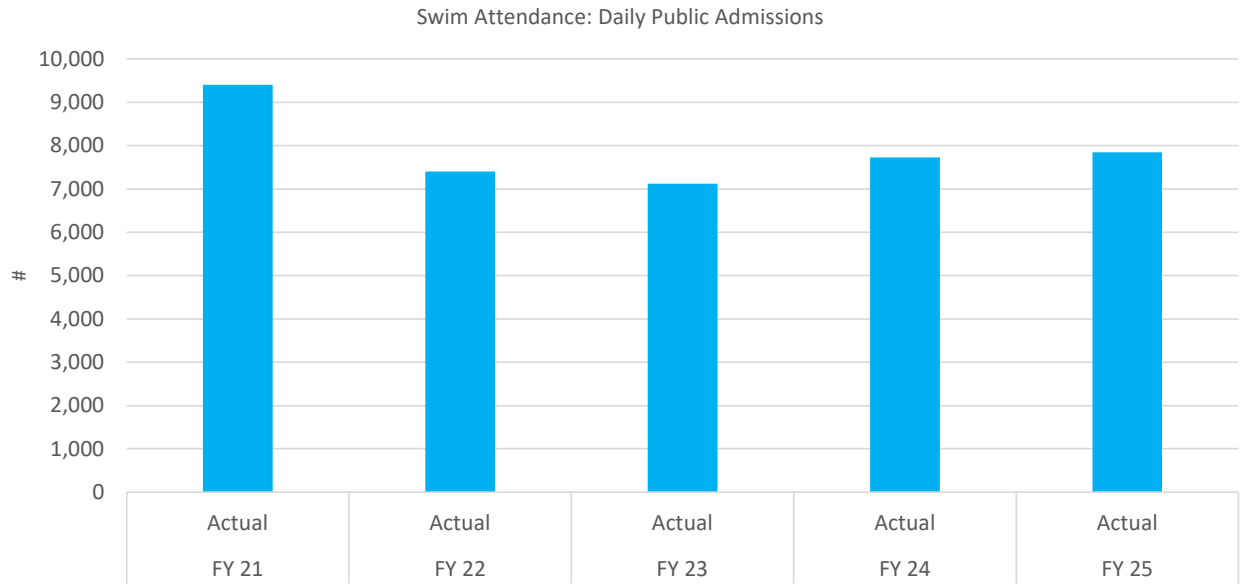
Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Number of Operating Days					
War Memorial	77	49	50	50	60
Mill River	77	66	65	65	80
Pool Memberships Sold					
Full Summer Memberships	125	129	120	112	91
Half Summer Memberships	88	42	163	102	58
Total Memberships Sold	213	171	283	214	149
Swim Attendance					
Daily Public Admissions	9,400	7,406	7,120	7,728	7,848
Camp Admissions	0	2,720	1,950	2,036	2,044
Total Admissions	9,400	10,126	9,070	9,764	9,945
Average Daily Attendance	122	176	140	170	153
(based on 65 days)					
Swim Lessons					
Public Swim Lessons Participants	61	448	461	678	630
Camp Swim Lessons Participants	0	456	515	575	579
Total Swim Lessons Attendees Participants Taught	61	904	976	1253	1,209
Free Passes Provided to Social Service Agencies	500	800	700	700	700

Notable Trends:
None.

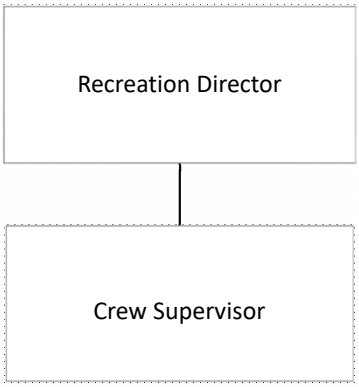


For more information, visit the Pools webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/370/Pools

COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6660)

Function: To provide a high quality and affordable golf experience for residents of the Town and the surrounding area as well as other year round recreational experiences for the community such as skiing, hiking, sledding, and special events.

Organization:



(Photo of Cherry Hill Golf Course Clubhouse)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6660)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Launched Cherry Hill Working Group of residents with staff support to analyze potential management and programming options at the course, and make recommendations to the Town Manager.
- Coordinated a more complex winter programming season centered around regularly groomed cross-country ski trails and an 18-hole disc golf course in the golf offseason.
- Hosted the Amherst Regional High School cross-country (running and skiing) teams for home meets.
- Expanded presence inside UMass campus through partnership with student marketing group.
- Exceeded high revenue marks from the prior two years with $343,000.
- Welcomed significant increases in student and senior participation.
- Coordinated a successful annual Cherry Hill Women's League, with community support for participation incentives.
- Refurbished clubhouse deck with new railings.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To manage the new presence of Disc Golf opportunities without sacrificing any of the safe, high quality golfing experience.
- To prepare for infrastructural challenges in an environmentally To generate revenue on the course during the offseason.
- To continue to expand recreational programming opportunities on the course to attract diverse participation.
- To create new generations of users with vested interest in the course- its programs and its long term health.
- To provide resources to meet infrastructure needs to keep the course operational.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To examine the structural and financial long-term viability of the course under the existing budget. **Accomplished**
- To work in active partnership with other town staff, North Amherst community members and business leaders, and Cherry Hill members to develop the clubhouse and increase its revenue-raising potential. **Accomplished**
- To introduce Disc Golf programming as an offseason supplement to golf revenue. **Accomplished**
- To expand membership, increase versatility, and continue to raise revenue. **Accomplished**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To assess Cherry Hill Working Group recommendations and build a manageable response regarding the structural and financial long-term viability of the course.
- To address short term and long term staffing concerns.
- To work in active partnership with other town staff, North Amherst community members and business leaders, and Cherry Hill members to develop the clubhouse and increase its revenue-raising potential.
- To brand winter programming and manage/integrate it as an active part of Rec programming.
- To expand membership, increase versatility, and continue to raise revenue.

COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6665)

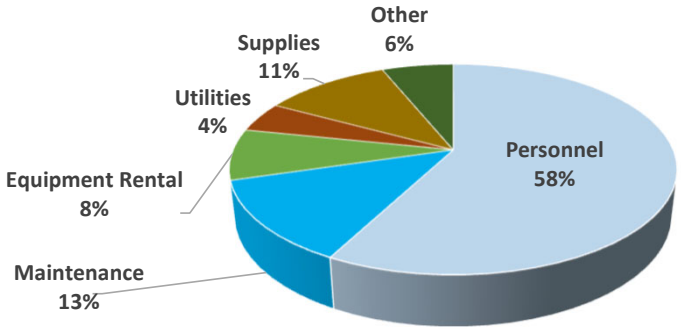
Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	146,568	152,408	155,858	156,603	161,752	5,149	3.3%
Operating Expenses	$	93,625	102,619	116,439	83,424	118,424	35,000	42.0%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	240,193	255,027	272,297	240,027	280,176	40,149	16.7%

Major Components:

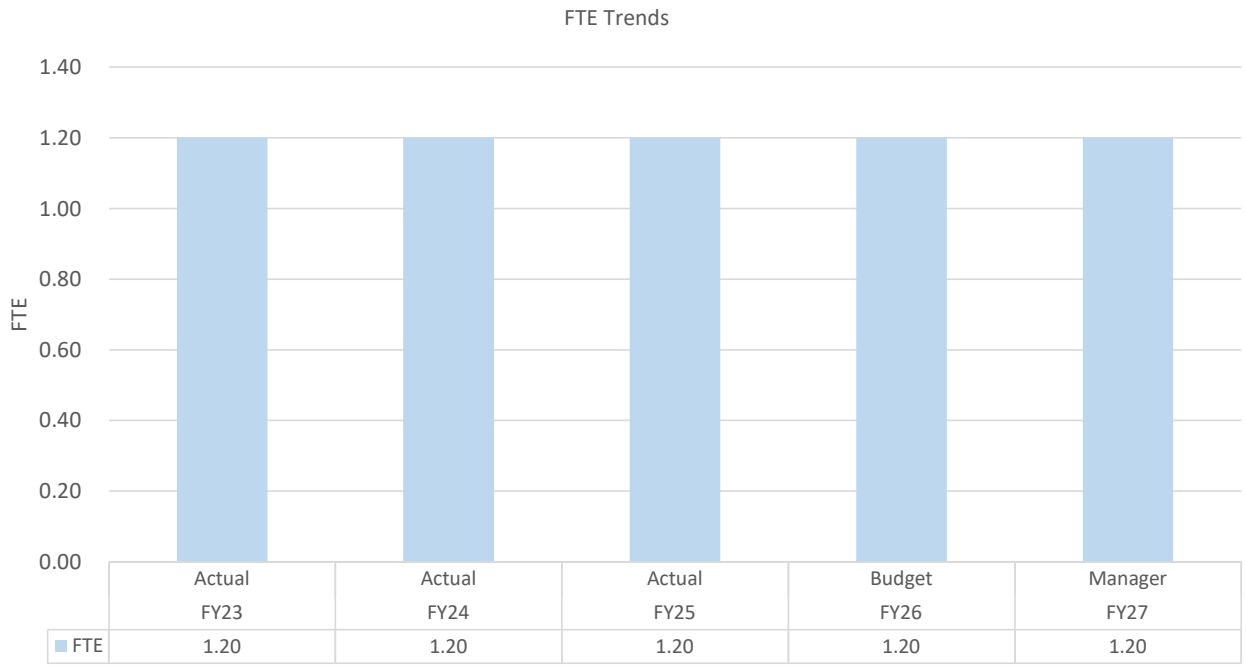
Personnel Services include the salary for the Director (shared 10/70/20% with the Recreation and Pools), a Program Director (shared 10/90% with Recreation), a Crew Supervisor and wages for part-time non-benefited help to operate the clubhouse and maintain the grounds. Operating Expenses include Maintenance (repairs to buildings, grounds, vehicles and equipment), Equipment Rental(lease of golf carts), Supplies (fertilizers, insecticides, grounds keeping, office, and equipment supplies), Utilities (fuel, electricity, water/sewer etc.), Other (banking fees, printing & advertising, communications, dues and subscriptions, etc.).

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected steps/colas. Operating Expenses increasing due to addition of funds to offset the impacts of inflation and to reflect historical spending patterns.



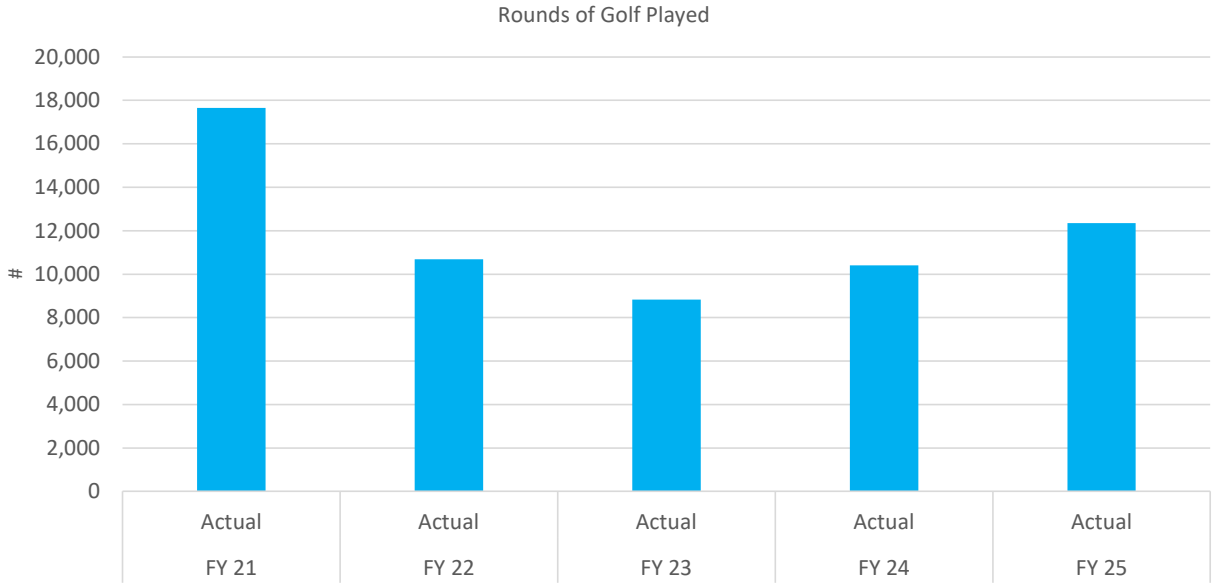
Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6660)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Rounds of Golf Played	17,659	10,684	8,829	10,403	12,343
By Members	6,935	3,973	3,895	4,108	3,221
By General Public	10,724	6,711	4,934	6,295	9,122
Operating Days	191	198	189	200	217
Average Daily Rounds Played	92	54	47	52	57
Memberships Sold	78	65	84	94	102
Partial Memberships Sold	0	0	0	0	0
Clinic Participants	18	0	4	0	0
League Participants	27	33	21	50	50
Nordic Skiers (ARHS)	40	40	40	40	40

Notable Trends:
Rounds of golf were up about 20% in FY25 compared to the previous year led by demand from the general public (rather than members). This trend was supported by the increase in the number of operating days during FY25.

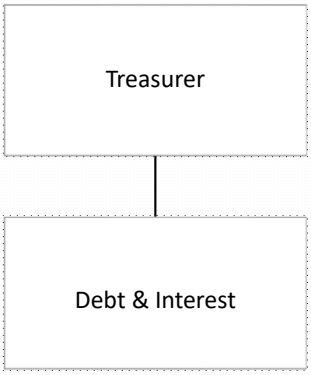


For more information, visit the Golf Course's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/373/Cherry-Hill-Golf-Course

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7701)

Function: To manage debt effectively to meet the needs of the Town and minimize debt service costs.

Organization:



(Photo of new Elementary School under construcion.)

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7701)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Issued $50 million in bonds and bond anticipation notes to fund the Amethyst Brook Elementary School and Jones Library construction projects.
- Completed Continuing Disclosure Report.
- Completed a Standard and Poor's rating review and maintained strong AA+ bond rating.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To prepare and secure financing for the Town's four municipal buildings.
- To plan for uncertain interest rates and their impact in our ability to fund major capital improvements.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To support the Town Manager and Town Council in preparing funding schedules for the four buildings projects. **Ongoing**
- To complete the annual renewal of existing short term debt and issuance of new debt to support projects in the capital program. **Accomplished/Ongoing**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To support the Town Manager and Town Council in preparing funding schedules for the four buildings projects.
- To complete the annual renewal of existing short term debt and issuance of new debt to support projects in the capital program.

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7700, 7701, 7702)

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	1,221,919	1,187,750	2,789,131	4,189,543	5,733,376	1,543,833	36.8%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	1,221,919	1,187,750	2,789,131	4,189,543	5,733,376	1,543,833	36.8%

Major Components:

	Principal	Interest	Total
AMAHT Belchertown Road CPA	55,000	16,500	71,500
Jones Library Special Collections CPA	95,000	44,476	139,476
Valley CDC - SRO Studio Apts CPA	50,000	13,750	63,750
Amethyst Brook Fields CPA	-	21,000	21,000
ARHS Track & Field CPA	100,000	66,690	166,690
Elementary School Bonds	560,000	1,392,593	1,952,593
Elementary School Short-Term Debt	215,000	165,953	380,953
Jones Library General Construction Bonds	255,000	641,707	896,707
Jones Library General Construction Short-term Debt	-	286,138	286,138
Regional School District Debt Assessment	761,660	-	761,660
I - Net Loop (PEG $450K)	60,000	7,050	67,050
Public Works Street Sweeper	60,000	3,000	63,000
School Feasibility Study	70,000	24,000	94,000
Pumper Truck	65,000	31,733	96,733
Ladder Truck	135,000	64,954	199,954
Public Safety Radio Equipment	200,000	60,000	260,000
Police Facility Chiller	108,905	3,267	112,172
Interest on Temporary Debt	-	100,000	100,000
Total	2,790,565	2,942,811	5,733,376

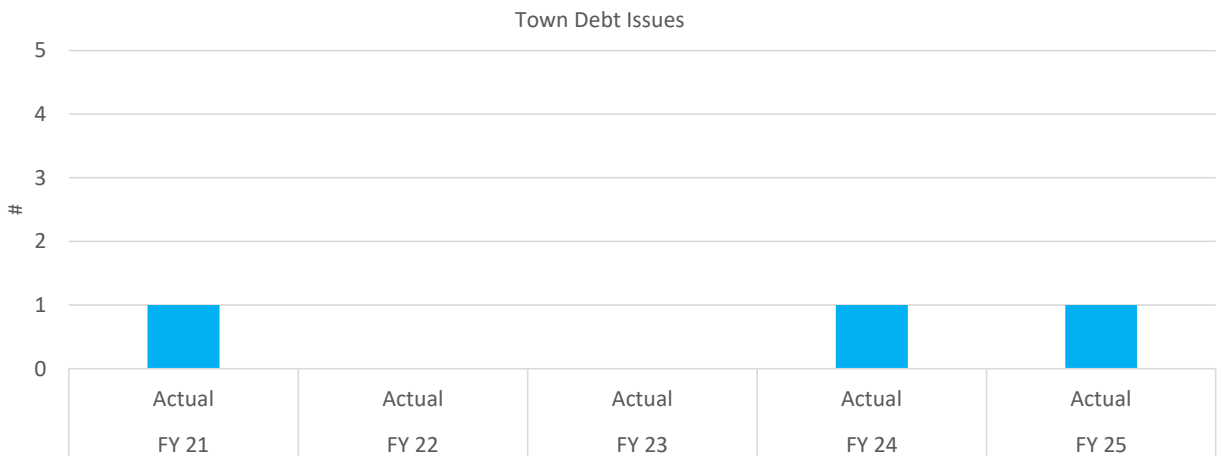
Significant Changes:

Debt is increasing in FY27 due to the initial debt payments for the Jones Library Renovation & Addition project, ARHS Track & Field, Amethyst Brook Elementary Fields, and Public Safety Radio Equipment.

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7701)

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Number of New Issues					
School Debt	0	0	0	1	1
Town Debt	1	0	0	1	1
Library Debt	0	0	0	0	1

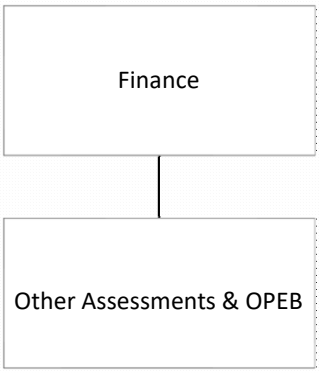
Notable Trends:
None.



OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Function: To pay for charges assessed by other governmental entities and to provide funding for Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB), i.e. health insurance and other non-pension benefits for retirees.

Organization:



(Photo of Community Gardens at Amethyst Brook Conservation Area.)

OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Recent Accomplishments:

- Updated OPEB actuarial study.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To fully fund the annual obligation to meet future OPEB liabilities.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue annual funding of the OPEB liability**.** **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue annual funding of the OPEB liability**.**
- To work with Finance Committee to develop an OPEB Liability Funding plan.

OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Budget:		FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Actual	FY26 Budget	FY27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Assessments	$	10,279,609	11,029,099	11,041,764	11,603,849	11,561,449	(42,400)	-0.4%
OPEB Contributions	$	500,000	550,000	600,000	600,000	600,000	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	10,779,609	11,579,099	11,641,764	12,203,849	12,161,449	(42,400)	-0.3%

Major Components:								
State Assessments								
Air Pollution Districts	$	9,520	9,722	10,098	10,415	9,902	(513)	-4.9%
RMV Non Renewal Surcharge	$	30,180	30,180	20,900	20,900	21,620	720	3.4%
Regional Transit (PVTA)	$	1,290,121	1,391,239	1,346,567	1,457,681	1,094,498	(363,183)	-24.9%
Special Education	$	-	-	18,899	19,655	-	(19,655)	-100.0%
School Choice Tuition	$	361,311	384,626	412,719	408,165	471,502	63,337	15.5%
Charter School Tuition	$	1,658,685	1,705,555	1,798,616	1,909,630	2,127,545	217,915	11.4%
County Regional Lockup	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
PVPC	$	6,993	7,168	7,347	-	-	-	--
Retirement Assessment	$	6,922,799	7,500,609	7,426,618	7,777,403	7,836,382	58,979	0.8%
Total Appropriations	$	10,279,609	11,029,099	11,041,764	11,603,849	11,561,449	(42,400)	-0.4%

Significant Changes:

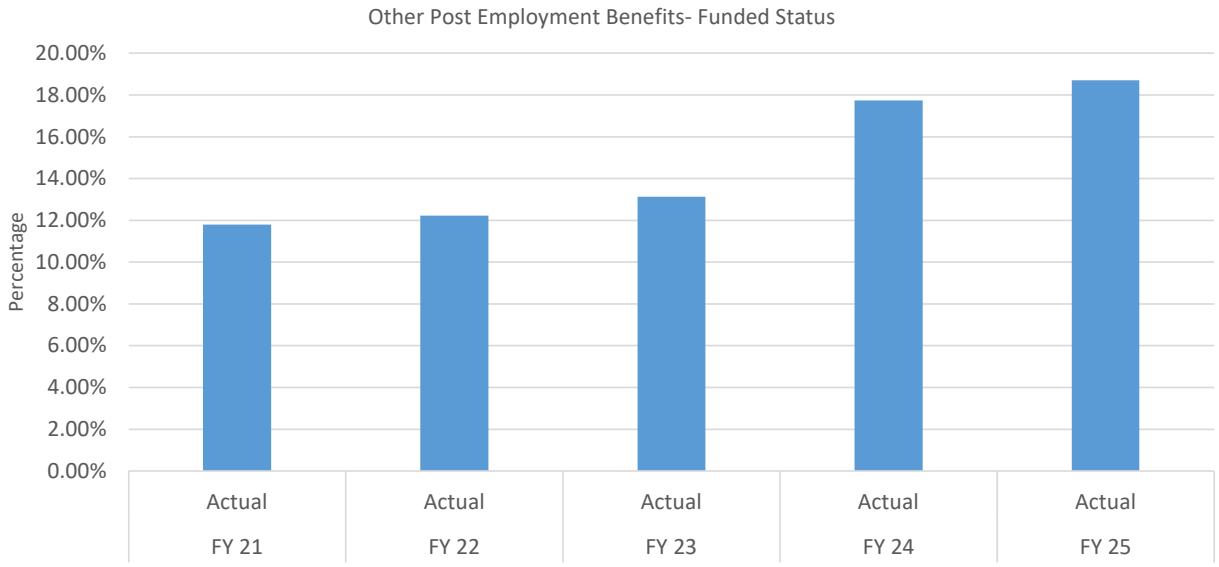
Assessments are changing due to increases and decreases from the State and the Hampshire County Retirement System. The retirement assessment for FY27 had a very minimal increase. The Regional Transit assessment is dropping due to Amherst routes staying flat while other transit system members have expanded or increased routes. Charter School Tuition is based on enrollment estimates.

OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Percent of Pension System	26.26%	26.16%	25.56%	25.79%	24.59%
Funded Status (Percentage)					
Hampshire County Retirement System	69.30%	78.55%	68.10%	75.10%	N/A
Other Post Employment Benefits	11.80%	12.22%	13.13%	17.74%	18.71%

Notable Trends:

The Town's slow and steady approach to funding Other Post Employment Benefits has resulted in almost 20% of the liability being funded.



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Enterprise Fund Summary & Detail

Overview

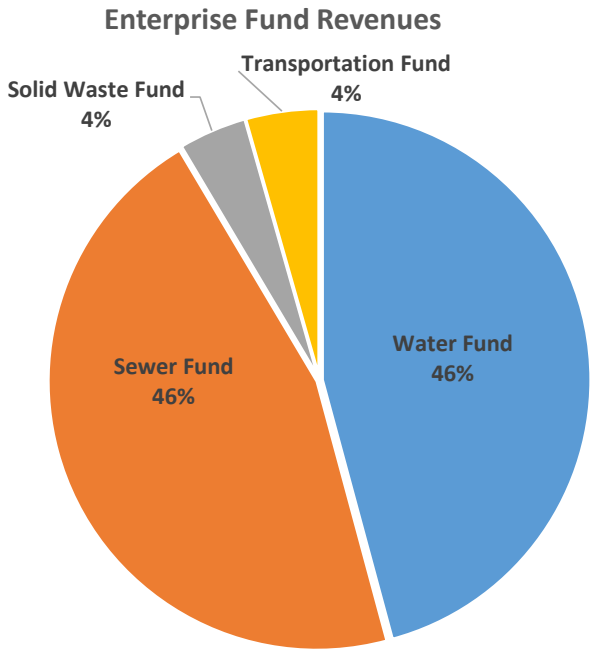
The following section provides a summary and additional details about the Enterprise Fund budgets including revenue and expenditure data.

ENTERPRISE FUND SUMMARY

Revenues:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Water Fund	$	5,283,350	5,365,159	5,962,101	7,002,500	7,331,475	328,975	4.7%
Sewer Fund	$	5,452,103	5,865,308	7,014,075	6,986,725	7,308,014	321,289	4.6%
Solid Waste Fund	$	717,632	626,188	820,361	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%
Transportation Fund	$	721,022	753,934	915,095	738,984	707,044	(31,940)	-4.3%
Total Revenues	$	12,174,106	12,610,589	14,711,631	15,368,328	16,005,695	637,367	4.1%
Expenditures:								
Water Fund	$	5,144,209	5,231,719	5,432,905	7,002,500	7,331,475	328,975	4.7%
Sewer Fund	$	5,005,545	5,823,189	6,566,914	6,986,725	7,308,014	321,289	4.6%
Solid Waste Fund	$	528,153	651,279	585,202	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%
Transportation Fund	$	648,184	657,969	824,673	738,984	707,044	(31,940)	-4.3%
Total Expenditures	$	11,326,091	12,364,156	13,409,694	15,368,328	16,005,695	637,367	4.1%
Fund Gain/(Loss)	$	848,015	246,433	1,301,937	-	0	0	--

Significant Changes:

Costs are rising due to projected steps/colas for Enterprise Fund employees along with operating increases. A new operator position has been added in both the Water and Sewer Enterprise Funds. The Transportation Fund budget overall is declining due to lower than anticipated revenues which impacts funding available for capital projects. Both the Solid Waste Fund and the Transportation fund require the use of Retained Earnings in FY27 due to revenue shortfalls.



ENTERPRISE FUND SUMMARY

Enterprise Fund Overview:

An enterprise fund is a separate accounting and financial reporting mechanism used to manage municipal services for which a fee is charged in exchange for goods or services. The Town has four Enterprise Funds: Water, Sewer, Solid Waste, and Transportation.

Water Enterprise Fund: This fund manages all of the costs associated with providing water to the Town. This includes costs to manage the Town's water sources, costs to make sure the water is safe to drink, and costs to get water to each household or property. In exchange for these services, the Town bills users based on their water consumption.

Sewer Enterprise Fund: This fund manages all of the costs associated with disposing of sewer related waste. This includes costs to manage the infrastructure that brings sewage from properties to the sewer treatment facility, costs to treat the sewage and prepare it for disposal, and the costs to actually dispose of it. In exchange for these services, the Town bills users based on their sewage discharge.

Solid Waste Enterprise Fund: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's solid waste. This includes costs to collect solid waste, costs to manage the Town's landfill, and costs to dispose of solid waste. In exchange for these services, the Town bills users based on the service provided.

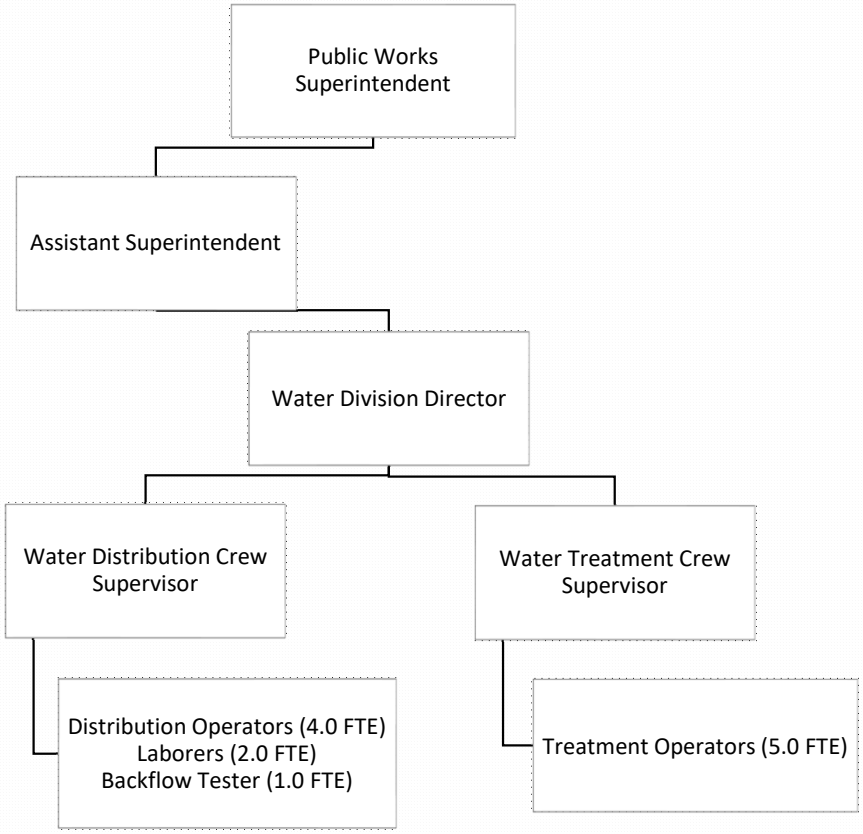
Transportation Enterprise Fund: This fund manages costs associated with Town related transportation services. This includes costs for public transportation, costs to maintain parking lots, and costs to enforce parking regulations. In exchange for these services, the Town collects parking fees and a variety of other revenue sources related to transportation.

(Photo of Water Treatment Staff at the Ribbon Cutting Ceremony for the new Centennial Water Treatment Plant.)

WATER FUND

Function: To develop, treat, and distribute a sufficient supply of high quality water to meet the needs of Amherst residents, businesses, and institutions through a user fee based revenue system.

Organization:



(Photo of first of its kind solar-powered groundwater treatment system in the Pine Grove and Hollow neighborhood.)

WATER FUND

Recent Accomplishments:

- Replaced water main on Amity Street from University Dr. to Dana Street for roundabout construction.
- Abandoned 6" Cast Iron water main on South East St. between Main St. and College St. and moved water services to 12" Ductile Iron main.
- Installed new pump and well column at Well #2.
- Paved Driveway and installed drainage at Baby Carriage Brook Water Treatment Plant.
- Replaced large water meters and vaults at Hampshire College.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain Water Division staff at the current level and retain employees.
- To design and replace valves and screens at the Atkins Reservoir screen house.
- To replace/repair roof at the Atkins Water Treatment Facility.
- To replace water lines on South Valley Road and Jones Road.
- To create a more efficient system to read, replace, and fix problematic water meters.
- To install a new backup generator for Wells #1 & #2.
- To incorporate a new drought emergency response plan.
- To replace large capacity meters and vaults.
- To replace of all 4" water mains.
- To operate a new treatment facility that has different technology than any other facility.
- To demolish East Pleasant St. Tank and transfer controls for system to Village Park Tank.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To implement the new water use restrictions based on requirement established by the State. **Accomplished**
- To manage the replacement of the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility upgrades. **Accomplished**
- To continue the process of replacing large capacity meters and vaults. **Ongoing**
- To continue to replace and upgrade all water meters to radio-read units. **Ongoing**
- To replace the boards and framing at Hills Reservoir. **Accomplished**
- To pave the driveway at the Baby Carriage Brook Water Treatment Facility. **Accomplished**
- To loop water line feeding the Town's Wastewater Treatment Facility to the line serving the University to assure a better supply to the Wastewater Treatment Facility. **Ongoing**

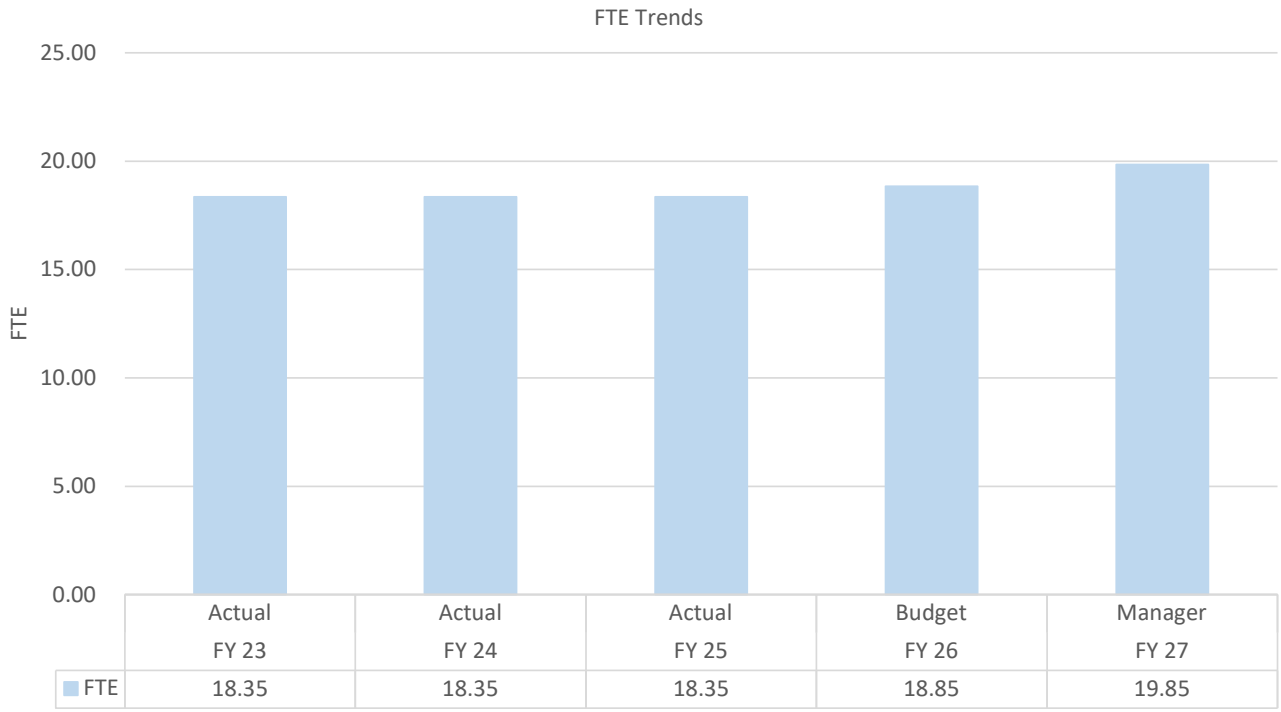
Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue the process of replacing large capacity meters and vaults.
- To continue to replace and upgrade all water meters to radio-read units.
- To loop water line feeding the Town's Wastewater Treatment Facility to the line serving the University to assure a better supply to the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- To conduct a leak survey of the entire distribution system.
- To inspect and clean the inside of the 3 water storage tanks in distribution system.
- To replace the roof at Atkins Water Treatment Plant.

WATER FUND

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	4,943,241	4,861,267	5,545,299	6,772,500	7,031,475	258,975	3.8%
Interest and Late Fees	$	93,515	109,158	163,401	40,000	85,000	45,000	112.5%
Other	$	246,594	226,855	253,400	190,000	215,000	25,000	13.2%
Subtotal Revenues	$	5,283,350	5,197,281	5,962,101	7,002,500	7,331,475	328,975	4.7%
Returned Capital	$	-	59,178	-	-	-	-	--
Retaining Earnings	$	-	108,700	-	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	5,283,350	5,365,159	5,962,101	7,002,500	7,331,475	328,975	4.7%
Operating Budget	$	3,593,334	3,574,654	3,628,173	4,017,662	4,356,251	338,589	8.4%
Debt Service	$	545,627	626,850	849,412	1,394,904	1,327,592	(67,312)	-4.8%
Capital Program	$	465,000	505,632	415,000	1,000,000	1,040,000	40,000	4.0%
Total Appropriation	$	4,603,961	4,707,136	4,892,585	6,412,566	6,723,843	311,277	4.9%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	540,248	524,583	540,320	589,934	607,632	17,698	3.0%
Total Expenditures	$	5,144,209	5,231,719	5,432,905	7,002,500	7,331,475	328,975	4.7%

Staffing Trends:

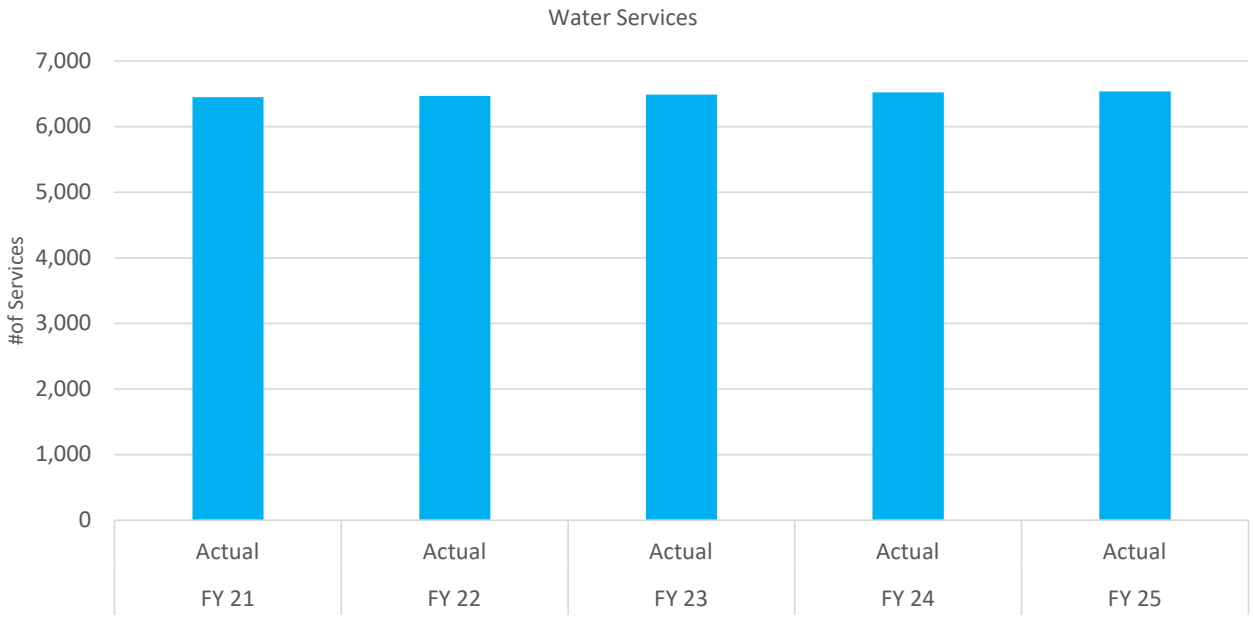


WATER FUND

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
New Water Services Installed	14	20	18	35	13
Water Service Relays	6	4	10	9	12
Water Services	6,448	6,468	6,486	6,521	6,534
Water Metered					
& Produced (billion gallons)	0.80	0.89	0.93	0.91	1.00
Positive Coliform Bacteria Samples	0	7	4	0	8
Meters Installed	268	353	290	203	429
Hydrants in Service	1,148	1,166	1,168	1,170	1,175
Frozen Water Services	0	3	0	0	0
Hydrants Repaired	72	57	65	60	67
Water Mains Flushed (mi)	114	116	116	116	116
Water Main Breaks Repaired	2	4	5	6	7
Meters Read by Radio	60%	68%	71%	75%	82%
Debt Issues					
Issues Outstanding	3	3	3	4	5
New Issues	2	0	0	1	1
Capital Projects					
Departmental Equipment	0	1	1	1	1
Existing Facilities	2	2	4	3	3
New Facilities	1	0	0	0	0

Notable Trends:

Debt issuances are increasing as the Town finalizes its financing of the Centennial Water Treatment Plant.



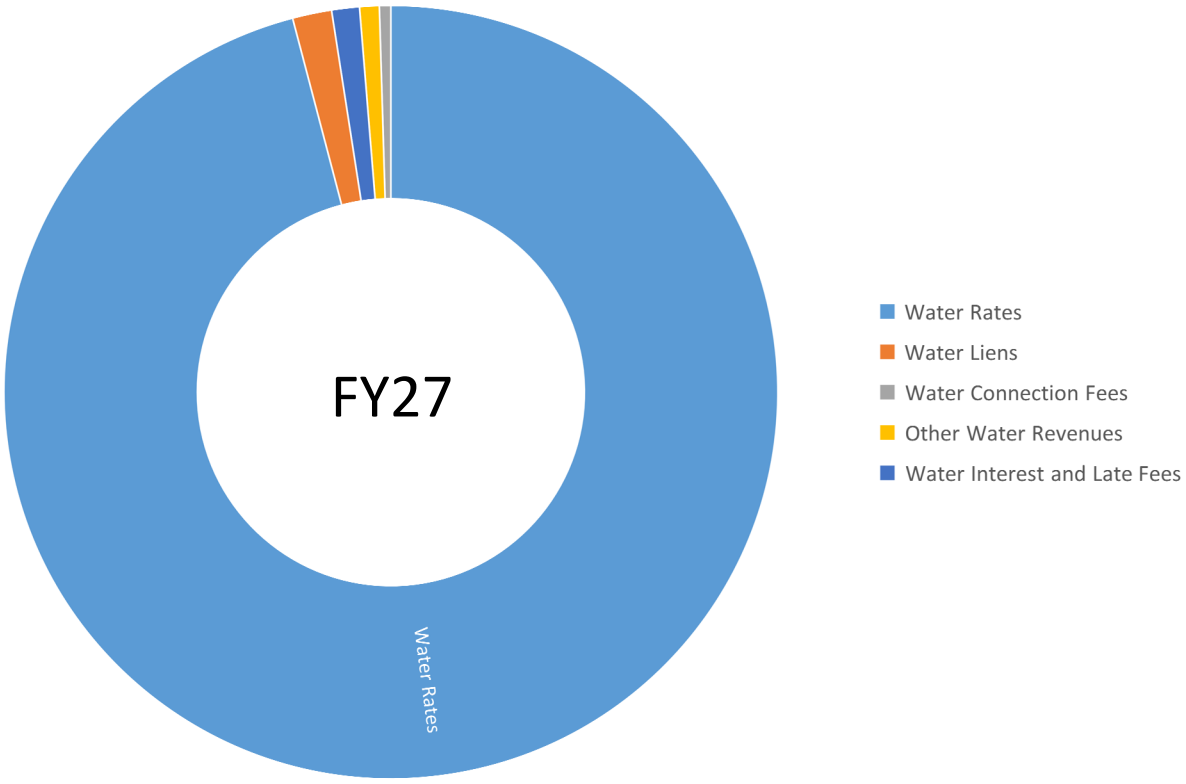
For more information, visit the Water Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/179/Water

WATER FUND

Revenue Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Water Rates	$	4,943,241	4,861,267	5,545,299	6,772,500	7,031,475	258,975	3.8%
Water Liens	$	112,718	124,101	127,079	95,000	120,000	25,000	26.3%
Water Connection Fees	$	32,300	27,400	42,500	35,000	35,000	-	--
Other Water Revenues	$	101,575	243,232	83,821	60,000	60,000	-	--
Water Interest and Late Fees	$	93,515	109,158	163,401	40,000	85,000	45,000	112.5%
Total Revenues	$	5,283,350	5,365,159	5,962,101	7,002,500	7,331,475	328,975	4.7%

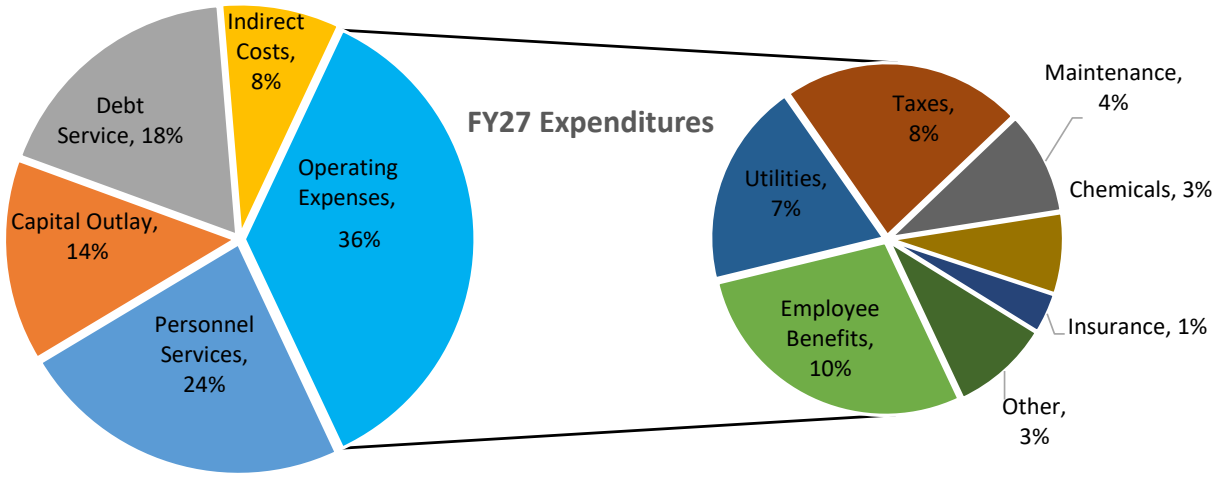
Significant Changes:

Water rate revenue is projected to grow by 3.8% due to a recommended increase in the water rate. For FY27, the proposed rate will increase from $6.45 to $6.75 per hundred cubic feet. A reduction in consumption is projected as a result of the upcoming closure of Hampshire College. Rates are expected to continue rising in the coming years to make necessary updates to the Town's aging water infrastructure. One of the Town's most important responsibilities is to provide an adequate supply of safe, potable water for its residents, and the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility will help ensure that this continues well into the future.



WATER FUND

Expenditure Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	1,207,462	1,210,392	1,313,319	1,540,888	1,713,545	172,657	11.2%
Operating Expenses	$	2,385,872	2,364,262	2,314,854	2,476,774	2,642,706	165,932	6.7%
Capital Outlay	$	465,000	505,632	415,000	1,000,000	1,040,000	40,000	4.0%
Debt Service	$	545,627	626,850	849,412	1,394,904	1,327,592	(67,312)	-4.8%
Indirect Costs	$	540,248	524,583	540,320	589,934	607,632	17,698	3.0%
Total Expenditures	$	5,144,209	5,231,719	5,432,905	7,002,500	7,331,475	328,975	4.7%



Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Assistant Superintendent (shared with the Sewer Fund and the General Fund), one Division Director, two Division Supervisors, five Water Treatment Operators, four distribution operators, two laborers, one Maintenance Worker, and one Backflow Tester. The Town Engineer, the Civil Engineer, a Division Supervisor, a Clerk, an Administrative Analyst, an Applications Manager, and an Engineer Technician are shared with the General Fund and Sewer Fund. A Utility Technician, Asset Manager, Environmental Scientist, and an Electrician are shared with the Sewer Fund. The Procurement Officer is shared with the General Fund, Sewer Fund and Transportation Fund. Also included is $70,000 for overtime. $744,679 is budgeted for health, retirement, life insurance, and other benefits, including a payment of $79,000 into the OPEB Trust Fund.

WATER FUND

Capital Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$	55,000	55,000	55,000	-	55,000	55,000	--
Existing Facilities	$	410,000	341,932	360,000	1,000,000	985,000	(15,000)	-1.5%
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	465,000	396,932	415,000	1,000,000	1,040,000	40,000	4.0%

Significant Changes:
Departmental equipment is increasing due to the replacement of one vehicle planned for next year.

Major Components:
Includes, $600,000 for water system improvements, $375,000 for water treatment system improvements, $55,000 for one truck replacement, and $10,000 for a water system leak study.

(Photo of Water Department Division Director giving a tour of the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility.)

WATER FUND

Debt Service:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	425,000	475,000	680,000	1,007,253	943,557	(63,696)	-6.3%
Interest	$	120,627	151,850	169,412	387,651	384,035	(3,616)	-0.9%
Total Appropriation	$	545,627	626,850	849,412	1,394,904	1,327,592	(67,312)	-4.8%

Significant Changes:

None.

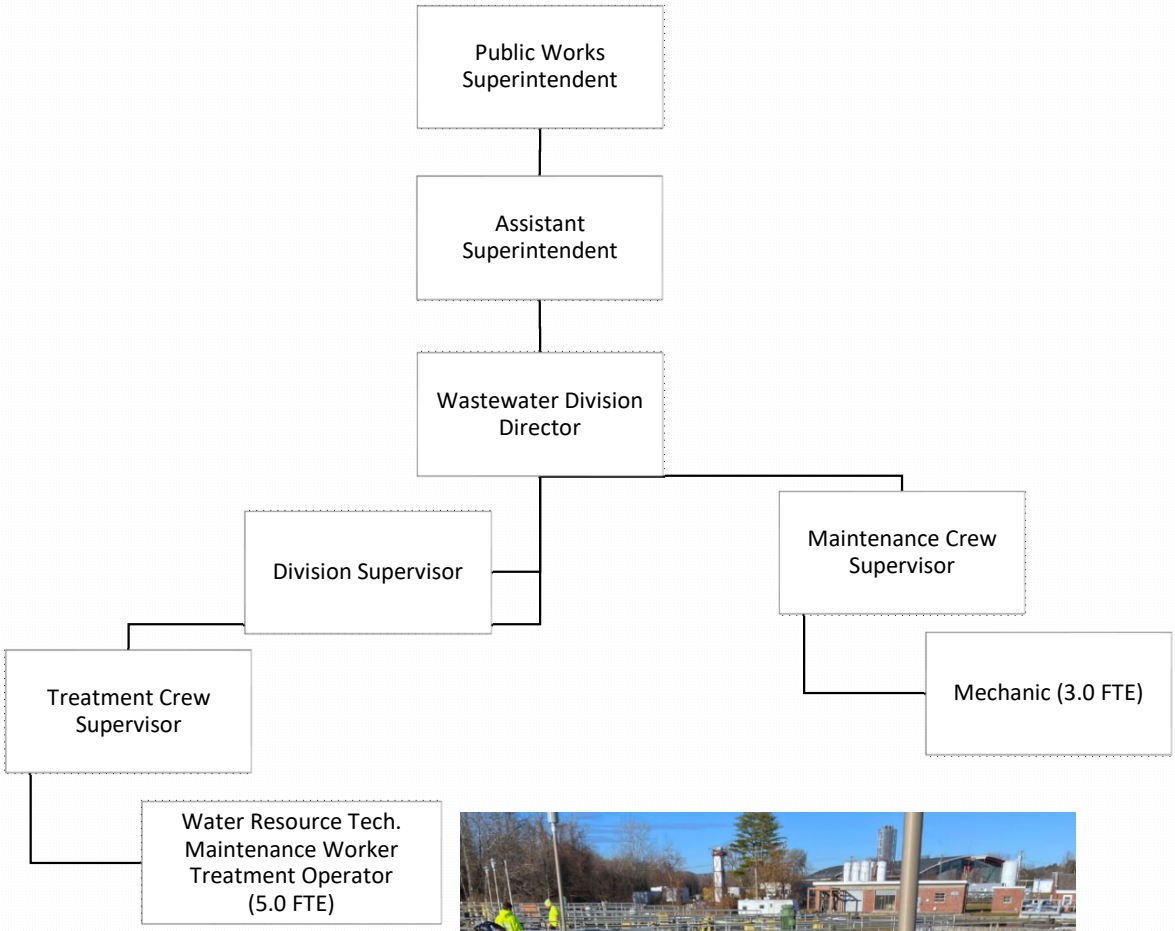
Major Components:

	Principal	Interest
Centennial Water Treatment Facility	$200,000	$30,600
Pine Street Extension	50,000	14,250
Water Meter Radios	70,000	4,200
Centennial Treatment Facility Engineering	65,000	8,750
Centennial Treatment Facility Construction	$473,557	$250,593
Northampton Road Water Main	55,000	43,050
Well # 4 Replace/Repair	30,000	4,200
Short Term Interest		28,392
Total	$943,557	$384,035

SEWER FUND

Function: To provide an environmentally safe system for collection, treatment, and disposal of sewage and to do so through a user-fee-based revenue system.

Organization:



(Photo of a DPW employee giving a tour of the of the Wastewater Treatment Facility)

SEWER FUND

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed installation of a new Gravity Belt Thickener.
- Replaced the Wastewater Treatment Facility effluent duplex strainer, a 500 lb. device used to remove particles from the effluent to create Plant Water.
- Replaced the slide gate valves in the aeration basin and final clarifier #1. These are 24 X 36 inch isolation valves used to isolate major components of the facility.
- Finished the installation of a replacement pump station for Southeast #4. Includes new wet well, pump assembly, generator and force main. This work was done with Contractor and Town forces.
- Sliplined several sewer mains in Town, including the gravity main near Greenleaves apartments.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To manage an aging facility.
- To continue rebuilding the institutional knowledge of the wastewater collection and treatment systems.
- To reduce inflow and infiltration at the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- To acquire parts and supplies that are difficult to source and have long lead times.
- To develop a fee structure for re-use water and effluent.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To complete replacement of three large effluent valves at the Wastewater Treatment Facility. **Ongoing**
- To begin a comprehensive Wastewater Treatment Facility study. **Accomplished**
- To complete pH study of the wastewater treatment processes. **Accomplished**
- To begin chlorine system study and analysis. **Accomplished**
- To slipline several sewer lines in Town to restore structural integrity and stop water infiltration. **Ongoing**

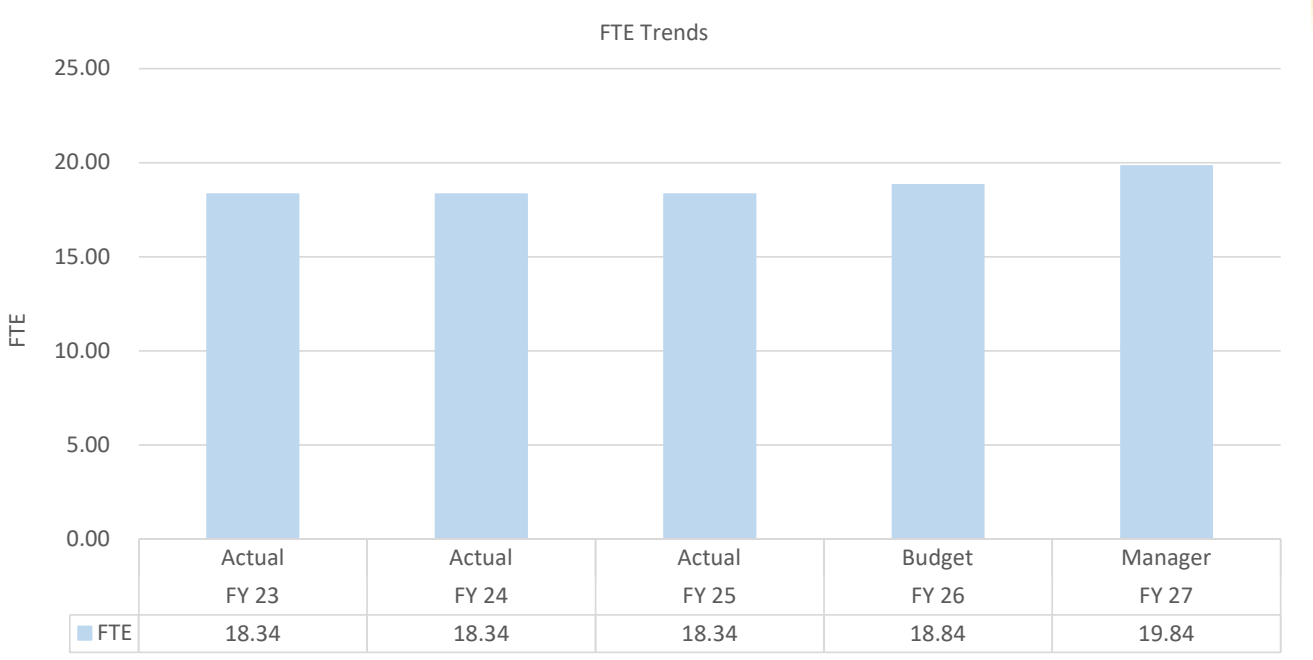
Upcoming Objectives:

- To complete replacement of three large effluent valves at the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- To complete comprehensive Wastewater Treatment Facility study.
- To slipline several sewer lines in Town to restore structural integrity and stop water infiltration.
- To repair final clarifier draft tubes.
- To install Stamford Baffles in final clarifier #1.

SEWER FUND

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	5,019,362	4,966,961	5,762,952	6,640,725	6,920,014	279,289	4.2%
Interest and Late Fees	$	129,286	181,075	118,943	80,000	90,000	10,000	12.5%
Other	$	303,455	213,530	307,180	266,000	298,000	32,000	12.0%
Subtotal Revenues	$	5,452,103	5,361,566	6,189,075	6,986,725	7,308,014	321,289	4.6%
Returned Capital	$	-	3,742	-	-	-	-	--
Other Financing Sources	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Retained Earnings	$	-	500,000	825,000	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	5,452,103	5,865,308	7,014,075	6,986,725	7,308,014	321,289	4.6%
Operating Budget	$	3,740,591	3,967,639	4,117,086	4,672,092	4,848,769	176,677	3.8%
Debt Service	$	652,220	919,924	992,184	1,150,623	1,246,614	95,991	8.3%
Capital Program	$	293,620	735,000	1,045,000	710,000	745,000	35,000	4.9%
Total Appropriation	$	4,686,431	5,622,563	6,154,269	6,532,715	6,840,384	307,669	4.7%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	319,114	200,626	412,645	454,010	467,630	13,620	3.0%
Total Expenditures	$	5,005,545	5,823,189	6,566,914	6,986,725	7,308,014	321,289	4.6%

Staffing Trends:

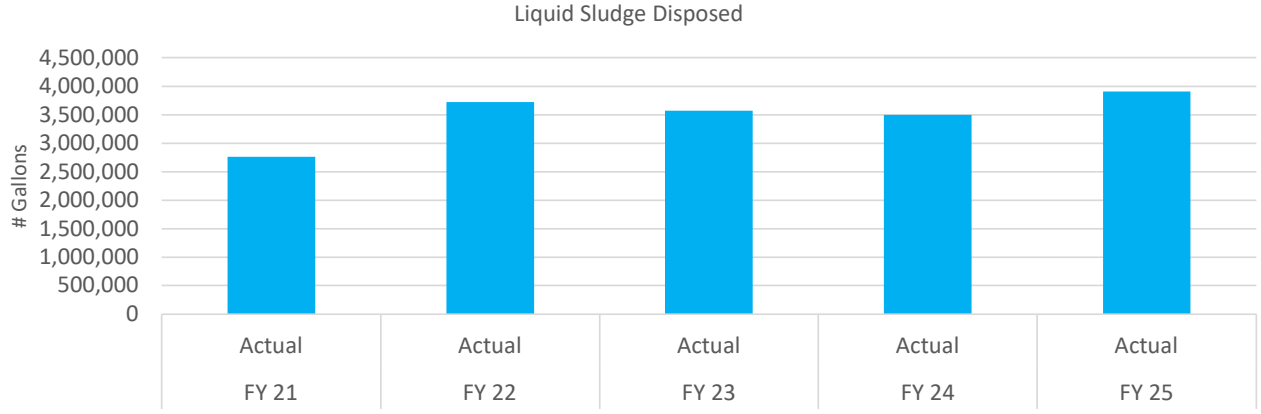


SEWER FUND

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Sanitary Sewer Complaints	39	36	36	35	33
Sewer Main Stoppages	12	12	16	18	16
Sewer Main Flushing (mi)	15.41	22.85	19	1	5.16
Sewer Mains Treated for Roots (linear ft)	7,183	5,289	5,223	5,223	2,654
Sewer Maintained (miles)	123	123	123	123	123
T.V.'d Sections of Problem Sewers (linear ft)	34,862	13,595	5,831	1,000	184
Sewer Rehabilitated (ft)	0	0	3	0	2043
Sewer Replaced (ft)	10	80	231	400	157
Flow Totals (billion gals)	1.21	1.5	1.41	1.5	1.39
Chlorine (lbs)	10,348	18,548	11,555	10,000	11,422
Polymer (lbs)	1,855	2,925	2,935	3,000	2,364
Tests Achieving EPA Standards:					
Main Plant	99.21%	99.53%	99.25%	90.00%	98.00%
Pumping Stations Operated	22	22	22	22	22
Grit & Screenings Deposited at Sanitary					
Landfill (cu.yd.)	45	72	63	54	51.4
Septic Waste Delivered to Plant (loads)	425	488	347	350	371
Liquid Sludge Disposed (gal)	2,762,200	3,724,500	3,573,600	3,500,000	3,906,500
Dry Sludge Produced (tons)	723	904	933	900	879
Debt Issues					
Issues Outstanding	3	3	3	4	5
New Issues	1	0	0	1	1
Capital Projects					
Departmental Equipment	0	0	2	0	1
Existing Facilities	2	3	2	4	3
New Facilities	0	0	0	0	0

Notable Trends:

Debt issuances increasing as the Gravity Belt project financing is completed.



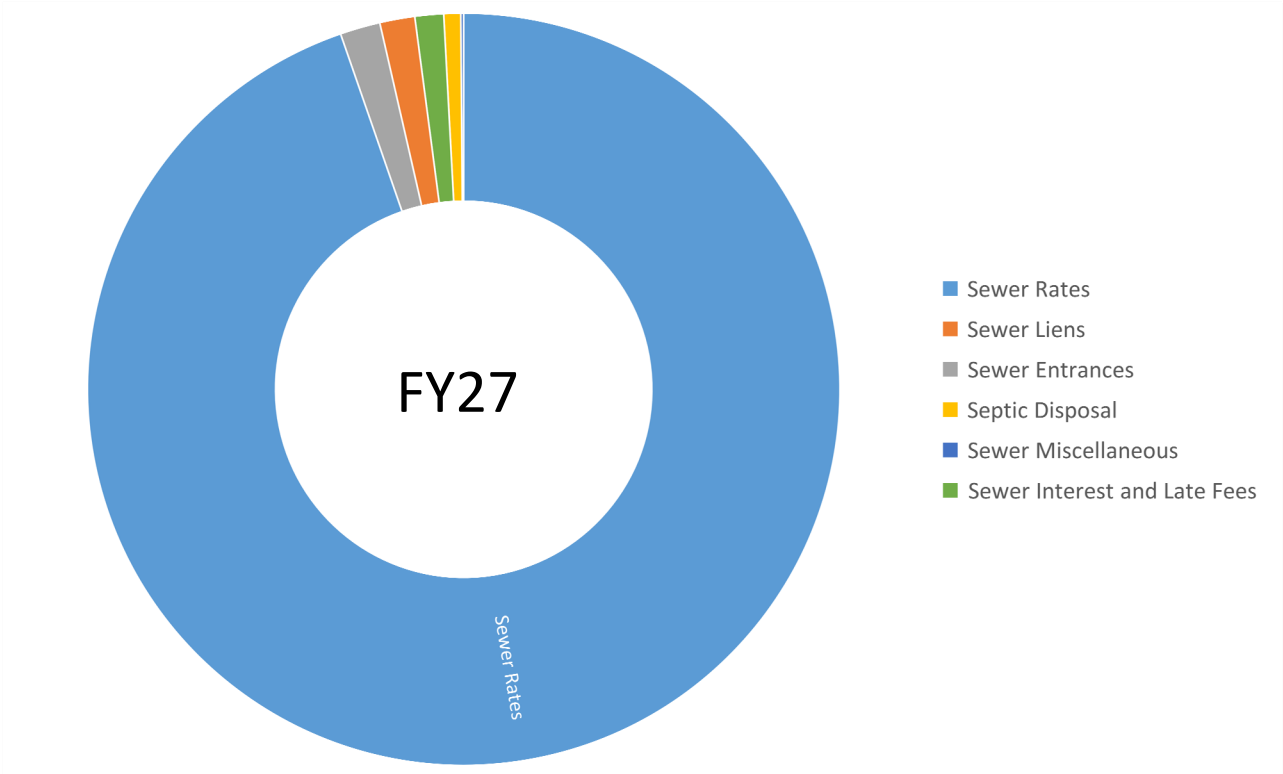
https://www.amherstma.gov/166/Wastewater

SEWER FUND

Revenue Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Sewer Rates	$	5,019,362	4,966,961	5,762,952	6,640,725	6,920,014	279,289	4.2%
Sewer Liens	$	102,886	108,348	113,845	90,000	110,000	20,000	22.2%
Sewer Entrances	$	121,227	37,225	103,250	126,000	126,000	-	--
Septic Disposal	$	62,400	53,850	79,030	50,000	53,000	3,000	6.0%
Sewer Miscellaneous	$	16,943	517,849	836,055	0	9,000	9,000	--
Sewer Interest and Late Fees	$	129,286	181,075	118,943	80,000	90,000	10,000	12.5%
Total Revenues	$	5,452,103	5,865,308	7,014,075	6,986,725	7,308,014	321,289	4.6%

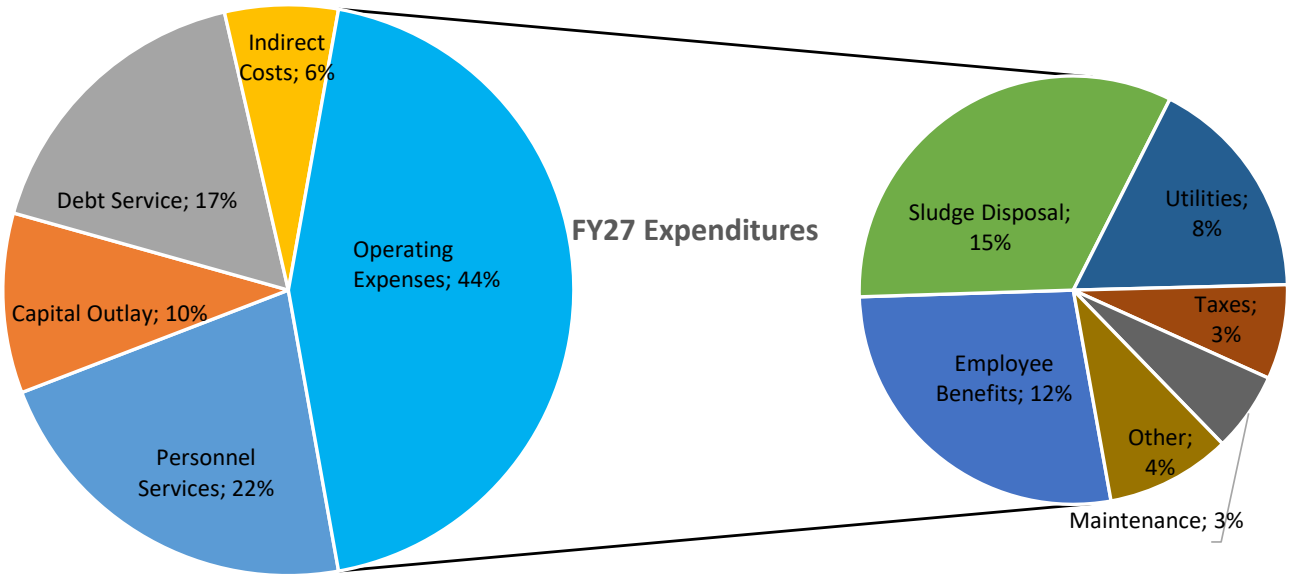
Significant Changes:

Sewer rate revenue is projected to increase by 4.2% due to a recommended increase in the sewer rate. For FY27, the proposed rate will increase from $6.95 to $7.30 per hundred cubic feet. Consumption is projected to decrease due to the closure of Hampshire College. Rates are expected to continue rising in the coming years to fund the debt of the new Gravity Belt Thickener and to make necessary updates to the Town's aging waste water infrastructure.



SEWER FUND

Expenditure Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	1,207,015	1,284,458	1,248,113	1,565,324	1,605,837	40,513	2.6%
Operating Expenses	$	2,533,576	2,683,181	2,868,973	3,106,768	3,242,932	136,164	4.4%
Capital Outlay	$	293,620	735,000	1,045,000	710,000	745,000	35,000	4.9%
Debt Service	$	652,220	919,924	992,184	1,150,623	1,246,614	95,991	8.3%
Indirect Costs	$	319,114	200,626	412,645	454,010	467,630	13,620	3.0%
Total Expenditures	$	5,005,545	5,823,189	6,566,914	6,986,725	7,308,014	321,289	4.6%



Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Assistant Superintendent (shared with the Water Fund and the General Fund), a Division Director, two Supervisors, a Water Resources Technician, a crew supervisor, five Treatment Operators, a maintenance worker, and three Mechanics. Engineering division staff, a Division Supervisor, an Office Manager, an Administrative Analyst, and an Applications Manager, are shared with the General Fund and the Water Fund. A Utility Technician, Asset Manager, Environmental Scientist, and an Electrician are shared with the Water Fund. The Procurement Officer is shared with the General Fund, Water Fund, and Transportation Fund. Also included is $42,800 for overtime. $886,020 is budgeted for health, retirement, life insurance, and other benefits, including a payment of $150,000 into the OPEB Trust Fund.

SEWER FUND

Capital Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Manager	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$	60,000	-	60,000	-	55,000	55,000	--
Existing Facilities	$	233,620	235,000	985,000	710,000	690,000	(20,000)	-2.8%
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	293,620	235,000	1,045,000	710,000	745,000	35,000	4.9%

Significant Changes:

A truck replacement is proposed for FY27 per the department's replacement schedule.

Major Components:

Includes $10,000 for facilities improvements, $55,000 for a truck replacement, $380,000 for collection system improvements, and $300,000 for treatment system improvements.

(Photo of Wastewater Treatment Plant)

SEWER FUND

Debt Service:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	494,600	762,928	805,000	855,000	973,333	118,333	13.8%
Interest	$	157,620	156,996	187,184	295,623	273,281	(22,342)	-7.6%
Total Appropriation	$	652,220	919,924	992,184	1,150,623	1,246,614	95,991	8.3%

Significant Changes:

Debt Service increasing due to initial payments for the Gravity Belt Thickener replacement.

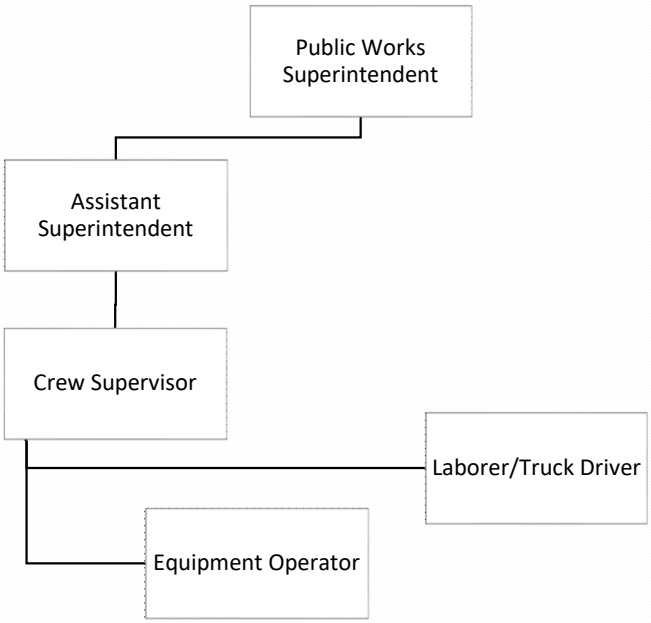
Major Components:

	Principal	Interest
Harkness Sewer Construction	200,000	30,625
Pine Street Extension	50,000	14,250
Amherst Woods Improvements	185,000	33,300
Gravity Belt Thickener - Engineering	70,000	30,350
Replace Gravity Belt Thickener	368,333	117,154
South East Street Sewer Pump Station #4	100,000	10,000
Short Term Interest expense		37,602
Total	$973,333	$273,281

SOLID WASTE

Function: To provide for the environmentally safe disposal of solid waste and to develop and promote programs that are viable alternatives to landfilling, all to be funded through a user-fee-based revenue system.

Organization:



(Photo of volunteers at Rubbish Roundup)

SOLID WASTE

Recent Accomplishments:

- Crack-sealed and repaired surface of main collection area.
- Translated handouts to Spanish.
- Chipped brush onsite in first step towards transforming to loam.
- Painted and weatherproofed bookshed, office and Universal waste shed.
- Made user-friendly modifications to webpage.
- Repaired several methane monitoring wells.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To achieve long term financial sustainability.
- To replace the loader with a backhoe capable of handling all Division needs.
- To convert the electronics shed into a multi-function building.
- To repair the floor and drainage in the scrap metal staging area.
- To repair the concrete floor of the roll-off pit.
- To install insulated doors on the vehicle garage.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To repair concrete curbing. **Ongoing**
- To paint/weatherproof wooden structures at the Transfer Station. **Accomplished**
- To begin replacing or repairing monitoring wells. **Ongoing**
- To expand outreach for trash and recycling programs. **Ongoing**
- To replace the Transfer Station scale. **Ongoing**
- To support development of the waste hauler bylaw. **Ongoing**

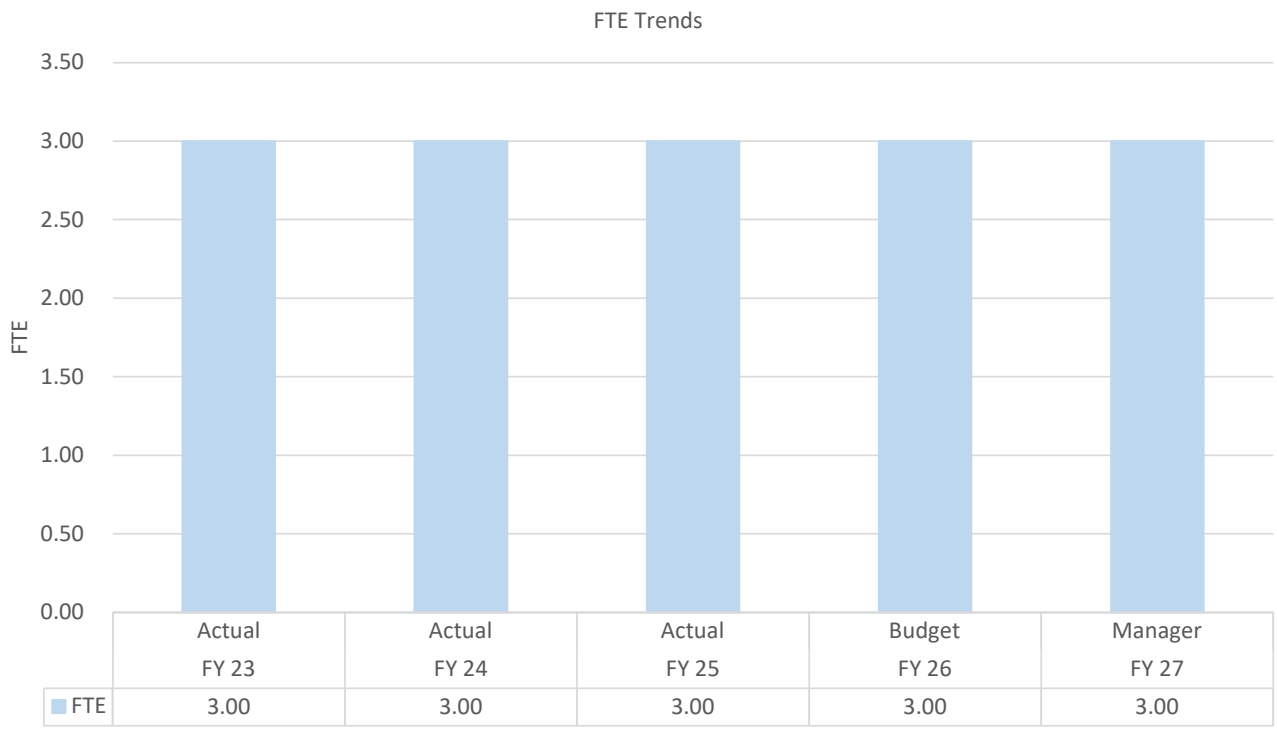
Upcoming Objectives:

- To repair concrete curbing.
- To begin replacing or repairing monitoring wells.
- To expand outreach for trash and recycling programs.
- To replace the Transfer Station scale.
- To support development of the waste hauler bylaw.
- To screen organic material at landfill to make a useful material.

SOLID WASTE

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	472,719	473,467	457,385	475,825	472,000	(3,825)	-0.8%
Interest Earnings	$	13,520	23,553	22,485	18,729	16,000	(2,729)	-14.6%
Other	$	206,393	85,011	245,491	145,565	150,000	4,435	3.0%
Subtotal Revenues	$	692,632	582,030	725,361	640,119	638,000	(2,119)	-0.3%
Returned Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Retained Earnings	$	25,000	44,158	95,000	-	21,162	21,162	--
Total Revenues	$	717,632	626,188	820,361	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%
Operating Budget	$	528,153	581,279	585,202	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Capital Program	$	-	70,000	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	528,153	651,279	585,202	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	528,153	651,279	585,202	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%

Staffing Trends:

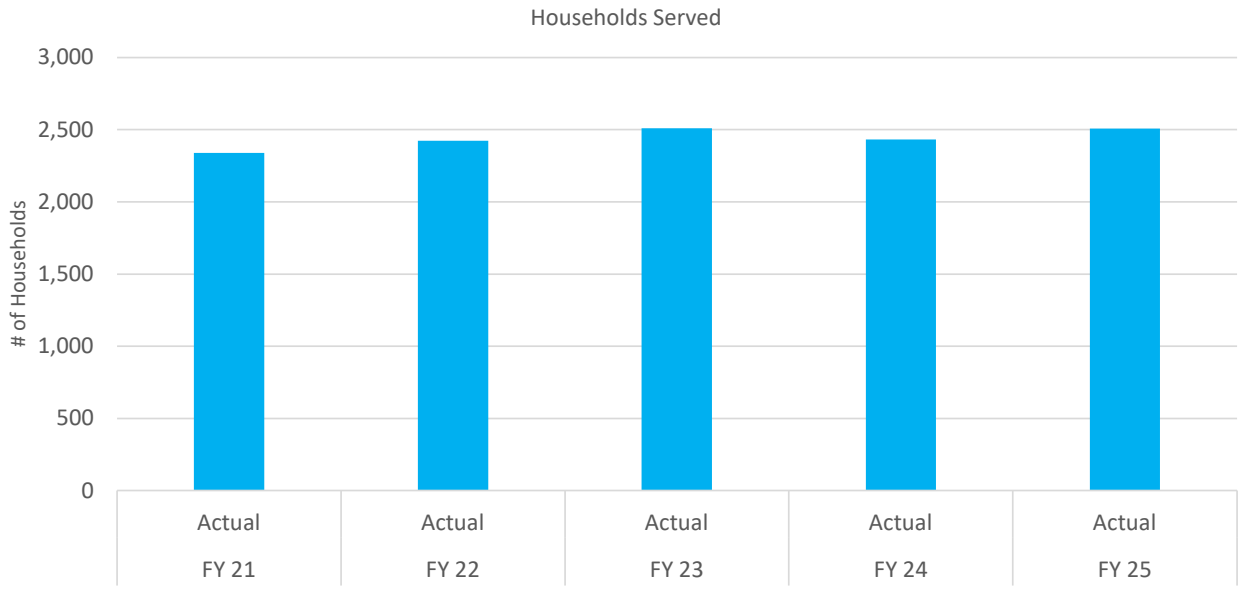


SOLID WASTE

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Households Served (stickers sold)	2,340	2,423	2,510	2,431	2,508
Commercial Businesses Served	164	142	140	129	138
Solid Waste Received & Transferred (tons)	187	208	170	189	208
Construction & Demo (tons)	1,037	1,157	1,097	1,078	1,212
Recycling Paper (tons)	295	283	292	257	222
Mixed Glass, Cans and Plastic	127	113	94	107	112
Metal	64	197	119	169	219
Oil (gal)	950	500	950	1250	500
Household Hazardous Waste (gal)	1,650	1,475	2,400	2,710	2,175
Tires (tons)	2.5	2.7	3	3.2	2.8
Compost Bins Sold	9	0	2	24	30
Electronics (tons)	23.6	15.3	13	11.2	9.4
Leaves (tons)	132	157	139	179	201
Fluorescent Bulbs (each)	1,482	1,767	1,607	1,828	1,434
Appliances with Freon (each)	376	360	312	379	361

Notable Trends:

None.



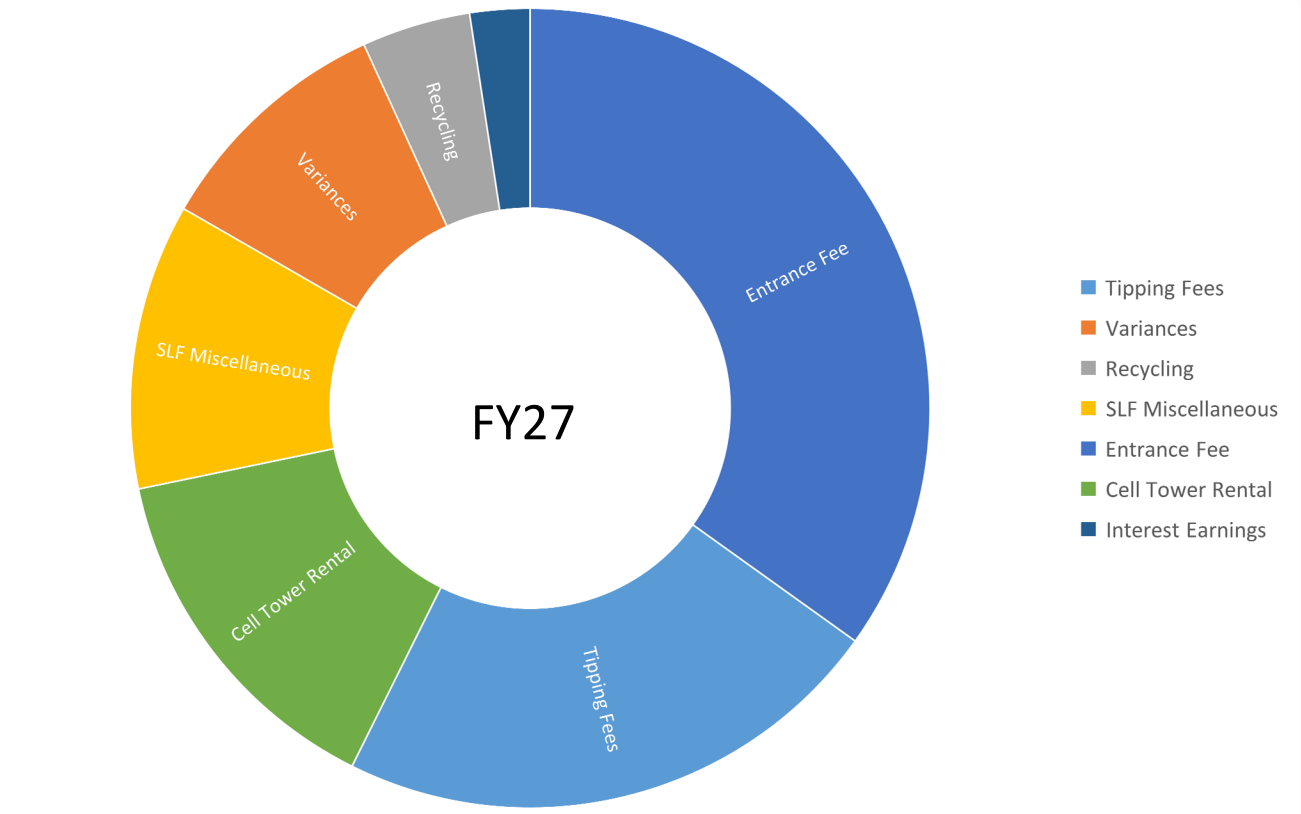
For more information, visit the Solid Waste webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/157/Recycling---Solid-Waste

SOLID WASTE

Revenue Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Tipping Fees	$	165,028	156,118	150,083	150,083	148,000	(2,083)	-1.4%
Variances	$	64,923	65,390	64,881	64,881	65,000	119	0.2%
Recycling	$	26,271	36,509	29,114	29,114	29,000	(114)	-0.4%
SLF Miscellaneous	$	148,314	46,011	249,988	55,062	76,162	21,100	38.3%
Entrance Fee	$	216,497	215,450	213,245	231,685	230,000	(1,685)	-0.7%
Cell Tower Rental	$	83,079	83,158	90,565	90,565	95,000	4,435	4.9%
Interest Earnings	$	13,520	23,553	22,485	18,729	16,000	(2,729)	-14.6%
Total Revenues	$	717,632	626,188	820,361	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%

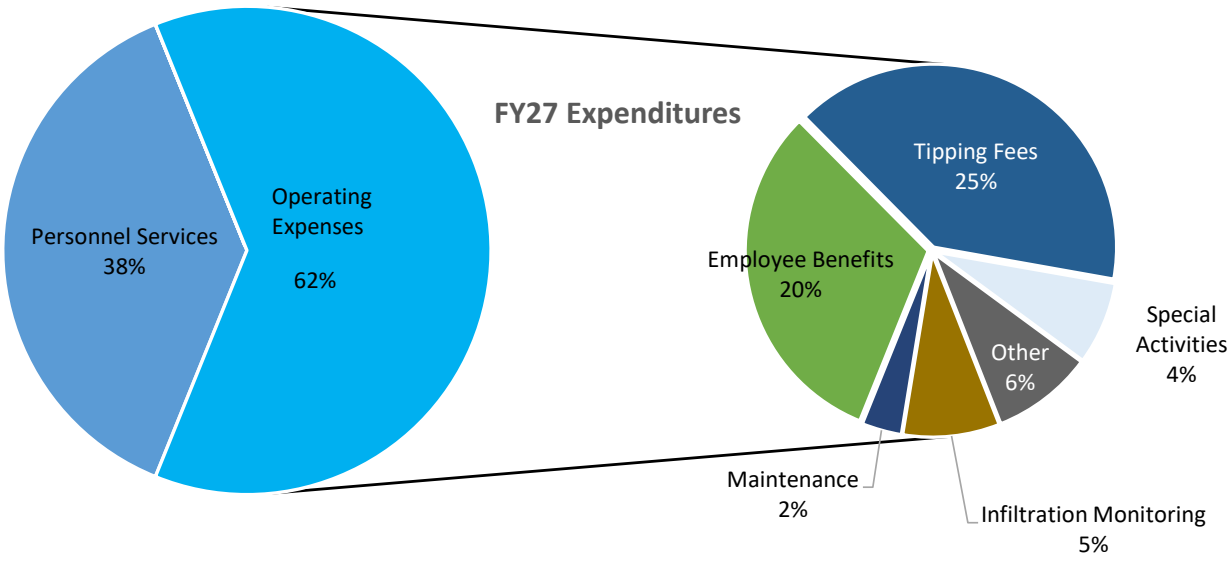
Significant Changes:

Updated revenues from a new cell tower contract at Ruxton are not yet reflected in the figures above but are expected to boost the financial sustainability of the Solid Waste Fund. Some user fees will be increased to keep up with budget demands.



SOLID WASTE

Expenditure Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	202,297	214,772	222,357	232,001	248,920	16,919	7.3%
Operating Expenses	$	325,857	366,507	362,845	408,118	410,242	2,124	0.5%
Capital Outlay	$	-	70,000	-	-	-	-	--
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Indirect Costs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	528,153	651,279	585,202	640,119	659,162	19,043	3.0%



Major Components:

Personnel Services include a Crew Supervisor, one Equipment Operator, and one Laborer/Truck Driver and extra help at the landfill.

$129,025 is budgeted for health, retirement, life insurance, and other employee benefits.

Maintenance, $14,500, includes funds to repair buildings and equipment.

Infiltration Monitoring, $35,000, includes funds for testing soil and gases emitted from the landfills, as well as PFAS.

Other includes $7,000 for diesel fuel, $15,647 for utilities, and smaller amounts for tools and equipment and office supplies.

Tipping fees, $165,000, are the cost of transporting and disposing of waste and recyclables collected at the Amherst transfer station.

SOLID WASTE

Capital Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$	-	70,000	-	-	-	-	--
Existing Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	70,000	-	-	-	-	--

Significant Changes:
None.

Major Components:
None.

(Photo of roll off truck purchased with a grant)

SOLID WASTE

Debt Service:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Interest	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--

Significant Changes:

None.

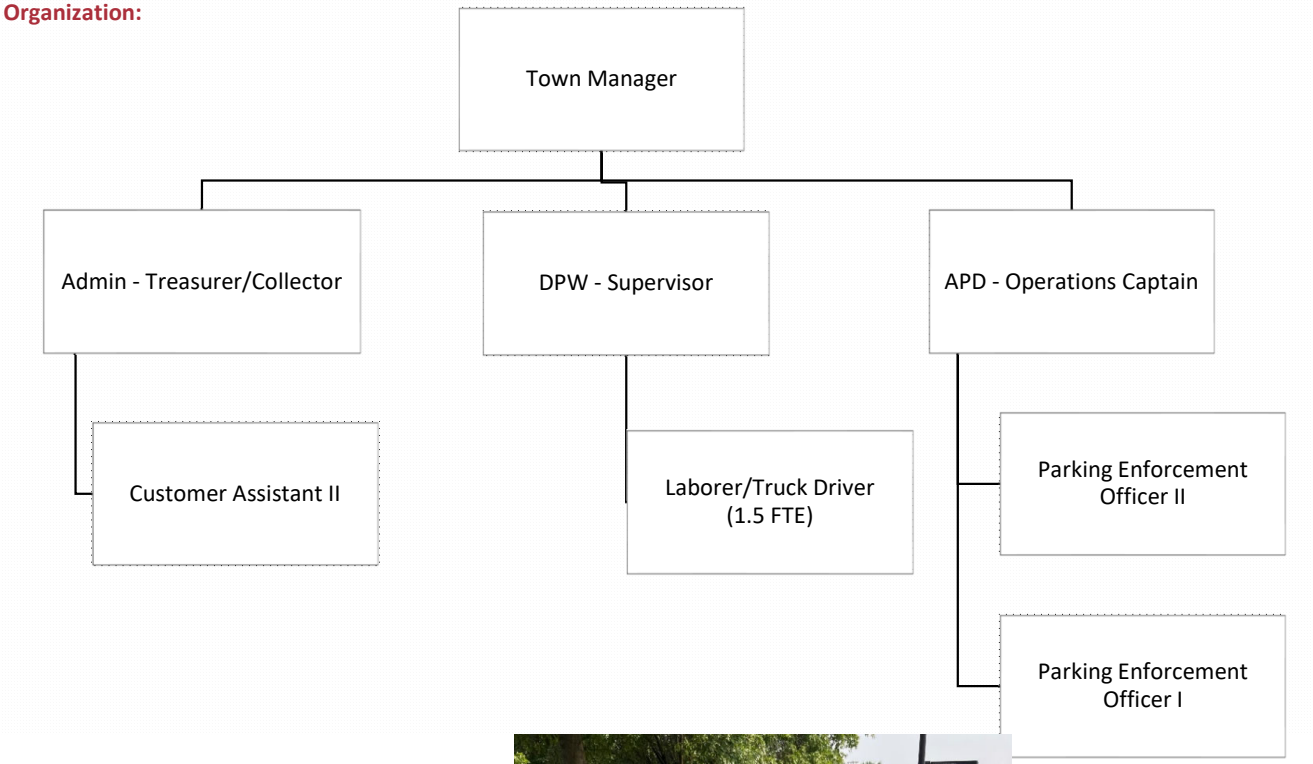
Major Components:

None.

TRANSPORTATION

Function: To provide a parking and public transportation systems and infrastructure that meets the needs of residents, visitors, and businesses, and that can be supported through fees and other alternative non-tax revenue sources.

Organization:



(Photo of Valley Bike station)

TRANSPORTATION

Recent Accomplishments:

- Replaced 27 single-spaced meters on Main Street.
- Replaced three kiosks located in front of the Masonic building, Sweetser Park, and in front of Crazy Noodle.
- Consolidated the parking zones on park mobile app, eliminating five different zones.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain adequate parking spaces for residents, visitors, and businesses.
- To develop new revenue sources for the Transportation Fund (parking garage, additional parking spaces, etc.).
- To develop internal policies and staffing to better coordinate management of the parking system.
- To transition away from single space meters to kiosks and online payments.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To maximize the efficiency and availability of existing parking supply. **Ongoing**
- To identify additional on-street parking options. **Ongoing**
- To review parking fine levels and recommend changes. **Ongoing**

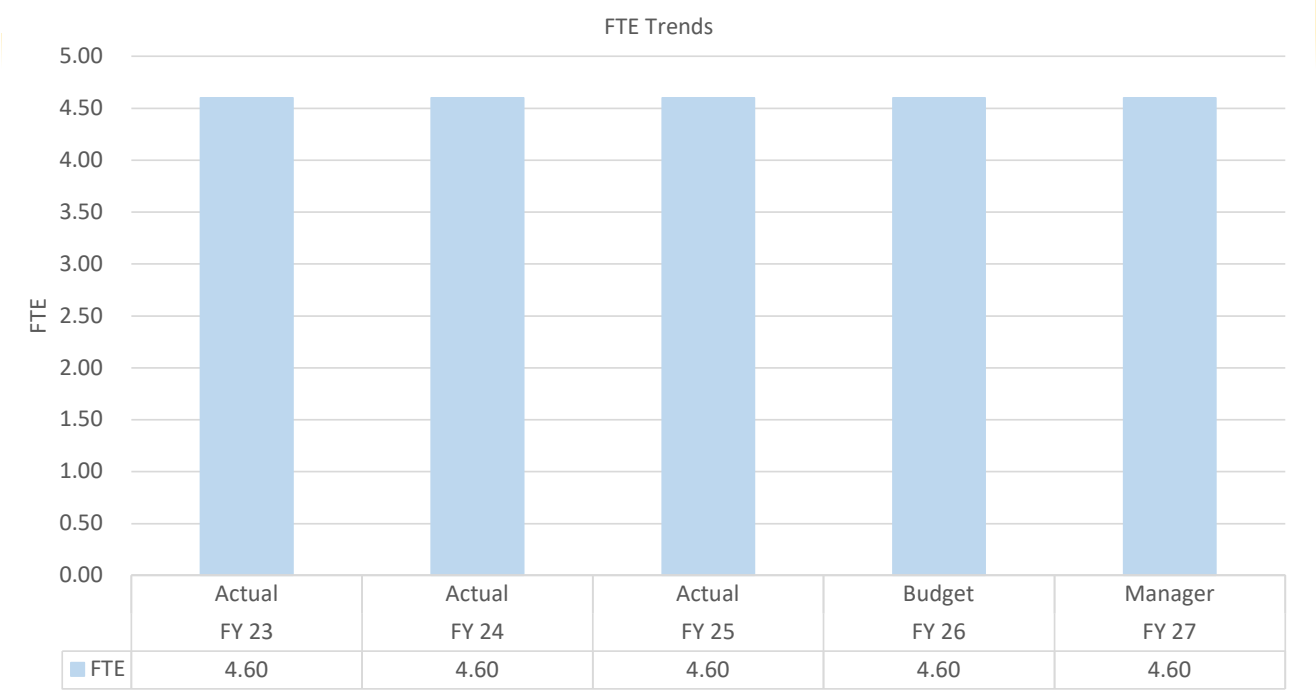
Upcoming Objectives:

- To maximize the efficiency and availability of existing parking supply.
- To identify additional on-street parking options.
- To review parking fine levels and recommend changes.
- To remove parking meters from Sellend Street and install a kiosk.
- To finish removing single-spaced meters on South Pleasant Street and Amity Street.
- To remove single-spaced meters in front of Emily Dickinson house and install kiosk.

TRANSPORTATION

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 -26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	708,213	731,703	755,932	738,984	635,996	(102,988)	-13.9%
Interest and Late Fees	$	12,072	22,231	22,225	-	10,000	10,000	--
Other	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	720,285	753,934	778,157	738,984	645,996	(92,988)	-12.6%
Returned Capital	$	737	-	-	-	-	-	--
Other Financing Sources	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Retained Earnings	$	-	-	136,938	-	61,048	61,048	#DIV/0!
Total Revenues	$	721,022	753,934	915,095	738,984	707,044	(31,940)	-4.3%
Operating Budget	$	623,184	617,969	680,673	714,984	707,044	(7,940)	-1.1%
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Capital Program	$	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	-	(24,000)	-100.0%
Total Appropriation	$	648,184	657,969	824,673	738,984	707,044	(31,940)	-4.3%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	648,184	657,969	824,673	738,984	707,044	(31,940)	-4.3%

Staffing Trends:

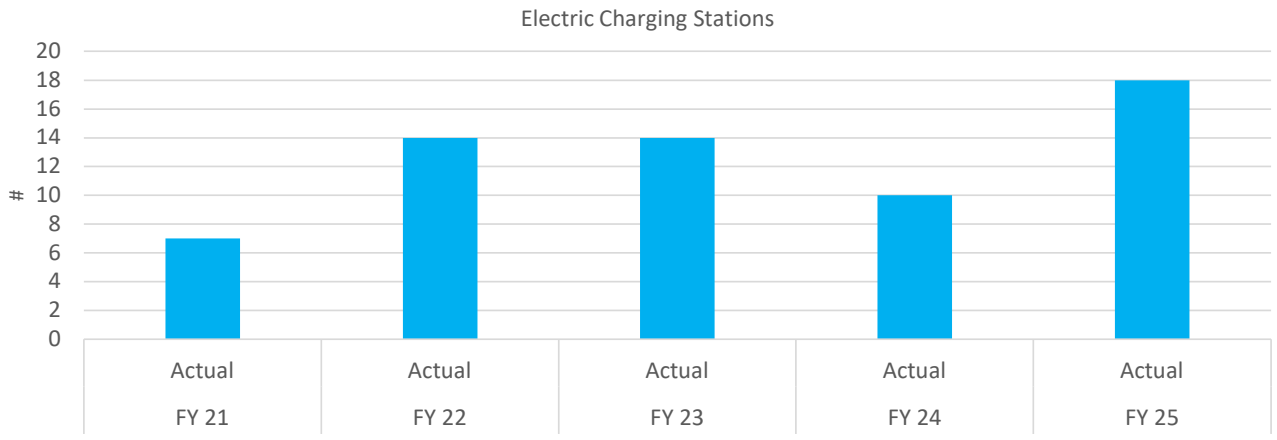


TRANSPORTATION

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Street Meters Maintained	357	344	344	204	177
Handicapped Spaces	21	21	21	26	26
Lot Meters Maintained	12	12	16	22	25
Electric Charging Spaces Maintained	7	14	14	10	18
Stolen and Demolished Meters	0	5	13	3	2
Meter Repairs	35	41	68	56	76
Tickets Issued	9,449	9,323	8,219	8,496	8,532
Traffic Enforcement/Special Events	29	50	50	50	50
Meter Enforcement (hours)	4,267	3,385	3,360	3,200	3,591
Boot Uses/Releases	0	49	24	8	26
Parking Permits Issued	543	648	573	570	512
Collection Rate of Total Issues	80%	80%	72%	70%	70%
Hearings/Appeals	646	688	497	426	408
Annual Meter Revenue per Space					
North Pleasant Street Lot	$116	$243	$261	$396	$1,988
Boltwood Garage - Upper	$598	$946	$905	$1,039	$933
Boltwood Garage - Lower	$237	$270	$228	$254	$195
Street Meters	$167	$262	$310	$453	$319
Amity Street Lot	$298	$1,464	$1,839	$2,202	$2,154
Main Street Lot	$826	$1,358	$1,384	$0	$0
Spring Street Lot	$531	$745	$722	$725	$974
Debt Issues Outstanding	0	0	0	0	0
Capital Projects					
Departmental Equipment	0	1	1	0	1
Existing Facilities	0	0	0	0	3

Notable Trends:

With the closure of the Main Street Lot due to the revitalization of the Common, the use of the North Pleasant Street Lot has increased.



For more information, visit the Parking in Amherst webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/732/Parking-in-Amherst

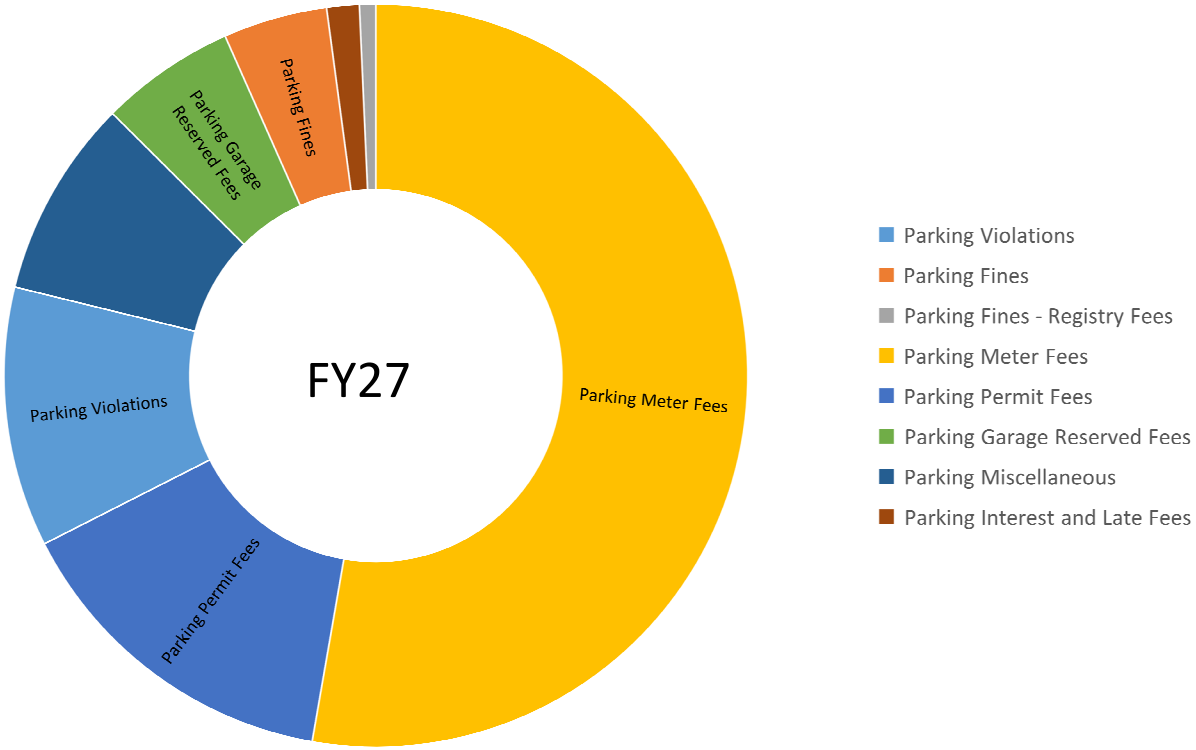
TRANSPORTATION

Revenue Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Parking Violations	$	110,490	107,041	135,518	118,623	80,000	(38,623)	-32.6%
Parking Fines	$	41,305	38,840	49,045	58,350	32,000	(26,350)	-45.2%
Parking Fines - Registry Fees	$	11,530	8,460	7,460	16,000	5,000	(11,000)	-68.8%
Parking Meter Fees	$	439,442	456,332	420,190	420,899	372,900	(47,999)	-11.4%
Parking Permit Fees	$	63,171	87,456	97,969	83,512	104,496	20,984	25.1%
Parking Garage Reserved Fees	$	41,600	33,200	44,800	41,600	41,600	-	--
Parking Miscellaneous	$	1,412	375	137,888	-	61,048	61,048	#DIV/0!
Parking Interest and Late Fees	$	12,072	22,231	22,225	-	10,000	10,000	#DIV/0!
Total Revenues	$	721,022	753,934	915,095	738,984	707,044	(31,940)	-4.3%

Significant Changes:

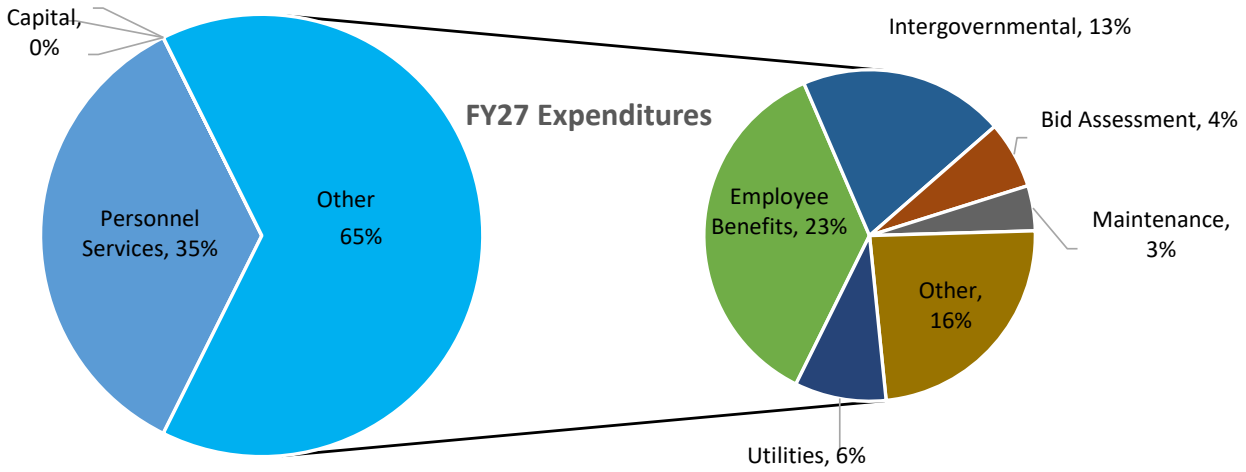
Parking violation revenue and parking meter revenue were both down in FY26 leading to lower estimates for FY27. Town Officials are working with parking enforcement staff to understand if FY26 was just an off year or the beginning of a trend.

Major Components:



TRANSPORTATION

Expenditure Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	233,484	199,067	209,516	251,695	249,612	(2,083)	-0.8%
Operating Expenses	$	389,700	418,902	471,157	463,289	457,432	(5,857)	-1.3%
Capital Outlay	$	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	-	(24,000)	-100.0%
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Indirect Costs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	648,184	657,969	824,673	738,984	707,044	(31,940)	-4.3%



Major Components:

Personnel Services includes funds for two full time Parking Enforcement Officers, a Parking Clerk, and one and one-half Maintenance Workers. The Procurement Officer is shared with the General Fund, Sewer Fund, and Water Fund. Also included are funds for one part-time Parking Enforcement Officer.

Employee Benefits are $165,420 for health insurance, retirement, and other employee benefits, including a payment of $27,000 into the OPEB Trust Fund.

Intergovernmental of $91,831 includes funds for the PVTA subsidies and taxes to the General Fund for parking facilities.

The Business Improvement District (BID) Assessment is $30,000.

Utilities, $40,900, for electricity costs.

Other includes supplies, utilities, technical services, subsidies, and Valley Bikeshare.

TRANSPORTATION

Capital Detail:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	-	(24,000)	-100.0%
Existing Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	-	(24,000)	-100.0%

Significant Changes:

Capital project funding was removed for FY27 to balance expenditures with revenue estimates which declined in FY27.

Major Components:

None.

TRANSPORTATION

Debt Service:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Interest	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--

Significant Changes:

None.

Major Components:

None.

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Grant Fund Summary & Detail

Overview

The following section provides a summary and additional details about grant funding by department.

GRANT FUNDS EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

Budget:		FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Community Services	$	81,885	2,019	-	-	605,100
Conservation	$	483,457	676,733	47,441	253,450	319,696
Council on Aging	$	22,226	34,467	79,364	77,443	60,592
CRESS	$	-	174,956	590,306	605,828	205,342
Dispatch	$	139,425	139,445	140,234	141,287	173,229
Fire	$	71,369	90,578	23,527	55,460	512,384
General	$	4,186,423	1,055,664	2,131,073	2,368,961	6,252,750
Information Technology	$	-	-	63,808	306,742	-
Library	$	5,531	11,731	1,142,605	1,538,306	400,104
Planning	$	1,102,397	437,416	1,132,133	494,792	109,160
Police	$	171,075	184,626	157,614	68,476	127,039
Public Works	$	274,219	992,892	1,583,902	7,942,616	13,680,008
Schools					2,115,166	-
Total Expenditures	$	6,538,007	3,800,528	7,092,005	15,968,527	22,445,405

Significant Changes:

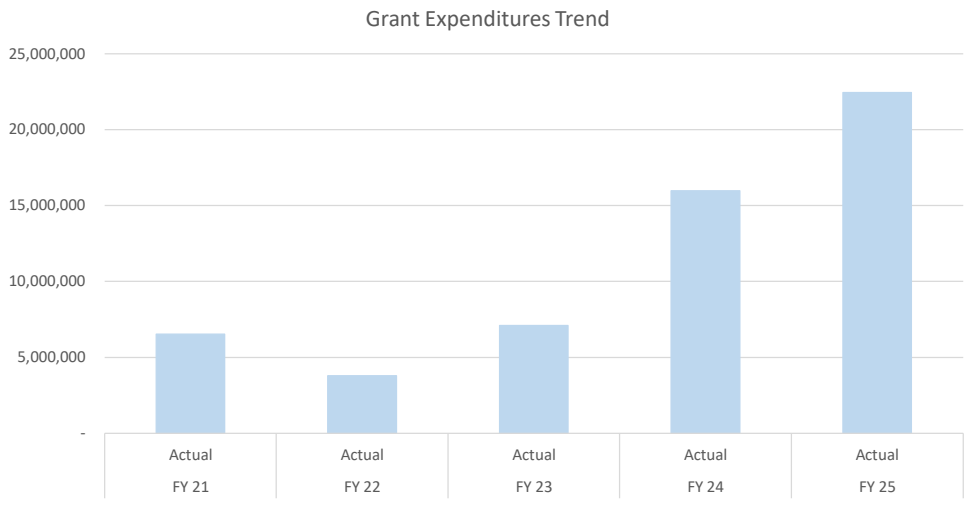
FY 21 significant grant expenditures included: Chapter 90 Funds, PARC (Parkland Acquisitions and Renovations for Communities) Grant, Massachusetts Volkswagen (VW) Grant, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA), Coronavirus Aid, Relief, and Economic Security Act (CARES), and Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA).

FY 22 significant grant expenditures included: Chapter 90 Funds, DOT Shared Streets Grant, PARC (Parkland Acquisitions and Renovations for Communities) Grant, MassDEP Fearing Brook Floodplain Creation Grant, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, Green Communities Grant, DHCD Housing Choice Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), Department of Justice (DOJ) Domestic Violence Grant, Stanton Foundation Dog Park Grant, and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA).

FY 23 significant grant expenditures included: Chapter 90 Funds, State Aid to Libraries, Department of Public Health Equitable Approaches to Public Safety grant, MassWorks Grant, Mass Board of Library Commissioners Construction Grant Program, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), Department of Justice (DOJ) Domestic Violence Grant, and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA).

FY 24 significant grant expenditures included: State Aid to Libraries, Department of Public Health Equitable Approaches to Public Safety Grant, MassWorks Grant, Mass Board of Library Commissioners Construction Grant Program, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), PARC Grant, LWCF (Land Water Conservation Fund) Grant, MVP Grant, Mass DWSRF (Drinking Water State Revolving Fund) Grant Program, MSBA (Massachusetts School Building Authority) Grant, and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA).

FY25 significant grant expenditures included State Aid to Libraries, Department of Public Health Equitable Approaches to Public Safety Grant, MassWorks Grant, Municipal Fiber Grant, Mass Board of Library Commissioners Construction Grant Program, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), MVP Grant, Mass DWSRF (Drinking Water State Revolving Fund) Grant Program, Dam & Seawall Repair Grant, Inland Dredging Grant, MSBA (Massachusetts School Building Authority) Grant, Firefighter Equipment Grants, and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA).



GRANT FUNDS EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

FY 26 Grant Awards Details:

NAME OF GRANT	PURPOSE	AWARD AMOUNT	DURATION
COMMUNITY SERVICES:			
CDBG-Community Development Block Grant Program	FY23 CDBG - Infrastructure improvements to East Street Neighborhood Park, Belchertown Road, South East Street Extension; microenterprise assistance (32 businesses); social services (family stabilization; food pantry, ESOL, homelessness prevention, youth mentoring).	$ 1,650,000	July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2026
CDBG-Community Development Block Grant Program	FY25 CDBG - North Pleasant St infrastructure improvements, microenterprise assistance program, social services (mobile food market, food pantry, youth services, ESOL, homlessness prevention.)	$ 925,000	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2027
CDBG-Community Development Block Grant Program	FY26 CDBG - Kendrick Park sidewalks, social services (mobile food market, food pantry, youth mentoring, ESOL, homlessness prevention), Planning (174 Amity, Amherst Housing Resource Center Predevelopment.	$ 850,000	October 1, 2025 - December 31, 2028
CONSERVATION:			
Energy Efficiency & Conservation Block Grant (EECBG)	To purchase an electric pick up truck for the Facilities Department.	$ 76,500	January 8, 2025 - January 8, 2027
Land Planning Grant FY25/26	For the Atkins Corner Cultural Connectivity Plan.	$ 23,000	June 18, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY25 Dam & Seawall Repair Program	To complete the necessary design work and filing of permits needed to repair the Puffer's Pond Dam & Dike.	$ 250,000	December 21, 2024 - June 30, 2027
FY26 MVP Program Action Grant	To complete the project "Fort River Watershed Culvert Assessment & Prioritization Plan."	$ 427,700	November 6, 2025 - June 30, 2027
FY26 Community One Stop for Growth Grant	To support the East Amherst Village Center Zoning Updates Project.	$ 70,000	December 30, 2025 - June 30, 2027
MassTrails Program Grant	Hickory Ridge Accessible Trail Connection.	$ 109,585	July 31, 2024 - December 31, 2026
SENIOR CENTER:			
FY 25 Formula Grant	To support community outreach and programs to seniors to help reduce social isolation	$ 80,265	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FY 26 Formula Grant	To support community outreach and programs to seniors to help reduce social isolation	$ 85,616	July 1, 2025 - June 30, 2026
DISPATCH:			
FY26 State 911 Dept Training Grant	Reimbursement of training-related costs associated with the 9-1-1 system.	$ 23,403	July 1, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY26 State 911 Dept Support and Incentive	Reimbursement of personnel costs for Public Safety Answering Point and Regional Emergency Communication Centers	$ 168,008	July 1, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FIRE:			
Ambulance Task Force Mobilization & Mass Causualty Incident Planning-	Cooperative agreement between MDPH-EOHHS-HRSA to provide EMS in reponse to mass casualty incidents. The grant includes the placement of a MCI trailer at the North station and the funds are to help support this as well.	$ 2,000	ongoing
MDU Grant	To ensure the Mass Decontamination Units assigned to AFD will be maintained in a state of readiness in the event of an emergency.	$ 2,000	ongoing
FY26 Firefighter Equipment Grant	For the purchase of breaching tools, mobile command console, PPV van, rescue saw.	$ 25,000	April 7, 2026 - June 30, 2026
Hazard Mitigation Grant Program	For updating local Hazard Mitigation Plans/Goals.	$ 34,200	January 10, 2024 - May 1, 2026
FY25 (23) Assistance to Firefighters Grant	For the purchase of complete sets of turnout gear.	$ 297,091	August 28, 2024 - August 27, 2026
GENERAL:			
FY26 Mass Cultural Council	For the Amherst Cultural Council to participate in the Local Cultural Council Program.	$ 56,100	December 9, 2025 - June 30,2026
FY26 MCC Creative Experiences Grant	To support DEI with creative experiences through the Amherst Global Village Festival.	$ 5,000	October 1, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY22 Earmark for COVID-19 Recovery Needs	To support translation services, promote engagement and inclusion, and facilitate participation in civic activities for BIPOC and ESL communities.	$ 80,000	February 10, 2022 - June 30, 2027
INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY:			
FY25 Community Compact Municipal Fiber Grant	To complete the installation of a fiber ring, creating a redundant path.	$ 160,837	June 17, 2025 - December 31, 2026
LIBRARY:			
MBLC- Mass Board of Library Commissioners Construction Grant	For construction of an additon to Jones Library	$ 13,871,314	July 1, 2021 - June 30, 2026
PLANNING:			
FY26 Municipal ADA Improvement Grant	To remove barriers and improve access to the Munson Memorial Library, including an accessible entranceway and doors.	$ 150,000	December 11, 2025 - June 30, 2026
POLICE:			
OVW-Grants to Improve the Criminal Justice Response	Town of Amherst, Umass and Hadley - continuation of a regional, collaborative project to respond effectively for women victimized by domestic, stalking, sexual, or dating violence.	$ 321,924	Octover 1, 2023 - September 30, 2026
FY26 Municipal Road Safety (MRS) Program	Highway Safety Traffic Enforcement & pedestrian/bike safety	$ 43,498	November 1, 2025 - September 15, 2026
FY26 Byrne Memorial Justice Grant	Purchase of police K9 and exterior kennel.	$ 17,320	November 6, 2025 - August 31, 2026
FY26 Crisis Intervention Team Expansion - Jail Diversion Program	To continue the Crisis Intervention Team (CIT) and to fund the additional staffing needed to attend training	$ 18,375	October 1, 2025 - June 30, 2026
PUBLIC WORKS:			
FY25/26 Chapter 90	For paving/resurfacing.	$ 2,000,000	May 1, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY 26 DWSP Grant Program	For the purchase of land in Pelham to protect an existing well or reservoir.	$ 218,820	July 28, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY25 EOEEA MVP Action Grant Program	To complete the projected entitled "Fort River Watershed Improvements for Flood & Water Quality Resiliency."	$ 1,179,700	August 2, 2024 - June 30, 2026
FY25 Inland Dredging Pilot Round	To support the Atkins Reservoir Sedimentation Basin Dredging Project.	$ 260,000	August 12, 2024 - June 30, 2026
FY25 MassWorks Infrastructure Program	To support a public infrastructure project at University Drive/Amity St.	$ 1,940,000	February 18, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY 26 30X30 Catalyst Fund Grant Program	For use towards the purchase of acquiring a property off Shutesbury Road in Pelham.	$ 90,800	August 25, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY25/26 Mass Technology Collaborative	For cybersecurity upgrades to our water and waste water operations	$ 25,000	March 1, 2025 - June 30, 2025

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Revolving Fund Summary & Detail

Overview

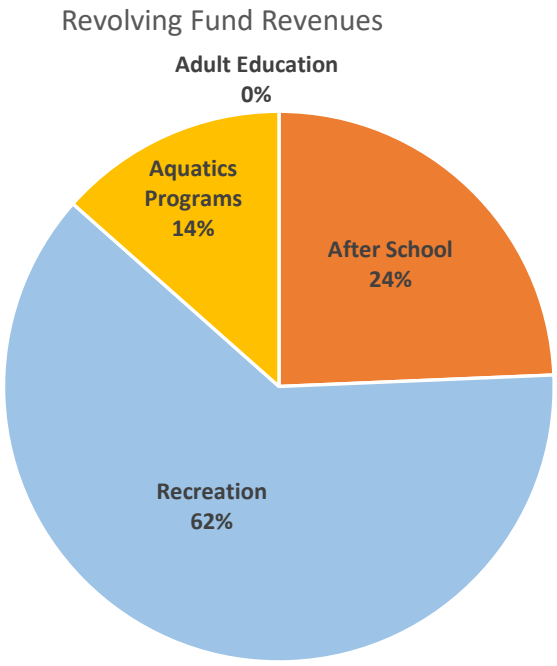
The following section provides a summary and additional details about the revolving fund for recreation programs.

REVOLVING FUND SUMMARY

Revenues:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Adult Education	$	5,397	7,652	8,894	-	-	-	-
After School	$	180,611	194,790	225,924	185,000	200,000	15,000	8.1%
Recreation	$	511,333	598,101	619,855	520,750	511,350	(9,400)	-1.8%
Aquatics Programs	$	-	-	-	117,500	110,500	(7,000)	-6.0%
Total Revenues	$	697,341	800,543	854,673	823,250	711,350	(111,900)	-13.6%
Expenditures:								
Adult Education	$	7,326	5,733	6,270	-	-	-	-
After School	$	176,367	185,629	176,293	185,000	196,500	11,500	6.2%
Recreation	$	558,316	619,855	619,855	520,750	511,350	(9,400)	-1.8%
Aquatics Programs	$	-	-	-	117,500	96,502	(20,998)	-17.9%
Total Expenditures	$	742,009	811,217	802,417	823,250	707,850	(115,400)	-14.0%
Fund Gain/(Loss)	$	(44,668)	(10,674)	52,256	-	3,500	3,500	--

Significant Changes:

The Adult Education revolving fund was closed due to low activity and was combined with the regular Recreation Revolving fund. A new revolving fund under Mass General Law Ch 44, sec 53 E ½ was created for Aquatics Programming. This is a strategic move to focus attention on swim programs and realize new revenues that can go toward future aquatics programming.



REVOLVING FUND SUMMARY

Revolving Fund Overview:

Revolving funds are used to manage fee based activities. Unlike the General Fund, Revolving Funds can carryover unexpended funds at year end hence the name Revolving Fund. Only certain activities are legally authorized to have Revolving Funds.

Adult Education: This fund ended in FY25. The adult education revolving fund has only been running one program for many years and it no longer makes sense to track this separately. The one program will be merged in the adult education section of the regular recreation revolving fund.

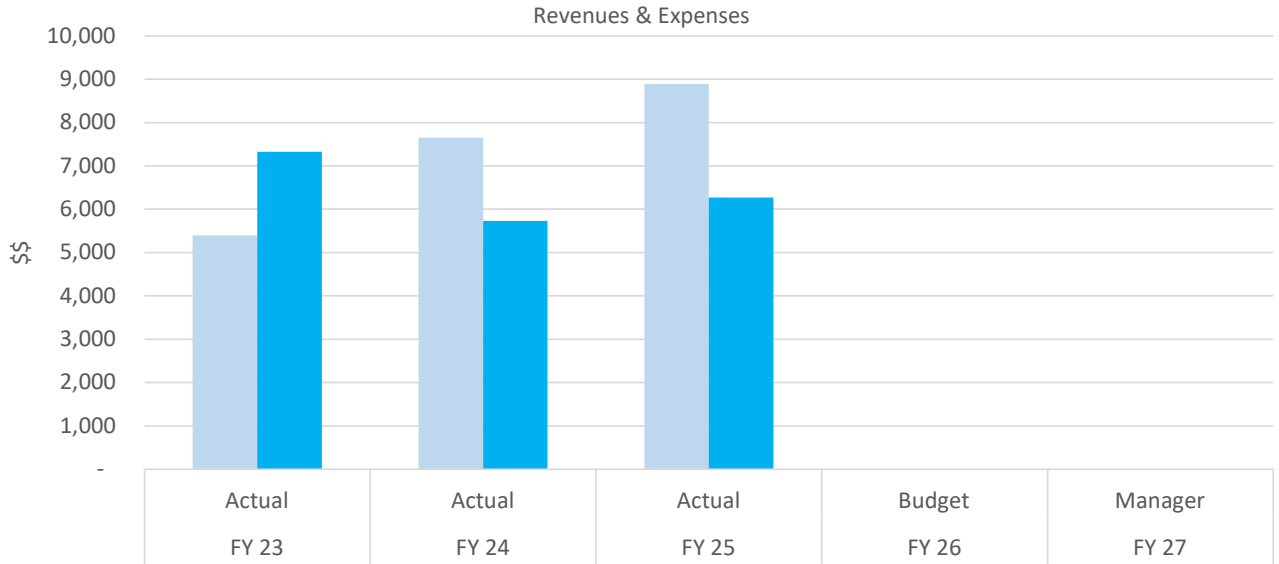
After School: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's After School programming. Expenses include wages for the staff and supplies. Tuition is charged for enrollment in this program. The Town provides subsidies to offset the tuition for income eligible families. Tuition payments are recorded in the Revolving Fund as revenue.

Recreation: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's Recreation programming. Expenses include supplies and payments to instructors. A fee is charged for participation in these programs. These fees get recorded in the Revolving Fund as revenue.

Aquatics Programs: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's Indoor Aquatics programming. Expenses include supplies and payments to instructors, lifeguards, pool rentals, uniforms, etc. A fee is charged for participation in these programs. These fees get recorded in the Revolving Fund as revenue.

ADULT EDUCATION REVOLVING FUND

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues								
Performing Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Visual Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Health Programs	$	5,397	7,652	8,550	-	-	-	--
Hobbies Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Personal Development	$	-	-	344	-	-	-	--
Sports Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	5,397	7,652	8,894	-	-	-	--
Use of Fund Balance	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	5,397	7,652	8,894	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses								
Performing Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Visual Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Health Programs	$	2,326	3,733	4,270	-	-	-	--
Hobbies Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Personal Development	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Sports Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Misc. Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Expenses	$	2,326	3,733	4,270	-	-	-	--
Admin. Reimbursements	$	5,000	2,000	2,000	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	7,326	5,733	6,270	-	-	-	--

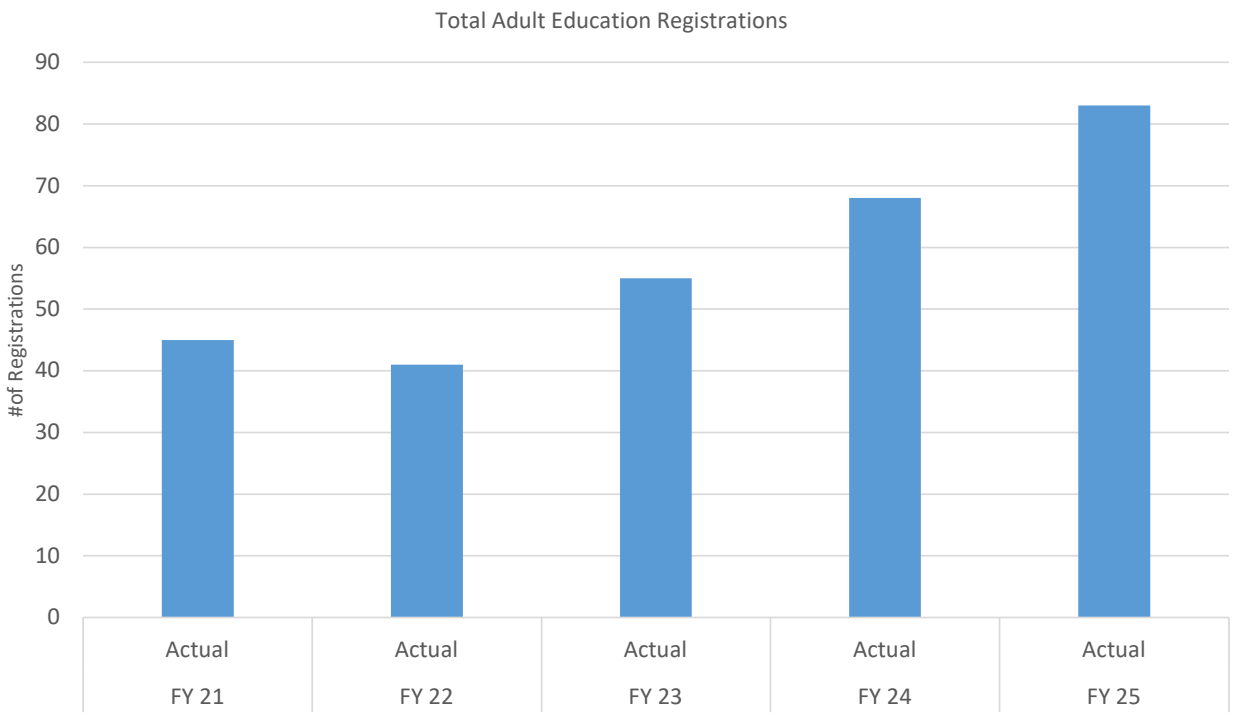


ADULT EDUCATION REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Registrations	45	41	55	68	83

Notable Trends:

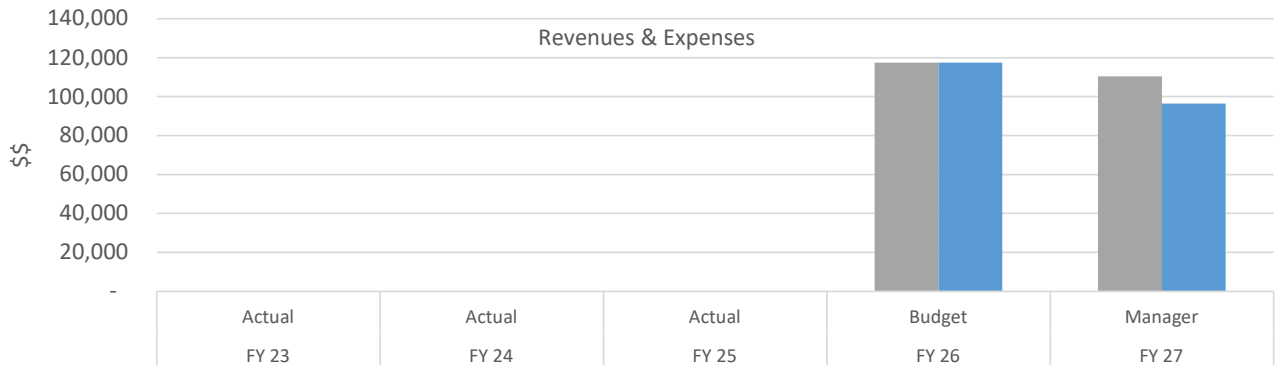
The only active program is Qi Gong. FY25 is the last year for this fund. This activity will move into the regular recreation revolving fund.



For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3535/Adult-Programs

AQUATICS PROGRAMS REVOLVING FUND

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues								
Amherst United	$	-	-	-	65,000	65,000	-	0.0%
Indoor Lessons	$	-	-	-	16,000	16,000	-	0.0%
Adaptive Lessons	$	-	-	-	6,500	6,500	-	0.0%
Masters Swimming	$	-	-	-	7,000	-	(7,000)	-100.0%
Open Swim	$	-	-	-	3,000	3,000	-	0.0%
Birthday Parties	$	-	-	-	1,000	1,000	-	0.0%
Adult Lessons	$	-	-	-	5,000	5,000	-	0.0%
Stroke & Turn Clinics	$	-	-	-	8,000	8,000	-	0.0%
Dive Clinics	$	-	-	-	3,000	3,000	-	0.0%
Pool Rentals	$	-	-	-	3,000	3,000	-	0.0%
Subtotal Revenues	$	-	-	-	117,500	110,500	(7,000)	-6.0%
Use of Fund Balance	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	-	-	-	117,500	110,500	(7,000)	-6.0%
Operating Expenses								
Pool Rental	$	-	-	-	14,000	14,000	-	0.0%
Full-Time Salary	$	-	-	-	70,183	49,185	(20,998)	-29.9%
Fringe Benefits	$	-	-	-	9,600	9,600	-	0.0%
Extra Help/Staff Payroll	$	-	-	-	15,917	15,917	-	0.0%
Administrative Software	$	-	-	-	900	900	-	0.0%
Meet Fees	$	-	-	-	800	800	-	0.0%
Trainings	$	-	-	-	200	200	-	0.0%
Small Equipment	$	-	-	-	500	500	-	0.0%
Cleaning Supplies	$	-	-	-	200	200	-	0.0%
Uniforms	$	-	-	-	1,200	1,200	-	0.0%
Credit Card Fees	$	-	-	-	4,000	4,000	-	0.0%
Subtotal Expenses	$	-	-	-	117,500	96,502	(20,998)	--
Admin. Reimbursements	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	-17.9%
Total Expenditures	$	-	-	-	117,500	96,502	(20,998)	-17.9%



AQUATICS PROGRAMS REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Registrations					1487
Amherst United	0	0	0	0	150
Indoor Lessons	0	0	0	0	355
Adaptive Lessons	0	0	0	0	56
Masters Swimming	0	0	0	0	375
Open Swim	0	0	0	0	400
Birthday Parties	0	0	0	0	0
Adult Lessons	0	0	0	0	40
Stroke & Turn Clinics	0	0	0	0	104
Dive Clinics	0	0	0	0	7
Pool Rentals	0	0	0	0	0

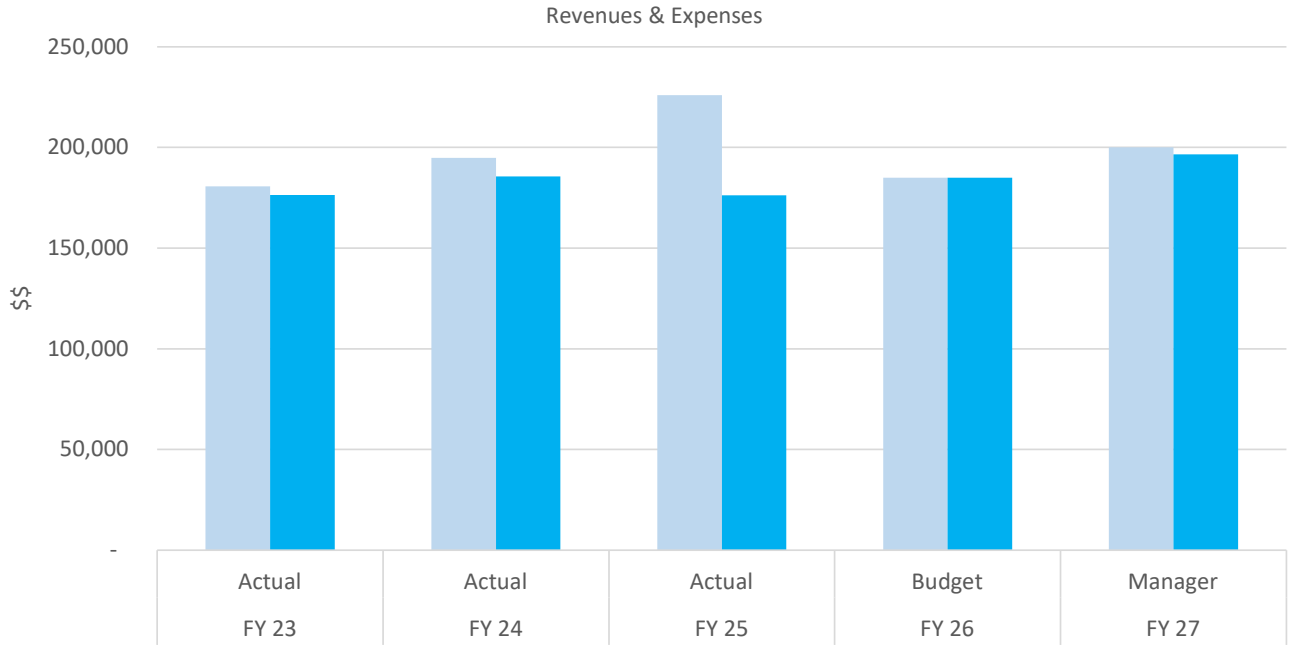
Notable Trends:

Revenue budget reduced based on uncertainty of access to Hampshire College pool. Operating Expenses reduced to reflect that a portion of the Aquatics Program Director salary is funded from the General Fund.

For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3564/Recreation-Department

AFTER SCHOOL REVOLVING FUND

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues								
Tuition	$	166,271	173,260	225,305	155,000	170,000	15,000	9.7%
Tuition Subsidies	$	14,340	21,530	619	30,000	30,000	-	0.0%
Gifts/Donations	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	180,611	194,790	225,924	185,000	200,000	15,000	8.1%
Use of Fund Balance	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	180,611	194,790	225,924	185,000	200,000	15,000	8.1%
Operating Expenses								
Personnel Services	$	121,658	128,909	125,008	132,000	140,000	8,000	6.1%
Benefits	$	16,490	16,982	17,392	18,000	18,000	-	0.0%
Professional Development	$	1,672	1,055	2,097	2,000	3,000	1,000	50.0%
Supplies	$	2,404	2,262	3,566	2,500	3,000	500	20.0%
Food	$	15,194	15,059	9,018	10,000	12,000	2,000	20.0%
Advertising	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Other	$	950	1,158	1,211	2,500	2,500	-	0.0%
Subtotal Expenses	$	158,367	165,426	158,293	167,000	178,500	11,500	6.9%
Admin. Reimbursements	$	18,000	20,203	18,000	18,000	18,000	-	0.0%
Total Expenditures	$	176,367	185,629	176,293	185,000	196,500	11,500	6.2%

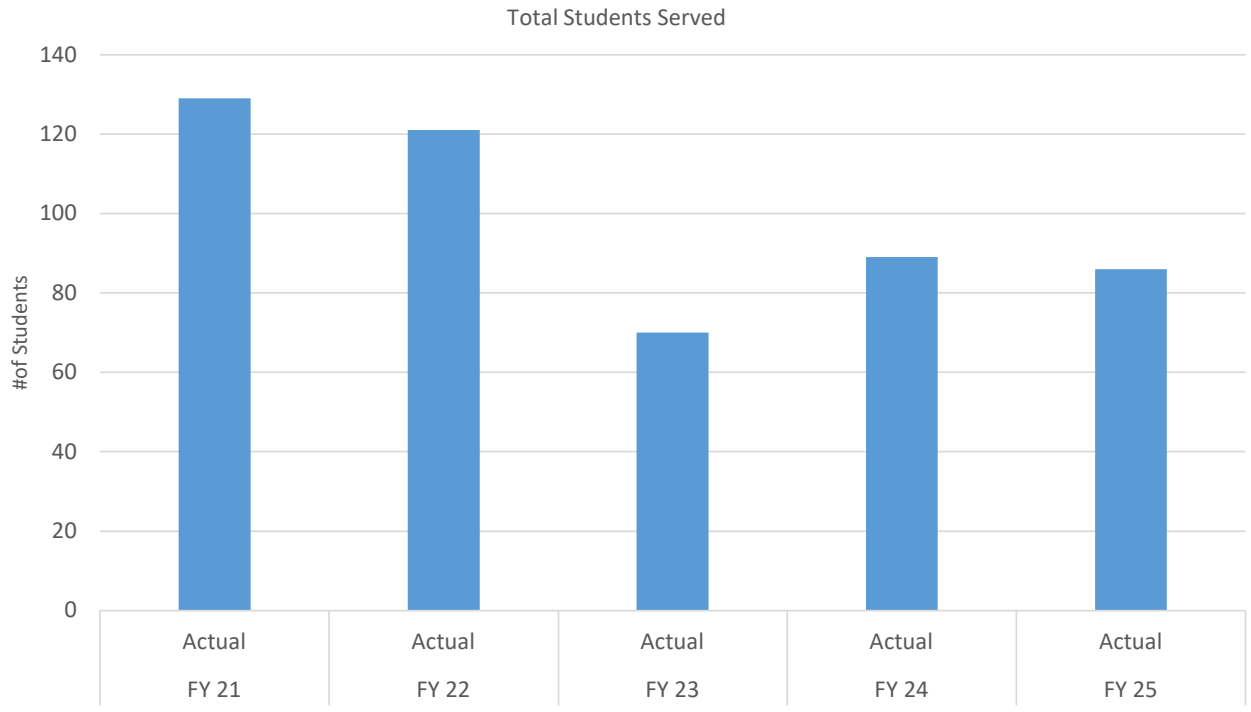


AFTER SCHOOL REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Students Served	129	121	70	89	86
School Year	129	121	70	89	86
Summer	0	0	0	0	0
Subsidies Provided (# of families)	35	27	21	22	50
School Year	35	27	21	22	50
Summer	0	0	0	0	0

Notable Trends:

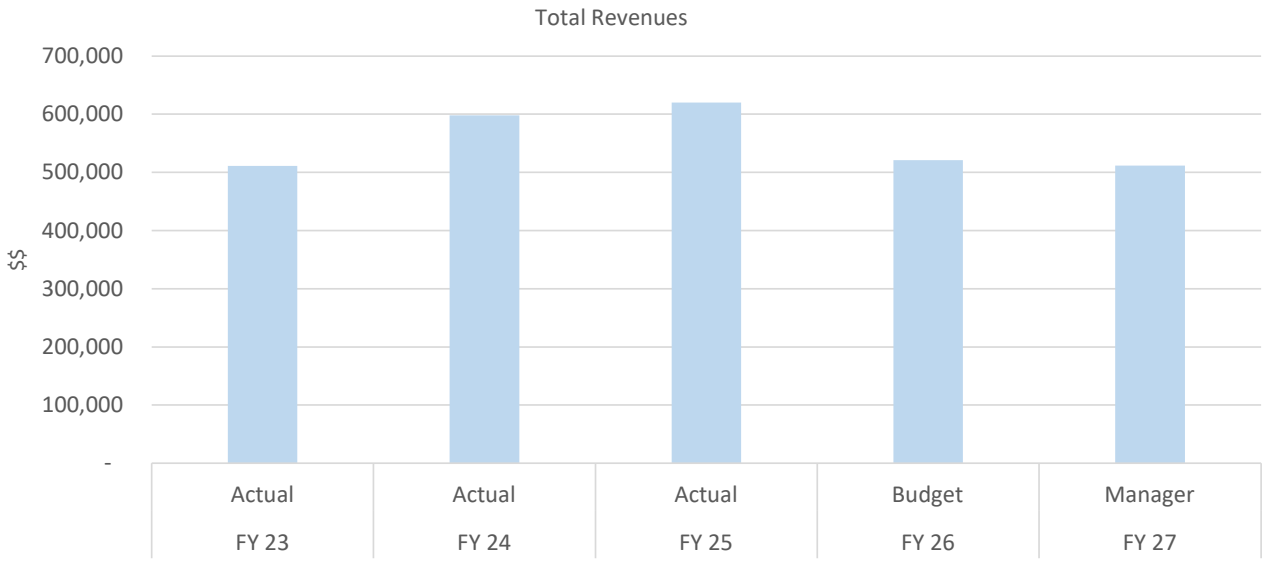
The number of families receiving subsidies in FY25 doubled compared to the year prior.



For more information, visit the Amherst After School webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/345/PrimeTime

RECREATION REVOLVING FUND

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues								
Purchase of Services								
Printing/Advertising	$		-	-	-	-	-	--
Misc.	$	1,252					-	--
Youth Programs								
Instructional Classes	$	1,906	2,370	6,186	5,000	5,000	-	0.0%
Day Camps	$	81,385	149,718	154,809	157,024	157,024	-	0.0%
Sports Camps	$	69,640	74,326	58,907	70,000	70,000	-	0.0%
NUTC	$		-		-	-	-	--
Youth Sports Leagues	$	129,917	138,333	86,024	83,000	83,000	-	0.0%
Downhill Skiing	$		-		9,400		(9,400)	-100.0%
Vacation Camps	$	15,064	15,759	21,010	18,820	18,820	-	0.0%
Adult Programs								
Sports Leagues	$	15,070	17,923	10,654	14,217	14,217	-	0.0%
Open Gyms	$	2,959	6,650	2,959	3,200	3,200	-	0.0%
Health Programs	$		-		5,500	5,500	-	0.0%
Family Programs								
Special Events	$	8,291	14,302	11,653	18,000	18,000	-	0.0%
Community Theater	$	111,286	97,574	119,676	114,894	114,894	-	0.0%
Field/Facility Activities	$	24,655	21,660	20,020	21,695	21,695	-	0.0%
Miscellaneous Programs	$	13,254	20,959	27,113	-	-	-	--
Indoor Pool	$	36,654	38,527	91,383	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	511,333	598,101	610,393	520,750	511,350	(9,400)	-1.8%
Use of Fund Balance	$	-	-	9,462	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	511,333	598,101	619,855	520,750	511,350	(9,400)	-1.8%



RECREATION REVOLVING FUND

Budget:		FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual	FY 26 Budget	FY 27 Manager	FY 27 - 26 Change	Percent Change
Operating Expenses								
Purchase of Services								
Extra Help	$	15,341			3,948	3,948	-	0.0%
Printing/Advertising	$	780	17,290	23,111		20,000	20,000	100.0%
Postage	$		9,999	1,150	-	1,500	1,500	100.0%
Credit Card Services	$	18,174	17,470	25,272	32,000	26,000	(6,000)	-23.1%
Food & Bev Supplies	$	7,286	9,119	11,683	-	10,000	10,000	100.0%
Youth Programs								
Instructional Classes	$	216	600	4,870	1,000	1,000	-	0.0%
Day Camps	$	90,246	72,625	90,080	108,328	95,000	(13,328)	-14.0%
Sports Camps	$	4,763	40,248	32,422	38,000	38,000	-	0.0%
NUTC	$				-	-	-	--
Youth Sports Leagues	$	105,747	42,512	45,144	42,000	42,000	-	0.0%
Downhill Skiing	$		435		8,760		(8,760)	--
Vacation Camps	$	6,368	4,989	7,606	10,412	8,000	(2,412)	-30.2%
Adult Programs								
Sports Leagues	$	920	1,059	1,657	7,400	2,000	(5,400)	-270.0%
Open Gyms	$				-	-	-	--
Health Programs	$	150			4,406	4,406	-	0.0%
Family Programs								
Special Events	$	22,373	30,349	17,167	30,000	25,000	(5,000)	-20.0%
Community Theater	$	85,901	76,938	100,434	92,296	92,296	-	0.0%
Field/Facility Activities	$	5,469	818	566	500	500	-	0.0%
Miscellaneous Programs	$	33,327	13,957	2,638	1,700	1,700	-	0.0%
Indoor Pool	$	28,587	43,809	61,983	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Expenses	$	425,650	382,215	425,784	380,750	371,350	(9,400)	-2.5%
Administrative Reimb.	$	68,050	176,101	194,071	140,000	140,000	-	0.0%
Total Expenses	$	493,700	558,316	619,855	520,750	511,350	(9,400)	-1.8%

RECREATION REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Actual
Youth Programs					
Instructional Classes	0	0	0	0	38
Day Camps	646	506	612	616	781
Sports Camps	515	312	542	543	179
NUTC	0	0	0	0	0
Youth Sports Leagues	425	500	568	611	1,159
Downhill Skiing	0	0	0	0	0
Vacation Camps	0	71	66	67	76
Adult Programs					
Sports Leagues	122	200	251	478	460
Open Gyms	600	500	814	840	830
Family Programs					
Special Events	10,000	11,000	12,000	12,000	13,000
Community Theater	0	0	4,280	3,627	4,820
Indoor Pool	150	125	150	212	206
Boltwood Project	0	0	0	0	0
Miscellaneous Programs	0	0	20	30	0

Notable Trends:
Day camp enrollment increased significantly in FY25 as did youth sports leagues participation.

For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3564/Recreation-Department

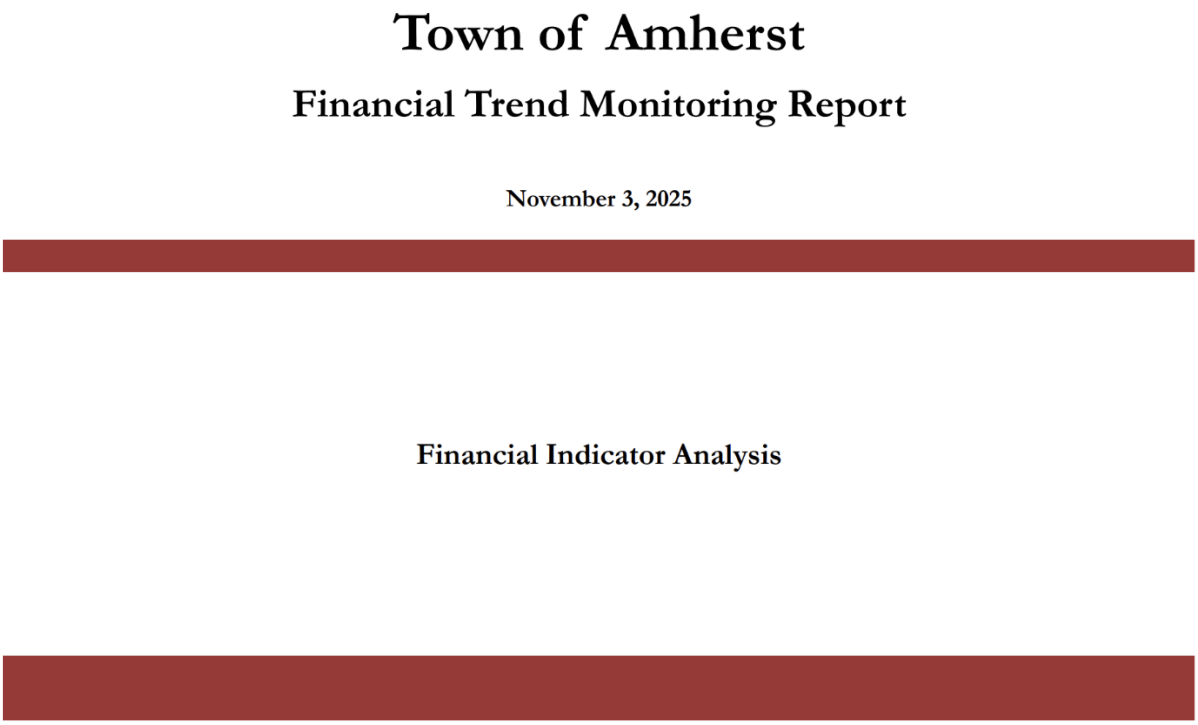
Informational Section

"The best thing about the future is that it comes one day at a time."

- Abraham Lincoln

Financial Indicators Report

The Financial Indicators report is presented to the Town Council each fall as a kickoff to the budget process. The report contains a wide array of current and historical financial information. The report includes an analysis of trends and projections for the next budget year. Click here to view the full report.



Town of Amherst

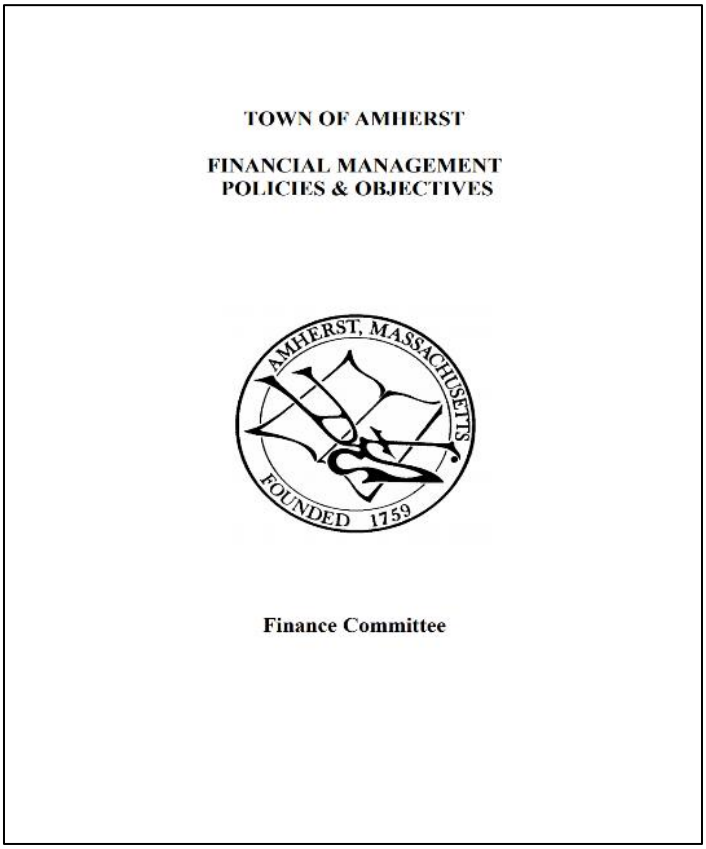
Financial Trend Monitoring Report

November 3, 2025

Financial Indicator Analysis

Financial Policies

The Town maintains Financial Policies that promote sound decision making. Click here to view these policies.



TOWN OF AMHERST

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT
POLICIES & OBJECTIVES

AMHERST, MASSACHUSETTS
FOUNDED 1759

Finance Committee

Debt Management

An important function of the Finance Department is to effectively manage the debt of the Town. Debt is created whenever the Town borrows funds to pay for a project such as building repairs, new vehicles, public works projects, etc. The loan can be short-term or long-term and is added to our debt schedule. Debt is paid from various sources but usually from funds appropriated for capital projects each year.

Using debt to finance projects is a prudent way to spread payments over several years and to preserve remaining capital funds for smaller projects. Borrowed funds include debt service costs or interest that must be paid by the Town. Interest rates fluctuate and that can affect the timing of when the Town utilizes debt for a project. An important factor in determining the interest rate is the Town's bond rating. Reports on the Town's bond rating can be found at https://www.amherstma.gov/122/Finance.

When planning for debt, staff use an integrated approach that combines the debt schedule with the Capital Improvement Program. This ensures all capital projects are recorded. The following page contains a detailed list of projects with debt service. Please note, some projects are still under construction so figures may change as final costs are paid.

Principal and Interest Payments	FY27 Total	FY28 Total	FY29 Total	FY30 Total	FY31 Total	FY32 Total	Future Years
GENERAL FUND							
Municipal:							
I - Net Loop	67,050	65,250	63,450	56,650	-		-
Public Works Sweeper	63,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
School Feasibility Study	94,000	90,500	87,000	83,500	80,000	71,500	68,250
Police Facility Chiller	112,172	-	-	-	-	-	-
Public Saftey - Radio	260,000	254,000	248,000	242,000	236,000	230,000	860,000
Jones Library Renovation and Addition	1,182,845	1,123,350	901,100	897,100	897,600	897,350	21,572,600
Ladder Truck	199,954	193,750	182,000	175,500	169,000	162,500	585,000
Crocker Farm Gym Floor Replacement	-	79,600	77,500	75,400	73,300	41,200	-
Fire EMS Facility Engineering	-	-	-	-			1,452,500
Public Works Facility Engineering	-	-	-	-			1,448,201
Fire Department Pumper	96,733	93,750	90,500	87,250	84,000	80,750	280,750
Short Term Interest Expense	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000	200,000	400,000
Municipal Total	**2,175,754**	**2,000,200**	**1,749,550**	**1,717,400**	**1,639,900**	**1,683,300**	**26,667,301**
Municipal: Debt Excluded							
Elementary School Project 1of 3	690,100	689,350	688,100	691,350	688,850	690,850	15,196,900
Elementary School Project 2 of 3	878,950	877,450	875,450	877,950	874,700	875,950	20,160,545
Elementary School Project 3 of 3 BONDS	383,543	380,050	384,300	383,050	381,550	379,800	8,786,750
Elementary School Project 3 of 3 BANS	380,953	380,050	384,300	383,050	381,550	379,800	8,786,750
Debt Excluded Total	**2,333,546**	**2,326,900**	**2,332,150**	**2,335,400**	**2,326,650**	**2,326,400**	**52,930,945**
Regional School District Assessment	**761,660**	**786,884**	**1,000,107**	**928,077**	**1,000,000**	**1,000,000**	**TBD**
Community Preservation Act							
Belchertown Road land (SRO) purchase	71,500	68,750	66,000	63,250	60,500	57,750	-
Valley CDC - SRO Studio Apts Northampton rd	63,750	56,250	54,000	51,750	49,500	47,250	-
Jones Library Historic Preservation	139,476	135,100	130,350	120,600	116,100	110,700	398,700
Fort River Project	21,000	98,000	95,200	92,400	89,600	86,800	392,000
High School Track	166,690	162,250	157,250	147,250	142,500	137,750	1,035,500
Community Preservation Act Total	**462,416**	**520,350**	**502,800**	**475,250**	**458,200**	**440,250**	**1,826,200**
ENTEPRISE FUNDS							
Water Enterprise Fund Debt							
Centennial / Repurpose	230,600	225,800	221,000	216,200	210,800	205,400	-
Pine Street (2M shared with Sewer)	64,250	62,750	61,250	59,375	57,500	55,625	105,625
Water meter radios	74,200	72,100	-	-	-	-	-
Centinnial Water Treatment Facility Engineering	73,750	71,800	69,850	62,900	56,100	-	-
Well Number #4 Replace/Repair	34,200	33,300	32,400	31,500	30,600	-	-
Northampton Rd Water Main Replacement	98,050	95,300	92,550	89,800	87,050	84,300	816,550
Centinnial Water Treatment Facility - Non DWSRF	174,000	174,000	174,000	168,000	162,000	156,000	-
Centinnial Water Treatment Facility- DWSRF FY24	394,348	394,387	394,428	394,469	394,512	394,555	9,088,701
Centinnial Water Treatment Facility- DWSRF FY25	155,802	159,551	159,551	159,551	159,551	159,551	3,669,673
Short Term Interest Expense	28,392	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	-
Water Enterprise Fund Total	**1,327,592**	**1,338,988**	**1,255,029**	**1,231,796**	**1,208,113**	**1,105,431**	**13,680,549**
Sewer Enterprise Fund Debt							
Sewer Extension Harkness Construction	230,625	226,250	221,750	217,125	212,375	207,500	202,500
Pine Street (2M shared with Water)	64,250	62,750	61,250	59,375	57,500	55,625	105,625
Finish Amherst woods phase II	218,300	212,750	207,200	201,650	196,100	192,400	188,700
Gravity Belt Thickener Engineering	100,350	96,850	93,350	89,850	86,350	82,850	147,800
Gravity Belt Thickener Construction 1	285,654	287,250	282,500	287,500	286,750	285,500	853,750
Gravity Belt Thickener Construction 2	199,833	194,433	188,733				-
SE Pump #4	110,000	105,000					-
Facilities Assessments	6,500	195,000	186,875	178,750	8,125		-
Short Term Interest Expense	31,102	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	-
Sewer Enterprise Fund Total	**1,246,614**	**1,430,283**	**1,291,658**	**1,084,250**	**897,200**	**873,875**	**1,498,375**
Total Debt Service (All Funds)	**8,307,582**	**8,403,605**	**8,131,295**	**7,772,173**	**7,530,063**	**7,429,256**	**96,603,370**

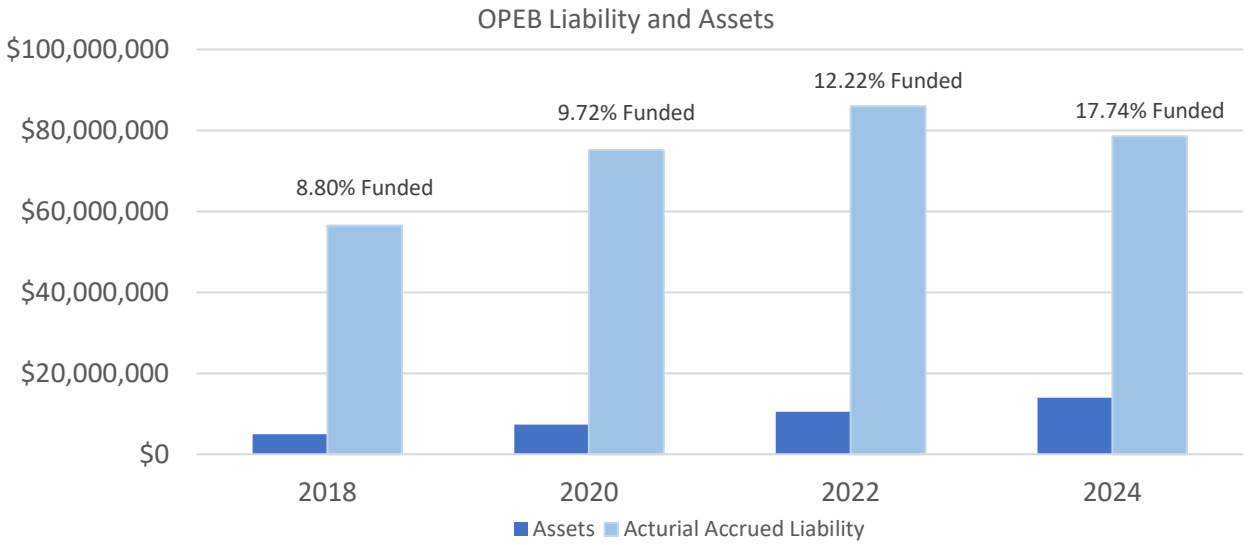
Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB)

The Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB) requires municipal governments to calculate their Other Post-Employment Benefit (OPEB) liability each year. Other Post-Employment Benefits are benefits owed to current and future retirees outside of a pension. The largest two for Amherst are health and life insurance. The Town pays a portion of health insurance and life insurance for all eligible employees. When an employee retires, the Town continues paying a portion of their insurance costs for the rest of their lives.

The Town's OPEB liability is calculated by a professional actuary and is an estimate of the Town's entire obligation for current and future retirees. The estimate is based on many variables including life expectancy, medical cost inflation, and the percentage of employees who will retire from the Town. The figure is large, but the Town is only required to pay for the current year benefit costs for current retirees.

Since the OPEB liability is quite large and there is an expectation that retiree health insurance costs will continue to rise, most Towns are setting aside funds each year to start paying down this future obligation. Setting aside funds now also helps better align the full cost of an employee with the resources needed to pay for that employee.

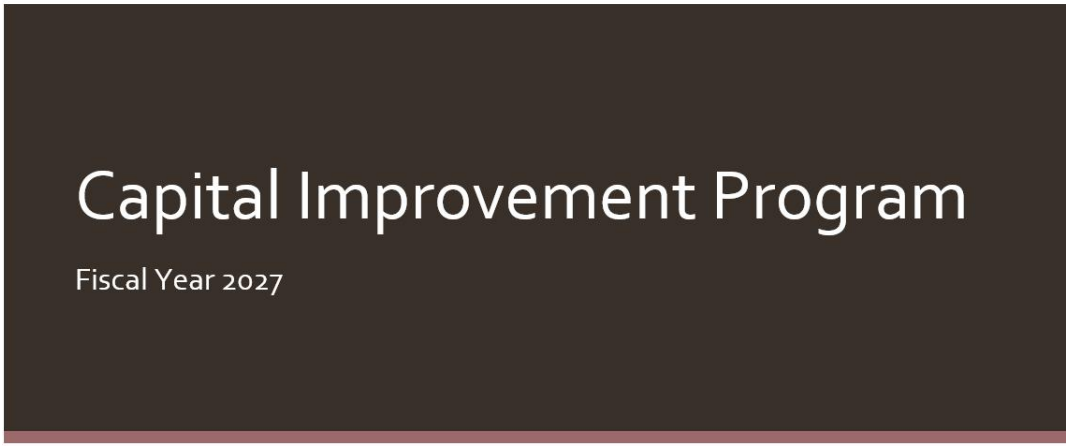
Amherst has established a plan to set aside funds and has been following this plan successfully for almost a decade. The funds go into a dedicated OPEB trust fund that can only be used for retiree OPEB costs. These funds are invested to grow the balance of the trust. The following chart compares the OPEB liability to the assets that have been set aside.



This budget proposes a contribution of $855,902 towards the Town's OPEB liability. This figure includes contributions from Enterprise Funds.

Capital Improvement Program and Capital Inventory

The Capital Improvement Program establishes a five-year plan for addressing the capital needs of the Town. The Town follows a thorough and comprehensive approach to developing the Capital Improvement Program that includes involvement from key stakeholders. Click here to view the complete plan which includes an inventory of all of the Town's capital assets.



Community Preservation Act

The Community Preservation Act (CPA) was passed by the State Legislature as Chapter 267 of the Acts of 2000. The act is designed to help Massachusetts cities and towns preserve and plan for their communities' futures and to raise funds to accomplish their Historic Preservation, Open Space, Recreation, and Community Housing goals.

Amherst adopted the CPA at its 2001 Annual Town Election, established a Community Preservation Act Committee (CPAC), and authorized the Town to levy a 1% surcharge on property tax bills to raise funds to address our Community Housing, Historic Preservation, Open Space, and Recreation needs. Amherst elected to exempt from the surcharge the first $100,000 of assessed value of each property's assessment. By accepting the CPA, Amherst became eligible to receive state funds that match a percentage of the funds raised locally each year. A few years later in 2008, residents voted to increase the levy to 1 ½ %, and in 2015 the residents voted to increase the levy to the maximum allowed of 3%.

Spending CPA-generated funds must be approved by Town Council. The CPAC receives all requests for use of CPA funds. The CPAC reviews and then recommends selected projects to the Town Council based on project quality and funds available. The law requires that at least 10% of the Town's CPA funds be allocated to projects in each of the following areas: Historic Preservation, Open Space, and Community Housing. Funding for Recreation is permitted but not at a mandated percentage; and counts toward the Open Space allocation.

Each year, CPAC completes a report summarizing its recommendations. Those reports can be found at https://www.amherstma.gov/929/Community-Preservation-Act-Committee.

Risk Management

The Town faces numerous risks inherent to its mission of providing high quality services to thousands of residents. Town staff utilize different strategies to help mitigate these risks and protect the assets of the Town and taxpayer funds.

Physical Assets: The Town has property and casualty insurance for its buildings, vehicles, and equipment. This insurance provides protection in a situation where a Town asset is damaged or destroyed.

Personnel: The Town Manager, working with the Human Resources Department, promulgates policies and procedures to promote the legal and ethical performance of work by Town employees. These policies also help employees by creating a rewarding, productive, and safe working environment. The Town purchases various types of insurance such as injured on duty insurance or employment practices insurance to protect taxpayers against unpredictable costs.

Taxpayer Funds: The Treasurer manages all the funds of the Town. The Treasurer follows an investment policy to help maximize returns and minimize risk. The Treasurer also employs financial advisors to provide additional expertise and advice.

The following definitions explain the meaning of some of the terms frequently used in documents and discussions related to the Town's financial matters:

Abatement	A reduction or elimination of a real or personal property tax, motor vehicle excise, a fee, charge, or special assessment imposed by a governmental unit. Granted only on application of the person seeking the abatement and only by the committing governmental unit. (See Commitment.)
Accounting System	The total structure of records and procedures that identify, record, classify, and report information on the financial position and operations of a governmental unit or any of its funds, account groups, and organizational components.
Accrued Interest	The amount of interest that has accumulated on the bond since the date of the last interest payment, and in the sale of a bond, the amount accrued up to but not including the date of delivery (settlement date). (See Interest.)
Additional Assistance	A state aid program that provides unrestricted general fund revenue to a certain number of communities through the Cherry Sheet. Additional Assistance evolved from the old resolution aid formula of the 1980s, but following state budget cuts, it was level funded beginning in FY 92 and then subsequently reduced.
Adopted Budget	The resulting budget that has been approved by vote of the Town Council.
Agency Fund	One of four types of Fiduciary Funds. It is used to report resources in a purely custodial capacity by a governmental unit. Agency funds generally involve only the receipt, temporary investment, and periodic transfer of money to fulfill legal obligations to individuals, private organizations, or other governments. For example, certain employee payroll withholdings typically accumulate in an agency fund until due and forwarded to the federal government, health care provider, and so forth.
Allocation	The distribution of available monies, personnel, buildings, and equipment among various Town departments, divisions, or cost centers.
Amortization	The gradual repayment of an obligation over time and in accordance with a pre-determined payment schedule.
Annual Budget	An estimate of Expenditures for specific purposes during the Fiscal Year and the proposed means (estimated Revenues) for financing those activities.
Appellate Tax Board (ATB)	A board appointed by the Governor that has jurisdiction to decide appeals from local decisions relating to property taxes, motor vehicle excises, state owned land valuations, exemption eligibility, property classification, and equalized valuations.
Appropriation	An authorization granted by a town meeting, city or town council, or other legislative body to expend money and incur obligations for specific public purposes. An appropriation is usually limited in amount and as to the time period within which it may be expended. (See Encumbrance, Free Cash).
Assessed Valuation	A value assigned to real estate or other property by a government as the basis for levying taxes. In Massachusetts, assessed valuation is based on the property's full and fair cash value as set by the Assessors. (See Fair Market Value.)
Assessment Date	The date property tax liability is fixed. In Massachusetts, property taxes are assessed as of January 1 prior to the fiscal year. Assessors determine the physical status of taxable real and personal property, its ownership, fair cash value and usage classification as of

	that date. By local option (M.G.L. Ch. 59 §2A), the physical status of real property on June 30 is deemed to be its condition on the previous January 1.
Audit	An examination of a community's financial systems, procedures, and data by a certified public accountant (independent auditor), and a report on the fairness of financial statements and on local compliance with statutes and regulations. The audit serves as a valuable management tool for evaluating the fiscal performance of a community.
Audit Committee	A committee appointed by the Town Council, with specific responsibility to review the community's independent audit of financial statements and to address all issues relating to it as well as those outlined in the accompanying management letter.
Audit Management Letter	An independent auditor's written communication to government officials, separate from the community's audit. It generally identifies areas of deficiency, if any, and presents recommendations for improvements in accounting procedures, internal controls and other matters.
Audit Report	Prepared by an independent auditor, an audit report includes: (a) a statement of the scope of the audit; (b) explanatory comments as to application of auditing procedures; (c) findings and opinions; (d) financial statements and schedules; and (e) statistical tables, supplementary comments, and recommendations. Almost always accompanied by a management letter.
Available Funds	Balances in the various fund types that represent non-recurring revenue sources. As a matter of sound practice, they are frequently appropriated to meet unforeseen expenses, for capital expenditures or other one-time costs. Examples of available funds include Free Cash, Stabilization Fund, Overlay Surplus, and enterprise Retained Earnings. (See Reserves.)
Balance Sheet	A statement that discloses the assets, liabilities, reserves, and equities of a fund or governmental unit at a specified date.
Balanced Budget	A budget in which receipts are greater than (or equal to) expenditures. A requirement for all Massachusetts cities and towns.
Betterments (Special Assessments)	A special property tax that may be assessed to the property owners of an area whenever part of a community benefits from a public improvement, or betterment (*e.g.*, water, sewer, sidewalks, etc.), to reimburse the governmental entity for all, or part, of the costs it incurred in completing the project. Each property parcel receiving the benefit is assessed a proportionate share of the cost which may be paid in full or apportioned over a period of up to 20 years. In this case, one year's apportionment along with one year's committed interest computed from October 1 to October 1 is added to the tax bill until the betterment has been paid.
Block Grant	A Federal grant of money awarded by formula under very general guidelines that allow grantees broad latitude in spending activities. Recipients are normally state or local governments.
Bond	A means to raise money through the issuance of debt. A bond issuer/borrower promises in writing to repay a specified sum of money, alternately referred to as face value, par value or bond principal, to the buyer of the bond on a specified future date (maturity date), together with periodic interest at a specified rate. The term of a bond is always greater than one year.
Bond Anticipation Note (BAN)	Short-term debt instrument used to generate cash for initial project costs and with the expectation that the debt will be replaced later by permanent bonding. Typically issued for a term of less than one year, BANs may be re-issued for up to five years, provided

	principal repayment begins after two years (M.G.L. Ch. 44 §17). Principal payments on school related BANs may be deferred up to seven years (increased in 2002 from five years) if the community has an approved project on the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) priority list. BANs are full faith and credit obligations.
Bond Authorization	Action of town meeting or a city or town council authorizing the executive branch to raise money through the sale of bonds in a specific amount and for a specific purpose. Once authorized, issuance is by the treasurer upon the signature of the manager, mayor, or select board. (See Bond Issue.)
Bond Issue	The actual sale of the entire, or a portion of, the bond amount authorized by a town meeting or city council.
Bond Rating	A credit rating assigned to a municipality to help investors assess the future ability, legal obligation, and willingness of the municipality (bond issuer) to make timely debt service payments. Stated otherwise, a rating helps prospective investors determine the level of risk associated with a given fixed income investment. Rating agencies such as Moody's, Standard and Poor's, and Fitch ICBA, Inc. use rating systems which designate a letter or a combination of letters and numerals where AAA is the highest rating and C1 is a very low rating.
Bonds Authorized and Unissued	Balance of a bond authorization not yet sold. Upon completion or abandonment of a project, any remaining balance of authorized and unissued bonds may not be used for other purposes but must be rescinded by town meeting or the city or town council to be removed from community's books.
Budget	A plan for allocating resources to support particular services, purposes, and functions over a specified period of time.
Budget Calendar	The schedule of key dates or milestones which a government follows in the preparation and adoption of the budget.
Budget Message	A statement by the Town Manager that, among other things, offers context by summarizing the main points of a budget, explains priorities, describes underlying policies that drive funding decisions, and otherwise justifies the expenditure plan and provides a vision for the future.
Business-Type Activities	One of two classes of activities reported in the GASB 34 government-wide financial statements. These activities are financed in whole or in part by fees charged to users for goods or services. Some examples are enterprise (M.G.L. Ch. 44 §53F½), special revenue (M.G.L Ch. 41 §69B) water, and municipal electric funds.
Capital Assets	All tangible property used in the operation of government, which is not easily converted into cash, and has an initial useful life extending beyond a single financial reporting period. Capital assets include land and land improvements; infrastructure such as roads, bridges, water and sewer lines; easements; buildings and building improvements; vehicles, machinery, and equipment. Communities typically define capital assets in terms of a minimum useful life and a minimum initial cost. (See Fixed Asset).
Capital Budget	An appropriation or spending plan that uses borrowing or direct outlay for capital or fixed asset improvements. Among other information, a capital budget should identify the method of financing for each recommended expenditure, *i.e.*, tax levy and rates, and identify those items that were not recommended. (See Capital Asset, Fixed Asset).
Capital Improvements Plan (CIP)	A blueprint for planning a community's capital expenditures that comprises an annual capital budget and a five-year capital plan. It coordinates community planning, fiscal

	capacity and physical development. While all of the community's needs should be identified in the plan, there is a set of criteria that prioritizes the expenditures.
Capital Outlay Expenditure Exclusion	A temporary increase in the tax levy to fund a capital project or make a capital acquisition. Exclusions require two-thirds vote of the select board or city or town council (sometimes with the mayor's approval) and a majority vote in a community wide referendum. The exclusion is added to the tax levy only during the year in which the project is being funded and may increase the tax levy above the levy ceiling.
Capital Projects Fund	Fund type used to account for financial resources to be used for the acquisition or construction of major capital facilities (other than those financed by proprietary funds).
Cash	Currency, coin, checks and bankers' drafts on hand or on deposit with an official or agent designated as custodian of cash and bank deposits.
Cash Basis of Accounting	An accounting method that records and recognizes revenues when cash is received and expenses when cash is paid out of the Town treasury.
Cash Book	A source book of original entry, which a treasurer is required to maintain, for the purpose of recording municipal receipts, adjustments to balances, deposits to municipal accounts, and disbursements through warrants.
Cash Management	The process of monitoring the ebb and flow of money in and out of municipal accounts to ensure cash availability to pay bills and to facilitate decisions on the need for short-term borrowing and investment of idle cash.
Cash Receipts	Any money received by a municipality or its departments whether by cash, check or electronic transfer.
Certificate of Deposit (CD)	A bank deposit evidenced by a negotiable or non-negotiable instrument that provides on its face that the amount of such deposit, plus a specified interest, is payable to the bearer or to any specified person on a certain date specified in the instrument, at the expiration of a certain specified time, or upon notice in writing.
Chapter 61 Land	Forest, agricultural/horticultural, and recreational lands valued according to M.G.L. Ch. 61, 61A, and 61B. Land is valued at its current use rather than the full and fair cash value. The commercial property tax rate is applicable for land defined under these chapters.
Chapter 70 School Funds	The school funding formula created under the Education Reform Act of 1993 by which state aid is distributed through the Cherry Sheet to help establish educational equity among municipal and regional school districts.
Chapter 90 Highway Funds	State funds derived from periodic transportation bond authorizations and apportioned to communities for highway projects based on a formula under the provisions of M.G.L. Ch. 90 §34. The formula is based on three variables: local road mileage (58.33%) as certified by the Massachusetts Highway Department (MHD), local employment level (20.83%) derived the Department of Employment and Training (DET), and population estimates (20.83%) from the US Census Bureau. Local highway projects are approved in advance, and then later on the submission of certified expenditure reports to MHD, communities receive cost reimbursements to the limit of the grant. Under the formula, communities with a larger number of road miles receive proportionately more aid than those with fewer road miles.
Charges for Services (User Charges or Fees)	The charges levied on the users of particular goods or services provided by local government requiring individuals to pay for the private benefits they receive. Such charges reduce the reliance on property tax funding.

Charter School Aid	A component of Ch. 70 state aid provided to a municipality for public education. Beginning in FY 99, no new charter aid has been included in Ch. 70 aid, and any Charter Aid distributed in FY 98 and prior years has been included in FY 99 base aid, in Ch. 70 aid, and any Charter Aid distributed in FY 98 and prior years has been included in FY 99 base aid.
Chief Procurement Officer (CPO)	An individual defined under M.G.L Ch. 30B §2 and authorized to procure supplies or services for a governmental body.
Cherry Sheet	Named for the cherry-colored paper on which they were originally printed, the Cherry Sheet is the official notification to cities, towns and regional school districts of the next fiscal year's state aid and assessments. The aid is in the form of distributions, which provide funds based on formulas and reimbursements that provide funds for costs incurred during a prior period for certain programs or services. Cherry Sheets are located at www.mass.gov/dls. (See Cherry Sheet Assessments, Estimated Receipts.)
Cherry Sheet Assessments	Estimates of annual charges to cover the cost of certain state, regional, and county programs.
Cherry Sheet Offset Items	Local aid that may be spent without appropriation in the budget, but which must be spent for specific municipal and regional school district programs. Current offset items include school lunch grants, School Choice Receiving Tuition and public libraries grants. (See also Offset Receipts.)
Cherry Sheet Receipts	M.G.L. Ch. 58 §25A provides that the Commissioner of Revenue estimate the state's funding of local reimbursement and assistance programs as authorized by law and appropriated by the legislature. Local assessors are required to use these figures when determining the local property tax rate.
Classification Of the Tax Rate	Each year, the select board or city or town council vote whether to exercise certain tax rate options. Those options include choosing a residential factor to adopt (M.G.L. Ch. 40 §56) and determining whether to offer an open space discount (Ch. 61, 61A and 61B), a residential exemption (Ch. 59 §5C), and/or a small commercial exemption (Ch. 59 §5I) to property owners.
Collective Bargaining	The process of negotiating workers' wages, hours, benefits, working conditions, etc., between an employer and some or all of its employees, who are represented by a recognized labor union.
Commercial, Industrial, Personal Property (CIP)	A group of three property types used to describe the effect of multiple tax rates. A municipality can take a number of actions to shift the levy burden associated with a single tax rate from Open Space and Residential categories to the CIP categories.
Commitment	An authorization to collect taxes, fees, or other charges due to a municipality. For example, the assessors' commitment of real estate taxes authorizes the collector to pursue and receive payment from property owners.
Community Preservation Act (CPA)	Enacted as M.G.L. Ch. 44B in 2000, the Community Preservation Act permits cities and towns accepting its provisions to establish a restricted fund from which monies can only be appropriated for a) the acquisition, creation and preservation of open space; b) the acquisition, preservation, rehabilitation, and restoration of historic resources; and c) the acquisition, creation and preservation of land for recreational use; d) the creation, preservation and support of community housing; and e) the rehabilitation and restoration of open space, land for recreational use and community housing that is acquired or created using monies from the fund. Acceptance requires town meeting or city or town council approval, together with referendum approval by majority vote. The local program is funded by a local surcharge of up to 3% on real property tax bills and

	matching dollars from the state generated from registry of deeds fees. (See DOR IGR 00-209 as amended by IGR 01-207 and IGR 02-208).
Computer Assisted Mass Appraisal (CAMA)	An automated system for maintaining property data, valuing property, notifying owners, and ensuring tax equity through uniform valuations.
Consumer Price Index (CPI)	The statistical measure of changes, if any, in the overall price level of consumer goods and services. The index is often called the "cost-of-living index."
Cost-Benefit Analysis	A decision-making tool that allows a comparison of options based on the level of benefit derived and the cost to achieve the benefit from different alternatives.
Cost Of Living Adjustment (COLA)	Reference to language in municipal contracts that provide for annual or periodic increases in salaries and wages for employees over the course of the contract. The amount of an increase is most often negotiated based on a community's ability to pay but is sometimes tied to the annual change in a specified index, *i.e.*, Consumer Price Index (CPI).
Debt Authorization	Formal approval by a two-thirds vote of town meeting or city or town council to incur debt, in accordance with procedures stated in M.G.L. Ch. 44 §§1, 2, 3, 4a, 6-15.
Debt Exclusion	An action taken by a community through a referendum vote to raise the funds necessary to pay debt service costs for a particular project from the property tax levy, but outside the limits under Proposition 2½. By approving a debt exclusion, a community calculates its annual levy limit under Proposition 2½, then adds the excluded debt service cost. The amount is added to the levy limit for the life of the debt only and may increase the levy above the levy ceiling.
Debt Limit	The maximum amount of debt that a municipality may authorize for qualified purposes under state law. Under M.G.L. Ch. 44 §10, debt limits are set at 5% of EQV for a city and by petition to the Municipal Oversight Board, cities can receive approval to increase their debt limit to 10% of EQV.
Debt Service	The repayment cost, usually stated in annual terms and based on an amortization schedule, of the principal and interest on any particular bond issue.
Debt Statement	Reference to a report, which local treasurers are required to file with the DOR, showing authorized and issued debt, debt retired, and interest paid by a community during the prior fiscal year, as well as authorized but unissued debt at year-end. Also known as the "Statement of Indebtedness."
Deferred Revenue	Amounts that do not meet the criteria for revenue recognition. Also, earned amounts that are not yet available to liquidate liabilities of a current period.
Deficit	The excess of expenditures over revenues during an accounting period. Also refers to the excess of the liabilities of a fund over its assets.
Demand	Notice to a delinquent taxpayer of overdue taxes typically mailed soon after the 30-day, or otherwise determined, payment period has ended.
Department	A principal, functional, and administrative entity created by statute and the Town Manager to carry out specified public services.
Department Of Revenue (DOR)	State department responsible for collecting a wide variety of taxes, providing taxpayer support, and administering programs related to municipal finance through the Division of Local Services (DLS).

Deputy Collector	If 14 days after the mailing of a demand payment is not received, the collector may issue warrants to one or more deputy collectors authorizing them to collect delinquent taxes, commonly motor vehicle excise. For outstanding excise, the deputy may mark licenses/registrations or provide evidence (*e.g.*, death absence, poverty, insolvency or other inability of the persons assessed to pay) that the accounts are uncollectable. All amounts collected by the deputy collector should be deposited to a municipal bank account from which the deputy may be paid his compensation by check signed by the collector once the tax payments have cleared (M.G.L. Ch. 60 §92). However, if a community requires all receipts be paid over to the treasurer, the deputy collector must be paid through the warrant process. (See DOR IGR 90-219)
Designated Unreserved Fund Balance	A limitation on the use of all or part of the expendable balance in a governmental fund.
Division Of Local Services (DLS)	A division within the DOR (Department of Revenue) responsible for helping Massachusetts cities and towns achieve sound and efficient fiscal management through technical assistance, training, and oversight. DLS bureaus are responsible for ensuring the fairness and equity of local property taxation, the accuracy and quality of local accounting and treasury management, interpreting state laws that affect local governance, distributing local aid, maintaining a comprehensive databank on local finances, and auditing local school districts.
Education Reform Act of 1993	State law that authorized the seven-year Ch. 70 funding program for education and that established spending targets for school districts as a means to remedy educational inequities. Scheduled to end by FY 00, the program has been extended, pending agreement on further reforms.
Emergency Spending	M.G.L. Ch. 44 §31 allows a community to spend in excess of appropriation in cases of major disasters that pose an immediate threat to the health or safety of persons or property, following the emergency declaration by council or select board and the approval of the Director of Accounts.
Eminent Domain	The power of a government to take property for public purposes. Frequently used to obtain real property that cannot be purchased from owners in a voluntary transaction. Property owner receives fair compensation (market value at the time of the taking) as determined through court proceedings.
Encumbrance	A reservation of funds to cover obligations arising from purchase orders, contracts, or salary commitments that is chargeable to, but not yet paid from, a specific appropriation account.
Enterprise Funds	A fund authorized by M.G.L. Ch. 44 §53F½ that is a separate accounting and financial reporting mechanism for municipal services for which a fee is charged in exchange for goods or services. It allows a community to demonstrate to the public the portion of total costs of a service that is recovered through user charges and the portion that is subsidized by the tax levy, if any. With an enterprise fund, all costs of service delivery—direct, indirect, and capital costs—are identified. This allows the community to recover total service costs through user fees if it chooses. Enterprise accounting also enables communities to reserve the "surplus" or retained earnings generated by the operation of the enterprise rather than closing it out to the general fund at year-end. Services that may be treated as enterprises include, but are not limited to, water, sewer, hospital, and airport services. Amherst has four: water, sewer, solid waste, and transportation. Both the costs and the revenues of the enterprise are segregated from other finances of the Town.

Equalized Valuations (EQV)	The determination of an estimate of the full and fair cash value of all property in the Commonwealth as of a certain taxable date. EQVs have historically been used as a variable in distributing some state aid accounts and for determining county assessments and other costs. The Commissioner of Revenue, in accordance with M.G.L. Ch. 58 §10C, is charged with the responsibility of biannually determining an equalized valuation for each city and town in the Commonwealth.
Estimated Receipts	A term that typically refers to anticipated local revenues listed on page three of the Tax Recapitulation Sheet. Projects of local revenues are often based on the previous year's receipts and represent funding sources necessary to support a community's annual budget. (See Local Receipts.)
Excess Levy Capacity	The difference between the levy limit and the amount of real and personal property taxes actually levied in a given year.
Exemption	A discharge, established by statute, from the obligation to pay all or a portion of a property tax. The exemption is available to particular categories of property or persons upon the timely submission and approval of an application to the assessors. Properties exempt from taxation include hospitals, schools, houses of worship, and cultural institutions. Persons who may qualify for exemptions include veterans, blind individuals, surviving spouses, and persons over 70 years of age.
Expendable Trust	A fund, administered by the treasurer, from which both principal and interest can be expended for the purposes specified and agreed upon when the money was donated or transferred to the community. (See Trust Fund; Non-Expendable Trust.)
Expenditure/Expense	An outlay of money made by municipalities to provide the programs and services within their approved budget.
Fair Market Value/Full and Fair Cash Value (FFCV)	Fair cash value has been defined by the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court as "fair market value", which is the price an owner willing but not under compulsion to sell ought to receive from one willing but not under compulsion to buy. It means the highest price that a normal purchaser not under peculiar compulsion will pay at the time and cannot exceed the sum that the owner after reasonable effort could obtain for his property. A valuation limited to what the property is worth to the purchaser is not market value. The fair cash value is the value the property would have on January first of any taxable year in the hands of any owner, including the present owner" (Boston Gas Co. v. Assessors of Boston, 334 Mass. 549, 566 (1956).
Fiduciary Funds	A repository of money held by a municipality in a trustee capacity or as an agent for individuals, private organizations, other governmental units, and other funds. These include expendable trust, non-expendable trust, pension trust, and agency funds.
Financial Advisor	An individual or institution that assists municipalities in the issuance of tax-exempt bonds and notes. The public finance department of a commercial bank or a non-bank advisor usually provides this service.
Financial Statement	A presentation of the assets and liabilities of a community as of a particular date and most often prepared after the close of the fiscal year.
Fiscal Year	Since 1974, the Commonwealth and municipalities have operated on a budget cycle that begins July 1 and ends June 30. The designation of the fiscal year is that of the calendar year in which the fiscal year ends. For example, the 2000 fiscal year is July 1, 1999 to June 30, 2000. Since 1976, the federal government fiscal year has begun October 1 and ended September 30.

Fixed Assets	Long-lived, tangible assets such as buildings, equipment and land obtained or controlled as a result of past transactions or circumstances.
Fixed Costs	Costs that are legally or contractually mandated such as retirement, taxes, insurance, debt service costs, or interest on loans.
Foundation Budget	The spending target imposed by the Education Reform Act of 1993 for each school district as the level necessary to provide an adequate education for all students.
Free Cash	Remaining, unrestricted funds from operations of the previous fiscal year including unexpended free cash from the previous year, actual receipts in excess of revenue estimates shown on the tax recapitulation sheet, and unspent amounts in budget line-items. Unpaid property taxes and certain deficits reduce the amount that can be certified as free cash. The calculation of free cash is based on the balance sheet as of June 30, which is submitted by the community's auditor, accountant, or comptroller. Important: free cash is not available for appropriation until certified by the Director of Accounts. (See Available Funds.)
Full Accrual	A method of accounting that recognizes the financial effect of transactions, events, and interfund activities when they occur, regardless of the timing of related cash flows.
Fund	An accounting entity with a self-balancing set of accounts that are segregated for the purpose of carrying on identified activities or attaining certain objectives in accordance with specific regulations, restrictions, or limitations.
Fund Accounting	Organizing the financial records of a municipality into multiple, segregated locations for money. A fund is a distinct entity within the municipal government in which financial resources and activity (assets, liabilities, fund balances, revenues, and expenditures) are accounted for independently in accordance with specific regulations, restrictions or limitations. Examples of funds include the general fund and enterprise funds. Communities whose accounting records are organized according to the Uniform Municipal Accounting System (UMAS) use multiple funds.
Fund Balance	The difference between assets and liabilities reported in a governmental fund. Also known as fund equity. (See also Undesignated Fund Balance.)
General Fund	The fund used to account for most financial resources and activities governed by the normal town meeting/city council appropriation process.
General Ledger	The accountant's record of original entry, which is instrumental in forming a paper trail of all government financial activity.
General Obligation Bonds	Bonds issued by a municipality for purposes allowed by statute that are backed by the full faith and credit of its taxing authority.
Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP)	Uniform minimum standards and guidelines for financial accounting and reporting that serve to achieve some level of standardization
GIS (Geographical Information System)	A computerized mapping system and analytical tool that allows a community to raise information on a parcel, area or community wide basis. It also allows parcels to be identified and sorted on the basis of certain specified criteria. The system can integrate assessors' property data, water and sewer line networks, wetlands, floodplains and as well as other data.
Government Finance Officers Association (GFOA)	A nationwide association of public finance professionals.

Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB)	The ultimate authoritative on accounting and financial reporting standard setting body for state and local governments.
Governmental Funds	Funds generally used to account for tax-supported activities. There are five different types of governmental funds: the general fund, special revenue funds, capital projects funds, debt service funds, and permanent funds.
Grant	A contribution of assets by one governmental unit or other organization to another. Typically, these contributions are made to local governments from the state and federal government. Grants are usually made for specific purposes.
Hotel/Motel Excise	A local option since 1985 that allows a community to assess a tax on short-term room occupancy. The community may levy up to 4% of the charge for stays of less than 90 days at hotels, motels, and lodging houses.
House 1 (Governor's Budget Proposal)	Designation given to the Governor's annual budget request, which is submitted to the House of Representatives by the fourth Wednesday of January. Except that a newly elected governor has eight weeks from the day he/she takes office to submit a budget. The budget is designated House 1 in the first year of the two-year legislative session and House 1A in the second year.
Indirect Cost	Costs of a service not reflected in the operating budget of the entity providing the service. An example of an indirect cost of providing water service would be the value of time spent by non-water department employees processing water bills. A determination of these costs is necessary to analyze the total cost of service delivery. The matter of indirect costs arises most often in the context of enterprise funds.
Inside Debt	Municipal debt incurred for purposes enumerated in M.G.L. Ch. 44, §7, and measured against the community's debt limit as set under Ch. 10. Consequently, the borrowing is inside the debt limit and referred to as inside debt. (See also Outside Debt.)
Interest	Compensation paid or to be paid for the use of money, including amounts payable at periodic intervals or discounted at the time a loan is made. In the case of municipal bonds, interest payments accrue on a day-to-day basis, but are paid every six months.
Interest Rate	The interest payable, expressed as a percentage of the principal available, for use during a specified period of time. It is always expressed in annual terms.
Internal Controls	The policies and procedures established by management to ensure the integrity and comprehensiveness of the data collected by the accounting system for use in internal and external financial reports, as well as the overall control environment in which the government operates.
Land Court	Established in 1898, the Land Court has the exclusive jurisdiction to foreclose rights of redemption on a property in tax title.
Levy	The amount a community raises through the property tax. The levy can be any amount up to the levy limit, which is re-established every year in accordance with Proposition 2½ provisions.
Levy Ceiling	A levy ceiling is one of two types of levy (tax) restrictions imposed by M.G.L. Ch. 59 §21C (Proposition 2½). It states that, in any year, the real and personal property taxes imposed may not exceed 2½% of the total full and fair cash value of all taxable property. Property taxes levied may exceed this limit only if the community passes a capital exclusion, a debt exclusion, or a special exclusion. (See Levy Limit.)
Levy Limit	A levy limit is one of two types of levy (tax) restrictions imposed by M.G.L. Ch. 59 §21C (Proposition 2½). It states that the real and personal property taxes imposed by a city or

	town may only grow each year by 2½% of the prior year's levy limit, plus new growth and any overrides or exclusions. The levy limit can exceed the levy ceiling only if the community passes a capital expenditure exclusion, debt exclusion, or special exclusion. (See Levy Ceiling.)
Lien	A legal claim against real or personal property to protect the interest of a party (i.e., a city or town) to whom a debt is owed (i.e., taxes). In the case of real property, the lien in favor of a municipality automatically arises each January 1, but must be secured through other action. On other property, a lien must be recorded to become secure.
Line-Item Budget	A budget that separates spending into categories, or greater detail, such as supplies, equipment, maintenance, or salaries, as opposed to a program budget.
Local Aid	Revenue allocated by the Commonwealth to cities, towns, and regional school districts. Estimates of local aid are transmitted to cities, towns, and districts annually by the "Cherry Sheets." Most Cherry Sheet aid programs are considered general fund revenues and may be spent for any purpose, subject to appropriation.
Local Appropriating Authority	In a town, the town meeting has the power to appropriate funds, including the authorization of debt. In a city, the city or town council has the power upon the recommendation of the Town Manager.
Local Receipts	Locally generated revenues, other than real and personal property taxes. Examples include motor vehicle excise, investment income, hotel/motel tax, fees, rentals, and charges. Annual estimates of local receipts are shown on the tax rate recapitulation sheet.
Long-Term Debt	Community borrowing, or outstanding balance at any given time, involving loans with a maturity date of 12 months or more. (See Permanent Debt.)
Mass Appraisal	Use of standardized procedures for collecting data and appraising property to ensure that all properties within a municipality are valued uniformly and equitably.
Massachusetts General Laws (M.G.L.)	Laws passed by the Massachusetts legislature. The M.G.L. is organized by chapters with multiple sections in each chapter. Currently there are 282 chapters (see www.mass.gov/legis/laws/mgl/index.htm). Note that laws enacted prior to the current legislative session are in one location and those enacted in the current session are located in a separate location.
Massachusetts Municipal Depository Trust (MMDT)	An investment program, founded in 1977 under the supervision of the State Treasurer, in which municipalities may pool excess cash for investment.
Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA)	Administers the state program that reimburses cities, towns, and regional school districts varying percentages of their school construction costs depending on the wealth of the community or district and the category of reimbursement. Projects that received their first reimbursement payment prior to July 26, 2004 will continue to get annual state payments to offset the related annual debt service. Thereafter, cities, towns, and regional school districts will receive a lump sum amount representing the state's share of the eligible project costs. (See DLS Bulletin 200420B.)
Minimum Local Contribution	The minimum that a city or town must appropriate from property taxes and other local revenues for the support of schools (See Education Reform Act of 1993.)
Motor Vehicle Excise (MVE)	A locally imposed annual tax assessed to owners of motor vehicles registered to an address within the community. The excise tax rate is set by statute at $25.00 per $1,000 of vehicle value. Owner registration and billing information is maintained by the State

	Registry of Motor Vehicles and is made available to a city or town, or to the Deputy Collector who represents it.
Municipal Charges Lien	For delinquent water (M.G.L. Ch. 40 §§42A-F), sewer (M.G.L. Ch. 83 §§16AF), and trash (M.G.L. Ch. 44 §28C(f)) charges, a community may lien these amounts on the property tax provided the enabling legislation is accepted and a certificate of acceptance is on file at the Registry of Deeds. For other unpaid local charges and fees, a community may adopt M.G.L. Ch. 40 §58 separately for each purpose in order to lien each upon the property tax. The lien is created by recording a listing of a particular type of charge or fee (by parcel of land and by name) at the Registry of Deeds.
Municipal Data Bank	Located within the Division of Local Services (DLS), the Municipal Data Bank collects, organizes, stores, and publishes historical financial information on cities and towns, regional districts and the Commonwealth. Public access to the data is available through links at the DLS website at www.mass.gov/dls.
Net Assets Unrestricted (Formerly Retained Earnings)	An equity account reflecting the accumulated earnings of an enterprise fund that may be used to fund capital improvements, to reimburse the general fund for prior year subsidies, to reduce user charges and to provide for enterprise revenue deficits (operating loss).
Net School Spending (NSS)	School budget and municipal budget amounts attributable to education, excluding long-term debt service, student transportation, school lunches and certain other specified school expenditures. A community's NSS funding must equal or exceed the NSS Requirement established annually by the Department of Education (DOE) (See Education Reform Act of 1993).
Net School Spending Requirement	Sum of a school district's minimum local contribution and the Chapter 70 aid received in a given fiscal year (FY). Municipalities and regional school districts must appropriate funds sufficient to the net school spending requirement. In addition to the NSS requirement funds need to be appropriated to support costs of student transportation, fixed assets, long term debt service, and other costs not part of the NSS. Ch. 194 §126 of the Acts of 1998 limits the net school spending requirement for regional vocational districts to 150% of the foundation budget. When the net school spending requirements exceed 150% of the foundation budget, the required local contributions of the member towns are reduced proportionately. Any reduction is applied to any below foundation districts to which the municipality belongs.
New Growth	The additional tax revenue generated by new construction, renovations and other increases in the property tax base during a calendar year. It does not include value increases caused by normal market forces or by revaluations. New growth is calculated by multiplying the assessed value associated with new construction, renovations and other increases by the prior year tax rate. The additional tax revenue is then incorporated into the calculation of the next year's levy limit. For example, new growth for FY 19 is based on new construction, etc. that occurred between January and December 2017. In the fall of 2018, when new growth is being estimated to set the FY 19 levy limit, the FY 18 tax rate is used in the calculation.
Non-Allocated Receipts	Municipal receipts that need not be expended in a particular way due to their source. Non-allocated receipts are listed on page 3 of the Tax Rate and Pro Forma Recapitulation form. Specifically excluded are offset receipts, enterprise funds, and revolving funds.
Non-Expendable Trust	A trust fund administered by the treasurer, from which principle, but not interest, can be expended for the purposes specified by the donor or agreed upon when the money was donated or transferred to the community. (See Trust Fund; Expendable Trust.)

Non-Recurring Revenue Source	A one-time source of money available to a city or town. By its nature, a non-recurring revenue source cannot be relied upon in future years. Therefore, such funds should not be used for operating or other expenses that continue from year-to-year. (See Recurring Revenue Source.)
Objects Of Expenditures	A classification of expenditures that is used for coding any department disbursement, such as "personal services," "expenses," or "capital outlay."
Official Statement	A document prepared for potential investors that contains information about a prospective bond or note issue and the issuer. The official statement is typically published with the notice of sale. It is sometimes called an offering circular or prospectus.
Offset Receipts	A local option that allows estimated receipts of a particular department to be earmarked for use of the department and appropriated to offset its annual operating budget. If accepted, M.G.L. Ch. 44 §53E limits the amount of offset receipts appropriated to no more than the actual receipts collected for the prior fiscal year. The Director of Accounts must approve use of a higher amount before appropriation. Actual collections greater than the amount appropriated close to the general fund at year-end. If actual collections are less, the deficit must be raised in the next year's tax rate.
Operating Budget	A plan of proposed expenditures for personnel, supplies, and other expenses for the coming fiscal year.
Other Amounts to Be Raised (see Tax Recapitulation Sheet)	Amounts not appropriated but raised through taxation. Generally, these are locally generated expenditures (*e.g.*, overlay, teacher pay deferral, deficits) as well as state, county, and other special district charges. Because they must be funded in the annual budget, special consideration should be given to them when finalizing the budget recommendations to the city or town council or town meeting.
Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB)	Employees of state and local governments may be compensated in a variety of forms in exchange for service that will not be received until after their employment with the government ends. The most common type of these post-employment benefits is a pension. Post-employment benefits other than pensions generally take the form of health insurance and dental, vision, prescription, or other healthcare benefits provided to eligible retirees, including in some cases their beneficiaries. They may also include some type of life insurance. As a group, these are referred to as OPEB.
Outside Debt	Municipal borrowing for purposes enumerated in M.G.L. Ch. 44, §8, the debt incurred for which is not measured against the community's debt limit per Ch. 10. Consequently, the borrowing is outside the debt limit and referred to as outside debt. (See Inside Debt.)
Overlay Reserve (Provision for Abatements & Exemptions)	An account established annually to fund anticipated property tax abatements, exemptions, and uncollected taxes in that year. The overlay reserve is not established by the normal appropriation process, but rather is raised on the tax rate recapitulation sheet.
Overlay Deficit	A deficit that occurs when the amount of overlay raised in a given year is insufficient to cover abatements, statutory exemptions, and uncollected taxes for that year. Overlay deficits must be provided for in the next fiscal year.
Overlay Surplus	Any balance in the overlay account of a given year in excess of the amount remaining to be collected or abated can be transferred into this account. Within ten days of a written request by the chief executive officer of a city or town, the assessors must provide a certification of the excess amount of overlay available to transfer. Overlay surplus may

	be appropriated for any lawful purpose. At the end of each fiscal year, unused overlay surplus is "closed" to surplus revenue; in other words, it becomes a part of free cash.
Override	A vote by a community at an election to permanently increase the levy limit. An override vote may increase the levy limit no higher than the levy ceiling. The override question on the election ballot must state a purpose for the override and the dollar amount.
Override Capacity	The difference between a community's levy ceiling and its levy limit. It is the maximum amount by which a community may override its levy limit.
Payments In Lieu Of Taxes (PILOT)	An agreement between a municipality and an entity not subject to taxation, such as charitable or educational organizations, in which the payer agrees to make a voluntary payment to the municipality. By law, a city or town must make such a payment to any other community in which it owns land used for public purposes.
Permanent Debt	Borrowing by a community typically involving a debt service amortization period of greater than one year. (See Long-Term Debt.)
Personal Property	Movable items not permanently affixed to, or part of the real estate. It is assessed separately from real estate to certain businesses, public utilities, and owners of homes that are not their primary residences.
Personnel Costs	The cost of salaries, wages, and related employment benefits.
Preliminary Tax Bill	The tax bill for the first two quarters of the fiscal year sent, no later than July 1, by communities on a quarterly tax billing cycle. The tax due on a preliminary tax bill can be no greater than the amount due in the last two quarters of the previous fiscal year.
Principal	The face amount of a bond, exclusive of accrued interest.
Property Tax Levy (See Levy)	The amount a community raises through the property tax. The levy can be any amount up to the levy limit, which is re-established every year in accordance with Proposition 2½ provisions.
Proposition 2½	State law enacted in 1980 that regulates local property tax administration. Major provisions of this legislation are located in M.G.L. Ch. 59 - Assessment of Local Taxes §21C and relate to the determination of a levy limit and levy ceiling for each town.
Proprietary Funds	Funds that account for government's business-type activities (e.g., activities that receive a significant portion of their funding through user charges). The fund types included in proprietary funds are the enterprise fund and the internal service fund. The internal service fund accounts for certain central services (*e.g.*, data processing, printing, postage, motor pool) and then allocates the cost among departments or funds within the governmental unit.
Provision for Abatements & Exemptions	(See Overlay Reserve.)
Public Employee Retirement Administration (PERAC)	The Public Employee Retirement Administration oversees and directs the state retirement system and administers benefits for members.
Purchase Order	An official document or form authorizing the purchase of products and services. Outstanding purchase orders are called encumbrances.
Quarterly Tax Bills	Local option to issue two estimated (or three estimated when authorized by the General Court) property tax bills followed by two (or one, if three estimated) regular bills by prescribed dates.

Raise And Appropriate	A phrase used to identify a funding source for an expenditure or expenditures, which refers to money generated by the tax levy or other local receipt.
Real Property	Land, buildings, and the rights and benefits inherent in owning them.
Recap Sheet	(See Tax Rate Recapitulation Sheet.)
Receipts Reserved	Proceeds that are earmarked by law and placed in separate accounts for appropriation for particular purposes. For example, ambulance receipts.
Receivables	An expectation of payment of an amount certain accruing to the benefit of a city or town.
Reconciliation Of Receivables	Periodic process where the accountant and collector compare records to confirm amount of taxes outstanding. DOR requires an annual reconciliation of receivables without variances to be submitted with a balance sheet as a prerequisite to certifying a community's free cash.
Recertification/Triennial Certification	The Commissioner of Revenue, through the Bureau of Local Assessment, is required to review local assessed values every three years and to certify that they represent full and fair cash value (FFCV). Refer to M.G.L. Ch. 40 §56 and Ch. 59 §2A(c).
Recurring Revenue Source	A source of money used to support municipal expenditures, which by its nature can be relied upon, at some level, in future years. (See Non-Recurring Revenue Source.)
Reserve Fund	An amount set aside annually within the budget of a city (not to exceed 3% of the tax levy for the preceding year) or town (not to exceed 5% of the tax levy for the preceding year) to provide a funding source for extraordinary or unforeseen expenditures. In a town, the finance committee can authorize transfers from this fund for "extraordinary or unforeseen" expenditures. Other uses of the fund require budgetary transfers by town meeting. In a city, transfers from this fund may be voted by the city or town council upon recommendation of the town manager or mayor.
Reserves	Money accumulated for future expenditure. The General Fund savings account and the Stabilization Fund are general reserves that may be used for a wide variety of purposes. Some reserves are available only for restricted purposes, for example, the Pension and Insurance reserve.
Rating Agencies	This term usually refers to Moody's Investors Service, Standard and Poor's Corporation, and Fitch ICBA, Inc. These are the three major agencies which issue credit ratings on municipal bonds.
Residential Exemption	A municipality can grant a residential exemption of a dollar amount that cannot exceed 20% of the average assessed value of all residential class properties. The exemption reduces, by the adopted percentage, the taxable valuation of each residential parcel that is a taxpayer's principal residence. Granting the exemption raises the residential tax rate and shifts the residential tax burden from moderately valued homes to apartments, summer homes and higher valued homes.
Retained Earnings	An equity account reflecting the accumulated earnings of an enterprise fund that may be used to fund capital improvements, to reimburse the general fund for prior year subsidies, to reduce user charges and to provide for enterprise revenue deficits (operating loss).
Revaluation	The assessors of each community are responsible for developing a reasonable and realistic program to achieve the fair cash valuation of property in accordance with constitutional and statutory requirements. The nature and extent of that program will depend on the assessors' analysis and consideration of many factors, including, but not

	limited to, the status of the existing valuation system, the results of an in-depth sales ratio study, and the accuracy of existing property record information. Every three years, assessors must submit property values to the DOR for certification. Assessors must also maintain current values in the years between certifications so that each taxpayer in the community pays his or her share of the cost of local government in proportion to the value of his property. (See Recertification.)
Revenue Deficit	The amount by which actual revenues at year-end fall short of projected revenues and are insufficient to fund the amount appropriated. In such a case and unless otherwise funded, the revenue deficit must be raised in the following year's tax rate.
Revenues	All monies received by a governmental unit from any source.
Revolving Fund	Allows a community to raise revenues from a specific service and use those revenues without appropriation to support the service. Wages or salaries for full-time employees may be paid from the revolving fund only if the fund is also charged for all associated fringe benefits.
Schedule A	A statement of revenues, expenditures and other financing sources, uses, changes in fund balance and certain balance sheet account information prepared annually by the accountant or auditor at the end of the fiscal year. This report is based on the fund account numbers and classifications contained in the UMAS manual.
School Choice Aid	A component of Chapter 70 state aid provided to a municipality for public education. If a district is spending below the foundation budget and it was a "sending" district under school choice in the prior fiscal year (FY), the district generally receives school choice aid in an amount equal to any increase in its prior year estimated gross school choice liability, when compared to the previous year.
Short-Term Debt/Temporary Debt	Outstanding balance, at any given time, on amounts borrowed with a maturity date of 12 months or less.
Special Assessments	(See Betterments.)
Special Revenue Fund	Funds, established by statute only, containing revenues that are earmarked for and restricted to expenditures for specific purposes. Special revenue funds include receipts reserved for appropriation, revolving funds, and grants from governmental entities and gifts from private individuals or organizations.
Stabilization Fund	A fund designed to accumulate amounts for capital and other future spending purposes, although it may be appropriated for any lawful purpose (M.G.L. Ch. 40 §5B). Communities may establish one or more stabilization funds for different purposes and may appropriate into them in any year an amount not to exceed 10% of the prior year's tax levy. The total of all stabilization fund balances shall not exceed 10% of the community's equalized value, and any interest shall be added to and become a part of the funds. A two-thirds vote of town meeting or city or town council is required to establish, amend the purpose of, or appropriate money from the stabilization fund
Submitted Budget	The proposed budget that has been approved by the Town Manager and forwarded to the Town Council for its approval. The Council must act upon the submitted budget within prescribed guidelines and limitations according to statute and the Town Charter.
Supplemental Appropriations	Appropriations made by the Town Council after an initial appropriation to cover expenditures beyond original estimates.

Surplus Revenue	The amount by which cash, accounts receivable, and other assets exceed liabilities and reserves.
Tailings	Unclaimed municipal funds, or a repository, referred to as a "tailings account," for the retention, until eventual disposition, of unclaimed funds in the custody of a municipality. Tailings might include unclaimed tax refunds, vendor payments yet to clear, overages on the community's commitment, etc. (M.G.L. Ch. 200A)
Tax Rate	The amount of property tax stated in terms of a unit of the municipal tax base; for example, $20.80 per $1,000 of assessed valuation of taxable real and personal property.
Tax Recapitulation Sheet	A document submitted by a city or town to the DOR in order to set a property tax rate. The recap sheet shows all estimated revenues and actual appropriations that affect the property tax rate. The recap sheet should be submitted to the DOR by September 1 (in order to issue the first-half semi-annual property tax bills before October 1) or by December 1 (in order to issue the third quarterly property tax bills before January 1).
Tax Title	A collection procedure that secures a city or town's lien on real property and protects the municipality's right to payment of overdue property taxes. Otherwise, the lien expires if five years elapse from the January 1 assessment date and the property has been transferred to another owner. If amounts remain outstanding on the property after issuing a demand for overdue property taxes and after publishing a notice of tax taking, the collector may take the property for the city or town. After properly recording the instrument of taking, the collector transfers responsibility for collecting the overdue amounts to the treasurer. After six months, the treasurer may initiate foreclosure proceedings.
Tax Title Foreclosure	The procedure initiated in Land Court by a city or town treasurer to obtain legal title to real property already in tax title and on which property taxes are overdue.
Tax Title Redemption	The act of a property owner to pay overdue taxes, plus any fees, charges, other costs and interest, on real property that the community had placed in tax title to secure its lien. The taxpayer's right to redeem terminates when the treasurer files a petition to foreclose on the property in the Land Court.
Trust Fund	In general, a fund for money donated or transferred to a municipality with specific instructions on its use.
Undesignated Fund Balance	A requirement imposed by law, regulation or order without underlying financial support, thereby resulting in direct or indirect costs to the body made responsible for its implementation.
Uniform Municipal Accounting System	UMAS succeeds the so-called Statutory System (STAT) and is regarded as the professional standard for municipal accounting in Massachusetts. As a uniform system for local governments, it conforms to Generally Accepted Accounting Principles.
User Charges/Fees	A municipal funding source where payment is collected from the user of a service to help defray the cost of providing the service. Note that any increases in the fees must satisfy the three tests set forth in the so-called Emerson case. (See Emerson College v. Boston, 391 Mass. 415 (1984); DOR IGR 88-207.)
Warrant	An authorization for an action. For example, a town meeting warrant establishes the matters that may be acted on by that town meeting. A treasury warrant authorizes the treasurer to pay specific bills. The assessors' warrant authorizes the tax collector to collect taxes in the amount and from the persons listed, respectively.

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Appropriation Orders

Taxes, after all, are dues that we pay for the privileges of membership in an organized society."

- Franklin D. Roosevelt

		ORDER DESCRIPTION	FUNDING SOURCES						
AMOUNT APPROPRIATED	ORDER NUMBER	FY2027 BUDGET ORDERS	RAISE & APPROP	AMB RECEIPTS	CPA	OTHER FINANCING SOURCES	ENTERPRISE REVENUE	ENTERPRISE RETAINED EARNINGS	TOTAL
$ 20,434,781	27-02	REGIONAL SCHOOL BUDGET ASSESSMENT	20,434,781						20,434,781
									-
	27-04	APPROPRIATE FY27 OPERATING BUDGET							-
$ 7,836,382		RETIREMENT ASSESSMENTS	7,836,382						7,836,382
$ 600,000		OTHER POST-EMPLOYMENT BENEFITS (OPEB)	600,000						600,000
$ 30,833,590		MUNICIPAL OPERATING BUDGET:	27,633,590	3,200,000					30,833,590
		GENERAL GOVERNMENT							-
		PUBLIC SAFETY							-
		PUBLIC WORKS							-
		CONSERVATION & DEVELOPMENT							-
		COMMUNITY SERVICES							-
$ 2,486,329		LIBRARY SERVICES	2,486,329						2,486,329
$ 29,478,590		ELEMENTARY SCHOOLS	29,478,590						29,478,590
$ 5,733,376		DEBT SERVICE	5,195,960		462,416	75,000			5,733,376
		ENTERPRISE FUNDS:							-
$ 6,840,384		SEWER FUND					6,840,384		6,840,384
$ 6,723,843		WATER FUND					6,723,843		6,723,843
$ 659,162		SOLID WASTE FUND					638,000	21,162	659,162
$ 707,044		TRANSPORTATION FUND					645,996	61,048	707,044
$ 91,898,700			73,230,851	3,200,000	462,416	75,000	14,848,223	82,210	91,898,700
$ 4,590,893	27-05A	CAPITAL IMPROVEMENT PROGRAM - FY27 CIP	4,200,893	15,000		375,000			4,590,893
$ 116,924,374			97,866,525	3,215,000	462,416	450,000	14,848,223	82,210	116,924,374